# Partisanship in Belgian Parliamentary Speech: Evidence from the Chamber of Representatives, 1831–2025*

Riccardo Graziani
KU Leuven, VIVES, Leuven, Belgium
riccardo.graziani@kuleuven.be

This version: October 14, 2026

**Abstract**

How have divisions between Belgian parties changed over time? How did they change around wider voting rights, proportional representation and the split of national parties along linguistic lines? We measure partisanship in speeches in the Belgian Chamber of Representatives from its first sitting in 1831 to 2025. We use the measure developed for the US Congress by Gentzkow et al. (2019): the expected posterior probability that a neutral observer assigns to a speaker's actual party after hearing a single phrase. It measures how easily parties can be told apart by their wording, not how far apart their policy positions are. The vocabulary leaves out phrases without content, such as the formulas with which ministers and rapporteurs submit bills and reports. Partisanship between Catholics and other parties is low under census suffrage and higher in the decade after the Socialists enter the Chamber in 1894. It remains moderate, with some periods above its random benchmark, until the early 1990s and is never above that benchmark in the federal era. Once procedural formulas are left out, the 1950s, the decade of the Royal Question and the second school war, are not a period of unusually distinct wording. Partisanship between the left and all other parties is high from 1898 to 1940, low from the mid-1980s to the 2010s and highest in the short period 2024–2025. Partisanship between government and opposition is highest between the wars and exceeds its random benchmark in more than half of the periods since 1995. In these three divisions, the model implies that an observer hearing one minute of speech would identify a member's group correctly with probability of at most 0.63 to 0.66, below the US Congress in 2007 and Finland in the 1970s. When the Liberals, the populist radical right and N-VA are grouped as the right, the wording of the left and that of the right are easiest to tell apart from 1904 to 1932, and the wording of the right and that of all other parties has become easier to tell apart since the 1970s, most clearly in 2024–2025. Since 1979, pairs of parties use more similar wording when both are in opposition. Before the national parties split, Flemish and Walloon members differed mainly in their regional agendas, and their speech did not become easier to tell apart; members of the same party voted differently mainly on language bills. As in the United States, Finland and Norway, partisanship between the left and other parties and between government and opposition has risen in recent years.

*Preliminary draft; comments welcome. The series are estimated on the version of the dataset of 12 October 2026, with a vocabulary that leaves out phrases without content. Text in brown still reports earlier estimates of the series estimated last and will be updated.

**JEL Classification**: D72, N43, N44
**Keywords**: text analysis, parliamentary speech, polarization, partisanship, Belgium

# 1 Introduction

Political polarization can weaken government efficiency and stability. High polarization may block decision-making (Jones, 2001; Binder, 2003) or even threaten democracy (Arbatli and Rosenberg, 2021). Polarization usually refers to disagreement or differences in attitudes between groups (DiMaggio et al., 1996). Political scientists typically measure it by estimating legislators' positions from roll-call votes and combining the distances between them (Poole and Rosenthal, 1985; McCarty et al., 2006). Under strong party discipline, however, votes reveal little about differences that parties choose not to bring to a vote. Speech is less constrained by party discipline than voting (Proksch and Slapin, 2015; Schwarz et al., 2017). This matters in Belgium, where parties control their members' parliamentary careers and discipline in the Chamber has traditionally been high (Depauw, 2003; Deschouwer, 2012). We document differences in speech between parties in the Belgian Chamber of Representatives from 1831 to 2025. Following Gentzkow et al. (2019), we call these differences partisanship of speech, or simply partisanship. Partisanship measures how easily an observer could tell parties apart from their words. It is not a measure of the distance between their policy positions: parties can speak differently because they discuss different subjects, hold different roles in parliament or use different words for similar policies.

We use the Belgian Chamber Debates dataset (Graziani, 2026). It covers the available official reports of the plenary sittings from the Chamber's first sitting in 1831 to the end of 2025; coverage is incomplete in 1832–1843 and 1992–1995, and individual sittings may be missing in other years (Section 3). Each speech is linked to its speaker and, through the speaker, to a party, electoral district and biography. We convert the 1,732,227 speeches by Chamber members into stemmed two-word phrases and count them by member and by period of about two years. The vocabulary leaves out phrases without content: procedural formulas, forms of address and titles, including the names of ministries, names of parties, groups and persons, numbers, dates, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (Section 3). The measure introduced for the US Congress by Gentzkow et al. (2019) is the expected posterior probability that a neutral observer assigns to a speaker's actual party after hearing a single phrase. We also use their penalized estimator, random-label benchmark, magnitude measures and measure of individual phrase partisanship. The measure has since been applied to Norway's (Fiva et al., 2021) and Finland's (Simola et al., 2025) multiparty parliaments. As in Belgium, these applications compare two groups at a time. Related supervised measures predict a speaker's party from the text and have been applied to the House of Commons (Peterson and Spirling, 2018; Goet, 2019) and Sweden's Riksdag (Wising et al., 2026).

Belgium extends the existing evidence in three ways. First, our series begins under census suffrage, when only a small fraction of adult men elected the Chamber. It covers the full transition from an elite electorate to mass democracy: plural voting in 1893, the adoption of list proportional representation for a national parliament in 1899, equal male suffrage in 1919 and women's suffrage in 1948. Second, three cleavages shaped the Belgian party system (Lorwin, 1966; Lipset and Rokkan, 1967; Lijphart, 1981): religion divided Catholics and anticlericals, socioeconomic interests divided labour and capital, and language divided Dutch- and French-speakers. We measure each through a separate grouping of parties. Third, debates take place in

two languages. Between 1968 and 1978, the national parties split along linguistic lines, leaving each party to represent one language community. Combining both languages in one measure would then capture differences in language as well as partisanship. We therefore build separate French and Dutch vocabularies, compare parties within each language, and weight the two estimates by their shares of speech.

Religious partisanship measures differences between the Catholic family and all other parties. Under census suffrage, it is low. Between 1846, when the Liberals organized as a party, and 1893, it averages less than 0.0001 above the random-label benchmark and exceeds that benchmark in only four of 23 periods. It is higher in the decade after the first elections under plural voting, when the Socialists join the Liberals in the non-Catholic group: it exceeds the benchmark in all five periods from 1894 to 1904, with net values of 0.0007 to 0.0017. From the First World War to the early 1990s, it is moderate, with periods above the benchmark between the wars, in 1944–1950, in the 1960s and in the 1980s. Its highest value, 0.0020 in 1969–1971, comes soon after the Christian democrats split along linguistic lines in 1968; it rests mainly on French speech and does not exceed the benchmark without covariates (Section 5.1). In the federal era, the series never exceeds its benchmark.

The 1950s are not a maximum. No period of 1950–1963 exceeds the benchmark, although these years include the end of the Royal Question and the second school war. In estimates on all phrases, the religious series was highest in 1950–1958, but that maximum came largely from the formulas with which the governing side submits bills and reports (Section 5.1.1). The one-minute probability is highest in 1981–1983: the model implies that an observer hearing one minute of speech would then identify a member's group correctly with probability 62.5 per cent, compared with 56.4 per cent in the last period. The US Congress reached 73 per cent in 2007 (Gentzkow et al., 2019), while Finland's Eduskunta peaked slightly below 70 per cent in the 1970s (Simola et al., 2023).

Partisanship between the left and all other parties, which we call left–others partisanship, is high from 1898 to 1940. It exceeds its benchmark in 16 of the 19 periods, with its highest pre-war values in 1904–1908 and an interwar maximum during the crisis and special powers of 1932–1934. It is lower after 1945, and lowest from the mid-1980s to 2021, when it exceeds its benchmark in two of 15 periods. It rises in 2021–2024 and reaches its highest value, 0.0052, in 2024–2025, a short period. This value comes mainly from Dutch speech, and in earlier estimates the recent values were sensitive to how the members of the joint green group are assigned to language communities. The leave-out estimator, which does not penalize phrase effects, places 2024–2025 above every other period after 1914 but below most periods before 1914. Unlike in Finland (Simola et al., 2025), the radical left does not drive the highest value: excluding it removes the rise of 2021–2024 and lowers the 1932–1934 value, but 2024–2025 remains the highest period.

Government–opposition partisanship compares the members of governing and opposition parties. It is low under census suffrage and plural voting, and highest between the wars, when it exceeds its benchmark in seven of the eight periods from 1921 to 1940 in which it is defined. In those years, the Socialists opposed Catholic–Liberal governments, except in 1925–1927, until they joined the government of national union in 1935; smaller groups then formed the opposition.

From 1947 to 1994, the series exceeds its benchmark in only two periods. Since 1995, it does so in 8 of 14 periods, more often than the religious, left–others, left–right and right–others series, and it is high again in 2021–2025. Across periods, it moves with left–others partisanship (correlation 0.55) and only weakly with religious partisanship (0.23). Left–others partisanship is higher, on average, when most Socialist members belong to the opposition, but it also exceeds its benchmark in many periods when they govern. These are associations, not effects of government status.

The most partisan phrases illustrate these divisions. They include vocabulary about schools (*écoles communales*, *instruction publique*, *enseignement libre*), social issues (*classe ouvrière*, *suffrage universel*) and the Royal Question (*consultation populaire*). Between government and opposition, they follow the policies of the day: the Socialist opposition of 1932–1934 speaks of the full powers of the government (*pleins pouvoirs*), and the opposition of 2024–2025 of flexi-jobs and new taxes (*flexi-jobs*, *nieuwe belastingen*). The formulas with which ministers and rapporteurs submit bills and reports are not in the vocabulary. Only those who govern use them, and with them the religious series would be highest in the 1950s (Section 5.12). We do not control for whether the speaker's party is in government. Simola et al. (2025) include this control, while Gentzkow et al. (2019) control for majority-party status in Congress. For long periods, a single party family formed the government, so including this control prevents us from separately identifying religious partisanship.

Belgium's multiparty system also allows comparisons between pairs of party families and, since 1979, between parties. Catholic and Liberal wording was hard to tell apart for most of the period; their partisanship exceeds its random benchmark mainly under census suffrage, when the two families held almost all the seats. Catholic–Socialist partisanship exceeds its benchmark more often than that of the other two pairs, in every period from 1894 to 1919 and in all but one between the wars. Liberal and Socialist wording was easiest to tell apart before 1914, when both families were in opposition to Catholic governments. Since 1979, two parties of the same language use more similar wording when both are in opposition, but not when both govern. The wording of N-VA and Vlaams Belang shows no clear trend towards greater similarity. These comparisons are symmetric: they show when the wording of two families or parties became more or less similar, not which of them changed.

Our multiparty index measures expected partisanship between two members of different families. It is highest in 1936–1939, when the Flemish nationalists and Rex entered the Chamber in strength, followed by 1896–1898, after the Socialists' entry, and 2024–2025. The recent rise comes mainly from comparisons involving PVDA-PTB's radical left or the radical right. Before the national parties split, Flemish and Walloon members differed in their French speech mainly because of their regional agendas: canals, coal and the Walloon industrial basins on one side, and linen, sugar and ports on the other. Language policy appears among their distinctive phrases only in some periods. Their speech did not become easier to tell apart in the decades before the split. In roll-call votes, Flemish and Walloon members of the same party seldom diverge, except on some language bills before the Second World War; all Flemish and all Walloon members vote most differently when one region's members are mostly in government and the other's mostly in opposition, as before 1914 and in 2014–2019.

Because the left–others grouping places Christian democrats, Greens and regionalists alongside Liberals and the radical right, we also compare the left with the right in a narrower sense—the Liberal family, the populist radical right and N-VA—and the right with all other parties. Left–right partisanship is high from 1904 to 1932, when it exceeds its benchmark in 8 of 12 periods; after 1946, it does so only in 2016–2019. Right–others partisanship is low until the 1970s and higher since then. It exceeds its benchmark in 7 of the 14 periods since 1995 and is highest in 2024–2025.

Changes in voting rights are only loosely associated with changes in these series. Religious and government–opposition partisanship rose after the first elections under plural voting in 1894, when the Socialists entered the Chamber. This is consistent with the Chamber–Senate comparison in Graziani and Vanschoonbeek (2026). After proportional representation, first used in 1900, government–opposition partisanship fell, while the changes in the other two series lie within two standard errors. Around equal male suffrage, religious and left–others partisanship changed little, while government–opposition partisanship was higher after the national-union governments of 1918–1921 than before the war. Around women's suffrage, first used in 1949, all three series changed by less than two standard errors.

Belgium's highest one-minute probabilities in the three main divisions, 62.5, 65.1 and 65.9 per cent, are below those of the US Congress in 2007 and of Finland's peak in the 1970s (Section 5.11). Its religious divide is most visible in speech in the decade after 1894 and, after the Christian democrats split, around 1970 and in the early 1980s; it is not visible in the federal era. Left–others partisanship reaches its highest value in 2024–2025, and government–opposition partisanship its highest value since the 1930s in 2021–2024, as partisanship has also risen in recent decades in the United States, Finland and Norway. From 1981 to 1999, the left–others probability is close to that of the Norwegian Storting in the same years, and it is lower afterwards. As in other parliamentary systems, the government–opposition divide is clearly visible in speech, between the wars and again since 1995.

Two companion modules of the dataset extend the analysis. Topic labels for every speech distinguish differences in what parties discuss from differences in how they discuss the same subject (Section 6). Within policy areas, religious and left–others partisanship lies above its random series in most legislatures and moves with partisanship over all phrases, closely for the left–others grouping and loosely for the religious grouping. Differences in the attention parties give to topics exceed a random benchmark mainly for the left before 1979.

The second module, still in progress, uses stage directions in the record to measure disorder in the Chamber (Section 7). Disorder peaks in the 1950s, a decade in which the parties' wording was not unusually easy to tell apart. Across decades, disorder is moderately correlated with left–others partisanship but not with religious or government–opposition partisanship. Opposition speakers received more disorder than government speakers in every decade from the 1840s to the 2000s. References to members by name were directed towards other party families more often than a random benchmark would predict. From 1900, they also favoured members of the speaker's own language community.

Three limitations matter for interpreting these findings. First, the measure captures differences in wording rather than differences in policy positions or the intensity of conflict. During

the first school war, both sides spoke about schools in proportion to their numbers. Religious partisanship therefore rose much less than historical accounts of the conflict might suggest (Lamberts and Lory, 1986; Witte et al., 2009). Second, levels are not directly comparable across eras, and they depend on the vocabulary. Members used more than twice as many vocabulary phrases per period under plural voting as in the federal era, and the Dutch vocabulary is about a quarter the size of the French vocabulary. Some phrases, such as the formulas with which the governing side submits bills and reports, distinguish the groups only because of their roles. In an earlier estimation on all phrases, the 1950s are the decade of highest religious partisanship and the second highest, after the incomplete 2020s, of left–others and government–opposition partisanship; without the phrases without content, they are not. We leave such phrases out of the vocabulary and remove the translations that the record prints within speech blocks (Sections 3 and 5.12). Third, our confidence intervals have 80 per cent nominal coverage and are not adjusted for the many periods and series we compare, and each random benchmark comes from a single permutation. We therefore emphasize patterns across periods rather than single estimates.

This paper contributes to research on partisan parliamentary speech outside the US two-party system. Peterson and Spirling (2018) measure polarization in Westminster through the accuracy of machine-learning classifiers. Goet (2019) studies polarization in the House of Commons from 1811. Lauderdale and Herzog (2016) estimate positions from speeches in the Irish Dáil and find that the government–opposition divide is the main dimension. Fiva et al. (2021) apply the measure of Gentzkow et al. (2019) to the Norwegian Storting from 1981. Simola et al. (2025) trace a century of Finnish speech. Wising et al. (2026) study the blocs of Sweden's Riksdag, and Hirst et al. (2014) show that Canadian debate classifiers learn government and opposition roles rather than ideology. More broadly, debate rules and party control shape who speaks and how freely members can speak (Proksch and Slapin, 2015; Bäck et al., 2021). For the United States, Jensen et al. (2012) and Gentzkow et al. (2019) document long-run changes in partisan language in Congress.

Belgium adds a series covering census suffrage, wider voting rights, proportional representation and federalization. Its bilingual parliament also allows us to study three distinct cleavages. For 1880–1912, Graziani and Vanschoonbeek (2026) use the same data and the leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019) to compare the Chamber and Senate around the reforms of 1894 and 1900. Here, we study the Chamber's full history and use the penalized estimator as our main measure.

Section 2 describes Belgium and the Chamber. Section 3 presents the data and their limitations, and Section 4 explains the speech model and estimation. Section 5 reports the results and compares Belgium with other parliaments. Within it, Section 5.7 follows Flemish and Walloon members over the whole period, in their votes and in the subjects of their speeches, and we compare differences in speech with divisions in roll-call votes for the main groupings, for pairs of parties and for Flemish and Walloon members. Section 6 discusses topics, Section 7 examines reactions and references in the Chamber, and Section 8 concludes. Online Appendix B lists the parties in each family and the parties in government.

# 2 Background

## 2.1 Belgium, 1830–2025

Belgium became independent after the revolution of 1830 and adopted its Constitution on 7 February 1831. It was the first country in continental Europe to industrialize. Industry developed around coal and iron in the Walloon basins and textiles in Ghent, while most of Flanders remained agricultural (Witte et al., 2009). Figure 10 shows GDP per capita and its growth from 1846, the first year of the annual series (Bolt and van Zanden, 2024, 2025). It records sustained nineteenth-century growth, sharp falls during both German occupations, rapid post-war expansion and a slowdown after the crises of the 1970s. After the Second World War, economic activity shifted from Wallonia towards Flanders. This shift contributed to conflict between the language communities (Deschouwer, 2012).

Three cleavages shaped Belgian politics (Lorwin, 1966; Lijphart, 1981). The religious cleavage divided Catholics and anticlerical Liberals over the Church's role in the state, especially in education. The Liberal school law of 1879 began the first school war. It ended with the Catholic victory of 1884 and a law allowing communes to adopt Catholic schools in place of their own (Lamberts and Lory, 1986; Witte et al., 2009). The second school war concerned the laws of the Socialist–Liberal government of 1954–1958 and ended with the School Pact of 1958. The socioeconomic cleavage developed with the foundation of the Belgian Workers' Party in 1885 and the industrial unrest of 1886. The party entered the Chamber in 1894. The linguistic cleavage divided the Flemish movement and the French-speaking state. It led to the Equality Law of 1898, the language laws of the 1930s, the split of the national parties in 1968–1978 and the state reforms of 1970–1993 that made Belgium a federation (Deschouwer, 2012). These cleavages structured pillars of parties, unions, mutual societies, schools and newspapers (Lijphart, 1981).

Other conflicts crossed these divisions. The Royal Question concerned King Leopold III's return after the Second World War. It divided Catholics from Socialists and Liberals, as well as Flanders from Wallonia. It was settled after the popular consultation of 1950 and the King's abdication in 1951 (Witte et al., 2009; Conway, 2012).

## 2.2 The Chamber of Representatives, 1831–2025

The Constitution of 1831 created a bicameral parliament. The Chamber of Representatives was elected under census suffrage in multi-member districts (arrondissements), with half its seats renewed every two years (Graziani, 2026). The voting qualification was lowered in 1848, but only a small fraction of adult men could vote until 1893. After a general strike, the constitutional revision of 1893 introduced universal male suffrage with plural voting and made voting compulsory. In 1899, Belgium became the first country to adopt list proportional representation for its national parliament; the system was first used in 1900. Equal male suffrage replaced plural voting in 1919, when elections also began to renew the entire Chamber. Women first voted in national elections in 1949 (Ahmed, 2013; Witte et al., 2009; Graziani, 2026).

Until the state reform of 1993, the Chamber and Senate shared legislative power on equal terms. We do not study the Senate's proceedings. The Chamber grew with the population, reaching 212 members in 1949, and has had 150 members since 1995. It did not sit during most of

the German occupations, from August 1914 to November 1918 and from May 1940 to September 1944.

For long periods, governments came from a single party family. After the early unionist cabinets, Liberal and Catholic governments alternated from 1847. Catholics then governed alone from 1884 to the First World War. Coalitions became the norm after 1918. Governments of national union included all three traditional families in 1918–1921, 1926–1927 and most of 1935–1939. The Christian democrats again governed alone in 1950–1954. Under a right established in the Constitution of 1831, ministers may address the Chamber whether or not they are members (Graziani, 2026).

The Chamber has kept a verbatim record of its sittings throughout the period. The record appeared in the official gazette, the *Moniteur belge*, until 1844 and then in the *Annales parlementaires*. For more than a century and a half, it was prepared from shorthand notes. Audio recordings replaced shorthand in 2000. Since 1999, each intervention has been numbered and accompanied by a summary in the other national language (Model, 2021; Graziani, 2026).

Sittings have been public since 1831. For most of the period, voters encountered the debates through newspapers belonging to the same pillars as the parties. French dominated nineteenth-century debates. Dutch speeches were almost absent before the mid-1890s, accounted for about a quarter of speeches by the late 1930s, and have been the majority since the 1980s (Graziani, 2026).

## 3 Data

The Belgian Chamber Debates dataset (Graziani, 2026) covers the available official reports of the plenary sittings from 1831 to 2025. The version used here (12 October 2026) contains 3,411,572 debate blocks, including 2,370,355 speeches. The blocks are segmented from OCR text of the *Moniteur belge* and *Annales parlementaires* and, from 1999, from the Chamber's verbatim reports in PDF. This version adds sittings that an earlier version had omitted on days with more than one sitting. For 533 of the 535 days of 1999–2018 for which the earlier version used the Chamber's website, it takes the text from the PDF reports instead, because the website text merges each intervention with its summary in the other language. In the PDF reports of 1 July 1999 to 14 July 2000, every accent is printed as a separate character after its letter (*pre´sident*); we join each accent to its letter before processing the text. Against hand-annotated excerpts, the segmentation rules achieve an F1 score of 89.1 per cent for block boundaries. Overall, 98.5 per cent of plenary speeches outside the chair's turns are linked to a member or minister. Each speech records its language and the speaker's party, district, gender and ministerial office on the sitting date. Online Appendix B details the sample, preprocessing, and definitions of parties, regions and government status.

**Sample.** We select French or Dutch speech blocks from plenary sittings whose speakers were Chamber members on the sitting date. Following Simola et al. (2023), who exclude the Speaker and Deputy Speakers, we exclude turns by the chair. We also exclude collective interjections, clerks' text, documents read into the record, summaries in the other language and committee

proceedings. Finally, we exclude speeches by ministers who were not Chamber members: senators and extra-parliamentary ministers have no Chamber district. Of the 1,798,626 plenary speeches linked to a member or minister, we retain the 1,732,227 delivered by Chamber members. Of these, 16.6 per cent are in Dutch.

**Periods.** We divide time into periods of about two years. Until 1919, half the Chamber was renewed every two years, so each legislature in the register lasts about two years and forms one period. From 1919, elections renewed the whole Chamber and legislatures lasted up to four years, or five from 2014. We divide legislatures lasting at least three years into two halves at mid-term. These periods correspond to the two-year Congresses in Gentzkow et al. (2019) and parliamentary years in Simola et al. (2025). The wars divide the legislatures elected before them. The sample contains 91 periods, from 1831–1833 to 2024–2025.

**Phrases.** Following Gentzkow et al. (2019), we remove interruptions in parentheses, replace symbols and punctuation with spaces, lowercase the text and remove stopwords. We then reduce words to stems using the Snowball stemmer for each language (Porter, 1980, 2001). We form bigrams from consecutive stems. We exclude bigrams containing a member's surname, a party acronym or name, an address to the chair or a month, along with a list of procedural phrases. We also leave out phrases without content: procedural formulas, courtesies and titles, names of parties and groups, amounts and other numbers (a law with its year and an age remain, as in *67 ans*), dates, other person names, fragments of words, pairs of filler words, and the names of ministries, which serve as titles. These rules are the same as those of the project's website (Online Appendix B). They matter for the results: the formulas with which rapporteurs and ministers deposit reports and bills are used only by those who govern, and the earlier estimates of religious partisanship in the 1950s came largely from them (Section 5.12). As in Gentzkow et al. (2019), a phrase enters the vocabulary if it occurs at least 100 times overall, at least 10 times in one period, and in at least 10 distinct speaker-periods. The separate French and Dutch vocabularies contain 77,324 and 18,045 phrases, with 33,676,145 and 5,135,420 occurrences. Leaving out the phrases without content removes 7,488 French and 4,195 Dutch phrases; 85.8 per cent of French and 71.7 per cent of Dutch occurrences remain. For each language, we count each phrase by member and period. The analysis contains 14,487 speaker-periods and 2,923 members.

**Parties, regions and government.** We use the party labels listed for each legislature and group parties into families: Catholic and Christian democrat, Liberal, Socialist, Communist and radical left, Flemish nationalist, Francophone regionalist, Green, and other. Where noted, the populist radical right—Rex, Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang, Front National and Parti Populaire—forms a separate group. After a family splits, each party belongs to one language community. Members of the joint parliamentary group of the two Green parties belong to the community of their district or, in Brussels, of the language they speak. Families group parties over time: a family's predecessors and successors form a grouping for comparison, not a claim of organizational continuity. Members who switch parties within a period are assigned to their party at the start of that period. Speakers whose party is unknown, 2.0 per cent of member-periods, are left out

of every comparison. Online Appendix Table B2 lists every party label of the register with its family, its speakers and speeches, its side in every comparison and its years in government.

We reconstruct each government's composition from the register of ministers. A party is in government on a given day if one of its members holds ministerial office. Before the national parties split, the party is the national party; afterwards, it is each community's party. Where a family has several parties at the same time—such as the Volksunie and the Vlaams Blok, which the register places in the same family, FDF and the Rassemblement Wallon, or Agalev and Ecolo—each party counts separately, and ministers without a party place no party in government. Online Appendix Table B3 lists the parties in government. We classify a member-period as governing if at least half the member's speeches were delivered while the party was in government. The province of the electoral district serves the same purpose as state in Gentzkow et al. (2019) and dialect region in Simola et al. (2023): it captures regional language differences and members' regional agendas.

**Quality of the record.** Three features of the source matter for the results. First, coverage is incomplete in 1832–1843, when we rely on digitized years of the *Moniteur*, and in 1992–1995, when much plenary business moved to a Central Commission whose proceedings are excluded. Individual sittings may also be missing in other years. Missing sittings can change which debates enter a period, so we shade these years in figures and exclude them from tables. Second, 74 per cent of speeches are linked to a member in the 1830s, compared with more than 92 per cent in every later decade (Online Appendix Figure D3).

Third, the record prints text in the other language and procedural formulas within speech blocks. From 1936 to 1958, a speaker's block often includes the translation of statements by rapporteurs and ministers who submit reports and bills (*Traduction :*, *Vertaling :*). In 1993–1995 and 1997–2007, blocks often end with the formulas of the roll-call procedure (*Résultat du vote*, *Uitslag van de stemming*). Some short interventions are mislabeled, and some speakers use both languages. Before counting phrases, we remove the translations and the roll-call formulas that close the blocks, relabel blocks whose function words clearly belong to the other language, and count sentences in the other language as speech in that language (Online Appendix B). After these corrections, phrases containing a function word from the other language account for at most 0.25 per cent of French phrases and, from 1919, at most 0.21 per cent of Dutch phrases in any period. Section 5.12 discusses the results that these corrections change.

# 4 Model and estimation

## 4.1 Partisanship measure

We divide parties into two groups: $A$, such as the Catholic family, and $B$, containing all other parties. Let $c_{ijt}$ be the number of times speaker $i$ uses phrase $j$ in period $t$, and $m_{it} = \sum_j c_{ijt}$. The share of group $P$'s phrases accounted for by phrase $j$ is $q_{jt}^P = \sum_{i \in P_t} c_{ijt} / \sum_{i \in P_t} m_{it}$. Following Gentzkow et al. (2019), an observer who initially considers both groups equally likely updates

the probability that the speaker belongs to $A$ after hearing phrase $j$:

$$\rho_{jt} = \frac{q_{jt}^A}{q_{jt}^A + q_{jt}^B}. \tag{1}$$

We model speaker $i$'s phrase counts as multinomial:

$$\boldsymbol{c}_{it} \sim MN\left(m_{it}, \boldsymbol{q}_t^{P_i}(\boldsymbol{x}_{it})\right), \tag{2}$$

with phrase-choice probabilities

$$q_{jt}^{P_i}(\boldsymbol{x}_{it}) = \frac{e^{u_{ijt}}}{\sum_k e^{u_{ikt}}}, \qquad u_{ijt} = \alpha_{jt} + \boldsymbol{x}_{it}'\boldsymbol{\gamma}_j + \varphi_{jt}\mathbf{1}_{i\in A_t}, \tag{3}$$

Here, $\alpha_{jt}$ captures the phrase's popularity in that period and $\varphi_{jt}$ is the party effect. The controls in $\boldsymbol{x}_{it}$ are gender and the province of the electoral district, which may affect speech independently of partisanship. Their effects are constant over time, as are most covariate effects in Gentzkow et al. (2019).

Gentzkow et al. (2019) control for majority-party status, while Simola et al. (2025) control for government status. Our main specification omits a control for whether the speaker's party is in government. In Belgium, government status closely follows party membership for long periods. Catholics governed alone in 1846–1847, 1870–1878, 1884–1914 and 1950–1954, and Liberals in 1840–1841, 1847–1855, 1857–1870 and 1878–1884. A nearly unpenalized government coefficient that is constant over time cannot then be separately identified from the penalized party effects.

The estimates confirm this problem. Adding government status produces religious partisanship values of 0.64 to 0.72 in nine periods between 1868 and 1898, all under governments of a single family. With gender and province also controlled for, as in Simola et al. (2025), the values are 0.53 to 0.70 in eight periods between 1868 and 1902, also under governments of a single family. These values lie far outside the range of the other penalized specifications (Online Appendix Figure A2). In the other periods, net partisanship averages close to zero. We instead measure the government–opposition divide directly in Section 5.4.[1]

For characteristics $\boldsymbol{x}$ in period $t$, partisanship is the expected posterior probability assigned to the speaker's actual group after one phrase, starting from equal prior probabilities:

$$\pi_t(\boldsymbol{x}) = \tfrac{1}{2}\,\boldsymbol{q}_t^A(\boldsymbol{x}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\rho}_t(\boldsymbol{x}) + \tfrac{1}{2}\,\boldsymbol{q}_t^B(\boldsymbol{x}) \cdot (1 - \boldsymbol{\rho}_t(\boldsymbol{x}))\,, \tag{4}$$

We average this measure across speakers:

$$\pi_t = \frac{1}{|A_t \cup B_t|} \sum_{i\in A_t\cup B_t} \pi_t(\boldsymbol{x}_{it}). \tag{5}$$

The measure is at least 0.5. It equals 0.5 when both groups use every phrase with the same

[1] Allowing the covariate effects to vary across six institutional periods leaves the real religious series almost unchanged (correlation 0.98) and changes average net religious partisanship little (0.00024, against 0.00028 with constant effects). Individual periods move more, because each specification draws its own random benchmark (Online Appendix Figure A11).

probability. Higher values mean that the two groups are easier to tell apart by their phrases. The measure is symmetric in the two groups and says nothing about how far apart their policy positions are.

### 4.2 Estimation

The vocabulary contains tens of thousands of phrases, most of which appear rarely in any one period. Estimating partisanship directly from observed frequencies therefore creates substantial finite-sample bias: a phrase used only once appears perfectly partisan (Gentzkow et al., 2019). Following Gentzkow et al. (2019) and Taddy (2015), we estimate phrase-choice probabilities with a multinomial logit and a lasso penalty on party effects. We use its Poisson approximation:

$$c_{ijt} \sim \text{Poisson}\left(\exp(\mu_{it} + u_{ijt})\right), \qquad \mu_{it} = \log m_{it}. \tag{6}$$

This approximation allows us to estimate a separate regression for each phrase. For phrase $j$, we minimize

$$\frac{1}{N}\sum_t \sum_i \left[m_{it}e^{u_{ijt}} - c_{ijt}u_{ijt}\right] + \psi\Big(\sum_t |\alpha_{jt}| + \|\gamma_j\|_1\Big) + \lambda_j \sum_t |\varphi_{jt}|, \tag{7}$$

where $N$ is the number of speaker-periods. The small penalty $\psi = 10^{-5}$ is the one Gentzkow et al. (2019) use to ensure convergence. As in their paper, we choose $\lambda_j$ using the Bayesian Information Criterion (Schwarz, 1978). We evaluate 100 penalty values, starting at the smallest value that sets all $\varphi_{jt}$ to zero.

All covariates are indicators. The likelihood therefore depends only on counts and exposures aggregated by period, group and covariate pattern, which simplifies estimation. Given $\gamma_j$, define group $P$'s exposure as $e_t^P = \sum_{i \in P_t} m_{it} e^{x_{it}'\gamma_j}$ and its phrase count as $c_{jt}^P$. Also define $s_{jt} = c_{jt}^A + c_{jt}^B$, $\pi_t^0 = e_t^A/(e_t^A + e_t^B)$, $\nu = N\psi$ and $\kappa_j = N\lambda_j$. The fitted count for group $A$ is

$$\hat{\mu}_{jt}^A = \begin{cases} c_{jt}^A - \kappa_j & \text{if } c_{jt}^A - \pi_t^0(s_{jt}+\nu) > \kappa_j, \\ c_{jt}^A + \kappa_j & \text{if } c_{jt}^A - \pi_t^0(s_{jt}+\nu) < -\kappa_j, \\ \pi_t^0(s_{jt}+\nu) & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \tag{8}$$

The fitted count for group $B$ is $\hat{\mu}_{jt}^B = s_{jt} + \nu - \hat{\mu}_{jt}^A$. The corresponding coefficients are $\hat{\alpha}_{jt} = \log(\hat{\mu}_{jt}^B/e_t^B)$ and $\hat{\varphi}_{jt} = \log(\hat{\mu}_{jt}^A/e_t^A) - \hat{\alpha}_{jt}$. The lasso moves group $A$'s count towards its nonpartisan value by $N\lambda_j$. The penalty on $\alpha_{jt}$ adds $N\psi$ to the fitted total. We can therefore compute the BIC in closed form at every point on the penalty path. We estimate $\gamma_j$ with proximal Newton steps, replacing $(\alpha_{jt}, \varphi_{jt})$ in the objective with their optimal values. We then choose $\lambda_j$ again and repeat until the selected point on the path stops changing.

**Two languages.** We build separate French and Dutch vocabularies and estimate the model for each language. A speaker-period contributes its phrases in the relevant language. After the Catholic (1968), Liberal (1972) and Socialist (1978) families split, members of these families enter only the estimation for their own language community. From 1968, the same rule applies to the parties that belong to a single language community, such as the Flemish nationalists, the

Francophone regionalists and the Greens. This ensures that we compare parties speaking the same language. Before the splits, the province control accounts for differences between Flemish and Walloon members within a party. Period $t$'s partisanship is the weighted average of both languages:

$$\pi_t = \sum_{\ell \in \{\text{fr,nl}\}} w_{\ell t}\, \pi_{\ell t}, \tag{9}$$

The weights $w_{\ell t}$ are each language's share of the phrases spoken by the two groups. We include a language only if each group has at least 10 speakers in it. We include a period only if each group has at least 20 speakers overall, or 15 in pairwise comparisons. Simola et al. (2023) use a threshold of 30. Our lower threshold reflects the Chamber's size: it had 102 to 152 members before 1912, the Socialists entered with 28 members in 1894, and each party belongs to only one language group after the national parties split.

Levels are not comparable across languages. The Dutch vocabulary is about a quarter the size of the French vocabulary. With fewer phrases, each phrase conveys more information about the speaker. We therefore compare the timing of the two series rather than their levels.

### 4.3 Inference

We construct confidence intervals by subsampling (Politis et al., 1999; Gentzkow et al., 2019). For each period, we draw 100 subsamples, each containing 20 per cent of speakers selected without replacement. We estimate the series in each subsample $k$. The intervals are

$$\left[0.5 + \exp\left(\log(\hat{\pi}_t - 0.5) - Q_t^{(90)}/\sqrt{N_t}\right),\ 0.5 + \exp\left(\log(\hat{\pi}_t - 0.5) - Q_t^{(10)}/\sqrt{N_t}\right)\right], \tag{10}$$

where $Q_t^{(p)}$ is the $p$-th percentile of $Q_{kt} = \sqrt{N_{kt}}\,[\log(\hat{\pi}_{t,k} - 0.5) - \log(\bar{\pi}_t - 0.5)]$. Here, $\bar{\pi}_t$ is the subsample average of $\hat{\pi}_{t,k}$ and $N_t$ is the number of speakers. The intervals have 80 per cent nominal coverage.

We also estimate each series after randomly reassigning group labels within each period, keeping group shares fixed (Gentzkow et al., 2019). This benchmark measures the partisanship the estimator detects when labels have no systematic relationship with speech. In our data, it is not flat at 0.5. With groups of a few dozen speakers, it usually lies between 0.500 and 0.503 and rises when one group is small. Because each random series uses a single permutation, it also reflects noise from that draw. For example, the real religious series for 1884–1886 is 0.5029 with covariates and 0.5030 without them, but the two random estimates are 0.5019 and 0.5044. We report net partisanship as $\hat{\pi}_t - \hat{\pi}_t^{\text{random}}$. We say that a period exceeds its random benchmark, and the tables report it as significant, when the real series' lower confidence bound exceeds the random series' upper bound. This is a descriptive rule, not a formal test of the difference between the two series. The intervals have 80 rather than 95 per cent nominal coverage, and we do not adjust them for the many periods and series we compare. We therefore read counts of such periods as a description of a series, and single periods above the benchmark with caution.

### 4.4 Phrase partisanship

The partisanship of phrase $j$ at $\boldsymbol{x}$ measures how removing it changes the expected posterior probability assigned to group $A$ (Gentzkow et al., 2019):

$$\zeta_{jt}(\boldsymbol{x}) = 0.5 - 0.5 \sum_{k \neq j} \left( \frac{q_{kt}^{A}(\boldsymbol{x})}{1 - q_{jt}^{A}(\boldsymbol{x})} + \frac{q_{kt}^{B}(\boldsymbol{x})}{1 - q_{jt}^{B}(\boldsymbol{x})} \right) \rho_{kt}(\boldsymbol{x}). \tag{11}$$

Positive values identify phrases associated with group $A$; negative values identify phrases associated with group $B$. We average across the period's speakers to obtain $\zeta_{jt}$.

### 4.5 OCR noise

OCR errors turn some phrase occurrences into strings outside the vocabulary. Since these errors affect all parties, they tend to blur party differences in older volumes (Hill and Hengchen, 2019; van Strien et al., 2020). We assess this effect by adding simulated OCR errors to the born-digital reports of 2019–2025: common character confusions, deletions, insertions, and split or merged words. We process the altered text with the same pipeline and vocabulary, then re-estimate partisanship. The ratio $(\pi_t^{\text{noisy}} - 0.5)/(\pi_t^{\text{clean}} - 0.5)$ measures attenuation at each character error rate.

## 5 Results

We first study two cleavages: Catholics versus other parties (Section 5.1) and the left versus other parties (Section 5.2). Simola et al. (2023) classify parties as left when their names refer to the left, socialism or workers. We similarly group the Socialist family—the Belgian Workers' Party and its successors—with the Communist and radical left family. All other parties form the comparison group. We call this comparison left–others partisanship, because the comparison group contains every party outside the left, not only the right. Section 5.3 compares the left with the right in a narrower sense, and the right with all other parties. Section 5.4 studies government versus opposition. Section 5.5 compares pairs of families, pairs of parties since 1979, women and men, and each current party with the rest. Section 5.6 compares Flemish and Walloon members before the national parties split, and Section 5.7 compares their votes and the subjects of their speeches from 1831 to 2025. Figures 1, 2 and 4 show both the real series and a benchmark based on randomly permuted group labels.

Table 1 summarizes the main series, and Table 2 reports decade averages. Three patterns stand out. First, no main series has its highest value in the 1950s. Net partisanship is highest in 1969–1971 for the religious grouping, in 2024–2025 for the left–others grouping and in 1934–1936 for government and opposition. The model implies that one minute of speech would allow an observer to identify a member's religious group correctly with probability of at most 62.5 per cent, in 1981–1983, their left–others group with at most 65.1 per cent, in 1932–1934, and their government–opposition group with at most 65.9 per cent, in 1934–1936.

Second, the left–others series exceeds its random benchmark in 47 per cent of periods, the government–opposition and religious series in 30 and 28 per cent, and the left–right and right–

**Table 1:** The main series

| | | | All periods | | Highest period | | | Last |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Series | Years | Periods | Signif. (%) | Mean | Period | Net | One minute | Net |
| Catholic vs other parties | 1843–2025 | 81 | 28 | 0.28 | 1969–1971 | 2.00 | 0.60 | 0.00 |
| Left vs other parties | 1894–2025 | 58 | 47 | 0.83 | 2024–2025 | 5.24 | 0.62 | 5.24 |
| Left vs right | 1900–2025 | 52 | 21 | 0.93 | 1929–1932 | 2.96 | | 2.15 |
| Right vs other parties | 1900–2025 | 52 | 23 | 0.44 | 2024–2025 | 4.30 | | 4.30 |
| Government vs opposition | 1845–2025 | 77 | 30 | 0.35 | 1934–1936 | 3.53 | 0.66 | 2.24 |
| Catholic vs Liberal | 1843–2025 | 81 | 15 | 0.04 | 1974–1977 | 1.89 | | -0.27 |
| Catholic vs Socialist | 1894–2025 | 58 | 47 | 0.53 | 1898–1900 | 4.13 | | 0.25 |
| Liberal vs Socialist | 1894–2025 | 56 | 30 | 0.83 | 1912–1914 | 4.63 | | 0.25 |
| Multiparty index | 1843–2025 | 83 | 35 | 0.60 | 1936–1939 | 4.82 | | 3.96 |
| Women vs men | 1974–2025 | 18 | 56 | 1.63 | 2021–2024 | 3.72 | | 1.11 |

*Notes*: Net partisanship: real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000. Periods: periods when the series is defined; periods with low coverage of the sittings (1832–1843, 1992–1995) are excluded. Signif.: share of the periods when the lower bound of the 80 per cent interval of the real series lies above the upper bound of the interval of the random series (a descriptive rule, not a test; Section 4). Highest period: among the periods above the benchmark, the one with the highest net partisanship. One minute: model-based probability of guessing a member's group correctly after one minute of speech (33 phrases, treated as independent) in that period, computed from the real series (Section 5.10). The multiparty index is estimated with the language rule for every party (Section 5.5). Produced by `code/python/20_main_tables.py`.

others series in 21 and 23 per cent. Third, religious partisanship is low after 1991: its decade averages are between −0.9 and 0.4 per thousand from the 1990s, and no later period exceeds its benchmark. Left–others averages are −0.1 to 0.3 per thousand from the 1990s to the 2010s, and government–opposition averages 0.1 to 0.4. They reach 3.0 and 2.1 in the 2020s, a decade our sample covers only to 2025. The tables also report the three pairs of party families, the multiparty index and the comparison of women and men (Section 5.5).

### 5.1 Religious partisanship

Figure 1 compares the Catholic family with other parties, controlling for gender and province. Three features stand out. First, partisanship is low under census suffrage. Before 1846, net partisanship ranges from −0.0011 to 0.0006, and the real series exceeds its random benchmark only in 1833–1835. Six of these eight periods fall in years that the source covers only in part; the two with adequate coverage, 1843–1845 and 1845–1848, do not exceed it. This fits a period of loose groupings of notables and unionist governments. From 1846, when the Liberals organize as a party, net partisanship averages less than 0.0001. The real series exceeds the random benchmark in 4 of the 23 periods to 1893. The highest values under census suffrage occur during and after the first school war: 0.0011 in 1880–1882 and in 1884–1886. These values appear only after controlling for province. Without covariates, they are no higher than in the 1870s (Online Appendix Figure A2).

Second, partisanship rises under plural voting. It ranges from 0.0007 to 0.0017 in every period from 1894 to 1904, and all these periods exceed the benchmark. This rise coincides with the Socialists' entry into the Chamber, joining the Liberals in group *B*. The Catholic–Liberal pair, which leaves the Socialists out, exceeds its random benchmark in no period of 1894–1914 (Section 5.5). Partisanship is lower in 1904–1912 (0.0001–0.0003) and again exceeds the benchmark in 1912–1914. Third, the series has no maximum in the 1950s. After low values

**Table 2:** Net partisanship by decade

| Decade | Religious | Left–others | Left–right | Right–others | Gov.–opp. | Cath.–Lib. | Cath.–Soc. | Lib.–Soc. | Multiparty | Women–men |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1840s | 0.3 | | | | -0.2 | 0.7 | | | 0.2 | |
| 1850s | -0.1 | | | | 0.2 | 0.2 | | | -0.0 | |
| 1860s | -0.3 | | | | -0.3 | 0.1 | | | -0.3 | |
| 1870s | -0.0 | | | | -0.1 | 0.3 | | | 0.2 | |
| 1880s | 0.4 | | | | -0.1 | 0.6† | | | 0.5† | |
| 1890s | 0.9† | 1.1 | | | 0.3 | 1.0 | 3.6† | 3.2 | 2.3 | |
| 1900s | 0.5 | 1.4† | 2.0† | 0.6 | 0.3 | -0.2 | 2.4† | 2.9† | 1.2† | |
| 1910s | 0.4 | 0.8† | 1.9† | 0.4 | -0.3 | 0.1 | 1.8† | 3.2† | 1.3† | |
| 1920s | 0.5 | 1.3† | 1.6 | 0.1 | 1.0† | -0.1 | 1.3† | 0.9 | 0.8† | |
| 1930s | 0.6 | 1.7† | 1.4 | -0.2 | 2.0† | 0.3 | 1.0† | 1.3 | 2.1† | |
| 1940s | 0.6† | 0.2 | 0.9† | -0.4 | 0.4† | 0.1 | 0.7† | 0.7 | 0.2 | |
| 1950s | 0.3 | 0.4 | 0.6 | -0.1 | 0.1 | -0.9 | 0.0 | -0.1 | 0.2 | |
| 1960s | 0.5† | 1.0† | 0.0 | 0.2 | -0.3 | -1.1 | 0.2 | -0.0 | -0.1 | |
| 1970s | 0.3 | 0.3 | 0.6 | 0.4 | 0.4 | -0.3 | 0.7† | 1.4† | 0.1 | 0.5 |
| 1980s | 0.8 | 0.5 | 0.6 | 0.8 | 0.3 | 0.7 | 0.4 | 0.7 | 0.3 | -0.4 |
| 1990s | 0.4 | 0.1 | -0.3 | 0.5 | 0.1 | -0.4 | -0.5 | -0.6 | -0.1 | 2.1 |
| 2000s | -0.0 | -0.1 | 0.7 | 0.3 | 0.4† | 0.2 | -2.0 | -0.1 | 1.0 | 1.9† |
| 2010s | -0.9 | 0.3 | 0.5 | 0.9† | 0.3 | -0.4 | -0.9 | -0.6 | -0.5 | 1.5† |
| 2020s | 0.0 | 3.0† | 1.0 | 2.4† | 2.1† | -0.1 | -0.8 | 0.7 | 1.9† | 2.6† |

*Notes*: Average net partisanship (real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000) of the periods whose middle year falls in the decade; periods with low coverage of the sittings are excluded. †: the real series is above its random benchmark (the 80 per cent intervals do not overlap) in at least half of the periods of the decade. Religious: Catholic family vs other parties; left–others: Socialist and Communist families vs other parties; left–right: Socialist and Communist families vs the Liberal family, the populist radical right and N-VA; right–others: the Liberal family, the populist radical right and N-VA vs other parties; government–opposition: members of the parties in government vs the others; Cath.–Lib., Cath.–Soc. and Lib.–Soc.: pairs of the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families, without covariates; multiparty: average partisanship of the pairs of all party families, weighted by the product of their numbers of speakers, without covariates; women–men: women vs men of the same family (Section 5.5). The 2020s are not a complete decade: they include the periods to 2025.

under the national-union governments of 1918–1921, partisanship is moderate. It exceeds the benchmark in 1921–1923, 1927–1934, 1944–1946 and 1947–1950, but in no period of 1950–1963, the years of the second school war and of the School Pact. In 1950–1958, net partisanship ranges from $-0.0001$ to 0.0007 (Section 5.1.1). Net partisanship reaches its highest level in 1969–1971, when the real series is 0.5037.

After the Christian democrats split in 1968, the series is noisy. It exceeds its benchmark in five of the 23 periods with adequate coverage: 0.0008 in 1968–1969, 0.0020 in 1969–1971, 0.0019 in 1981–1983, 0.0013 in 1983–1985 and 0.0008 in 1989–1991. The value of 1969–1971, the highest of the series, rests mainly on French speech, in which the Christian democrats have 19 speakers. Their most partisan French phrases in that period concern development cooperation and the European Parliament (Table 10). In 1981–1985, under centre-right governments, special powers (*pouvoirs spéciaux*) are among the other parties' most partisan French phrases (Online Appendix C). The last period includes the abortion law, which passed against the votes of the Christian democrats despite their being in government; *ongeboren leven* is among their most partisan Dutch phrases.

In the federal era, the real series never exceeds the random benchmark. Net partisanship ranges from $-0.0013$ in 2014–2016 to 0.0004 and averages $-0.0003$. In 2019–2024, the Christian democrats have fewer than 20 speakers across both languages, so the series is undefined. Net partisanship is 0.0000 in 2024–2025. Across the full sample, the real series' lower confidence bound exceeds the random series' upper bound in 27.0 per cent of all periods, and in 28 per cent of the periods with adequate coverage (Table 1).

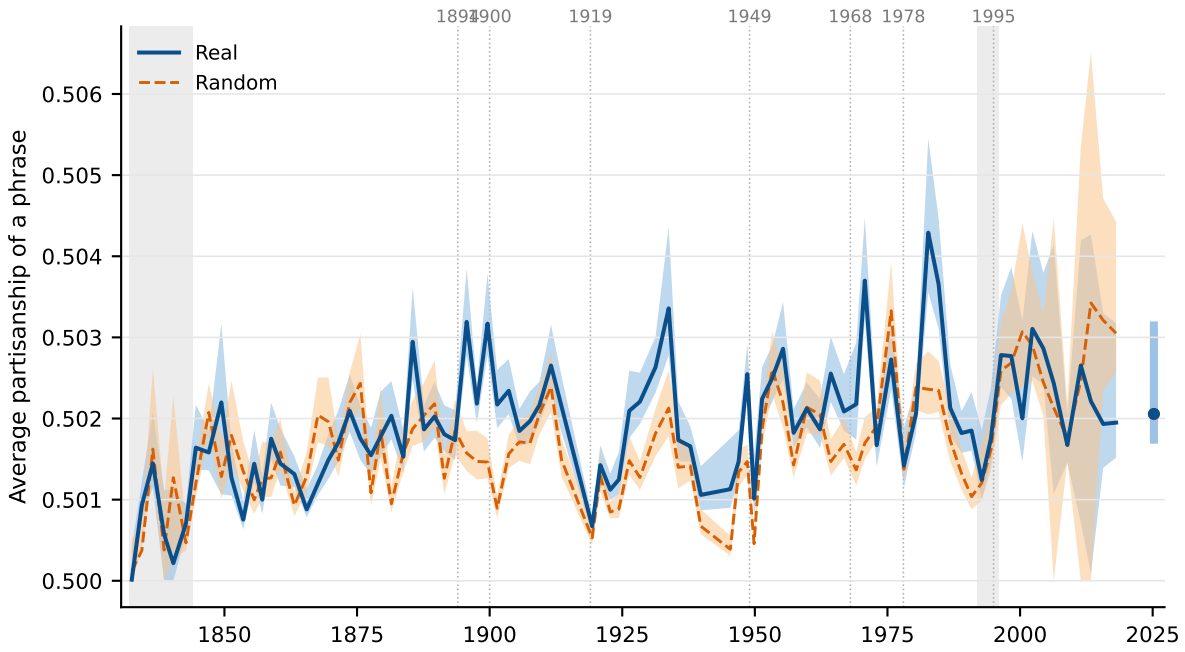



**Figure 1:** Religious partisanship: Catholic family vs other parties, controls for gender and province

*Notes*: Average partisanship of a phrase, $\hat{\pi}_t$, by period of about two years; French and Dutch averaged by their share of speech. Controls for gender and the province of the district. Real: actual party labels; random: labels assigned at random among the speakers of each period, holding group shares fixed. Shaded areas: subsampling confidence intervals with 80 per cent nominal coverage, centred at the estimate. Dotted lines: the reforms of 1894, 1900, 1919, 1949, 1968, 1978 and 1995. Grey bands: years when the source covers the sittings only in part (1832–1843, before the *Annales parlementaires*, and 1992–1995, when much of the plenary business went to a Central Commission). The series breaks when a group has fewer than 20 speakers in total; a language enters the average when each group has at least 10 speakers in it.

The timing is only partly robust across specifications (Online Appendix A). Without covariates, the series also exceeds its benchmark in most periods of 1894–1908, in 1932–1936 and in 1981–1985, and in only one period of the 1950s (1950–1952). Its highest value is then in 1894–1896, and 1969–1971 does not exceed the benchmark. Allowing covariate effects to vary by institutional period leaves the real series almost unchanged, but the specification draws its own random benchmark: with it, 1969–1971 falls to 0.0009 and no longer exceeds the benchmark, and the highest value is 0.0019, in 1932–1934 (Figure A11). Without covariates, changing $\psi$ to $10^{-4}$ or $10^{-6}$ alters levels, but the highest value remains under plural voting (Figure A7). Without the speeches that members delivered as ministers, none of the five periods after 1968 that exceed the benchmark in the main series does so, including 1969–1971 (0.0005), while both periods of 1950–1954 do (Figure A10). Excluding the populist radical right changes the real series by less than 0.0001 before 1985 and by at most 0.0005 afterwards, but with its own random benchmark the net value of 1969–1971 falls to 0.0007 (Figure A4).

The series based on empirical phrase-choice probabilities, the plug-in estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019), moves with its random benchmark (Figure A5). This shows that finite-sample bias dominates without penalization. The leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019), which does not penalize phrase effects, is positive in every period of 1843–1893 but exceeds its benchmark in only three of them. It exceeds its benchmark in all ten periods of 1894–1914, is highest in 1894–1896 and exceeds it in no period of the 1950s (Figure A9). The Dutch component exceeds its benchmark in six periods, among them 1954–1956 (0.0029), during the second school war. The French component exceeds its benchmark in no period of the 1950s and is highest in 1969–1971 (0.0028; Figure A8). Levels are not comparable between the languages, whose vocabularies differ in size (Section 4).

#### 5.1.1 Schools, the Royal Question and the language of governing

Simola et al. (2025) link Finland's high partisanship in the 1970s to the extreme left's phrases about the Soviet Union. In Belgium, schools and the Royal Question are the natural candidates for such a role. Figure 17 compares the share of phrases about schools and education with religious partisanship. School phrases peak during the conflicts identified by historians: 3.7 per cent of all phrases in 1878–1880, when the Liberal school law was debated; 4.5 per cent in 1884–1886, when the Catholic majority replaced it; 3.3 per cent in 1912–1914, during the compulsory education law; and 2.6 per cent in 1954–1956, during the second school war. Religious partisanship does not follow these peaks. It exceeds its benchmark in 1884–1886 and 1912–1914, but not in 1878–1880 or 1954–1956.

Figure 18 suggests why. During the first school war, both sides discussed schools roughly in proportion to their numbers. Catholic members spoke 52 per cent of school phrases in 1878–1880, while accounting for 45 per cent of speakers and 43 per cent of seats. They spoke 49 per cent in 1880–1884, when they represented 46–49 per cent of speakers. The main difference was their choice of school phrases. The Liberal government and majority referred to *écoles communales*, the communal schools covered by the 1879 law. The Catholic opposition referred to *instruction publique* and *enseignement libre*. After 1884, their roles reversed, and the Liberal opposition used *écoles communales*, *écoles adoptées* and *pères de famille* (Online Appendix C). Phrase frequencies

capture this difference only partly because most debate vocabulary was shared.

The Royal Question leaves a clearer trace in the attention the parties gave to it. Related phrases reach their highest share in 1949–1950. Catholic members used only 19 per cent of them, despite representing 46 per cent of speakers and half the seats (Online Appendix Figure A15). In that period, *consultation populaire* and *question royale* are the other parties' most partisan French phrases (Table 10), and religious partisanship exceeds its benchmark at a modest level (0.0006).

Table 10 reports the five French phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group, selecting one period every ten years, as Gentzkow et al. (2019) do for selected Congresses. It also reports predicted counts per 100,000 phrases. Online Appendix C lists phrases for every period and both languages. Figure A13 tracks the most partisan phrases of each decade.

Three kinds of phrases recur. The first concerns the cleavages themselves: secondary and religious education for Catholics in 1848–1850 (*enseignement moyen*, *enseignement religieux*); *classe ouvrière* and *suffrage universel* for other parties after 1894; family allowances for Catholics in the 1930s (*allocations familiales*); *consultation populaire* for their opponents in 1949–1950; public, technical, secondary and free education for Catholics in the 1950s (*enseignement technique*, *enseignement libre*; *technisch onderwijs* in Dutch); and development aid and cooperation for Christian democrats from the 1960s (*assistance technique*, *coopération au développement*).

The second kind reflects governing and opposition roles. Opposition members speak of the special or full powers of the government (*pouvoirs spéciaux*, *pleins pouvoirs*), and members of both sides of the previous government (*vorige regering*). In earlier versions of the vocabulary, the clearest examples were procedural formulas and titles. Rapporteurs and ministers submit reports and bills with fixed formulas (*j'ai l'honneur de déposer sur le bureau de la Chambre*, *section centrale*; *ter tafel neerleggen* in Dutch), which only those who govern use, and members address ministers by their titles (*ministre de l'intérieur*, *premier ministre*). These phrases switch sides when governments change. In 1950–1958, one bloc governed and the other opposed throughout: the Christian democrats in 1950–1954 and the Socialists and Liberals in 1954–1958. In estimates on all phrases, the submission formulas account for 57 per cent of the religious partisanship of 1952–1954 in French and 75 per cent in Dutch, and the religious series is highest in 1950–1958, at 0.0026–0.0031. The vocabulary used here leaves out procedural formulas, forms of address and titles, and other phrases without content (Section 3). Without them, no period of 1950–1958 exceeds the benchmark. The leading Dutch phrases of these years concern technical and public education, social insurance and pensions on the Catholic side, and the length of military service on the other (*technisch onderwijs*, *sociale voorzorg*, *twintig maanden*). Section 5.12 discusses how the vocabulary affects the other series.

Before the corrections described in Section 3, Dutch versions of the same formulas (*legt ter tafel het verslag over het wetsontwerp*) also led the French series in these years, because the record prints them within the rapporteur's or minister's French speech. After the translations are removed, phrases containing a Dutch function word account for at most 0.026 per cent of the French phrases of Catholics, Liberals, Socialists and Communists in 1950–1958 (Online Appendix B). The third kind of phrase reflects noise in the record, discussed in Section 5.12.

### 5.2 Left–others partisanship

Figure 2 compares the left with other parties from 1894, when the Belgian Workers' Party entered the Chamber. The series exceeds its random benchmark in 47 per cent of periods. Net partisanship is 0.0006 in 1894–1896 and 0.0008 in 1896–1898, neither above the benchmark, and averages 0.0013 from 1898 to 1914, with its highest pre-war values in 1904–1908 (0.0020–0.0022). From 1894 to 1914, 29 to 40 Socialist speakers opposed Catholic-only governments. Their distinctive phrases concerned the working class, universal suffrage, working hours, the eight-hour day and labour courts (*classe ouvrière*, *suffrage universel*, *heures de travail*, *huit heures*, *conseils de prud'hommes*; Table 11).

Partisanship declines under the national-union governments of 1918–1921, then rises through the 1920s to 0.0039 in 1932–1934, and it exceeds its benchmark in every period from 1921 to 1940. The early 1930s were the years of strikes, special powers for Catholic–Liberal governments and the Plan of Labour. The Socialists were in opposition, with *pleins pouvoirs* and *classe ouvrière* among their most partisan phrases. Partisanship falls to 0.0010 in 1936–1939, when the Socialists join tripartite governments, and is close to zero under the governments of the Liberation.

After 1945 the series is lower. From 1944 to 1958, it exceeds its benchmark only in 1954–1956, and net partisanship is at most 0.0011. From 1958 to 1985, it exceeds its benchmark in six of 12 periods, with values of up to 0.0017 in 1979–1981. The value of 1974–1977 (0.0014), under Christian-democratic and Liberal governments that excluded the Socialists, comes mainly from Dutch speech and does not exceed the benchmark. From 1985 to 2021, net partisanship averages 0.0001 and exceeds its benchmark in two of 15 periods, the longest stretch of low values in the series. It then rises to 0.0030 in 2021–2024 and reaches its highest value, 0.0052, in 2024–2025. This last value comes mainly from Dutch speech (0.0105, against 0.0009 in French, which does not exceed its benchmark) and rests on 65 sittings. In Dutch, the left's most partisan phrases in 2021–2025 include *werkende klas* and *sterke overheid*, and the other parties' include *gegarandeerde dienstverlening*, guaranteed service (Online Appendix C). The recent values are also sensitive to how the members of the joint green group are assigned to language communities: in earlier estimates on all phrases, correcting that assignment raised the values of 2021–2024 and 2024–2025 from 0.0017 and 0.0029 to 0.0039 and 0.0062. The leave-out estimator, which does not penalize phrase effects, places 2024–2025 (0.023) above every other period after 1914 but below most periods before 1914 (Figure 3).

Simola et al. (2025) show that the extreme left drives Finland's 1970s peak. We perform the same check by excluding the Communist and radical left family in Figure 16. The family first has speakers in 1925; before then, the series changes only because penalties and covariate effects are estimated jointly across periods. Excluding it lowers the 1932–1934 value from 0.0039 to 0.0024 and removes the rise of 2021–2024 (0.0001 rather than 0.0030): in that period, the radical left, PVDA-PTB, has 13 speakers. The highest value remains that of 2024–2025 (0.0045, against 0.0052). In 1950–1958, the series exceeds its benchmark only in 1954–1956 with the radical left, and in no period without it.

Online Appendix Figure A4 excludes the populist radical right: Rex, Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang, Front National and Parti Populaire. This follows Simola et al. (2025)'s analysis excluding Finland's Rural Party. The three highest values remain those of 2024–2025, 1932–1934

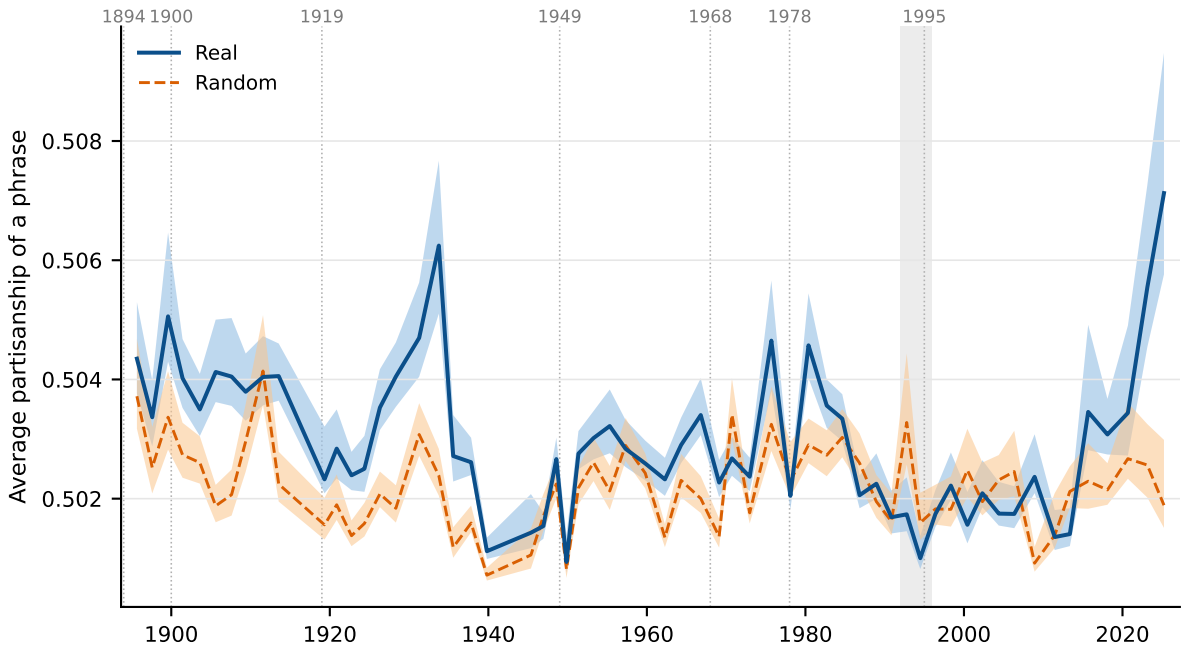



**Figure 2:** Left–others partisanship: Socialist and Communist families vs other parties, controls for gender and province

*Notes*: As Figure 1, from the first period with Socialist members (1894).

and 2021–2024. Adding government status to the main controls, as in Simola et al. (2025), lowers the real series in 36 of 58 periods, including 1932–1934 and 2024–2025 (Online Appendix Figure A3). Allowing covariate effects to vary by institutional period lowers the real series most in 2019–2025: net partisanship in 2024–2025 is 0.0029 rather than 0.0052, still above its benchmark, and 1932–1934 (0.0045) becomes the highest value (Online Appendix Figure A11).

### 5.3 Left–right and right–others partisanship

The left–others grouping places Christian democrats, Greens and regionalists in the same group as Liberals and the radical right. We therefore also compare the left with the right in a narrower sense: the Liberal family, the populist radical right and N-VA. Other parties are left out of this comparison. We also compare the right with all other parties. Both series use the penalized estimator with controls for gender and province, as the main series do, with subsampling intervals and random benchmarks. They are undefined in 1894–1900, 1946–1949 and 1952–1954, when the right has fewer than 20 speakers. The leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019) has subsampling intervals with 80 per cent nominal coverage. Table 3 reports averages by institutional period, and Figure 3 shows the series. Values in this subsection are net partisanship multiplied by 1,000.

Left–right partisanship is highest from 1904 to 1932. It exceeds its benchmark in 8 of the 12 periods of these years, and its averages under plural voting and equal male suffrage, 1.98 and 1.45, are higher than those of left–others partisanship (1.17 and 1.39). Its highest net value, 3.81 in 1927–1929, does not exceed the benchmark, because the right has only 23 speakers and the random interval is wide; the highest value above the benchmark is 2.96 in 1929–1932 (Table 1).

**Table 3:** Left–others, left–right and right–others partisanship by institutional period

| | Penalized: mean net (×1,000) | | | Leave-out: significant periods | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Institutional period | Left–others | Left–right | Right–others | Left–others | Left–right | Right–others |
| Plural voting | 1.17 | 1.98 | 0.54 | 10/11 | 7/8 | 0/8 |
| Equal male suffrage | 1.39 | 1.45 | −0.08 | 6/11 | 8/11 | 2/11 |
| Post-war unitary state | 0.44 | 0.43 | −0.06 | 1/13 | 1/10 | 2/10 |
| State reforms | 0.49 | 0.43 | 0.72 | 2/9 | 3/9 | 2/9 |
| Federal Chamber of 150 | 0.72 | 0.62 | 0.97 | 6/14 | 4/14 | 5/14 |

*Notes*: Penalized estimator: mean net partisanship (real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000), controls for gender and province. Leave-out estimator (Gentzkow et al., 2019), without covariates: periods in which the lower bound of the 80 per cent interval of the real series lies above the upper bound of the interval of the random series, out of the periods in which the series is defined. Left: Socialist and Communist families; right: Liberal family, populist radical right and N-VA; left–right leaves the other parties out. Averages are over the periods in which each series is defined: left–right and right–others are undefined in 1894–1900, 1946–1949 and 1952–1954, when the right has fewer than 20 speakers. Periods with low coverage of the sittings are excluded. Produced by `code/python/27_paper_extras.py`.

In both periods, Liberals governed with Catholics and the Socialists were mostly in opposition. After 1945, left–right partisanship is low. It averages 0.43 in the post-war unitary state and during the state reforms and 0.62 in the federal era, and after 1946 it exceeds its benchmark only in 2016–2019. In these decades, the left's main opponents, in government and in opposition, were often the Christian democrats, who are left out of this comparison. Across periods, left–others and left–right partisanship are moderately related (correlation 0.41 over 52 periods). The leave-out series exceeds its random benchmark in 7 of 8 periods under plural voting and 8 of 11 under equal male suffrage, but in only 1 of 10 in the post-war unitary state.

Right–others partisanship is low until the 1970s. Its averages are at most 0.54 before 1971, and it exceeds its benchmark in 3 of the 29 periods before 1971. The leave-out series exceeds its benchmark in 6 of 38 periods before 1995. Its averages are higher during the state reforms and in the federal era (0.72 and 0.97), and it exceeds its benchmark in 7 of the 14 periods since 1995, in 2003–2005 partly because of text of the voting procedure (Section 5.12). Its highest values are 4.30 in 2024–2025, 2.50 in 1983–1985 and 1.90 in 1974–1977; the second and third come when the Liberals governed with the Christian democrats. The leave-out series exceeds its benchmark in 4 of the 5 periods since 2014. The recent rise of left–others partisanship therefore coincides with a period in which the wording of the right and that of all other parties have also become easier to tell apart. In a variant in which the Greens join the left, left–right partisanship exceeds its benchmark in 2021–2024 and 2024–2025 (2.42 and 4.32), and in only one other period after 1946 (1995–1997). In 2024–2025, the two estimators rank the left's comparisons differently: the penalized estimator places left–others partisanship (5.24) above left–right partisanship (2.15), while the leave-out estimator places left–right (37.0) above left–others (23.3).

## 5.4 Government and opposition

Figure 4 compares members of governing and opposition parties, controlling for gender and province. Belgium had parliamentary government from 1831, unlike Finland, where government became responsible to parliament only after 1917. Our series therefore spans the full period, except eleven periods when almost all members belonged to governing parties. These cover the unionist and mixed cabinets of 1831–1845, except 1839–1841, and 1854–1857, the national-

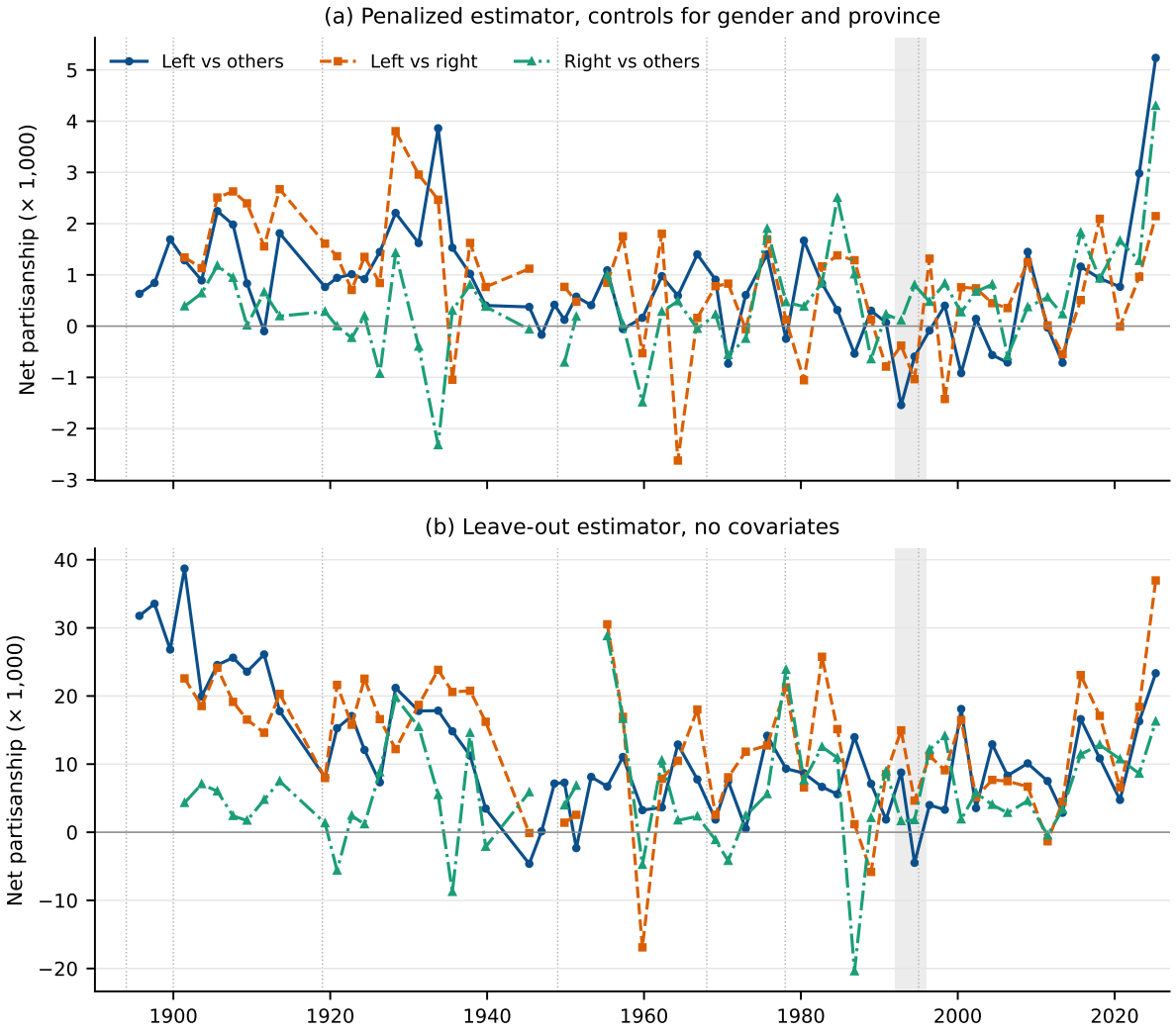



**Figure 3:** Left–others, left–right and right–others partisanship

*Notes*: Net partisanship (real minus random series), multiplied by 1,000. (a) Penalized estimator with controls for gender and province. (b) Leave-out estimator without covariates. Left: Socialist and Communist families; right: Liberal family, populist radical right and N-VA; left–right leaves the other parties out. Gaps: periods when the right has fewer than 20 speakers. Shaded: low coverage of the sittings; dotted lines: reforms. Produced by `code/python/27_paper_extras.py`.

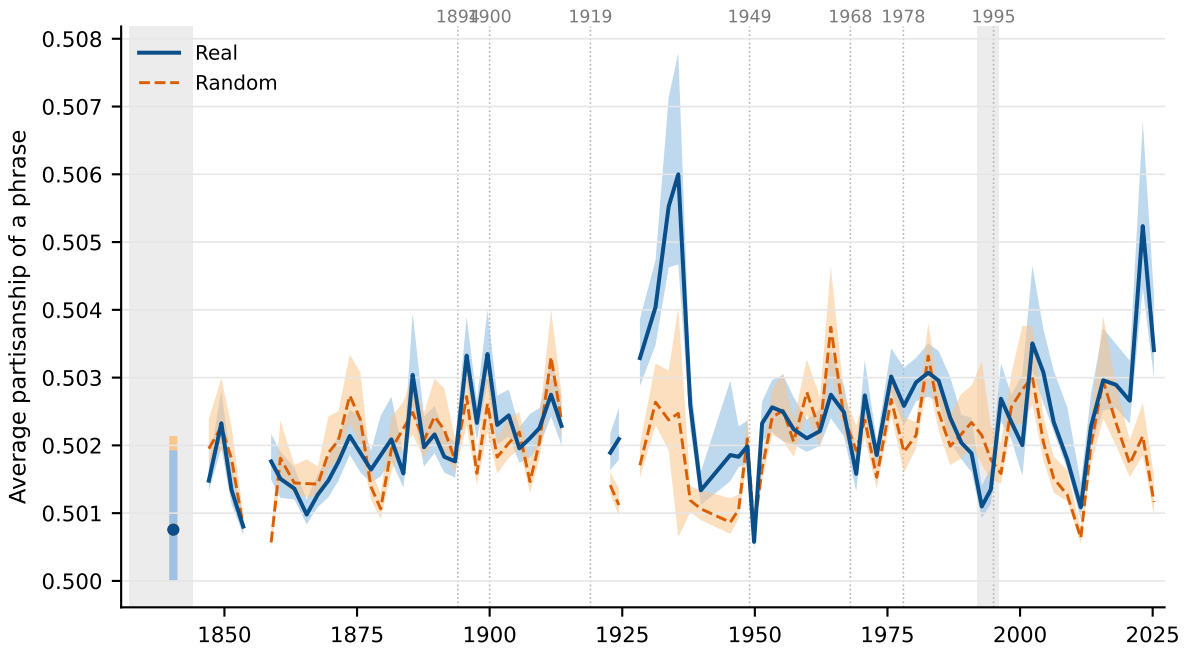



**Figure 4:** Government–opposition partisanship, controls for gender and province

*Notes*: Group A: members of the parties in government; group B: members of the parties in opposition. A member-period is in government if at least half of the member's speeches were delivered while the party was in government. Gaps: periods when the opposition had fewer than 20 speakers (unionist and national-union governments). Otherwise as Figure 1.

union governments of 1918–1921 and 1926–1927, and 1925–1926, when the register counts an extra-parliamentary Liberal minister in the Catholic–Socialist government.

The series exceeds its random benchmark in 30 per cent of periods (Table 1), less often than the left–others series (47 per cent) and about as often as the religious series (28 per cent). Its institutional-period averages (Table 4) are −0.0001 under census suffrage and 0.0003 under plural voting. They are highest under equal male suffrage, at 0.0015, close to zero in the post-war unitary state and during the state reforms (0.0000 and 0.0002), and 0.0008 in the federal era.

The series is highest between the wars. It exceeds its benchmark in seven of the eight periods from 1921 to 1940 in which it is defined, and in 1944–1947. In 1927–1934, Socialists opposed Catholic–Liberal governments, and all three main series exceed their benchmarks. Net partisanship reaches 0.0032 in 1932–1934 and its highest value, 0.0035, in 1934–1936. In that period, the Socialists joined the government of national union formed in March 1935, and the opposition was small: 27 of its members enter the series. The opposition's most partisan phrases include the decree-laws and the national-union government in French (*arrêtés-lois*, *union nationale*) and the Flemish people in Dutch (*Vlaamsche volk*). Before 1919, the series is low. Under census suffrage, it exceeds its benchmark only in 1857–1859 and during the first school war, in 1878–1880; under plural voting, only in 1896–1898 and 1906–1908.

Under governments formed by a single family, the government–opposition grouping is the same as the religious grouping. This is the case in 32 periods with adequate coverage between 1848 and 1914 and in 1950–1954. In these periods, the real series of the two groupings differ by at most 0.0002, but their random benchmarks, each from a single permutation, differ by up to 0.0012, and in 13 of the 32 periods only one of the two series exceeds its benchmark. Single

periods above or below the benchmark should therefore be read with caution (Section 4).

After 1945, the series is low. From 1947 to 1994, it exceeds its benchmark only in 1950–1952 and 1979–1981. Under the centre-right governments of 1981–1987, which used special powers, it does not exceed its benchmark, while religious partisanship does in 1981–1985. In the federal era, government–opposition partisanship exceeds its benchmark in 8 of 14 periods, more often than the right–others series (7), the left–others series (4), the left–right series (1) and the religious series (none). Its values in 2021–2024 (0.0031) and 2024–2025 (0.0022) are its highest since the 1930s. In 2021–2024, the government included Liberals, Socialists, Greens and Christian democrats and was opposed mainly by Flemish nationalists, the radical right and the radical left. As Lauderdale and Herzog (2016) find for the Irish Dáil, government and opposition form a recurring division in speech, even where other cleavages structure the party system.

The most partisan phrases reflect the policies of the government of the day and the opposition's objections to them. In 1932–1934, the Socialist opposition speaks of the working class, the full powers and unemployment benefits (*classe ouvrière*, *pleins pouvoirs*, *allocations de chômage*). In 2024–2025, the governing side speaks of the government agreement and the energy transition (*accord de gouvernement*, *transition énergétique*), and the opposition of flexi-jobs and new taxes (*flexi-jobs*, *nieuwe belastingen*; Online Appendix C). The formulas with which the governing side submits bills and reports, and the titles with which members address ministers, are not in the vocabulary (Section 3). In estimates on all phrases, the series exceeds its benchmark in 12 of the 14 periods of the federal era (Section 5.12). The unpenalized leave-out estimator depends differently on speech volume (Online Appendix Figure A9). It exceeds its benchmark in 11 of the 14 periods of the federal era, and its federal-era average (0.016) is as high as under plural voting and equal male suffrage (0.015 and 0.016). Its highest value, 0.035, is that of 2024–2025, a short period.

### 5.5 Other comparisons between parties

**Pairwise comparisons.** Figure 5 compares the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families in pairs, without covariates. This follows Simola et al. (2025), who compare four parties present throughout their sample. Levels and timing differ across the three pairs (Tables 1 and 2).

Catholics and Liberals, separated only by the religious cleavage, speak similarly for most of the period. Net partisanship averages less than 0.0001 and exceeds its random benchmark in 12 of 81 periods. Nine of these fall under census suffrage, when the two families held almost all the seats, among them three of the four periods from 1878 to 1886, during and after the first school war (0.0007–0.0010). After 1894, the pair exceeds its benchmark only in 1929–1932, 1974–1977 and 2003–2005. Its highest value, 0.0019 in 1974–1977, comes when the two families governed together. During the second school war, net partisanship is 0.0002 in 1954–1956 and $-0.0014$ in 1956–1958, and the pair's decade averages are negative in the 1950s and 1960s.

Catholics and Socialists, divided by religion and class, are the pair whose partisanship most often exceeds its random benchmark: in 27 of 58 periods, including every period from 1894 to 1919 and all but one between the wars. Net partisanship averages 0.0026 under plural voting, 0.0012 under equal male suffrage and 0.0002 in the post-war unitary state. Its highest values come soon after the Socialists entered the Chamber: 0.0041 in 1898–1900 and 0.0038 in 1894–1896.

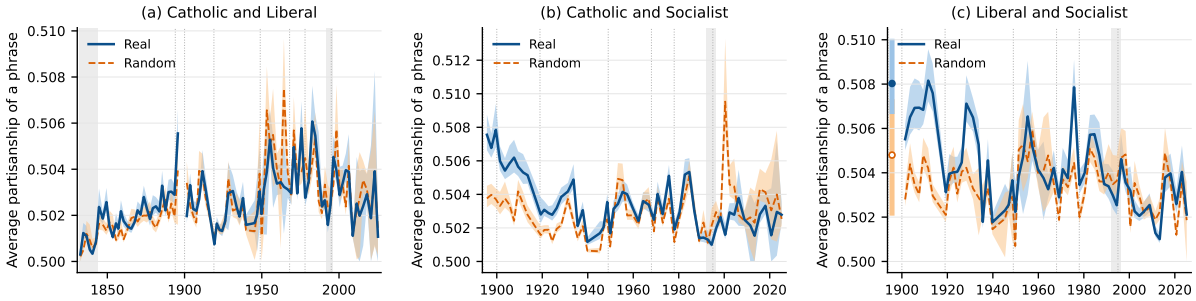



**Figure 5:** Partisanship, pairwise comparisons

*Notes*: Pairs of the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families, without covariates; real and random series. Gaps: periods when one of the two families had fewer than 15 speakers. Otherwise as Figure 1.

The interwar maximum is 0.0025 in 1932–1934. In 1950–1958, the pair exceeds its benchmark only in 1956–1958 (0.0013), and it never does so after 1978. Since 1985, when the two families often governed together, its net partisanship is negative in 12 of 17 periods; the lowest value, −0.0079 in 1999–2001, comes from a random benchmark far above the real series.

Liberal and Socialist wording is easiest to tell apart before 1914, when both families were in opposition to Catholic governments. The pair exceeds its benchmark in every period from 1900 to 1919, and net partisanship averages 0.0030 under plural voting. It peaks at 0.0046 in 1912–1914, after their electoral cartel's defeat. Between the wars, it exceeds its benchmark in 1927–1934, when the Liberals governed with the Catholics and the Socialists were in opposition. In the 1950s and 1960s, it does so only in 1968–1969. It exceeds its benchmark again in the three periods of 1974–1981 (0.0034 in 1974–1977), when one of the two families governed and the other was in opposition, but not under the centre-right governments of 1981–1987, which the Socialists also opposed. Since 1995, it exceeds its benchmark in two of 14 periods, 1999–2001 and 2019–2021.

The pairs are not consistently related to government status. Here a family governs in a period when at least half of its speakers are in government. Catholic–Socialist partisanship is higher, on average, in periods when one of the two families governs and the other is in opposition (0.0008 against 0.0002). This difference comes from the decades before 1945, when the Socialists opposed Catholic-led governments; after 1945 it is reversed. Catholic–Liberal and Liberal–Socialist partisanship is lower in such periods (close to zero against 0.0002, and 0.0007 against 0.0009). These are associations: parties that enter or leave government also change their agendas and their members. Because each comparison is symmetric, these series show when two families' wording became more or less similar, but not which family changed.

**Multiparty partisanship.** With more parties, the probability of identifying the right one falls mechanically. We therefore combine binary comparisons between all families present in a period: Catholics, Liberals, Socialists, Communists and the radical left, Flemish nationalists, the populist radical right, Francophone regionalists and Greens. The multiparty index averages pairwise partisanship, weighting each pair by the product of the two families' speaker counts. It measures expected partisanship between two randomly selected members of different families. Each comparison has a baseline of one half, so the index retains the other series' scale without a

mechanical dependence on party count. The pairs have no covariates, and each has its own random benchmark. A pair enters a period when each family has at least 15 speakers in total; a language enters the pair's average when each family has at least 10 speakers in it.

The pairs are estimated with the language rule of Section 4. From 1968, comparisons involving Flemish nationalists or the radical right therefore use Dutch speech, and those involving Francophone regionalists French speech; the other pairs average the two languages (Online Appendix B).

Figure 6 shows point estimates of the index and the contributions of the pairs among the three traditional families and of the pairs involving other families. It also reports an index based on comparisons that control for gender. To compare a pair with its random benchmark, we use the pair's own subsampling intervals. Until 1968, the index consists mostly of pairs among the traditional families: pairs involving other families enter it only in 1936–1940 and 1946–1949. Under census suffrage, it reduces to the Catholic–Liberal comparison. It rises when the Socialists enter the Chamber, to between 0.0030 and 0.0044 in 1894–1900; in 1896–1900, when the Liberals have fewer than 15 speakers, only the Catholic–Socialist comparison remains.

The index is highest in 1936–1939, at 0.0048, when the Flemish National League and Rex entered the Chamber in strength. Pairs involving the Flemish nationalists contribute 0.0032 and the other pairs involving Rex 0.0008, against 0.0007 for the pairs among the traditional families. All four pairs involving the Flemish nationalists exceed their random benchmarks, and none of the other three involving Rex does. From 1944 to 2001, the index lies between $-0.0011$ and 0.0010 in every period with adequate coverage, and between $-0.0005$ and 0.0010 in 1950–1958.

The index is higher in 2001–2010 (0.0010 to 0.0016), when pairs involving Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang contribute 0.0010 to 0.0020, and slightly negative in 2010–2019 ($-0.0010$ to $-0.0002$), when Vlaams Belang has too few speakers to enter it. It rises to 0.0004 in 2019–2021, 0.0014 in 2021–2024 and 0.0040 in 2024–2025, a short period. This is the third-highest value of the series, after 1936–1939 and 1896–1898. No pair exceeds its random benchmark in 2021–2024.

In 2024–2025, pairs involving PVDA-PTB's radical left contribute 0.0022 and the other pairs involving the radical right 0.0012. Six of the 13 pairs exceed their benchmarks, and five of these six involve the radical left or the radical right. Pairs among the three traditional families, which have governed together in various combinations since the 1980s, contribute between $-0.0005$ and 0.0001 in every period since 1999. As with the pairwise comparisons above, these contributions show which comparisons became easier or harder to tell apart, not which family changed its wording. Controlling for gender gives similar results: across the periods with adequate coverage, the two indexes are correlated at 0.84, and their three highest values fall in the same periods.

**Parties since 1979.** After the national parties split, we also compare parties within each language, following the comparisons between families above. For every pair of parties with at least 8 speakers in a language and period, we estimate partisanship without covariates, with its own random benchmark. Each comparison is symmetric: it shows when two parties' wording becomes more or less similar, not which party changed. Across 21 Dutch-language pairs (210 pair-periods), a regression with pair and period fixed effects associates being on the same

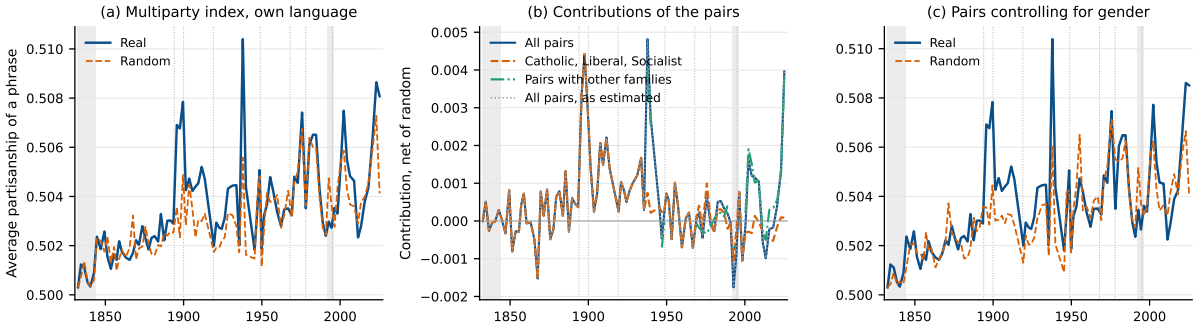



**Figure 6:** Multiparty partisanship

*Notes*: (a) Average pairwise partisanship of the party families present in each period, weighted by the product of their numbers of speakers; real and random series. Under the language rule, the pairs that involve the Flemish nationalists or the populist radical right are read in Dutch from 1968 and those that involve the Francophone regionalists in French; the other pairs average the two languages. (b) Contribution of the pairs to the index, net of the random series: all pairs, pairs among the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families, and pairs that involve the other families; dotted grey: the same index computed from each pair's average of the two languages, which coincides with it because the language rule leaves a single language in the pairs concerned. (a) and (b) without covariates. For the three pairs of Figure 5, the real series are the same, but the random series are drawn anew. (c) the same index from pairs that control for gender. The province is not controlled for, because it is close to collinear with some of the smaller parties. Point estimates (`code/python/18_multiparty_ownlang.py`); subsampling intervals are not shown.

side of the government–opposition divide with a difference in net partisanship of −0.82 per thousand (standard error 0.28, clustered by pair). The difference is larger when both parties are in opposition (−1.76, standard error 0.48) than when both govern (0.04, standard error 0.21). In French, pairs in which both parties are in opposition are also more similar (−1.68, standard error 0.88), while pairs in which both govern are, if anything, less similar (0.21, standard error 0.11). These are associations, not effects of government status: parties that enter or leave government also change their agendas, their roles and their members.

Figure 7 follows N-VA, with its predecessor the Volksunie, and Vlaams Belang. Their net partisanship shows no clear trend. Net of period effects estimated on the other pairs, its trend since 2003 is 1.32 per thousand per decade, with an 80 per cent interval from −0.45 to 3.05 over 6 periods, and 0.24 over all 8 periods. In 2024–2025, the largest differences in Dutch speech are those between VB–PVDA (21.53 per thousand) and N-VA–PVDA (17.70), while N-VA is closest to CD&V (0.32). The pair comparisons do not show which of the two parties changed, so they cannot tell whether either party has moved towards the other.

**Women and men.** Women entered the Chamber in 1929 but remained below a tenth of members until 1995. Their share has exceeded a third since the parity law of 2002 and two fifths since 2019 (Online Appendix Table D2). Figure 21 measures how easily women and men can be told apart by their wording. We control for party family, allowing family effects to vary across eras beginning in 1929, 1945, 1971, 1995 and 2007. This compares women with men of the same family. Each group must have at least 15 speakers in total and 10 in a language. The series therefore begins in 1974–1977 and, until 1999, rests on Dutch speech alone.

Since 1995, net partisanship between women and men averages 0.0021 and exceeds its random benchmark in 10 of 14 periods: in every period from 1999 except 2012–2016. The highest of these values is 0.0037, in 2021–2024. Before 1995, the series is defined in four periods, with

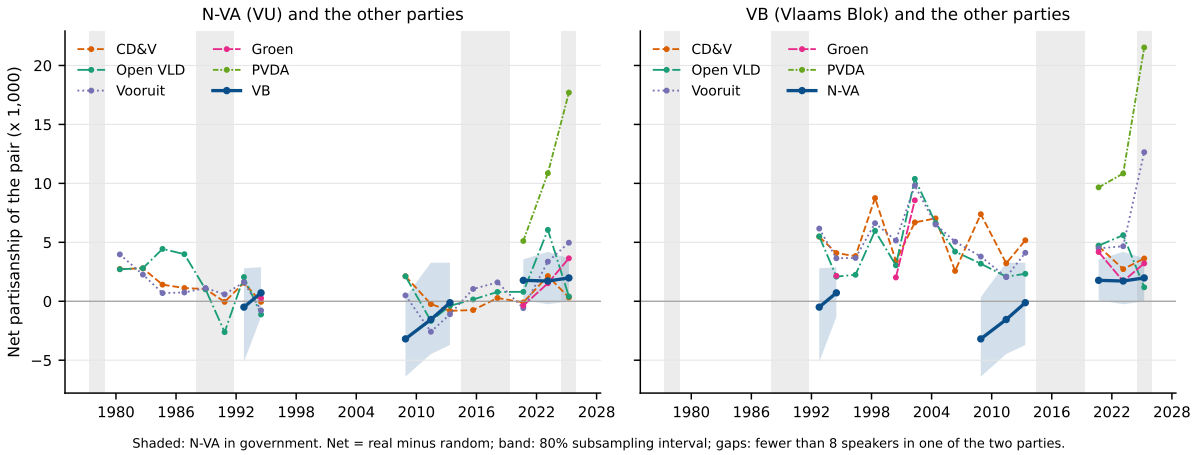



**Figure 7:** N-VA and Vlaams Belang compared with the other Dutch-speaking parties

*Notes*: Net partisanship of each pair of parties in Dutch speech, without covariates (real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000); band: 80 per cent subsampling interval; shaded: N-VA, or the Volksunie, in government; gaps: fewer than 8 speakers in one of the two parties. N-VA includes its predecessor, the Volksunie; predecessors are grouped for comparison and need not be the same organization. Produced by `code/python/24_dyads_analysis.py`.

15 to 18 women speakers, and never exceeds its benchmark. Without controls, the average since 1995 is 0.0016, and again 10 of 14 periods exceed the benchmark. Women and men are therefore about as easy to tell apart within families as across them. In the federal era, they are also easier to tell apart than the groups of the main series, whose net partisanship averages −0.0003 (religious), 0.0007 (left–others) and 0.0008 (government–opposition; Table 4).

**Today's parties.** Figure 22 traces each party elected in 2024 back to its foundation or its predecessors; the predecessors are grouped for comparison and need not be the same organization. It compares the party's speech with that of other parties in its language group. Dutch-speaking parties are compared with Dutch-speaking parties, and French-speaking parties with French-speaking parties; before the split, each series follows the members of the predecessor party who spoke that language. PVDA-PTB, a national party, is compared across both languages. Table 7 reports legislature averages since 1995. The series have no covariates and require at least 8 speakers in the party's language. The random benchmark is therefore especially important for smaller parties.

Before 1995, the Flemish nationalists never exceed their random benchmark. The predecessors of the traditional parties exceed it more often in French than in Dutch; the French-speaking Socialists, for example, do so in every period from 1894 to 1914. Since 1995, the series exceed their benchmarks in only 10 of 117 party-periods, all of Dutch-speaking parties: Vooruit in 2003–2010 and 2024–2025, Open VLD in 2003–2007 and 2021–2024, Vlaams Belang in 1997–1999 and 2001–2003, and N-VA, the largest party since 2010, in 2021–2024.

In Table 7, 62 of the 69 legislature averages lie within 0.003 of the random benchmark. The highest are those of Vooruit (0.0050) and PVDA-PTB (0.0049) in the legislature elected in 2024, which so far covers only 2024–2025, and of Vlaams Belang in the legislature elected in 1995 (0.0042). No PVDA-PTB period exceeds its benchmark: since 2019 the party has 12 to 15 speakers, and its intervals are wide. Ecolo's averages are negative in all five legislatures with enough

speakers: a randomly selected group of French-speaking members of the same size is easier to tell apart from the others than Ecolo's members are. Levels cannot be compared across languages (Section 4).

### 5.6 The linguistic cleavage before the split

Before the national parties split, Flemish and Walloon members of the same party shared a parliamentary group. Figure 20 compares their French speech up to 1967, before the first split, controlling for party family and gender. The grouping is Flanders versus Wallonia, based on the electoral district, rather than party. Net partisanship averages 0.0008 and exceeds its random benchmark in 28 of the 58 periods with adequate coverage. Higher values occur in 1850–1861 (up to 0.0027 in 1859–1861), 1900–1910 (up to 0.0027 in 1908–1910) and between the wars (0.0027 in 1927–1929). Values are lower after 1945: three of the eleven periods from 1946–1947 exceed the benchmark. There is no upward trend before the split. The last period above the benchmark is 1958–1961 (0.0015). The three following periods are below zero, and the last, 1965–1968, has the series' lowest value ($-0.0014$). These last values depend on the specification: estimated together with the later periods, in which only the families that had not yet split are compared, the values of 1961–1968 lie between 0.0000 and 0.0004. In that extended comparison, net partisanship lies between $-0.0003$ and 0.0010 in 1968–1974 and never exceeds its benchmark; later periods have too few Flemish members speaking French (Figure 9, panel a).

The phrases show what distinguished the regions (Online Appendix C). Most reflect regional economic interests. Flemish members discuss beet sugar, linen, the port of Ostend and West Flanders. Walloon members discuss the Société Générale, the coal basins, the Charleroi canal, the canalization of the Meuse and, before 1914, the councils of industry and labour and work accidents (*industrie travail*, *accidents travail*). In 1936–1939, paid holidays and the forty-hour week distinguish Walloon members (*congés payés*, *quarante heures*), and in the 1950s the coal industry does (*industrie charbonnière*, *national charbonnages*). In 1936–1939 and 1958–1961, the Congo distinguishes Flemish members (*congo belge*, *ruanda urundi*).

Language policy appears among the distinctive phrases of Flemish members in several periods: the Flemish language in 1856–1864 (*langue flamande*), the Dutch-language university of Ghent in the 1920s (*université gand*, *université flamande*), cultural councils in 1939–1940 (*conseil culturel*) and the language question in 1961–1963, when the language border was fixed by law (*problème linguistique*). Walloon members refer to the Walloon question in 1944–1946 (*problème wallon*). Within families, Flemish and Walloon Catholics speak similarly: their partisanship exceeds its random benchmark in only 4 of 42 periods (Online Appendix Figure A12). Socialists differ more, exceeding their benchmark in four periods between the wars and in 1952–1954. Before the split, the linguistic cleavage therefore appears in speech mainly through regional interests.

### 5.7 Flanders and Wallonia, 1831–2025

Wording can be compared only within one language, so the comparison above ends when the national parties split. Votes can be followed to 2025. We compare the roll-call votes of members elected in Flemish and in Walloon districts with the party-unlikeness index of Rice (1925): the

absolute difference between the shares of the two groups voting yes. From each roll call's index we subtract its expected value when the region labels are assigned at random among the members voting, and we average over the roll calls of each period. Members elected in Brussels are left out, as in the speech comparison. The index measures votes, not language. Figure 8 shows the periods with at least 20 usable roll calls, which begin in 1870; Online Appendix A gives the definitions.

Panel (a) compares all Flemish with all Walloon members. Their votes differ most before 1914. The net division averages 0.17 in 1870–1893 and 0.23 under plural voting, and it peaks at 0.34 in 1898–1900, when the majorities of the two regions vote on opposite sides in 62 per cent of roll calls. It averages 0.06 between the wars, 0.07 in 1945–1970 and 0.04 in 1971–1994, when the two majorities are on opposite sides in 2 per cent of roll calls. In the federal era it rises again, to 0.13, with opposite majorities in 13 per cent of roll calls.

These divisions move with government status. Panel (c) shows the share of Flemish speakers whose party is in government minus the same share among Walloon speakers. Under the Catholic governments of 1870–1878 and 1884–1900, this difference is 59 to 74 points; under the Liberal government of 1878–1884, it is $-67$ to $-74$ points. After proportional representation, in 1900–1914, it is 28 to 37 points. Across periods, the size of this difference is correlated with the net division in votes (0.79 over 66 periods). In the federal era, the majorities of the two regions are most often on opposite sides in 2014–2016 and 2016–2019 (51 and 39 per cent of roll calls), when MR was the only French-speaking party in government.

Panel (b) compares Flemish and Walloon members of the same family: of the same national party before its split, and of the family's two parties afterwards (Christian democrats, Liberals, Socialists and Greens). Their votes differ much less. The net division averages 0.01 to 0.05 in each institutional period, and it is unrelated to the difference in government status of panel (c) (correlation $-0.02$). The highest values are in 2024–2025 (0.20), 1921–1923 (0.15) and 2007–2010 (0.12). Since 1995, the largest divisions within families occur when the two parties of a family sat on opposite sides of the government–opposition divide: the Socialists from December 2007 to December 2011 (PS in government, sp.a in opposition), the Christian democrats in 2014–2019 (CD&V in government, cdH in opposition), and the Liberals and Socialists in 2025 (MR and Vooruit in the government formed in February, Open Vld and PS in opposition). Parties of the same family also divide while governing together: in a roll call of February 2004 on the bill on the right of foreigners to vote in municipal elections, VLD voted against and MR for. In 1921–1923, the Chamber voted on the language of teaching at the University of Ghent: in a roll call of 22 December 1922 on the bill on the use of languages at the university, 95 per cent of Flemish and 3 per cent of Walloon Socialists voted yes.

Online Appendix Figure A20 classifies the roll calls by keywords in the title of the bill. Among all members, many subjects divide the regions in each institutional period, with values of up to 0.35 for subjects other than language. Within families, language is the only subject with large divisions: 0.33 under plural voting and 0.10 between the wars (10 and 12 roll calls), against at most 0.08 for any other subject in any institutional period. In the final vote on the bill on the use of Flemish in official publications, in March 1898, all Flemish and 8 per cent of Walloon Catholics voted yes; in a roll call of May 1913 on the bill on the use of languages in the army,

8 per cent of Flemish and 91 per cent of Walloon Liberals did. In 1970, Flemish and Walloon Liberals, still one party, voted on opposite sides in a roll call on the bill on the use of languages in the administration of the communes around Brussels, and so did the Christian democrats, by then two parties, on the bill on agglomerations and federations of communes. After 1945, the division within families on language bills falls to 0.04, and after the splits to 0.00 in 1971–1994 and 0.03 in the federal era, although language bills are now frequent (247 and 258 roll calls).

The subjects of speeches give a second comparison, which does not depend on wording. Panel (b) of Figure 9 assigns each French speech its most likely topic (Section 6) and asks how well the topic of one speech reveals the region of the speaker: the probability of guessing the region correctly with equal priors, net of its mean when the region labels are permuted at random among the speakers. This probability lies above the 90th percentile of its permutations in 26 of 55 periods until 1961–1963, after which fewer than 20 Flemish members speak French. It does so in 9 of the 10 periods of plural voting, when Walloon members devote 16 per cent of their substantive speeches to labour and Flemish members 9 per cent, while Flemish members speak more often of transport (12 against 8 per cent), agriculture (8 against 6) and language policy (4.4 against 2.7). The differences are small: the probability is at most 3.76 percentage points above the mean of its permutations, in 1868–1870. From the late 1930s, fewer Flemish members speak French (24 to 43 in the periods measured after 1944), so the comparison rests on a smaller group.

After the split, Flemish members speak Dutch and Walloon members French, and the topics of the two languages are labelled by different classifiers. On all speech, the topic shares of Flemish and Walloon members differ by 16 per cent in the federal era (half the sum of the absolute differences), but Dutch and French speeches in the same sittings already differ by 10 per cent. We therefore do not compare the subjects of the two regions' speech after the split.

Taken together, Flemish and Walloon members of the same party differed before the split in the subjects they raised and, in votes, mainly on language bills; their wording did not become easier to tell apart before the split. The votes of all Flemish and all Walloon members differ most when one region's members are mostly in government and the other's mostly in opposition, as before 1914 and in 2014–2019. These comparisons are descriptive, and the Rice index measures votes, not language.

### 5.8 Partisanship and institutional change

Table 4 reports average net partisanship by institutional period. Table 8 reports changes around each reform: plural voting, first used in 1894; proportional representation in 1900; equal male suffrage in 1919; women's suffrage in 1949; party splits in 1968 and 1978; and the federal Chamber in 1995. Figure 23 plots the series alongside institutional-period averages. These comparisons describe changes around each reform; they do not isolate its effect, because other events occurred at the same time.

Religious partisanship averages 0.00004 under census suffrage, 0.00070 under plural voting and 0.00055 under equal male suffrage and in the post-war unitary state. It is 0.00043 during the state-reform decades and $-0.00028$ in the federal era. Left–others partisanship averages 0.00117 under plural voting, 0.00139 under equal male suffrage and 0.00044 to 0.00072 after-

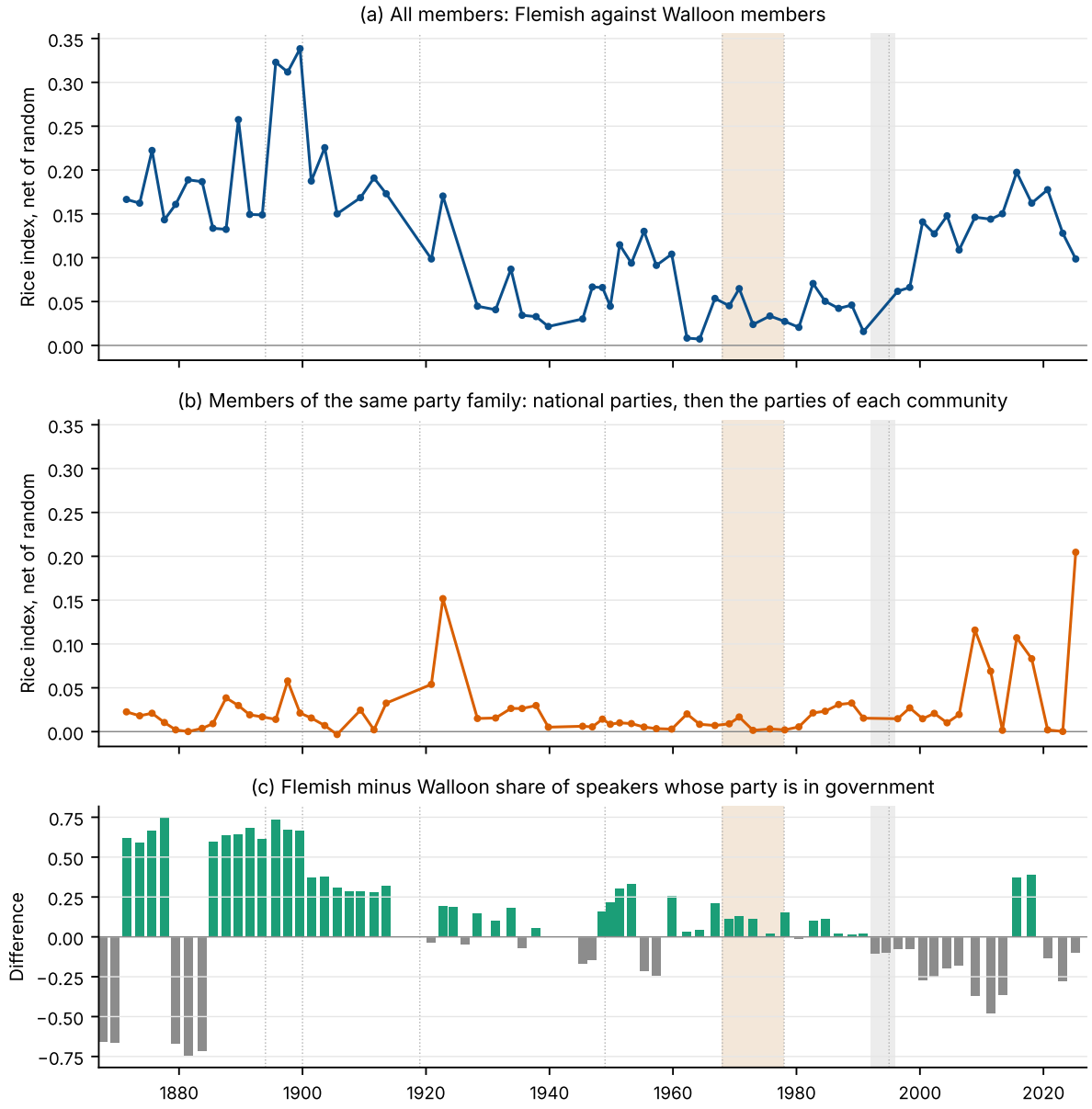



**Figure 8:** Flemish and Walloon members in roll-call votes, 1870–2025

*Notes*: (a) Members elected in Flemish against members elected in Walloon districts: Rice index of party unlikeness (Rice, 1925), the absolute difference between the two groups' shares of yes among their yes and no votes, minus its expected value when the region labels are assigned at random among the members voting; mean over the roll calls of the period with at least 10 yes or no votes in each region. (b) The same within each party family, with at least 5 yes or no votes in each region: the national party before its split (Catholics 1968, Liberals 1972, Socialists 1978), afterwards the family's parties in the two communities (CD&V and cdH/Les Engagés, Open Vld and MR, sp.a/Vooruit and PS, Groen and Ecolo); mean over the families, weighted by their votes. (c) Share of the Flemish speakers of the period whose party is in government minus the share of the Walloon speakers. Members elected in Brussels are left out, and so are the roll calls in which a member appears more than once (2,402 of 31,615). Periods with fewer than 20 roll calls and periods with low coverage of the sittings are not shown. Shaded: the years of the party splits, 1968–1978 (beige), and low coverage (grey); dotted lines: start of the institutional periods of Table 4. Produced by `code/python/29_regions.py`.

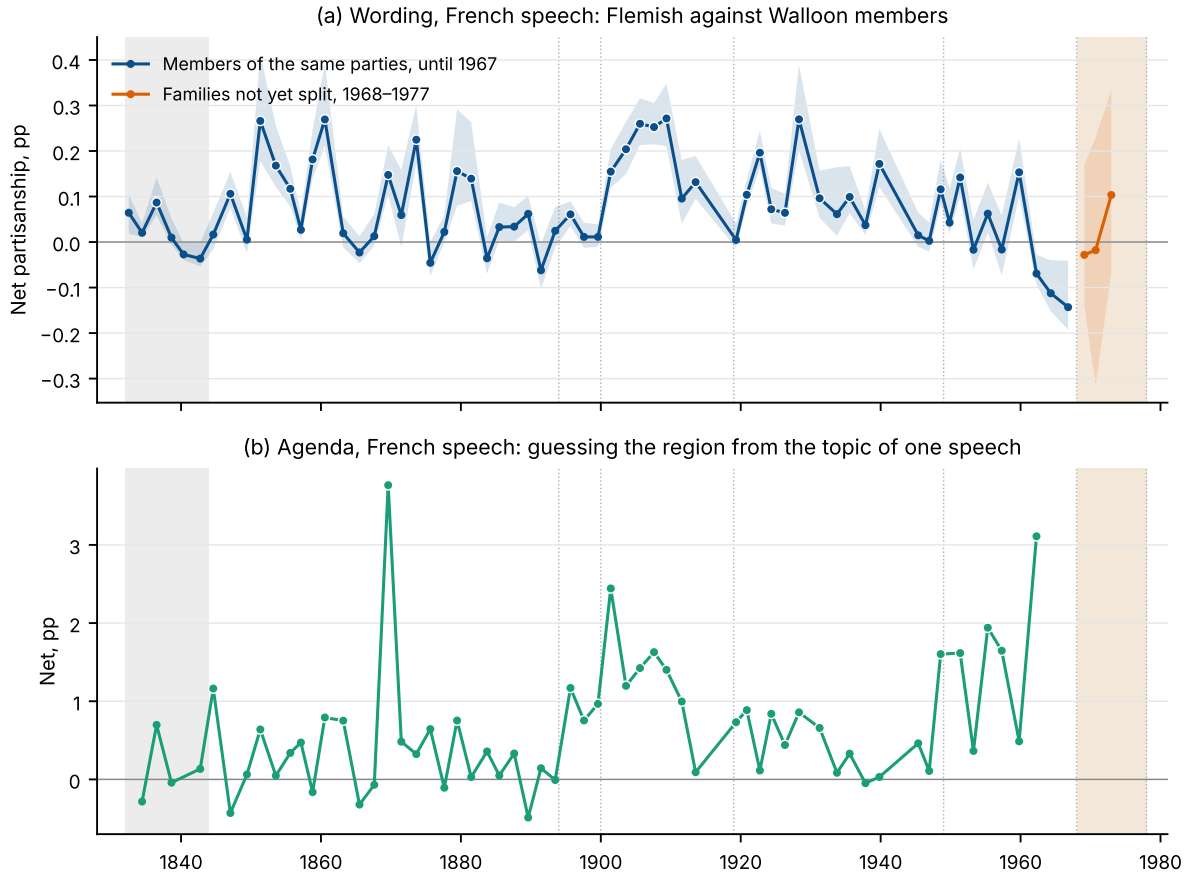



**Figure 9:** Flemish and Walloon members in French speech: wording and topics, 1831–1977

*Notes*: (a) Net partisanship between members elected in Flemish and in Walloon districts, French speech, controls for party family and gender, in percentage points (0.27 points: 0.0027), with 80 per cent intervals; dots: periods above the random benchmark. Blue: members of the national parties, until 1967 (Figure 20); orange: from 1968, members of the families that had not yet split (Liberals until 1971, Socialists until 1977), in a series estimated with all periods to 1977. (b) Probability of guessing the region of the speaker from the topic of one French speech, with equal priors, minus its mean when the region labels are permuted among the speakers of the period (1,000 permutations), in percentage points; speakers with at least five speeches on a substantive topic, and at least 20 speakers in each region; dots: periods above the 90th percentile of the permutations. Shaded: low coverage of the sittings (grey) and the years of the party splits, 1968–1978 (beige); dotted lines: start of the institutional periods. Produced by `code/python/29_regions.py`.

**Table 4:** Partisanship by institutional period

| Institutional period | Catholic vs other | Left vs other | Government vs opposition |
|---|---|---|---|
| Census suffrage, 1831–1893 | 0.00004 | | -0.00010 |
| | (0.00010) | | (0.00010) |
| Plural voting, 1894–1918 | 0.00070 | 0.00117 | 0.00029 |
| | (0.00024) | (0.00017) | (0.00017) |
| Equal male suffrage, 1919–1944 | 0.00055 | 0.00139 | 0.00153 |
| | (0.00012) | (0.00036) | (0.00043) |
| Post-war unitary state, 1945–1970 | 0.00055 | 0.00044 | -0.00001 |
| | (0.00017) | (0.00014) | (0.00013) |
| State reforms, 1971–1994 | 0.00043 | 0.00049 | 0.00024 |
| | (0.00032) | (0.00023) | (0.00014) |
| Federal Chamber of 150, 1995–2025 | -0.00028 | 0.00072 | 0.00075 |
| | (0.00024) | (0.00056) | (0.00033) |

*Notes*: Mean partisanship net of the random series, by institutional period; Newey–West standard errors (two lags) in parentheses. Periods with low coverage of the sittings (1832–1843, 1992–1995) are excluded.

wards; the federal-era mean has a large standard error because of the high values of 2021–2025. Government–opposition partisanship is −0.00010 under census suffrage and 0.00029 under plural voting. It is highest under equal male suffrage, at 0.00153, close to zero in the post-war unitary state and during the state reforms (−0.00001 and 0.00024), and 0.00075 in the federal era.

The 1894 elections are followed by increases of 0.00126 in religious partisanship (standard error 0.00025) and 0.00092 in government–opposition partisanship (standard error 0.00011). This agrees with Graziani and Vanschoonbeek (2026), who find that the partisan gap widened in the Chamber relative to the Senate after these elections. As discussed above, the rise coincides with Socialists joining group *B*; the Catholic–Liberal pair exceeds its random benchmark in no period of 1894–1914 (Section 5.5). After proportional representation in 1900, government–opposition partisanship is 0.00048 lower (standard error 0.00021), while the changes in religious and left–others partisanship (−0.00061 and 0.00042) lie within two standard errors. Around equal male suffrage, religious and left–others partisanship change little (−0.00010 and 0.00013), while government–opposition partisanship is 0.00104 higher (standard error 0.00024), in a comparison of four periods that leaves out the national-union governments of 1918–1921.

Around women's suffrage, first used in 1949, the three series change by less than two standard errors (−0.00028, 0.00034 and −0.00040), although the later periods of this comparison include the Royal Question and the beginning of the second school war. Women's voting rights changed the Chamber's composition little. After the Christian democrats split in 1968, left–others partisanship is 0.00074 lower (standard error 0.00031), mainly because of its low value in 1969–1971. The other changes after the party splits of 1968 and 1978 lie within two standard errors, including the higher religious partisanship after 1978 (0.00125, standard error 0.00070).

Partisanship can change through member turnover or through changes in sitting members' speech. Figure 24 and Table 9 decompose changes in leave-out partisanship between consecutive periods. The decomposition uses each member's leave-out score, pooled over the two languages, so from the 1890s its changes differ somewhat from those of the leave-out series of Online Appendix Figure A9, which combines the estimates of the two languages. One component measures changes among members present in both periods; the other measures entry and exit. For religious partisanship, the components have opposite signs in five of six institutional periods. Across the full sample, changes among continuing members add to partisanship, while turnover reduces it. This is consistent with members becoming more distinctive as their careers progress and entrants speaking less distinctively than those they replace. We treat this as a career pattern rather than a response to specific reforms and do not interpret individual periods. Neither component measures a change in political positions: sitting members' speech can become more distinct because they take up different subjects or roles.

### 5.9 Partisanship and the economy

Most variation in partisanship occurs within institutional periods (Figure 23). Figure 10 compares the three series with GDP-per-capita growth averaged over each period. Across all periods, correlations are 0.03 for religious partisanship, −0.17 for left–others partisanship and −0.13 for government–opposition partisanship. Within the institutional periods in Table 4, which account for long-run changes, the correlations are −0.12, −0.25 and −0.15 (panels c–e). The slopes per

percentage point of growth are −0.00004, −0.00010 and −0.00006, with Newey–West standard errors of 0.00003, 0.00003 and 0.00007. Only the slope for left–others partisanship is more than two standard errors from zero.

Within institutional periods, partisanship therefore tends to be somewhat higher when growth is slower than usual, most clearly between the left and other parties. The clearest case is the depression of 1932–1934, when all three series are above their institutional-period averages, left–others partisanship by 0.0022. Reconstruction in 1919–1923 combines the fastest growth with low partisanship in every series. Slow growth also coincides with high religious partisanship in 1981–1983 and with high left–others partisanship in 2007–2010. Other slow periods do not follow the pattern. In 1929–1932, the slowest growth relative to its institutional period, partisanship is close to its institutional-period average in all three series, and in 1936–1939 it is below average in all three. In the slowdowns of 1952–1954 and 1956–1958, religious and left–others partisanship are at or below their averages.

This relationship is descriptive. Growth and partisanship may share causes, and partisan conflict may itself slow growth. Reconstruction occurred under national-union governments. Excluding the post-war unitary state, whose slowdowns of the 1950s coincide with average or low partisanship, gives within-period correlations of −0.22, −0.28 and −0.17; leaving out any one institutional period gives within-period correlations between −0.29 and −0.04 for the three series. Evidence from elsewhere links economic hardship to political extremism in interwar Europe (de Bromhead et al., 2013), and shows increased polarization after financial crises but not ordinary recessions (Funke et al., 2016).

### 5.10 Magnitudes

Following Gentzkow et al. (2019), we compare parliaments using the probability of correctly identifying a member's party after one minute of speech, or about 33 phrases. This is a projection from the estimated model: it treats the 33 phrases as independent draws from the estimated phrase-choice probabilities. It does not measure how well actual speeches can be classified. Online Appendix Figure A1 shows the expected posterior probability as the number of phrases heard increases. Figure 11 shows each period's one-minute probability alongside values for other parliaments. For the US Congress, Gentzkow et al. (2019) report an increase from 57 per cent in 1989 to 73 per cent in 2007. For Finland's Eduskunta, Simola et al. (2023) report about 55 per cent at the end of the sample and slightly below 70 per cent at the 1970s peak. For Norway's Storting, Fiva et al. (2021) report 57 per cent in 1982–2000 and 61 per cent in 2001–2020 (Section 5.11).

In Belgium, the religious-group probability ranges from 52 to 60 per cent in 1846–1914, reaches 62.5 per cent in 1981–1983 and is 56.4 per cent in the last period. The left–others probability is 61 per cent in 1894–1896, peaks at 65.1 per cent in 1932–1934, and is 62.0 per cent in the last period. The government–opposition probability reaches 65.9 per cent in 1934–1936, below the US Congress in 2007, and is 59.2 per cent in the last period.

These probabilities use the real series without subtracting finite-sample bias. A random-series value of 0.502 already implies a one-minute probability of about 56 per cent in the absence of partisanship. With this qualification, Belgium's highest probabilities are below Finland's

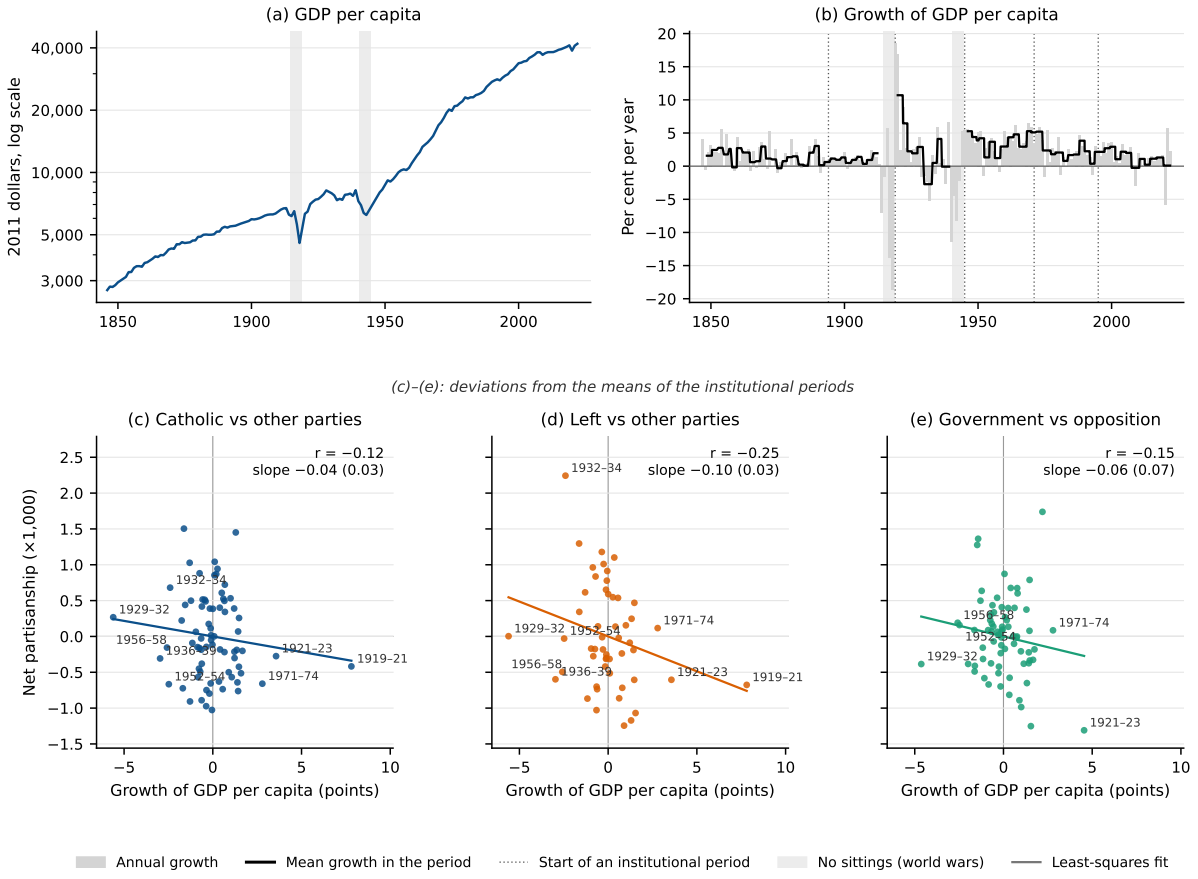



**Figure 10:** The Belgian economy and partisanship, 1846–2022

*Notes*: (a) GDP per capita in 2011 dollars, log scale. (b) Annual growth of GDP per capita, and its mean in each period of the partisanship series, with the years weighted by the days of the period that fall in them (periods that include a year of war or occupation left out); dotted lines: start of the institutional periods of Table 4 (1894, 1919, 1945, 1971, 1995). (c)–(e) Net partisanship (Figures 1, 2 and 4), multiplied by 1,000, against the mean growth of GDP per capita in the period, both as deviations from the means of the institutional period among the periods shown in the panel; line: least-squares fit; $r$: correlation; slope: change in partisanship ($\times$1,000) per percentage point of growth, with fixed effects for the institutional periods, and its Newey–West standard error (two lags). Periods with low coverage of the sittings and the four periods that include a year of war or occupation (1912–1914, 1918–1919, 1939–1940, 1944–1946) are excluded; labels mark the periods whose growth is at least 2.3 points away from the mean of their institutional period. Shaded: no sittings of the Chamber (August 1914 to November 1918, May 1940 to September 1944). Source: Maddison Project Database 2023 (Bolt and van Zanden, 2024, 2025), from Gadisseur (1973) for 1846–1913, Carbonnelle (1959) for 1913–1950 and the Total Economy Database of the Conference Board for 2008–2022 (`code/python/22_economy.py`).

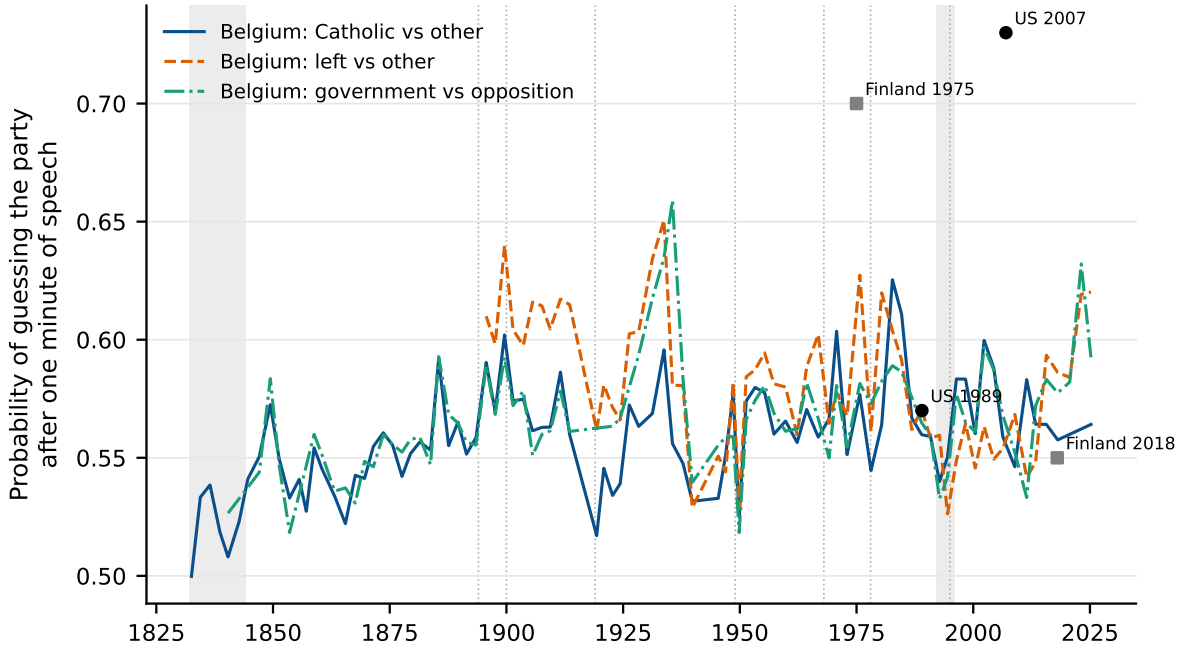



**Figure 11:** Probability of guessing the party after one minute of speech

*Notes*: Expected posterior probability assigned to the actual group after hearing 33 phrases (Gentzkow et al., 2019), by period, computed from the real series under the model, with the phrases treated as independent. Markers: values reported by Gentzkow et al. (2019) for the US Congress and by Simola et al. (2023) for Finland.

1970s peak. In the last period, the Belgian probabilities of 56 to 62 per cent are above Finland's at the end of its sample and, for the left–others grouping, close to Norway's in 2001–2020.

Gentzkow et al. (2019) compare their speech measure with roll-call voting in the US Congress. We compare differences in wording with divisions in roll-call votes in three ways. The division between two groups in a roll call is the party-unlikeness index of Rice (1925): the absolute difference between the groups' shares voting yes, averaged over the roll calls of the period (Online Appendix A). The index measures votes, not language.

First, for the three main divides, the correlation across periods between the division in votes and net partisanship in speech is 0.19 for Catholics and other parties (64 periods), 0.18 for the left and other parties (54) and 0.05 for government and opposition (65; Online Appendix Figure A17 and Table A1). Within institutional periods, the correlations change sign. Votes divide Catholics from other parties most under plural voting (a mean of 0.65). Within that period, the two measures move in opposite directions (correlation −0.63): religious partisanship in speech is highest in 1894–1902, the division in votes in 1904–1914. Votes divide the left from other parties mainly when the Socialists are in opposition.

Second, since 1979, two parties of the same language that sit on the same side of the government–opposition divide vote alike (a mean division of 0.11) and are harder to tell apart in speech (a mean net partisanship of 0.94 per thousand) than two parties on opposite sides (0.57 and 2.67; Online Appendix Figure A18). Across the 278 pair-periods of 34 pairs, the correlation between the two measures is 0.30; within pairs over time, it is 0.16. Third, before the splits, Flemish and Walloon members of the same national party seldom vote differently (Section 5.7), and the correlation between their division in votes and their partisanship in speech is 0.17 (49

periods; Online Appendix Figure A19).

Divisions in votes and differences in wording therefore move only loosely together. Votes record the side a group takes on a bill; wording records how its members speak, including on subjects that are not put to a vote. Figure 19 compares religious partisanship with five other features of the Chamber, following Simola et al. (2023). Online Appendix Figure A21 reports the OCR experiment. In the born-digital reports of 2019–2025, a character error rate of 5 per cent reduces left–others partisanship above 0.5 to 81 per cent of its clean-text value with covariates and 72 per cent without them. At 10 per cent error, these shares fall to 69 and 56 per cent. The religious series is undefined in most of these years. Historical volumes' error rates have not yet been measured, so we cannot use these results to correct nineteenth-century levels. If historical error rates were about 5 per cent, those levels would be understated by 19 to 28 per cent. A correction of that size would not change the rank of census suffrage among the institutional periods of Table 4.

### 5.11 Comparison with other parliaments

Table 5 compares Belgium with available long-run measures of parliamentary speech partisanship. Three differences stand out.

First, the peaks occur at different times. Belgian religious partisanship is most visible in the decade after 1894 and, after the Christian democrats split, around 1970 and in the early 1980s; it never exceeds its random benchmark in the federal era. Left–others partisanship is highest in 2024–2025, a short period, and government–opposition partisanship between the wars. Elsewhere, peaks are recent or occur in the late twentieth century. US congressional partisanship is low and stable from 1873 to the early 1990s, then rises sharply (Gentzkow et al., 2019). Jensen et al. (2012) date an earlier increase in partisan language to the late 1960s. Finnish partisanship peaks in the mid-1970s and rises again from the 1990s to its 1930s level (Simola et al., 2025). In Norway's Storting, it stays at 0.502–0.503 per word until about 2000, then rises to a peak in 2019 (Fiva et al., 2021).

In the British House of Commons, party-classifier accuracy falls to its lowest level during the Second World War, rises sharply from 1979 and peaks around 1987. It then declines, faster after Tony Blair becomes Labour leader in 1994, returning to mid-1960s levels (Peterson and Spirling, 2018). In the religious and left–others series, Belgium shares Britain's lower partisanship under broad coalitions, such as the national-union governments of 1918–1921, and its decline in the 1990s. Like Finland, Norway and the United States, Belgium shows a recent rise: left–others partisanship reaches its highest value in 2024–2025, and government–opposition partisanship its highest value since the 1930s in 2021–2024.

Second, peak levels differ. Belgium's highest one-minute probabilities, 62.5 per cent for the religious grouping in 1981–1983, 65.1 per cent for the left–others grouping in 1932–1934 and 65.9 per cent for government and opposition in 1934–1936, are below Finland's 1970s peak of slightly below 70 per cent and the US Congress's 73 per cent in 2007. Belgium's left–others probability averages 57 per cent in the periods from 1981–1983 to 1997–1999, close to Norway's bloc-identification probability of 57 per cent in 1982–2000, and 56 per cent in those from 2001–2003 to 2016–2019, below Norway's 61 per cent in 2001–2020 (Fiva et al., 2021). These

comparisons are approximate: Fiva et al. (2021) use single words rather than bigrams and compare two blocs, and none of these probabilities subtract finite-sample bias.

Third, the groups behind the peaks differ. Finland's extreme left drives its 1970s peak (Simola et al., 2025). Belgium's radical left contributes to the 1932–1934 value, to the rise of 2021–2024 and to part of the 2024–2025 value (0.0045 without it, against 0.0052), but it does not change which period is highest. The highest left–others value, in 2024–2025, comes mainly from Dutch speech, and the highest religious value, in 1969–1971, mainly from French speech (Sections 5.1 and 5.2).

The government–opposition divide recurs across studies of parliamentary systems. In the Irish Dáil, it is the main dimension of speech, with ministers more extreme than backbenchers (Lauderdale and Herzog, 2016). Classifiers trained on Canadian debates learn governing and opposition roles rather than ideology and fail when parties exchange roles (Hirst et al., 2014). In the House of Commons, the second dimension of party embeddings separates government from opposition (Rheault and Cochrane, 2020). Swedish parties within the same bloc spoke most similarly during the formal alliances of 2006–2014 (Wising et al., 2026). Government–opposition interests also explain roll-call voting better than policy positions in most parliamentary systems (Hix and Noury, 2016). Belgium extends this evidence over the long run. Government–opposition differences can be measured from the 1840s. They are clearest between the wars, and since 1995 they exceed their random benchmark more often than the religious, left–others, left–right and right–others series (Section 5.4).

### 5.12 Limits of the measure

Four limitations matter when comparing levels across eras.

**The amount of speech.** The penalized estimator retains a party coefficient only when the data support it. Speech volume has fallen: members use about 4,100 vocabulary phrases per period in 1894–1918 and 1,800 in 1995–2025. Phrases with a non-zero religious coefficient fall from about 300 to about 130 per period (Online Appendix Figures A6 and D4). Part of the low religious and left–others partisanship from the mid-1980s to the 2010s may therefore reflect less speech per member rather than smaller differences in speech.

The unpenalized leave-out estimator ranks recent decades higher than the penalized estimator does (Online Appendix Figure A9). Left–others leave-out partisanship is higher in the 2000s and 2010s than in the 1950s and 1960s, and higher in 2024–2025 than in any other period after 1914. Government–opposition leave-out partisanship averages as much in the federal era as under plural voting and equal male suffrage and is highest in 2024–2025. Leave-out confidence intervals are, however, more than ten times wider than penalized intervals.

**Role and substance.** Partisanship captures differences in wording whatever their source; it is not a measure of the distance between policy positions. Governing members submit bills, while opposition members question ministers, so institutional roles generate distinctive phrases. The vocabulary leaves out the formulas and titles that go with these roles, but not the words with which the opposition criticizes the government, such as those about its special powers

**Table 5:** Partisanship of parliamentary speech: Belgium and other parliaments

| Study | Parliament | Measure | Highest values | Recent decades |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| This paper | Belgium, Chamber of Representatives, 1831–2025 | GST, pairs of words; party families | Religious: 1969–1971 and 1981–1983, one minute 0.60 and 0.63; left–others: 1932–1934 and 2024–2025, 0.65 and 0.62; government–opposition: 1934–1936, 0.66 | Religious never above its random benchmark since 1995; left–others highest in 2024–2025; government–opposition above its benchmark in 8 of 14 periods since 1995; one minute 0.56–0.57 (left–others) and 0.57 (government–opposition) in 1981–2019 |
| Simola et al. (2025) | Finland, Eduskunta, 1907–2018 | GST, pairs of words; left vs other parties | Mid-1970s, driven by the extreme left; one minute somewhat below 0.70 | Rising since the 1990s, to the level of the 1930s; one minute about 0.55 |
| Gentzkow et al. (2019) | United States, Congress, 1873–2016 | GST, pairs of words; Democrats vs Republicans | 2000s; one minute 0.73 in 2007 | Sharp rise from the early 1990s |
| Fiva et al. (2021) | Norway, Storting, 1981–2020 | GST, single words; left vs right bloc | 2019, 0.506 per word | Rising from about 2000; one minute 0.57 (1982–2000) and 0.61 (2001–2020) |
| Peterson and Spirling (2018) | United Kingdom, House of Commons, 1935–2013 | Accuracy of party classifiers (about 0.65–0.76) | Around 1987 | Falling after 1994, to the level of the mid-1960s |
| Wising et al. (2026) | Sweden, Riksdag, 1991–2023 | Party classifiers | Similarity within the blocs highest in 2006–2014 | Declining after the formal alliances |

*Notes*: GST: the measure of Gentzkow et al. (2019), the expected posterior probability assigned to a speaker's actual group after one phrase. One minute: model-based probability of guessing a speaker's group after one minute of speech (about 33 phrases, treated as independent), computed from the real series; for Belgium, Table 1 and Figure 11; for the United States, Gentzkow et al. (2019); for Finland, Simola et al. (2023); for Norway, Fiva et al. (2021). Levels are comparable only roughly across studies that differ in the unit of text, the groups compared, the covariates and the treatment of finite-sample bias.

(*pouvoirs spéciaux*; Section 5.1.1). Left–others partisanship is higher, on average, when most Socialist members are in opposition, while religious partisanship moves only weakly with government–opposition partisanship. The measure also misses conflicts conducted largely with shared vocabulary, as the first school war illustrates. Pairwise comparisons, the government–opposition series and dictionaries of school, royal, language and labour phrases help distinguish cleavages from roles. They do not remove role-related vocabulary from the series.

**The record.** Language labels, procedural text and the conversion of the reports affect several results. Before counting phrases, we remove the translations printed within speech blocks and the roll-call formulas, relabel blocks whose function words belong to the other language, and count sentences in the other language as speech in that language (Section 3). From 1968, we also apply the language rule to every party that belongs to one language community. These corrections change several results of earlier estimates. Roll-call formulas appended to Christian-democratic members' French speeches no longer produce a religious peak in 2001–2003. French passages in Dutch blocks no longer drive the left–others estimate for 1974–1977, which now comes mainly from Dutch speech. Dutch blocks labeled French no longer inflate comparisons involving the Flemish nationalists and the radical right after 2010. Translations of the submission formulas no longer enter the French series of the 1950s (Section 5.1.1).

Some problems remain. Dutch words still occur in some French blocks: *ik citeer* and *handelingen plenaire* are among the most partisan French phrases of other parties in the left–others comparison of 1969–1971 and 1989–1991 (Table 11). Text of the voting procedure also remains in some Dutch blocks: vote tallies printed in both languages in 2001–2003 (*oui nee*, *abstentions totaal*) and the formula that applies the result of a previous vote in 2003–2005 (*uitslag vorige*, *stemming gelden*) are among the most partisan Dutch phrases of the Christian democrats in the religious comparison (Online Appendix C) and of the other parties in the right–others comparison, and the answers of a roll call (*non neen*, *neen geantwoord*) among those of the right in 1985–1989 (phrase tables of the replication package). The right–others value of 2003–2005, which exceeds its benchmark, rests on its Dutch component, in which these phrases are four of the five most partisan phrases of the other parties. In earlier estimates, the recent left–others values were sensitive to how the members of the joint green group are assigned to language communities (Section 5.2).

**The vocabulary.** We leave phrases without content out of the vocabulary (Section 3). Some of these phrases distinguish the groups only through their roles: only those who govern use the formulas with which ministers and rapporteurs submit bills and reports. In an earlier estimation on all phrases, with the version of the dataset of 11 October 2026, the three main series were high in the 1950s, when one bloc governed and the other opposed. The religious series was highest in 1950–1958, at 0.0026 to 0.0031, and exceeded its random benchmark in all four periods of these years, as did the left–others and government–opposition series. The religious values of these years came largely from the submission formulas (Section 5.1.1). With the vocabulary used here, no period of 1950–1958 exceeds its benchmark in the religious series, and only one does in each of the other two (1954–1956 and 1950–1952).

Most other patterns depend little on the vocabulary. Period by period, net partisanship in the two estimations has a correlation of 0.75 in the religious series, 0.90 in the left–others series and 0.81 in the government–opposition series, and of 0.90, 0.97 and 0.89 when 1950–1958 is left out. Every period that exceeds its benchmark in the religious and left–others series also does so in the estimation on all phrases, and so do all but one in the government–opposition series. With the vocabulary used here, net partisanship is lower in 77 of 81, 49 of 58 and 75 of 77 periods, and fewer periods exceed their benchmarks, especially for government and opposition after 1945: 2 rather than 8 of the 13 periods of the post-war unitary state, 1 rather than 6 of the 9 periods of the state reforms, and 8 rather than 12 of the 14 periods of the federal era. Several results hold in both estimations. Religious partisanship is higher under plural voting than under census suffrage and never exceeds its benchmark in the federal era. Left–others partisanship exceeds its benchmark in 9 of the 11 periods under equal male suffrage and is highest in 2024–2025. Government–opposition partisanship exceeds its benchmark in most periods between the wars and since 1995.

## 6 Topics: what the parties talk about and how

Parties may discuss different subjects or use different language to discuss the same subject. Gentzkow et al. (2019) separate these components. Between-topic partisanship treats topics as the choices and measures differences in the attention each group gives them. Within-topic partisanship is estimated separately from each topic's phrases, then averaged using the topic's share of speech as its weight.

The dictionaries in Section 5.1.1 suggest both types of difference. The first school war mainly reflects differences within a topic. Catholic and Liberal members discuss schools roughly in proportion to their numbers but use different school phrases. The Royal Question and social issues instead reveal differences in topic attention. In 1949–1950, Catholics use only 19 per cent of Royal Question phrases while representing 46 per cent of speakers. In 1894–1914, Socialists represent 18–22 per cent of speakers but use 45–59 per cent of labour phrases. These account for 1.4–2.7 per cent of all phrases (Online Appendix Figure A16). Language policy is not primarily a Flemish subject within the national parties: between the wars, Flemish members use 37–51 per cent of its phrases and represent 45–48 per cent of speakers.

**Topic labels.** A companion module assigns a topic to every speech in five steps, without fixing the topic list in advance. First, a language model freely labels agenda items from a sample of sittings drawn by half-legislature. It also converts keywords and EuroVoc descriptors from legislative files into labels. Second, these labels are grouped into 23 categories and a residual category for procedure. Third, the language model applies the resulting codebook to samples of passages of up to 300 words. Fourth, we train CamemBERT for French (Martin et al., 2020) and the 2023 version of RobBERT for Dutch (Delobelle et al., 2020) on 5,868 French and 5,212 Dutch passages labelled in this way. On 612 French and 588 Dutch passages held out from training, the classifiers assign the language model's category to 74 per cent of French and 74 per cent of Dutch passages, with macro-averaged F1 scores of 0.62 and 0.63. A check of 150 passages per

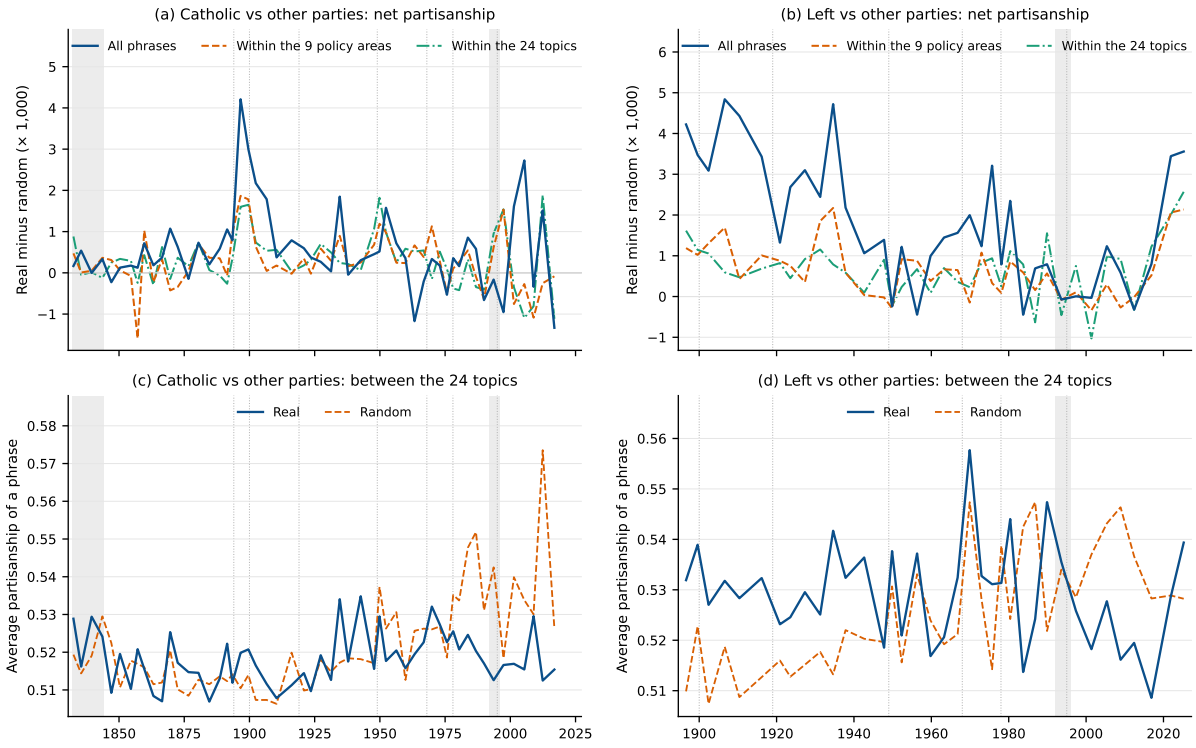



**Figure 12:** Partisanship within and between topics

*Notes*: (a)–(b) Partisanship net of the random series, multiplied by 1,000, of all the phrases of the classified speeches, and within the nine policy areas and the 24 topics (averages of the area or topic series, weighted by their phrases). (c)–(d) Partisanship between the 24 topics, which treats the topics as the choices: real series and series with randomly permuted labels. Religious and left–others groupings without covariates; time unit: legislature; points: legislatures whose neighbours have no value. Shaded: low coverage of the sittings; dotted lines: reforms. Produced by `code/python/26_topic_figures.py` from the series of `code/python/23_topic_areas.py`.

language by two human coders is planned. Fifth, the classifiers label every passage, and each speech takes the category with the highest mean probability across its passages, weighted by passage length. The residual category contains about half of the classified speeches but typically only 1 to 6 per cent of the phrases in a legislature, so its speeches are short or consist mostly of phrases outside the vocabulary. We group the 24 categories into nine policy areas (Table 6).

**Estimation.** For the religious and left–others groupings, we estimate partisanship without covariates over all phrases of the classified speeches, between topics, and within each topic and policy area. We use legislatures rather than periods as the unit of time, merging the periods of each legislature, so that each topic has more speakers. A topic or area enters a legislature when each group has at least 15 speakers in a language, and only those languages enter its average; estimates over all phrases and between topics require 20. As for the main series, we repeat each estimate after permuting group labels among the legislature's speakers and report net partisanship. We do not compute subsampling intervals for these series, so values for individual legislatures are only indicative.

**Within and between topics.** Figure 12 and Table 6 report the results. Within-topic partisanship lies above its random series in 35 of 49 legislatures (the topic series have no intervals) for the religious grouping and in 32 of 36 for the left–others grouping. Partisanship within policy areas

is lower than partisanship over all phrases and moves with it, closely for the left–others grouping and loosely for the religious grouping, with correlations of 0.65 and 0.33 across legislatures. Its median is 0.25 per thousand for the religious grouping, against 0.37 over all phrases, and 0.59 against 1.42 for the left–others grouping. The two levels are not directly comparable: each within-topic estimate uses fewer phrases, and the penalized estimator retains a party coefficient only when the data support it (Section 5.12).

Between topics, the random benchmark is high (Figure 12c–d). With 24 topics as the choices and thousands of phrases per member, a member's division of attention across topics distinguishes even groups drawn at random, plausibly because members specialize and random groups differ in their mix of specialists. For the religious grouping, the random series lies between 0.506 and 0.574 and the real series between 0.507 and 0.535, while partisanship over all phrases peaks at 0.506. For the left–others grouping, the real series lies above its random series in 21 of the 24 legislatures that begin before 1979, including all 13 that begin before 1946: until the late 1970s, the left divided its attention across subjects differently from the other parties. For the religious grouping, it does so in 20 of 39 legislatures before 1979. From 1979, the real series lies below its benchmark in 10 of 10 legislatures for the religious grouping and 9 of 12 for the left–others grouping. One possible reason is that parties divide the agenda among their members, so that each party covers subjects more evenly than a random group of the same size. Each between-topic benchmark comes from a single permutation, so we do not interpret individual legislatures of these series.

**Policy areas.** For the religious grouping, the most partisan areas over the whole period are public finance and money, institutions, and school, religion and culture, with medians of 0.54, 0.53 and 0.31 per thousand across legislatures; justice, rights and public order is the least partisan (0.00). Partisanship in school, religion and culture rises during both school wars: to 0.6 and 1.1 in the legislatures of 1878–1886 and to 1.9 and 1.5 in those of 1950–1958. It is the most partisan of the eight substantive areas in 1882–1886 and in both legislatures of 1950–1958, and the fourth in 1878–1882. During the first school war, this agrees with the dictionaries, which show Catholic and Liberal members using different school phrases. For the left–others grouping, public finance and money, and labour and welfare are the most partisan areas, with medians of 0.94 and 0.89, while justice, rights and public order, and school, religion and culture are the least partisan ($-0.10$ and $-0.07$). Both leading areas are most partisan under plural voting and lower in every later institutional period.

The procedural area is the most volatile area for the religious grouping. In 1950–1954, when one bloc governed and the other opposed, its net partisanship is 2.3 per thousand for the religious grouping and 1.3 for the left–others grouping, although these estimates leave out the formulas with which the governing side submits bills and reports, from which much of the religious partisanship of these years came in the estimates on all phrases (Section 5.12). Its highest values are 24.5 in 2003–2007 for the religious grouping, during the roll-call-formula years, after which it stays above 10 until 2014, and 7.3 in 2003–2007 for the left–others grouping. Removing the area changes within-area partisanship by more than 0.5 per thousand in only two legislatures, both for the religious grouping: 1999–2003 and 2003–2007.

**Table 6:** Net partisanship by policy area and institutional period

| | 1831–1893 | 1894–1918 | 1919–1944 | 1945–1970 | 1971–1994 | 1995–2025 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *A. Catholic vs other parties* | | | | | | |
| Legislatures | 15 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 7 | 6 |
| All phrases | 0.4 | 2.1 | 0.5 | 0.3 | 0.1 | 0.5 |
| Within the 9 policy areas | 0.1 | 0.7 | 0.4 | 0.7 | 0.0 | −0.2 |
| Within the 24 topics | 0.2 | 0.9 | 0.3 | 0.7 | −0.1 | 0.0 |
| Public finance and money | 0.4 | 0.2 | 0.5 | 0.9 | 0.4 | 1.3 |
| Economy and infrastructure | 0.3 | 0.3 | 0.2 | 0.6 | −0.3 | −1.3 |
| Labour and welfare | 0.1 | 1.1 | 0.7 | 0.2 | −0.6 | −0.9 |
| Institutions | 0.0 | 0.8 | 0.8 | 1.0 | −0.1 | 1.9 |
| Language and territory | −0.6 | 2.0 | 0.4 | 0.5 | −1.3 | 0.8 |
| Justice, rights and public order | 0.6 | 0.5 | 0.2 | −0.3 | −0.1 | −1.8 |
| Foreign affairs, defence and colonies | 0.2 | 1.0 | −0.5 | 1.1 | 0.2 | 0.4 |
| School, religion and culture | −0.4 | 0.4 | 0.1 | 0.7 | 0.8 | −1.0 |
| Procedure and residual | 0.2 | 1.1 | −0.4 | 0.6 | −0.1 | 7.5 |
| *B. Left vs other parties* | | | | | | |
| Legislatures | | 6 | 7 | 8 | 7 | 8 |
| All phrases | | 3.9 | 2.5 | 1.0 | 1.2 | 1.2 |
| Within the 9 policy areas | | 1.1 | 0.9 | 0.4 | 0.5 | 0.6 |
| Within the 24 topics | | 0.9 | 0.7 | 0.4 | 0.7 | 0.9 |
| Public finance and money | | 2.3 | 1.3 | 0.9 | 0.8 | 1.2 |
| Economy and infrastructure | | 1.6 | 0.9 | −0.3 | 0.4 | 1.0 |
| Labour and welfare | | 2.2 | 1.4 | 0.5 | 0.7 | 0.5 |
| Institutions | | 0.5 | 0.2 | 0.7 | 0.7 | 0.7 |
| Language and territory | | 1.6 | 1.3 | −0.5 | 1.4 | |
| Justice, rights and public order | | 0.4 | 0.8 | −0.2 | −0.2 | −0.2 |
| Foreign affairs, defence and colonies | | −0.8 | 0.4 | 0.2 | 0.0 | 0.9 |
| School, religion and culture | | −0.8 | 0.4 | 0.3 | −0.2 | 0.1 |
| Procedure and residual | | 1.1 | 0.5 | 0.6 | 0.9 | 2.0 |

*Notes*: Mean over the legislatures that begin in each institutional period (census suffrage, plural voting, equal male suffrage, post-war unitary state, state reforms and federal Chamber, as in Table 4) of partisanship net of the random series, multiplied by 1,000; no covariates. Legislatures with low coverage of the sittings, and legislatures in which partisanship over all phrases is undefined, are excluded. Within: average of the area or topic series, weighted by their phrases. Blank: fewer than two legislatures with a value. Single legislatures with small groups can dominate a cell: in 1898–1900, language and territory reaches 7.8 for the religious grouping and 13.3 for the left–others grouping. Areas and their topics: public finance and money (public finance and taxation; money and financial systems); economy and infrastructure (economic activity; agriculture and food; transport and maritime affairs; housing and public works; environment and energy); labour and welfare (employment and labour; social protection; health and medicine; family and personal status); institutions (constitutional government; public administration); language and territory (language policy; territorial government); justice, rights and public order (justice and law; rights and citizenship; public safety and emergency response); foreign affairs, defence and colonies (foreign relations and colonial governance; national defence); school, religion and culture (education; religion and church–state relations; communications, media and culture); procedure and residual (residual and procedural). Produced by `code/python/26_topic_figures.py`.

**Three questions.** The dictionaries leave three questions open. Do the religious and left–others divides reflect different agendas, or different language about the same subjects? Does low religious partisanship in the federal era reflect a shared agenda or a shared vocabulary? How much of the government–opposition difference is procedural?

For both groupings, differences in language about the same subjects are more common than differences in agendas. Between-topic partisanship lies above its random series in 20 of 49 legislatures for the religious grouping and in 24 of 36 for the left–others grouping, less often than within-topic partisanship. Within-area religious partisanship is highest in 1894–1898, the first legislature with Socialist members, at 1.87 per thousand; between-topic partisanship also lies above its random series in that legislature. In the 1950s, within-area religious partisanship is 0.98 in 1950–1954 and 0.25 in 1954–1958. It is positive in 8 of 8 substantive areas in 1950–1954 but in only 4 of 8 in 1954–1958, and between topics the real series lies below its benchmark in both legislatures. Procedural text adds little: without the procedural area, within-area religious partisanship in 1950–1954 is 0.93 rather than 0.98. For the left–others grouping, within-area partisanship is highest in 1932–1936, at 2.17; in 1950–1958, 7 and 6 of the eight substantive areas are positive, and between-topic partisanship exceeds its benchmark in both legislatures.

In the federal era, religious partisanship within areas and within topics is close to zero or negative, as during the state reforms, and about as low as under census suffrage (Table 6). On average, it is negative in economy and infrastructure, labour and welfare, justice, rights and public order, and school, religion and culture, while public finance and money, institutions, language and territory, and foreign affairs remain positive. Since the between-topic real series also lies below its benchmark from 1979, the low federal-era values reflect both a shared agenda and, in several areas, shared wording. In these estimates over all phrases, by contrast, federal-era religious partisanship is not low, owing to high values in 1999–2007 and 2010–2014 that do not appear within the policy areas. For the left–others grouping, the federal era is not uniformly low: within areas, partisanship is close to zero from 1999 to 2014 and rises to 2.06 and 2.14 per thousand in 2019–2024 and 2024–2025, close to its highest value.

The figure and the table do not show the government–opposition grouping. For the groupings they show, the procedural area is the most partisan area in 10 of 49 legislatures for the religious grouping and in 4 of 36 for the left–others grouping; for the religious grouping, these include both legislatures of 1950–1958 and the four from 2003 to 2019. Estimates for government and opposition from the same module give a first answer to the third question. There, the procedural area is the most partisan area in 7 of 49 legislatures, including both of 1950–1958 and the four from 1999 to 2014. But it holds less than 7 per cent of the phrases of any legislature, so leaving it out changes within-area government–opposition partisanship by at most 0.17 per thousand. This does not separate the wording of roles within substantive speeches.

## 7 Reactions, references and emotions

Partisanship measures differences in speech rather than how members treat each other. A second companion module examines the affective side of debates across the full period. It follows Peeters (2026), who study interactions between Dutch- and French-speaking federal parliament

members since 1961. The module records three features. First, it detects stenographers' descriptions of disorder (interruptions, noise, protests and uproar), approval and laughter, plus the chair's calls to order and censures. Second, it detects references by name between members and whether they cross party families or language communities. Third, it will classify speakers' emotions using the eight categories of Widmann and Wich (2023), and the tone towards referenced members as no attack, civil attack or uncivil attack (Muddiman, 2017). A language model codes a sample, and a multilingual classifier (Conneau et al., 2020) extends these labels to the corpus. The first two features require no model and cover the full period; the third is in preparation: the language model has labelled the samples, and two human coders will label part of the test samples.

The results below come from the module's run of 12 October 2026 on the version of the dataset used in this paper. Online Appendix E explains the measures. Four patterns stand out. Disorder is highest in the 1950s and, before then, from the 1870s to the 1910s. Opposition speakers receive more disorder than governing speakers. Across decades, disorder is moderately correlated with left–others partisanship, but not with religious or government–opposition partisanship. Members refer to other party families more often than a random benchmark predicts but, from 1900, to the other language community less often.

**The temperature of the Chamber.** Recorded disorder rises from 6 occurrences per 100,000 words spoken by members in the 1830s to 82 in the 1870s. It stays between 70 and 80 until the 1910s and falls to 48 in the 1940s (Figure 13a). It peaks at 90 in the 1950s. Around the turn of the decade, it reaches 167 in the first half of the short Royal Question legislature (1949–1950), which contains only seven sittings, and 121 in its second half. It reaches 117 in 1954–1956 during the second school war. After the School Pact, disorder rises again to 106 in 1959–1961, then falls to 34 in the 1960s and 15 in the 1990s. Levels after 1999 are not comparable because interventions became numbered and transcription later switched to recordings.

Calls to order and censures peak after the Socialists enter, at 55–58 per 100 sittings in 1894–1898. This is twice the earlier maximum of 27 in the 1884–1886 half-legislature. They rise again in the 2010s, to 4 per 100 sittings, and to 6 in 2016–2019 (Figure 13c). We calculate the hostile share as disorder divided by disorder plus approval. We begin in 1880 because stenographers rarely recorded approval from the 1840s to 1878. The share falls from 0.65 in the 1880s to 0.41 in the 1920s–1940s, rises to 0.55 in the 1950s, and stays between 0.24 and 0.37 from the 1960s, apart from 0.42 in the 1990s, a decade of partial coverage (Figure 13d).

**Who received the disorder.** Opposition speakers receive more disorder per word than governing-party speakers, including ministers, in every decade from the 1840s to the 2000s (Figure 13b). The ratio is 1.4–1.6 in the 1880s, 1890s, 1940s and 1970s, and about two in the 1960s: 49 versus 24 occurrences per 100,000 words. The gap is small in the 1900s, 1910s and 1980s and reversed in the 2010s and the incomplete 2020s. A study of question time in 2010–2020 also finds that opposition members make most attacks (Poljak, 2023). Dutch speeches receive less disorder than French speeches until the 1980s, including 23 versus 42 per 100,000 words in the 1960s, and more from the 1990s.

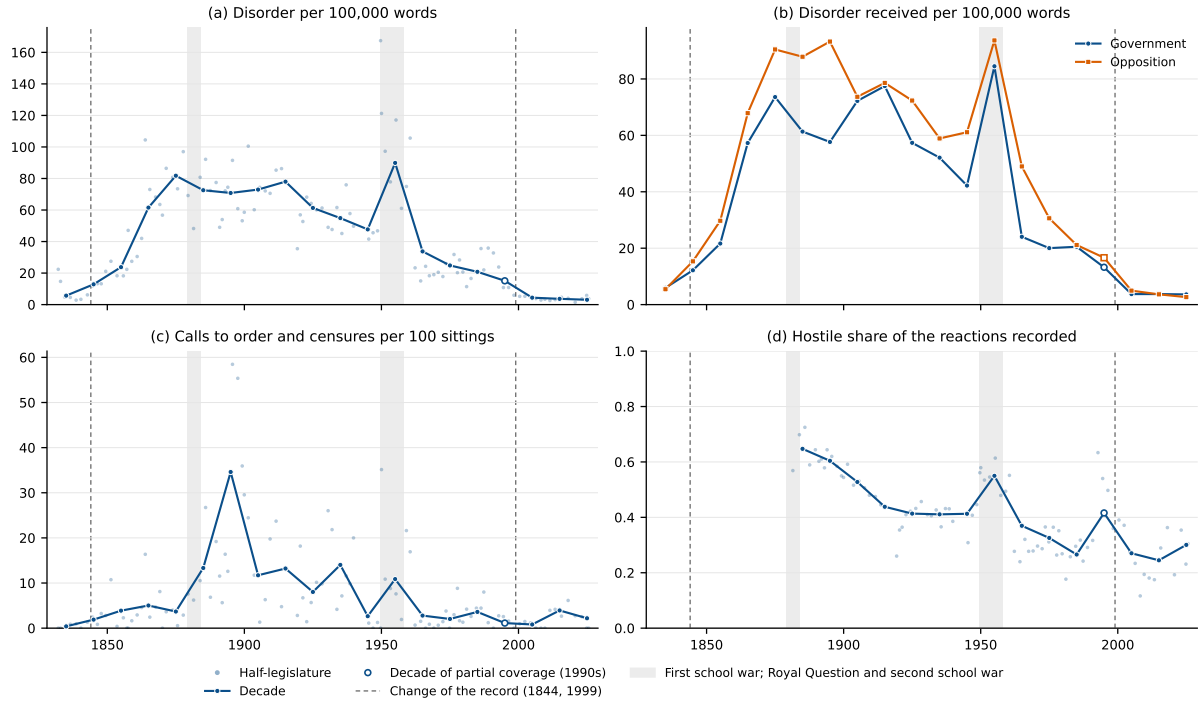



**Figure 13:** The temperature of the Chamber

*Notes*: (a) Stage directions recording disorder (interruptions, noise, protests, uproar) per 100,000 words spoken by members, the chair excluded. (b) The same, in the speeches of members of the governing parties, ministers included, and of the opposition. (c) Calls to order and censures by the chair per 100 sittings. (d) Hostile share of the reactions recorded by the stenographers, disorder / (disorder + approval), from 1880, since approval is rarely recorded between the 1840s and 1878. Points (panels a, c and d): half-legislatures; lines: decades; open markers: the 1990s, when much of the plenary business went to a Central Commission whose proceedings are not included (Section 3). Dashed lines: the record moves from the *Moniteur belge* to the *Annales parlementaires* (1844); interventions are numbered from 1999 and transcribed from audio recordings from October 2000, and the levels after 1999 are not comparable with the earlier ones. Shaded: first school war (1879–1884); Royal Question and second school war (1949–1958). Emotions module (`code/emotions`), run of 12 October 2026; produced by `code/python/21_emotions_link.py`.

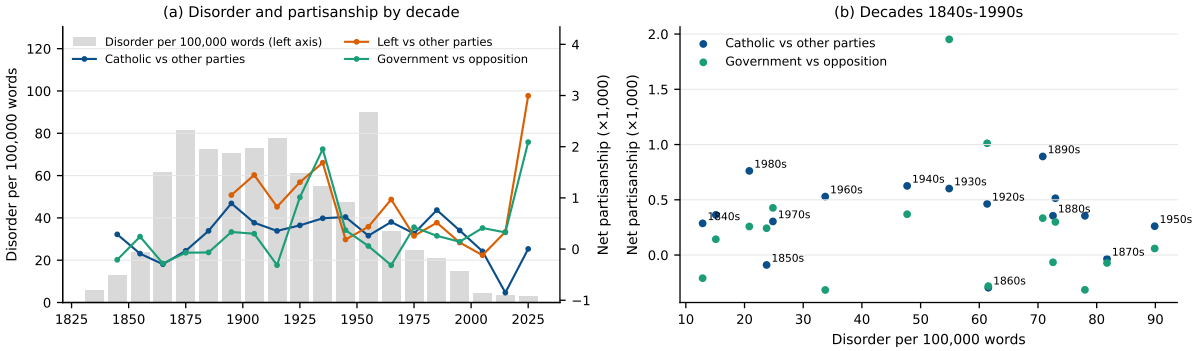



**Figure 14:** Disorder and partisanship

*Notes*: (a) Bars: stage directions recording disorder per 100,000 words spoken by members, by decade (left axis); lines: net partisanship of the religious, left–others and government–opposition series, multiplied by 1,000, averaged over the periods whose middle year falls in the decade (right axis). (b) The religious and government–opposition averages against disorder, decades 1840s–1990s. Periods with low coverage of the sittings are excluded. The comparison is made by decade because the emotions module divides the legislatures at different dates. After 1999 the levels of disorder are not comparable with the earlier ones (Figure 13). Produced by `code/python/21_emotions_link.py`, which writes the correlations to `output/series/emotions_corr.csv`.

**Disorder and partisanship.** Disorder and partisanship follow different long-run patterns (Figure 14). Across decades from the 1840s to the 1990s, disorder per 100,000 words is not correlated with net religious partisanship ($-0.06$) or with government–opposition partisanship ($-0.01$). From the 1890s, it is moderately correlated with left–others partisanship (0.44 over 11 decades): both are high from the 1890s to the 1930s and low from the 1970s. Excluding the 1950s gives correlations of $-0.02$, 0.03 and 0.66. Disorder is also correlated with Catholic–Socialist partisanship (0.55 over 11 decades, 0.85 without the 1950s; Section 5.5).

The 1950s show the difference most clearly. The Royal Question and the second school war produce more disorder than any other decade, but in all three series net partisanship in the 1950s is below its average over the decades compared (Figure 14a). Debates were loud, yet the parties' vocabularies were not unusually easy to tell apart.

**References.** References to members by name follow party and language lines (Figure 15). The module detects about 1.2 million references by name and links more than three quarters to a member or minister. In every decade, members refer to other party families more often than random speaker–target pairing within the half-legislature would predict. The gap reaches 15 percentage points in the 1870s (66 versus 51 per cent) and 12 in the 1950s (77 versus 65 per cent). From the 1860s to the 1890s, references to the other language community—or, before party splits, the other region—also exceed the benchmark by 6–7 points. From 1900, they fall below it by 6–13 points: 41 versus 49 per cent in the 1900s and 32 versus 41 per cent in the 2000s. Before proportional representation, most districts elected members of one party, so cross-region references were largely cross-party references.

We compare the module with the investiture and State of the Union debates of 1961–2023 studied by Peeters and Lefever (2026). Its intervention counts are within 15 per cent of theirs in 37 of 49 debates; the median ratio is 1.01 across the 20 debates of 1961–1991 and 0.97 across the 29 of 1993–2023. The largest shortfall is in 2006, when only one of the debate days is in the dataset. Cross-language reference shares track theirs, with a correlation of 0.80 across 49 debates

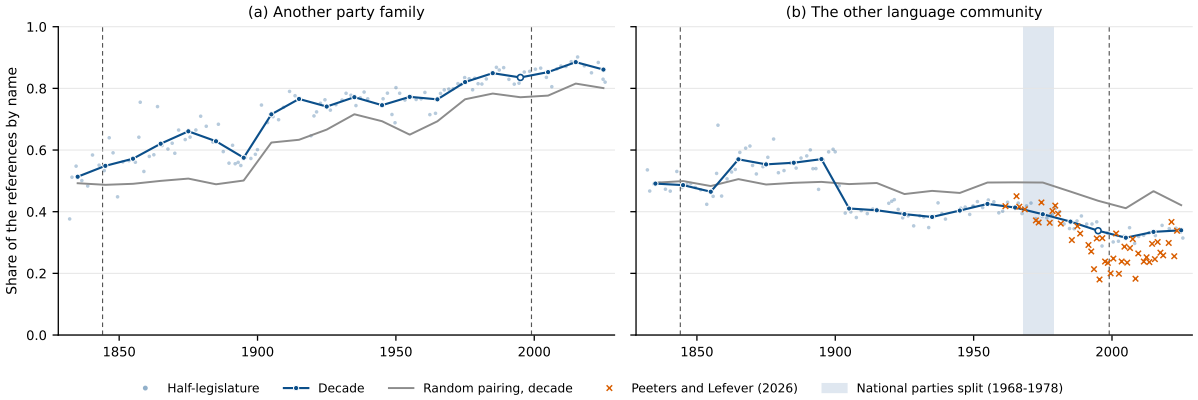



**Figure 15:** References between groups

*Notes*: Share of the references by name from one member to another, attributed to a member or minister, that point to (a) a member of another party family and (b) a member of the other language community, among the references whose speaker and target groups are known. Points: half-legislatures; lines: decades; grey lines: the share expected if, within each half-legislature, every reference paired its speaker with a target drawn at random from all the targets referred to. Crosses: the same share in the investiture and State of the Union debates of 1961–2023 studied by Peeters and Lefever (2026, Appendix 1), pooled by year. Language community: that of the party after the national parties split (1968–1978, shaded), otherwise the region of the constituency, so before the 1960s it separates Flemish from Walloon and Brussels constituencies rather than languages spoken. Dashed lines and open markers as in Figure 13. Emotions module (`code/emotions`), run of 12 October 2026; produced by `code/python/21_emotions_link.py`.

(0.85 without 2006) and a mean absolute difference of 0.05 (crosses in Figure 15b). They find that only 31 per cent of references cross the language border. In their data, the share declines from 1979, after the last national-party split, and rises again from 2007.

Coding emotions and reference tone will show whether parties with more distinct speech also address each other with more anger and incivility; stage directions suggest so only for left–others partisanship. It will also show whether low partisanship in the federal era coexists with greater hostility.

# 8 Conclusions

This paper traces differences in Belgian Chamber speech from 1831 to 2025. We compare Catholics with other parties, the left with other parties and with the right, the right with all other parties, government with opposition, pairs of party families and of parties, and Flemish with Walloon members of the same national party. Partisanship is low under census suffrage, when parties are coalitions of notables and conflicts use largely shared vocabulary. It rises when Socialists enter under plural voting: religious partisanship exceeds its random benchmark in every period from 1894 to 1904, and left–others partisanship in most periods from 1898 to 1940. Government–opposition partisanship is highest between the wars, when the Socialists opposed Catholic–Liberal governments and smaller groups opposed the governments of national union that followed. Once procedural formulas are left out of the vocabulary, the 1950s, the decade of the Royal Question and the second school war, are not a period of unusually distinct wording. Religious partisanship is moderate until the early 1990s, highest in the main specification in 1969–1971, soon after the Christian democrats split, and never above its benchmark in the federal era. Differences between the left and other parties are low from the mid-1980s to 2021

and highest in 2024–2025, a short period. Government–opposition differences exceed their benchmark in more than half of the periods since 1995. In the three main divisions, the model implies that one minute of speech would identify a member's group correctly with probability of at most 63 to 66 per cent, below the US Congress in 2007 and Finland in the 1970s.

Studying the cleavages separately yields two findings. First, differences between the left and other parties move with the government–opposition divide: left–others partisanship is higher, on average, when most Socialist members are in opposition, and it is correlated with government–opposition partisanship across periods. Religious partisanship moves only weakly with government–opposition partisanship. Among pairs of families, Catholic–Socialist partisanship exceeds its random benchmark more often than that of the other pairs and is higher, on average, when one of the two families governs and the other opposes; the Catholic–Liberal and Liberal–Socialist pairs show no such pattern. Since 1979, two parties of the same language use more similar wording when both are in opposition. Second, before the national parties split, the linguistic cleavage appears mainly through regional interests, despite later reorganizing the party system. Section 5.7 follows Flemish and Walloon members over the whole period, in their votes and in the subjects of their speeches.

The clearest changes in partisanship around wider voting rights coincide with changes in the Chamber's composition, especially the Socialists' entry in 1894. Belgium's religious divide is most visible in speech in the decade after 1894 and, after the Christian democrats split, around 1970 and in the early 1980s, rather than during the second school war or the Royal Question. The recent rise of left–others and government–opposition partisanship places Belgium alongside the United States, Finland and Norway; it coincides with a period in which the wording of the right and that of all other parties have also become easier to tell apart. Divisions in roll-call votes, which we compare with speech for the main groupings, for pairs of parties and for Flemish and Walloon members, move only loosely with differences in wording. Across decades, recorded disorder is moderately correlated with left–others partisanship but not with religious partisanship, and opposition speakers receive more disorder than governing speakers in almost every decade.

By construction, this measure captures how easily parties can be told apart by their wording, not how far apart their policies are. It misses a hardening of rhetoric shared by all parties, and the groupings studied here cannot describe every division in a multiparty system (Simola et al., 2025). In Belgium, the measure combines cleavage-related vocabulary with language reflecting institutional roles. Its levels depend on speech volume, record quality and the vocabulary: with the formulas used by the governing side, the 1950s would be the decade of highest religious partisanship.

Three extensions follow. Emotion and tone coding (Section 7) will test whether more distinct speech also means greater hostility, which recorded reactions suggest only for left–others partisanship. Separating procedural from substantive speech will show how much of the government–opposition divide reflects institutional roles. Leaving procedural formulas and the other phrases without content out of the vocabulary already lowers it, especially after 1945 (Section 5.12), and the procedural category of the topic labels offers a way to isolate the procedural speech that remains (Section 6). Finally, extending the analysis to the Senate, which

shared legislative power with the Chamber until 1993, will reveal whether a second chamber elected under different rules spoke differently.

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## Additional figures and tables

This section presents additional figures and tables referenced in the main text. Each paragraph explains the display, highlights relevant patterns and points to the section discussing it. The final two tables list the most partisan French phrases for the religious and left–others groupings, selecting one period per decade.

Figure 16 repeats Figure 2 excluding the Communist and radical left family, following Simola et al. (2025)'s treatment of Finland's extreme left. Before 1925, when this family first has speakers, the real series changes only because penalties and covariate effects are estimated jointly across periods, by at most 0.0007 (in 1898–1900). Net values change more, by up to 0.0021 in 1910–1912, mainly because each specification draws its own random benchmark. Excluding the family lowers net partisanship in 1932–1934 from 0.0039 to 0.0024, although it has only three speakers, and in 2021–2024 from 0.0030 to 0.0001. The highest value remains that of 2024–2025 (0.0045, against 0.0052), followed by 1898–1900 and 1906–1908. The radical left therefore contributes to the 1932–1934 and 2021–2024 values, but does not determine the highest one (Section 5.2).

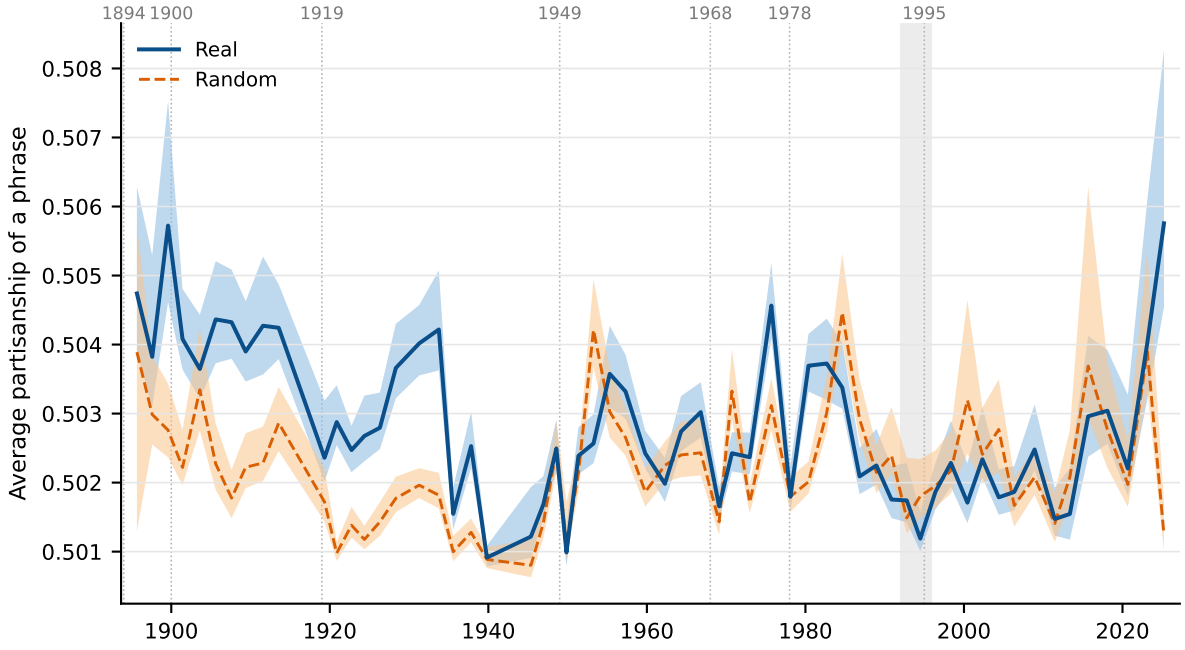



**Figure 16:** Left–others partisanship without the Communist and radical left family

*Notes*: As Figure 2, without the members of the Communist and radical left family.

Figure 17 plots school- and education-related phrases as a share of all phrases, alongside religious partisanship. The share peaks during each school conflict. It reaches its maximum of 4.5 per cent in 1884–1886, when the new Catholic majority replaces the Liberal school law, 3.3 per cent during the compulsory-education debate in 1912–1914, and 2.6 per cent during the second school war in 1954–1956. Religious partisanship does not follow these peaks: it exceeds its benchmark in 1884–1886 (0.0011) and 1912–1914 (0.0007), but not in 1954–1956 (0.0007) or in 1878–1880 (−0.0001), when the share is 3.7 per cent. School phrases almost disappear after education passes to the Communities in 1989. Across periods, the two have a correlation of 0.21: topic attention and partisanship need not move together. Both sides discuss schools extensively

during the first school war (Figure 18; Section 5.1.1).

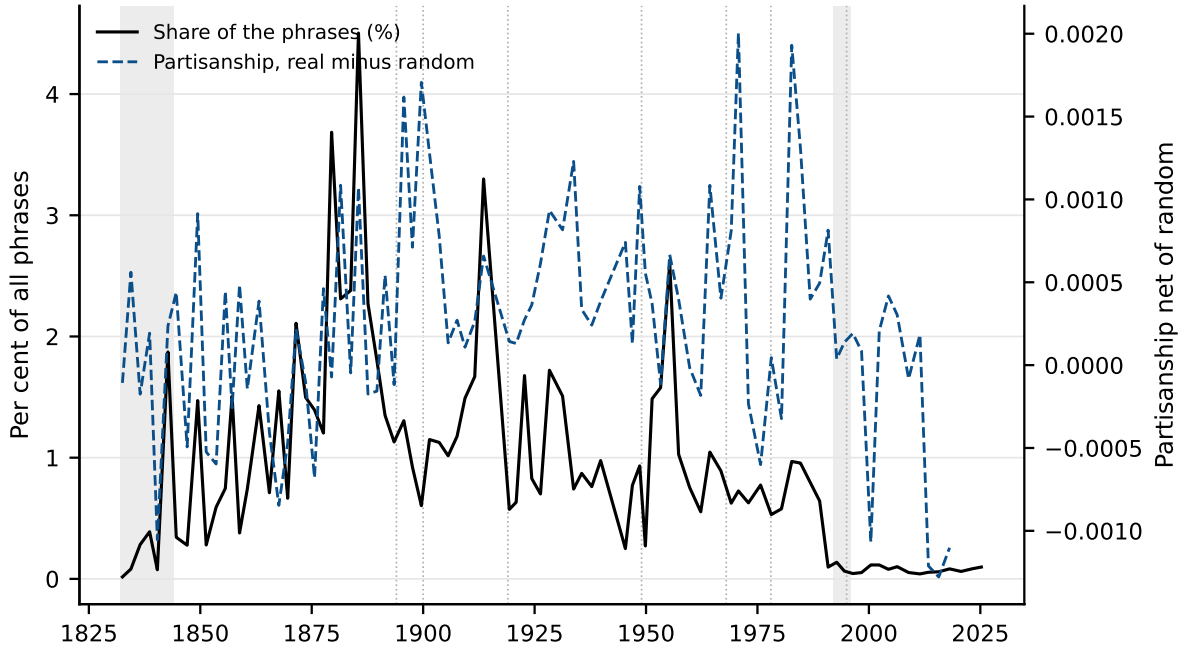



**Figure 17:** Phrases related to schools and education, and religious partisanship

*Notes*: Share of all phrases (both languages) that contain a stem related to schools and education (Online Appendix B), and religious partisanship net of the random series (Figure 1).

Figure 18 breaks down Figure 17's school phrases by speaker. Panel (a) counts Catholic members' school phrases; panel (b) shows their share of all school phrases. Counts are highest in 1884–1886 and 1878–1880. In the second school war, they are a little over half their 1878–1884 level, although the Chamber uses only about a fifth fewer phrases. The Catholic share of school phrases generally tracks its share of speakers (correlation 0.75). In 1878–1884, Catholics use 49–52 per cent of school phrases and account for 45–49 per cent of speakers. The 1950s differ. Catholics use 36–37 per cent in 1950–1954, when they govern alone and represent 52–53 per cent of speakers. In opposition in 1954–1956, they use 53 per cent while representing 46 per cent of speakers. After 1989, shares rely on at most about 400 phrases per period. During the first school war, both sides discuss schools; their choice of phrases distinguishes them (Section 5.1.1).

Figure 19 compares religious partisanship with six features of the Chamber. The roll-call comparison in panel (a) follows Gentzkow et al. (2019)'s US Congress analysis and is discussed in Section 5.10; the other five follow Simola et al. (2023)'s Finnish analysis. These indicators follow trends of their own. Roll calls rise from fewer than twenty per period before 1870 to several hundred in most periods after 1945, and more than a thousand in some periods from 1974. The effective number of parties rises from about two before 1894 to seven to ten in the federal era, when 40–61 per cent of members are new in each legislature. Very long speeches are most common in the 1960s–1980s and, less so, the 1850s–1880s, and they are only weakly correlated with religious partisanship (0.10 over 78 periods since 1850).

Figure 20 groups members by region rather than party. It compares national-party members elected in Flemish and Walloon districts, using French speech and controlling for party family and gender. Net partisanship averages 0.0008 and exceeds its random benchmark in 28 of the 58

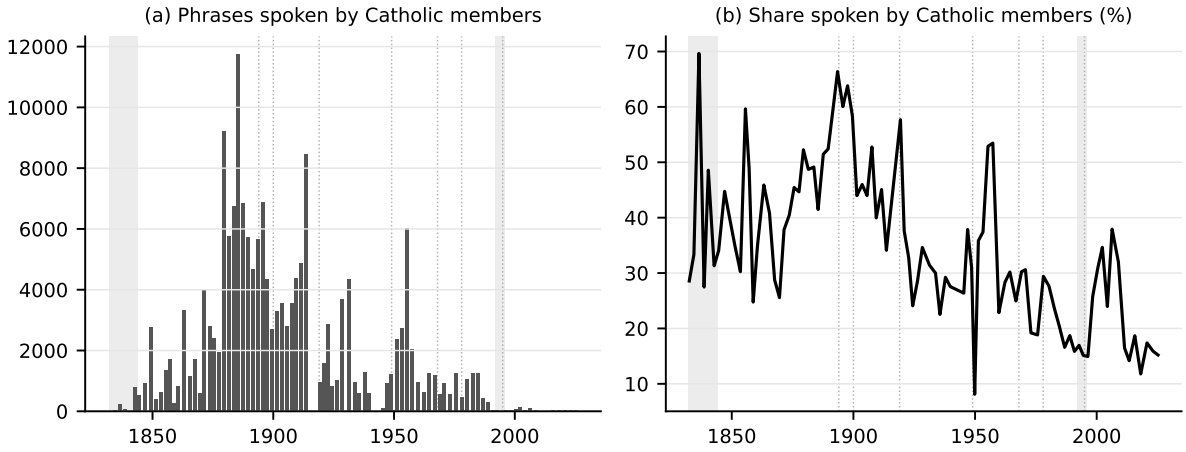



**Figure 18:** Catholic members and the school phrases

*Notes*: (a) Number of phrases related to schools and education spoken by Catholic members; (b) share of these phrases spoken by Catholic members.

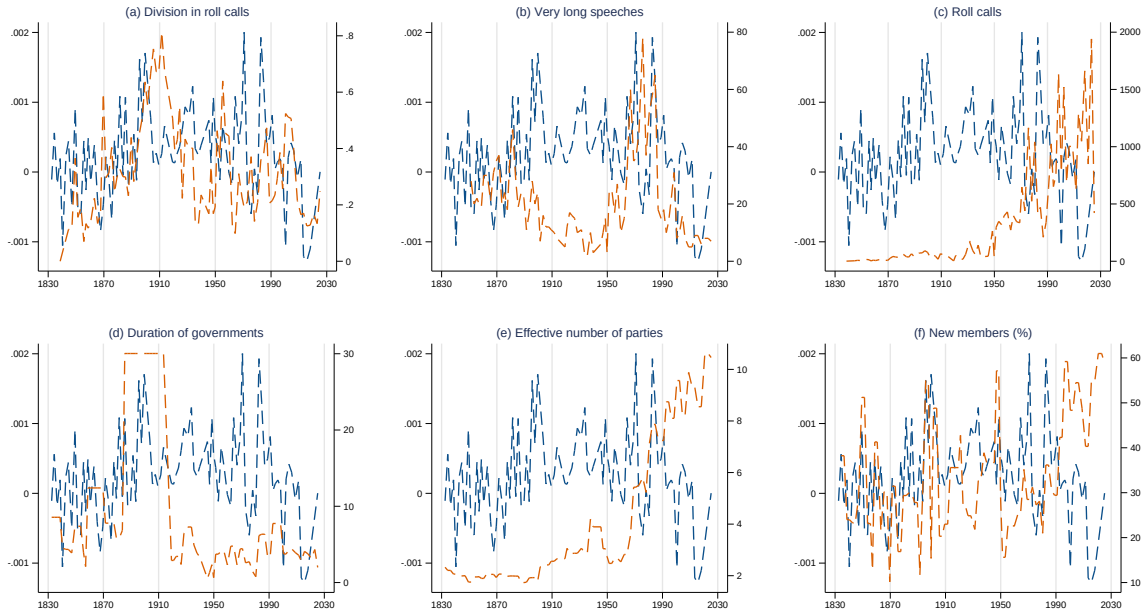



**Figure 19:** Religious partisanship and other features of the Chamber

*Notes*: Blue (left axis): religious partisanship net of the random series. Orange (right axis): (a) division between Catholics and other parties in roll calls (Rice, 1925), as in Online Appendix Figure A17; (b) number of very long speeches (top 0.1 per cent of the speeches since 1850); (c) number of roll calls; (d) mean duration of the governments in office; (e) effective number of parties among the members; (f) share of the members of a legislature who did not sit in the previous legislature.

periods with adequate coverage. Values are highest in the 1900s, 1850s and 1920s, peaking at 0.0027 in 1908–1910. The 1960s are the lowest decade, with no period above the benchmark, and the final period, 1965–1968, has the lowest value of the series (−0.0014). The regions' speech therefore does not become easier to tell apart before the party splits. As Section 5.6 argues, linguistic divisions appear mainly through regional interests (Online Appendix Table C94).

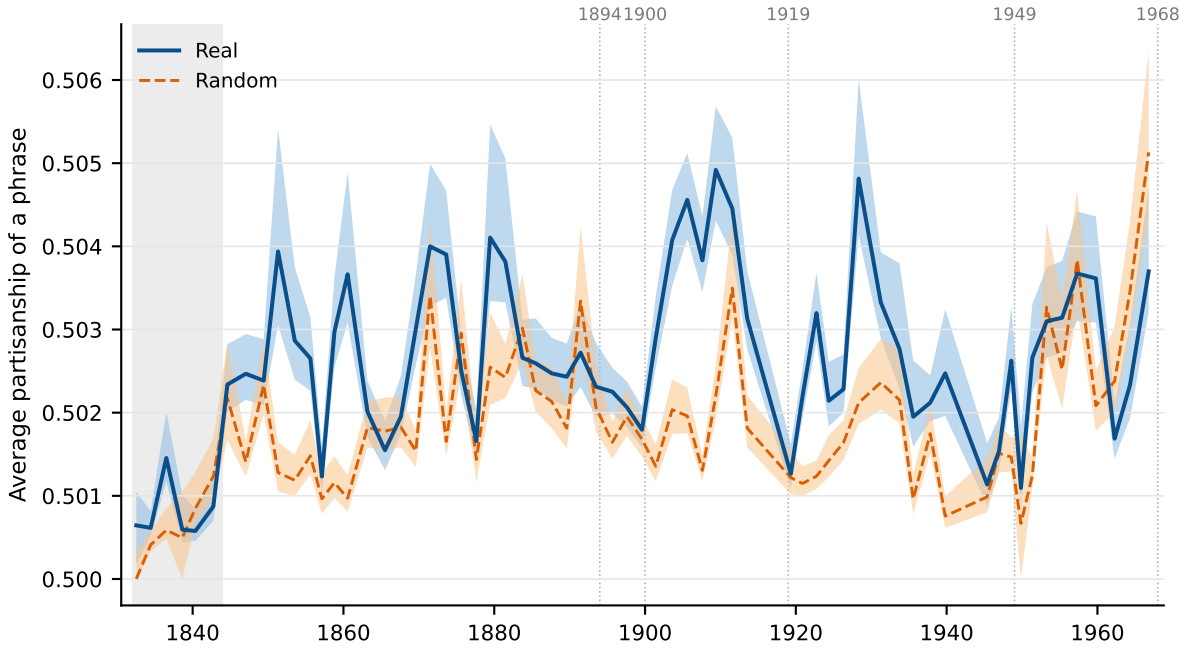



**Figure 20:** Flemish vs Walloon members of the national parties, before the split (French speech)

*Notes*: Group A: members elected in Flemish districts; group B: members elected in Walloon districts; members from Brussels are excluded. French speech, periods that begin before 1968, when the first of the national parties split. Controls for the party family and gender. Otherwise as Figure 1.

Figure 21 measures how easily women and men can be told apart by their wording. Before 1995, the series is defined in only four periods, each with 15 to 18 women speakers; intervals are wide and no period exceeds its random benchmark. Since 1995, as women's share of members rises to two fifths, the real series exceeds its random benchmark in 10 of 14 periods, both with and without party-family controls. Net partisanship averages 0.0021 with controls and 0.0016 without them. The leave-out estimator (panel c) exceeds its random benchmark in 5 of these 14 periods. Women and men are therefore about as easy to tell apart within families as across them. In the federal era, they are easier to tell apart than the religious, left–others and government–opposition groups (Section 5.5).

Figure 22 traces parties elected in 2024 through their predecessors. Without covariates, it compares each with other parties in its language group. Before 1995, the predecessors of the traditional parties exceed their random benchmarks more often in French than in Dutch: the Socialists in 20 of 44 periods in French, among them every period from 1894 to 1914, against 7 of 39 in Dutch; the Catholics and Christian democrats in 24 of 69 against 2 of 42; and the Liberals in 13 of 69 against 5 of 40. In Dutch, the Christian democrats and the Socialists both exceed their benchmarks in 1952–1954 (0.0017). Levels cannot be compared across languages (Section 4).

Smaller parties rarely exceed the benchmark of a random group of equal size. The Flemish

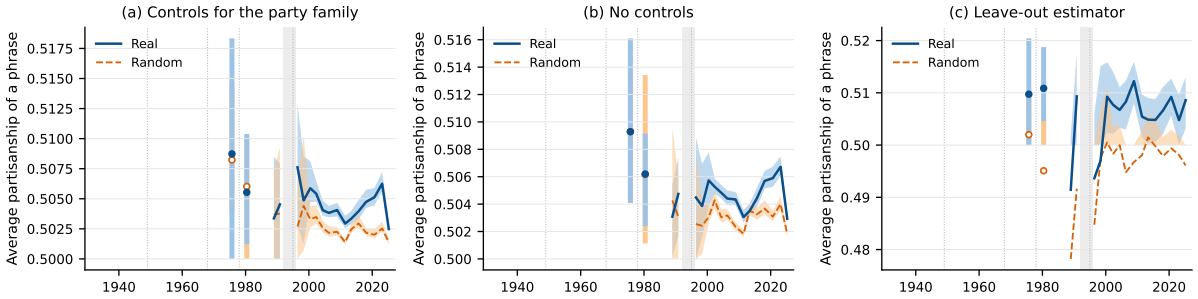



**Figure 21:** Women vs men

*Notes*: Group A: women; group B: men. (a) Controls for the party family, with effects that differ by era; (b) no controls; (c) leave-out estimator, no controls. Periods that begin in 1929 or later; a period enters the series when each group has at least 15 speakers in total and 10 in a language. Otherwise as Figure 1.

nationalists never do so before 1995, and afterwards only in 2021–2024. The series of DéFI, which groups the FDF with the Rassemblement wallon, has enough speakers only in eight periods of 1968–1985; its net partisanship is negative in six of them and exceeds the benchmark only in 1983–1985, with eight speakers. The Greens and the radical left never exceed their benchmarks. Since 1995, 10 of 117 party-periods do so, all of Dutch-speaking parties (Table 7; Section 5.5).

Table 7 averages Figure 22's series by legislature from 1995, multiplying values by 1,000. Of 69 entries, 62 lie between −3 and 3. Seven of the 11 parties with entries have both positive and negative values, so rankings change across legislatures; Vlaams Belang and PVDA-PTB have only positive values, and Ecolo and Groen only negative ones. The largest positive values belong to Vooruit and PVDA-PTB in the legislature elected in 2024, which so far covers only 2024–2025, and to Vlaams Belang in 1995. No PVDA-PTB period exceeds its benchmark. The largest negative values are Ecolo's, down to −8.95 in 2010, from a single period with eight speakers in which the random estimate lies far above the real one. Vlaams Belang's averages are positive in all seven legislatures with entries, but only two of its periods exceed the benchmark; no other federal-era party consistently stands apart from the other parties of its language group. This agrees with low religious and left–others partisanship in most of these years; the high values of Vooruit and PVDA-PTB in 2024–2025 coincide with the highest left–others value (Sections 5.2 and 5.5).

Figure 23 plots religious and left–others partisanship alongside the institutional-period means in Table 4. Religious means do not follow successive expansions of voting rights. They rise from 0.00004 under census suffrage to 0.00070 under plural voting, are 0.00055 under equal male suffrage and in the post-war unitary state and 0.00043 during the state reforms, and are negative in the federal era (−0.00028). Left–others means are 0.00117 and 0.00139 under plural voting and equal male suffrage and 0.00044 to 0.00072 afterwards. Most variation occurs within these periods. Period means explain about a quarter of religious-series variance and 12 per cent of left–others variance. For example, the post-war mean combines values of −0.00011 to 0.00067 in 1950–1958 with the series' highest value, 0.00200 in 1969–1971. These shifts coincide more closely with changes in Chamber and government composition than with voting rights (Section 5.8).

Figure 24 decomposes consecutive-period changes in leave-out religious partisanship. The within component measures changes among members present in both periods; renewal measures

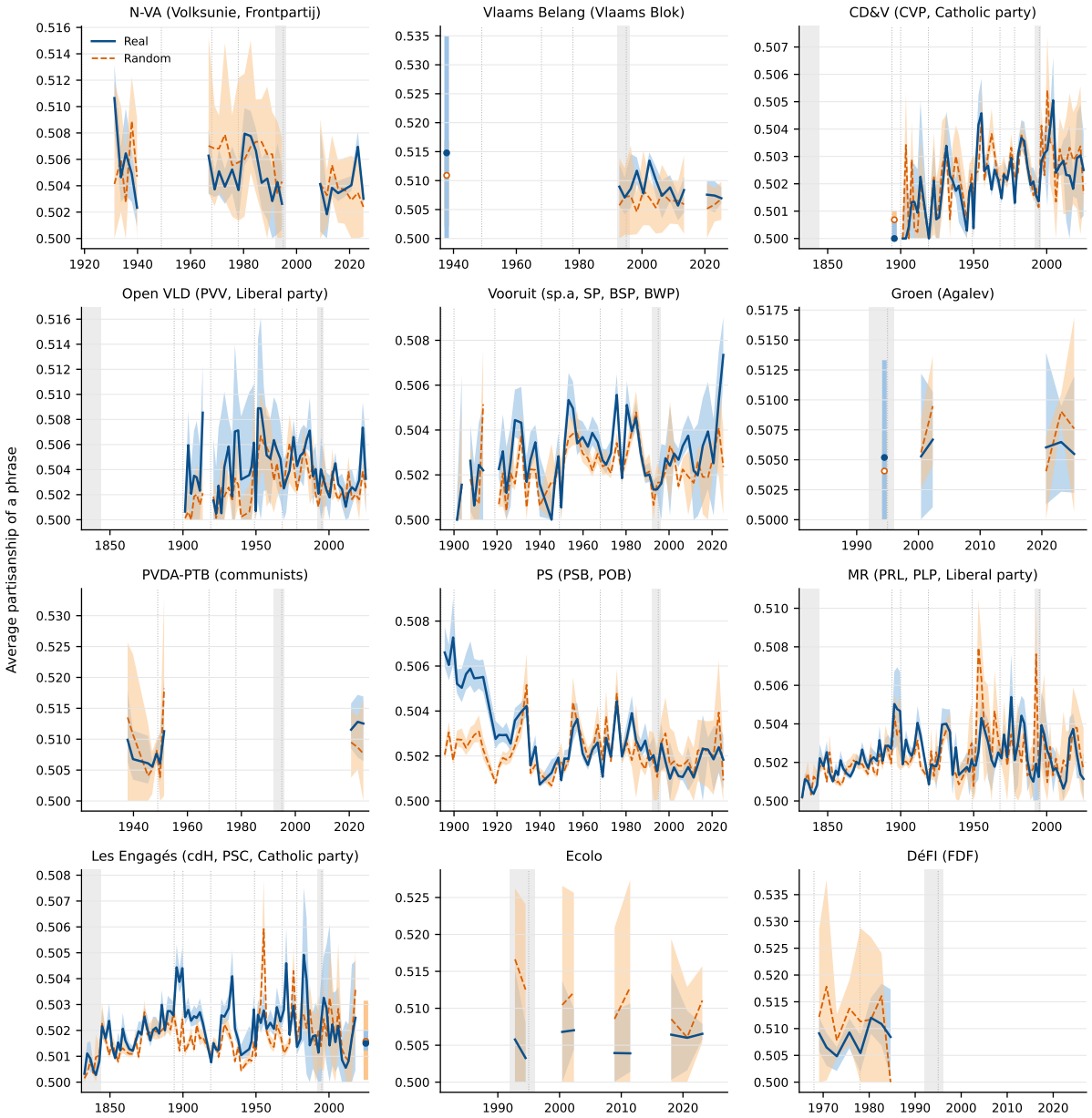



**Figure 22:** The parties of today's Chamber: partisanship against all the other parties

*Notes*: Each panel: group A is the party named in the title, followed back through its predecessors; group B, all the other parties of the same language group. Dutch series for the Dutch-speaking parties, French series for the French-speaking ones, both languages for PVDA-PTB. No covariates; a period enters the series when the party has at least 8 speakers. Otherwise as Figure 1.

**Table 7:** Partisanship of today's parties by legislature, 1995–2025

| | Legislature elected in | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Party | 1995 | 1999 | 2003 | 2007 | 2010 | 2014 | 2019 | 2024 |
| N-VA | | | | -0.05 | -1.58 | -0.19 | 2.31 | 0.64 |
| Vlaams Belang | 4.17 | 2.96 | 2.16 | 2.35 | 0.81 | | 1.98 | 0.11 |
| CD&V | -0.26 | -0.83 | 1.34 | -0.60 | -0.13 | -1.04 | -0.22 | 0.87 |
| Open VLD | -0.15 | -0.43 | 1.76 | 0.24 | -1.10 | 0.63 | 2.51 | 0.74 |
| Vooruit | 0.28 | -0.41 | 1.11 | 1.82 | -0.02 | 1.71 | 0.45 | 5.00 |
| Groen | | -1.56 | | | | | -0.28 | -2.11 |
| PVDA-PTB | | | | | | | 3.10 | 4.87 |
| PS | -0.66 | -0.44 | -0.48 | -0.31 | -0.34 | 0.04 | -0.86 | 0.92 |
| MR | 0.35 | 0.54 | -0.12 | 0.18 | -1.12 | 0.52 | -1.21 | -0.47 |
| Les Engagés | 0.94 | -1.06 | -0.34 | -0.40 | -0.21 | -0.54 | | -0.08 |
| Ecolo | | -4.39 | | -4.61 | -8.95 | -2.10 | -2.28 | |
| DéFI | | | | | | | | |

*Notes*: Partisanship of each party against all the other parties of its language group, real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000; mean of the periods of each legislature. Blank: fewer than 8 speakers.

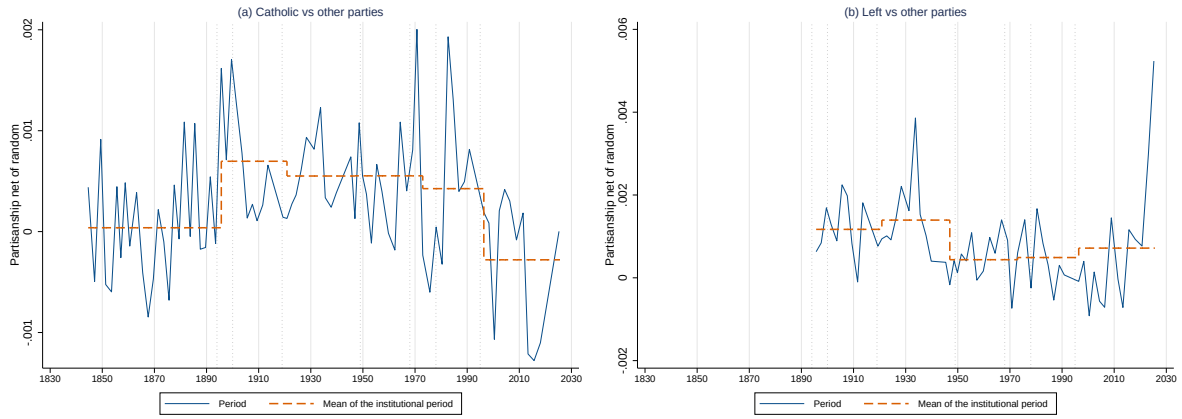



**Figure 23:** Partisanship and the institutional periods

*Notes*: Partisanship net of the random series, and its mean in each institutional period: census suffrage (to 1893), plural voting (1894–1918), equal male suffrage (1919–1944), the post-war unitary state (1945–1970), the state reforms (1971–1994) and the federal Chamber of 150 members (from 1995).

entry and exit. Both are cumulated from 1845. Over the whole period, the within component adds 0.036 and renewal subtracts 0.027. Renewal mainly reduces partisanship because departing members spoke more distinctly than those who remained: exits subtract 0.068, while entries add 0.041. Entry contributes most in 1894–1896, the first period under plural voting (0.023), partly offset by exit (−0.012). Individual changes are noisy, and the components have opposite signs in just over half of them (45 of 81). We therefore interpret careers and long swings rather than effects of specific reforms (Section 5.8). Online Appendix Figure A22 reports the left–others decomposition.

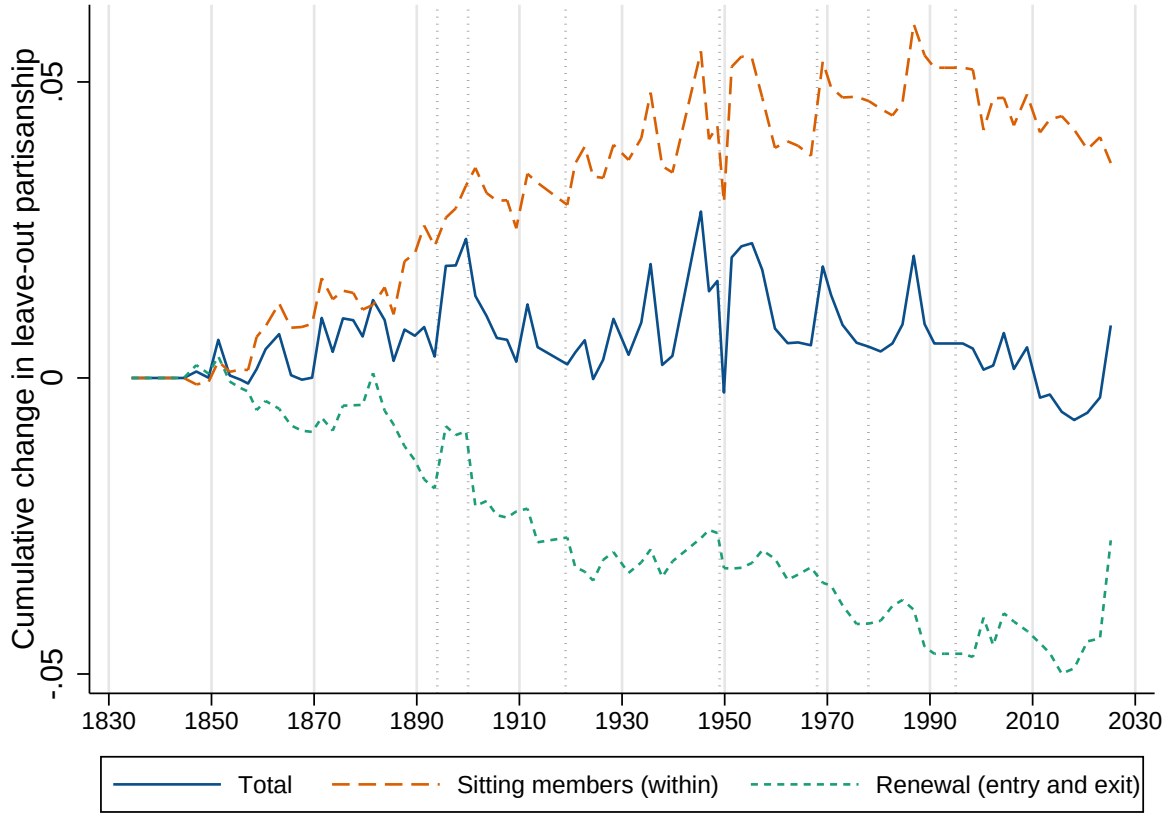



**Figure 24:** Renewal of the Chamber and adaptation of sitting members: Catholic vs other parties

*Notes*: Cumulative change in leave-out partisanship (Gentzkow et al., 2019) between consecutive periods, decomposed into the change among members who sat in both periods (within) and the contribution of entry and exit (renewal). Changes into or out of a period with low coverage of the sittings are not counted.

Table 8 compares periods beginning within five years after each reform with those beginning within six years before it. Each comparison uses four to seven periods, so standard errors are only indicative. The clearest changes occur after 1894 and, for government and opposition, around 1919. Following the Socialists' entry in 1894, religious and government–opposition partisanship rise by 0.00126 and 0.00092. After proportional representation, government–opposition partisanship is 0.00048 lower (standard error 0.00021), while the changes in the other two series lie within two standard errors. Around equal male suffrage, religious and left–others partisanship change little, while government–opposition partisanship is 0.00104 higher, in a comparison of four periods. Around 1949, all three series change by less than two standard errors. After the 1968 split, left–others partisanship is 0.00074 lower (standard error 0.00031); the

other changes after both party splits lie within two standard errors. Too few periods around 1995 have adequate sitting coverage (Section 5.8).

**Table 8:** Partisanship around the reforms

| Reform | Catholic vs other | Left vs other | Government vs opposition |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1894 | 0.00126 | | 0.00092 |
| | (0.00025) | | (0.00011) |
| 1900 | -0.00061 | 0.00042 | -0.00048 |
| | (0.00033) | (0.00047) | (0.00021) |
| 1919 | -0.00010 | 0.00013 | 0.00104 |
| | (0.00009) | (0.00038) | (0.00024) |
| 1949 | -0.00028 | 0.00034 | -0.00040 |
| | (0.00020) | (0.00024) | (0.00031) |
| 1968 | 0.00012 | -0.00074 | 0.00057 |
| | (0.00052) | (0.00031) | (0.00049) |
| 1978 | 0.00125 | 0.00036 | -0.00017 |
| | (0.00070) | (0.00079) | (0.00018) |
| 1995 | | | |

*Notes*: Difference in partisanship net of the random series between the periods that begin up to five years after the reform year and those that begin up to six years before (for 1919, from 1910, because the Chamber did not sit during the war); Newey–West standard errors (one lag) in parentheses. Periods with low coverage of the sittings are excluded, which leaves too few periods around 1995.

Table 9 sums the changes in Figure 24 within each institutional period, alongside the left–others changes from Online Appendix Figure A22. For religious partisanship, the within component is positive in the three periods before 1945 and negative in the post-war unitary state ($-0.006$). The components have opposite signs in five of six periods, partly offsetting each other. The largest total, 0.026 under equal male suffrage, comes almost entirely from sitting members. In the federal era, sitting members become less distinct ($-0.016$), while renewal adds 0.019. For left–others partisanship, both components have the same sign under plural voting and equal male suffrage. The federal-era rise of 0.026 comes from sitting members (0.058), partly offset by renewal ($-0.033$). These totals accumulate noisy changes and describe careers rather than reform effects (Section 5.8).

**Table 9:** Renewal and adaptation, by institutional period

| | Catholic vs other | | | Left vs other | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Institutional period | Total | Within | Renewal | Total | Within | Renewal |
| Census suffrage, 1831–1893 | 0.00362 | 0.02228 | -0.01866 | | | |
| Plural voting, 1894–1918 | -0.00132 | 0.00696 | -0.00828 | -0.02830 | -0.01327 | -0.01503 |
| Equal male suffrage, 1919–1944 | 0.02581 | 0.02593 | -0.00012 | 0.00493 | 0.00401 | 0.00093 |
| Post-war unitary state, 1945–1970 | -0.01409 | -0.00608 | -0.00801 | -0.00054 | 0.00279 | -0.00332 |
| State reforms, 1971–1994 | -0.00819 | 0.00332 | -0.01152 | -0.00086 | -0.00358 | 0.00271 |
| Federal Chamber of 150, 1995–2025 | 0.00305 | -0.01610 | 0.01915 | 0.02569 | 0.05823 | -0.03254 |

*Notes*: Sum over the periods of each institutional period of the change in leave-out partisanship (total), and of its components: change among sitting members (within) and entry and exit (renewal). Changes into or out of a period with low coverage of the sittings (1832–1843, 1992–1995) are not counted.

Table 10 lists the five French phrases most typical of each group in one period per decade, following Gentzkow et al. (2019, Table I)'s comparison of selected Congresses. Most concern the cleavages or the policies of the day. Role-related phrases are fewer than in earlier versions of the vocabulary, which kept the formulas with which the governing side submits bills and reports and the titles with which members address ministers. The clearest remaining example concerns the special powers of governments (*pouvoirs spéciaux*): in the full-period lists (Online Appendix C), it belongs to the group with the smaller share of governing members in 7 of the 8 periods in which it appears.

Cleavage-related phrases include religious education for Catholics in 1848–1850, *instruction publique* versus *écoles communales* during the first school war, working-class and universal-suffrage phrases for other parties after 1894, family allowances for Catholics in 1929–1932 and 1939–1940, the Royal Question for other parties in 1949–1950, the School Pact for other parties in 1958–1961, and development cooperation for Christian democrats from 1969–1971.

**Table 10:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1839–1841* | | | | | |
| société générale | 256 | 135 | sucre exotique | 105 | 185 |
| adjudication publique | 45 | 41 | tribunal commerce | 51 | 104 |
| chemin fer | 513 | 513 | chemins vicinaux | 49 | 73 |
| travaux publics | 266 | 266 | caisses prévoyance | 9 | 20 |
| plus grande | 145 | 144 | | | |
| *1848–1850* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 611 | 307 | garde civique | 49 | 84 |
| enseignement religieux | 131 | 49 | société générale | 23 | 57 |
| enseignement moyen | 159 | 86 | banque nationale | 18 | 45 |
| conseil mines | 89 | 28 | lettre voiture | 8 | 35 |
| canal charleroy | 93 | 42 | code pénal | 18 | 43 |
| *1859–1861* | | | | | |
| vol domestique | 130 | 24 | garde civique | 10 | 88 |
| passe port | 99 | 20 | bruxelles louvain | 43 | 85 |
| fonds communal | 147 | 83 | sucre betterave | 18 | 48 |
| cours légal | 85 | 44 | cour appel | 42 | 72 |
| communes octroi | 119 | 78 | cours certificat | 10 | 39 |
| *1868–1870* | | | | | |
| listes électorales | 100 | 41 | sociétés coopératives | 4 | 76 |
| conseil communal | 109 | 75 | assemblée générale | 42 | 97 |
| service militaire | 90 | 56 | sociétés anonymes | 85 | 137 |
| visites domiciliaires | 50 | 19 | écoles normales | 11 | 57 |
| police judiciaire | 35 | 9 | travail enfants | 3 | 32 |
| *1878–1880* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 279 | 119 | chemin fer | 349 | 455 |
| corps électoral | 117 | 42 | écoles communales | 81 | 133 |
| valeur locative | 76 | 18 | marques fabrique | 19 | 50 |
| enseignement libre | 80 | 28 | département travaux | 35 | 64 |
| contribution personnelle | 60 | 18 | voies navigables | 26 | 52 |
| *1888–1890* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 400 | 299 | sûreté publique | 21 | 105 |
| prud hommes | 245 | 161 | agents provocateurs | 4 | 51 |
| conseils prud | 172 | 106 | ville gand | 17 | 63 |
| pays flamand | 90 | 46 | écoles spéciales | 63 | 103 |
| programme candidature | 23 | 3 | conseil communal | 44 | 82 |
| *1898–1900* | | | | | |
| juge paix | 106 | 43 | banque nationale | 137 | 358 |
| chemin fer | 308 | 270 | classe ouvrière | 37 | 132 |
| fer vicinaux | 58 | 25 | tramways bruxellois | 32 | 118 |
| cour militaire | 41 | 9 | suffrage universel | 52 | 130 |
| conseil guerre | 89 | 61 | conseil communal | 48 | 96 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| comité spécial | 113 | 29 | chemin fer | 333 | 420 |
| loi 1902 | 84 | 23 | classe ouvrière | 35 | 105 |

**Table 10:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| temps service | 93 | 50 | fer postes | 34 | 93 |
| effectif paix | 70 | 36 | écoles normales | 40 | 94 |
| union minière | 48 | 18 | postes télégraphes | 37 | 90 |
| *1918–1919* | | | | | |
| dommages guerre | 204 | 142 | classe ouvrière | 61 | 115 |
| oeuvre nationale | 43 | 8 | comité national | 50 | 93 |
| tribunaux dommages | 95 | 62 | avant guerre | 143 | 174 |
| écoles normales | 76 | 45 | chemin fer | 149 | 177 |
| orphelins guerre | 39 | 12 | pendant guerre | 159 | 179 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| pensions vieillesse | 95 | 56 | société nationale | 114 | 166 |
| allocations familiales | 73 | 41 | classe ouvrière | 75 | 127 |
| main oeuvre | 82 | 52 | sciences arts | 61 | 102 |
| produits agricoles | 41 | 14 | écoles moyennes | 19 | 56 |
| responsabilité limitée | 31 | 5 | écoles communales | 19 | 47 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 157 | 80 | personnel enseignant | 26 | 69 |
| pommes terre | 85 | 18 | nationalistes flamands | 12 | 46 |
| assurance chômage | 53 | 18 | politique indépendance | 11 | 37 |
| allocations familiales | 91 | 58 | sous officiers | 25 | 48 |
| caisses chômage | 42 | 9 | politique étrangère | 12 | 25 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| assurés libres | 73 | 17 | consultation populaire | 201 | 406 |
| travailleurs indépendants | 66 | 15 | question royale | 105 | 148 |
| conseil entreprise | 65 | 20 | stations épuration | 9 | 31 |
| pouvoirs représentants | 53 | 9 | sociétés habitations | 14 | 31 |
| central provincial | 45 | 8 | eaux usées | 27 | 43 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| politique scientifique | 53 | 3 | classe ouvrière | 26 | 74 |
| budget ordinaire | 59 | 26 | loi unique | 62 | 109 |
| gouverneur général | 61 | 31 | haute autorité | 27 | 72 |
| force publique | 62 | 31 | personnel enseignant | 9 | 54 |
| économique régional | 39 | 10 | pacte scolaire | 33 | 78 |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| pays voie | 282 | 26 | police judiciaire | 13 | 94 |
| voie développement | 262 | 27 | gaz naturel | 11 | 54 |
| coopération développement | 136 | 15 | santé publique | 72 | 112 |
| parlement européen | 127 | 40 | travailleurs indépendants | 16 | 50 |
| gouvernement belge | 121 | 40 | personnes âgées | 12 | 45 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| gouvernement belge | 128 | 46 | organisations syndicales | 26 | 56 |
| communauté germanophone | 97 | 23 | travailleurs indépendants | 15 | 44 |
| coopération développement | 84 | 29 | région bruxelles | 32 | 56 |
| parlement européen | 68 | 17 | communauté flamande | 26 | 46 |
| education nationale | 113 | 72 | communautés régions | 41 | 61 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| juge instruction | 162 | 72 | culturelles nationales | 16 | 69 |
| services police | 161 | 80 | scientifiques culturelles | 17 | 69 |
| précompte mobilier | 103 | 36 | loi financement | 26 | 72 |
| agents change | 69 | 7 | publics institutions | 24 | 65 |
| communauté germanophone | 64 | 12 | etat major | 10 | 33 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| coopération développement | 151 | 43 | services police | 32 | 92 |
| arc ciel | 76 | 31 | criminalité organisée | 14 | 55 |
| principe précaution | 77 | 35 | union européenne | 129 | 169 |
| nations unies | 66 | 29 | réduction temps | 18 | 55 |
| soumis sanction | 53 | 17 | police locale | 36 | 71 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| partenaires sociaux | 243 | 117 | intérêts notionnels | 32 | 73 |
| demandeurs emploi | 111 | 29 | fraude fiscale | 69 | 102 |
| plan relance | 113 | 57 | demandeurs asile | 20 | 52 |
| titres services | 107 | 54 | aide financière | 12 | 34 |
| coopération développement | 109 | 56 | médecins généralistes | 53 | 69 |
| *2016–2019* | | | | | |
| juge instruction | 125 | 45 | sécurité sociale | 153 | 201 |
| secret professionnel | 84 | 29 | saut index | 10 | 53 |
| aide juridique | 68 | 16 | hommes femmes | 21 | 49 |

**Table 10:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| toute série | 125 | 74 | droits femmes | 21 | 45 |
| arabie saoudite | 88 | 44 | droits humains | 17 | 41 |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| union européenne | 459 | 178 | flexi jobs | 40 | 115 |
| coopération développement | 127 | 33 | malades longue | 17 | 86 |
| norme croissance | 119 | 48 | travailleurs travailleuses | 14 | 73 |
| consommation drogues | 47 | 6 | travailleuses travailleurs | 11 | 62 |
| spf justice | 39 | 4 | tableaux budgétaires | 10 | 56 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

Table 11 presents the same comparison for the left and other parties from 1898–1900. Before the Second World War, social issues distinguish the left. *classe ouvrière* appears among its five most partisan phrases in every displayed period before 1945, alongside universal suffrage and the eight-hour day. The other side's phrases concern the courts, the army and the colony before the First World War (*juge de paix*, *conseil de guerre*, *union minière*), the Flemish language between the wars (*langue flamande*) and, from the late 1960s, the communities and regions (*conseil culturel*, *région wallonne*). After the Second World War, the left's phrases concern the School Pact and the *loi unique* in 1958–1961, then public health and trade unions; in 2007–2021, they concern health care, social security, the financial crisis and tax havens (*paradis fiscaux*), and in 2024–2025 working women and men, the pension age and purchasing power (*travailleuses et travailleurs*, *67 ans*, *pouvoir d'achat*).

As in the religious comparison, *pouvoirs spéciaux* marks the side out of government. In the full-period lists, it belongs to the left in the four periods when French-speaking Socialists are mostly out of government and to other parties in the five when they govern.

**Table 11:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1898–1900* | | | | | |
| banque nationale | 414 | 139 | juge paix | 27 | 113 |
| classe ouvrière | 186 | 31 | conseil guerre | 42 | 96 |
| suffrage universel | 143 | 57 | députation permanente | 39 | 88 |
| caisse épargne | 155 | 71 | cour militaire | 5 | 50 |
| tramways bruxellois | 111 | 36 | cour appel | 15 | 51 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 180 | 34 | comité spécial | 6 | 85 |
| chemin fer | 477 | 342 | union minière | 4 | 45 |
| prud hommes | 299 | 168 | loi 1902 | 26 | 61 |
| conseils prud | 200 | 121 | budget extraordinaire | 33 | 63 |
| huit heures | 120 | 46 | effectif paix | 31 | 60 |
| *1918–1919* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 258 | 46 | dommages guerre | 43 | 214 |
| comité national | 133 | 55 | tribunaux dommages | 13 | 99 |
| huit heures | 50 | 10 | écoles normales | 22 | 73 |
| suffrage universel | 90 | 50 | juge unique | 40 | 77 |
| suffrage femmes | 69 | 37 | langue flamande | 10 | 44 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| industrie travail | 180 | 77 | sociétés privées | 6 | 33 |
| classe ouvrière | 164 | 69 | langue flamande | 14 | 42 |
| société nationale | 191 | 116 | libre échange | 24 | 52 |
| huit heures | 63 | 21 | responsabilité limitée | 2 | 27 |
| assurances sociales | 61 | 24 | deux langues | 20 | 43 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| personnel enseignant | 102 | 23 | santé publique | 80 | 116 |
| instruction publique | 156 | 105 | budget extraordinaire | 21 | 51 |
| classe ouvrière | 81 | 47 | classes moyennes | 33 | 63 |
| union soviétique | 29 | 2 | défense nationale | 239 | 269 |
| masses laborieuses | 25 | 1 | fournitures bureau | 3 | 32 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| membres conseil | 149 | 70 | eaux usées | 10 | 66 |
| consultation populaire | 400 | 323 | dommages guerre | 29 | 63 |
| libre belgique | 62 | 16 | société nationale | 53 | 83 |
| question royale | 162 | 122 | collège électoral | 18 | 47 |
| vrai oui | 46 | 11 | organisations ouvrières | 15 | 44 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 94 | 20 | congo belge | 70 | 172 |
| loi unique | 120 | 58 | table ronde | 99 | 141 |
| pacte scolaire | 89 | 33 | politique scientifique | 3 | 40 |
| services publics | 103 | 52 | ruanda urundi | 73 | 107 |
| personnel enseignant | 60 | 12 | marché commun | 71 | 100 |

**Table 11:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| santé publique | 153 | 75 | conseil culturel | 34 | 106 |
| distribution eau | 70 | 9 | police judiciaire | 42 | 99 |
| organisations syndicales | 114 | 59 | ik citeer | 9 | 62 |
| etats unis | 119 | 75 | conseil économique | 41 | 89 |
| marché commun | 105 | 67 | six communes | 19 | 66 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| loi programme | 184 | 103 | région bruxelles | 15 | 66 |
| organisations syndicales | 96 | 28 | communauté germanophone | 5 | 56 |
| etats unis | 94 | 37 | finances publiques | 37 | 86 |
| défense nationale | 126 | 74 | région wallonne | 106 | 149 |
| sécurité sociale | 194 | 144 | matières personnalisables | 14 | 50 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| défense nationale | 191 | 92 | handelingen plenaire | 250 | 352 |
| etat major | 90 | 10 | loi financement | 27 | 76 |
| office contrôle | 88 | 31 | communauté européenne | 73 | 110 |
| santé publique | 84 | 33 | cour arbitrage | 14 | 46 |
| sécurité sociale | 154 | 105 | précompte professionnel | 13 | 35 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| conséquence proposition | 57 | 4 | organisations syndicales | 33 | 49 |
| proposition modification | 54 | 8 | poser question | 98 | 114 |
| parole déclaration | 75 | 33 | non seulement | 169 | 170 |
| temps travail | 95 | 55 | union européenne | 160 | 161 |
| défense européenne | 43 | 10 | celle ci | 154 | 155 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| santé publique | 182 | 77 | titres services | 29 | 75 |
| soins santé | 183 | 82 | coopération développement | 48 | 76 |
| sécurité sociale | 193 | 95 | jeux hasard | 27 | 51 |
| crise financière | 159 | 84 | droits enfant | 20 | 40 |
| paradis fiscaux | 82 | 24 | état fédéral | 31 | 49 |
| *2019–2021* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 236 | 61 | droit passerelle | 62 | 181 |
| paradis fiscaux | 105 | 19 | entités fédérées | 61 | 117 |
| soins santé | 237 | 152 | niveaux pouvoir | 35 | 76 |
| services publics | 136 | 63 | état islamique | 4 | 44 |
| conditions travail | 123 | 56 | gouvernement fédéral | 40 | 77 |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| travailleuses travailleurs | 119 | 10 | énergies fossiles | 8 | 58 |
| 67 ans | 106 | 6 | transition énergétique | 6 | 32 |
| travailleurs travailleuses | 125 | 28 | aidants proches | 12 | 34 |
| pouvoir achat | 205 | 123 | santé publique | 36 | 56 |
| services publics | 161 | 85 | travailleurs sociaux | 29 | 49 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

## Online Appendix A: Partisanship results

This appendix adds results for Section 5. It examines identification after multiple phrases and robustness to covariates, estimators, the penalty $\psi$, language and sample selection. It also compares regions within families, studies individual phrases and phrase groups, compares speech with roll calls, tests OCR noise and decomposes left–others changes through Chamber renewal. Each specification draws its own random benchmark (Section 4). Differences in net partisanship for a single period may therefore reflect the random draw. We mainly compare real series. Most checks follow Gentzkow et al. (2019): magnitude, estimates without covariates, the penalty $\psi$, plug-in and leave-out estimators, and roll-call comparisons. Government-status controls and checks excluding the radical left or right follow Simola et al. (2023)'s Finnish analysis.

Figure A1 shows the expected posterior probability assigned to a speaker's actual group after up to 100 phrases, following Gentzkow et al. (2019, Figure 3). It selects eight religious-series periods from 1859–1861 to 2024–2025 and seven left–others periods from 1894–1896: the periods closest to 1860, 1880, 1900, 1925, 1950, 1975, 2000 and 2025 in which each series is defined. The probability rises slowly. After one minute, or 33 phrases, the model implies probabilities of 0.53 to 0.59 for the religious grouping and of 0.53 to 0.63 for the left–others grouping. The steepest religious curve is that of 1898–1900, under plural voting; the four steepest left–others curves (1894–1896, 1898–1900, 1974–1977, 2024–2025) lie close together, well above the other three. These curves use real estimates and include finite-sample bias. For example, the religious curve for 1974–1977 is the second steepest even though its real estimate lies below its random benchmark. The selected periods do not include the religious maximum of 1969–1971. Figure 11 reports every period's one-minute probability (Section 5.10); it comes from separate, smaller simulations, and for the selected periods its values differ from those of the curves by less than 0.01.

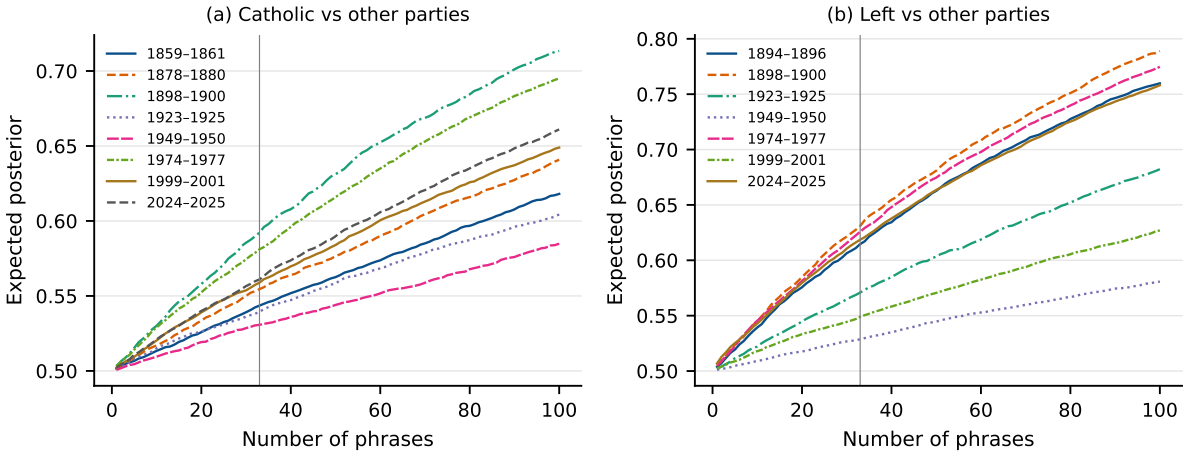



**Figure A1:** Magnitude of partisanship when more than one phrase is heard

*Notes*: Expected posterior on the true group after hearing up to 100 phrases, for selected periods; computed as in Gentzkow et al. (2019). Vertical line: one minute of speech (33 phrases).

Figure A2 re-estimates religious partisanship with alternative controls. Without covariates (panel a), the real series closely matches the main specification, with a correlation of 0.93. Most

differences in net estimates come from the random benchmarks. Government status, whether alone or with gender and province as in Simola et al. (2025) (panels b and c), nearly coincides with the religious grouping in most periods of 1848–1914 and in 1950–1958. Catholics then either govern alone or form almost the whole opposition. Party and government effects cannot be separately identified in these periods. The real series jumps to 0.64–0.72 in nine periods of 1868–1898 with government status alone, and to 0.53–0.70 in eight periods of 1868–1902 with gender and province as well. In other periods, including the 1950s, it stays close to its random benchmark (average net partisanship −0.0001 in panel b and 0.0001 in panel c). We therefore omit government status from the main specification (Section 4) and measure government–opposition differences directly in Section 5.4.

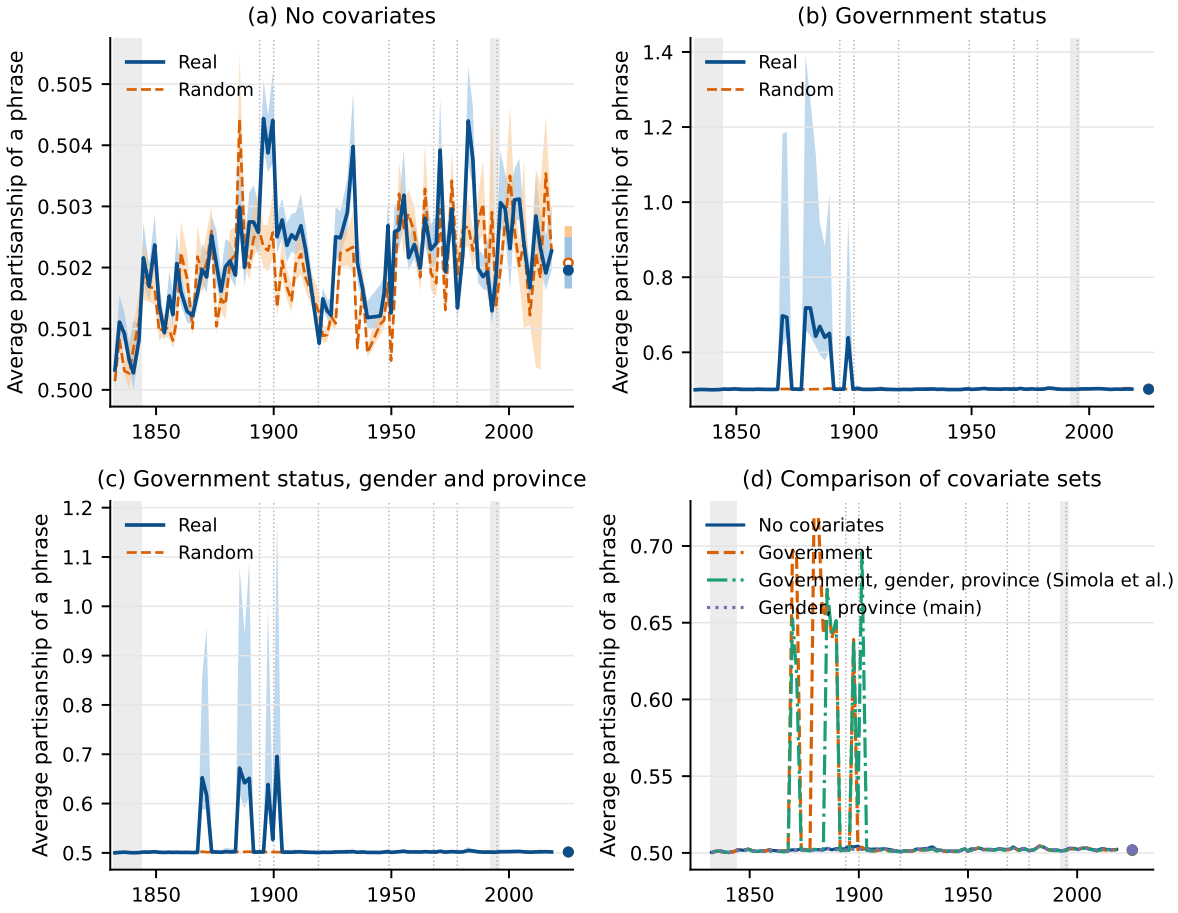



**Figure A2:** Religious partisanship: impact of covariates

*Notes*: (a)–(c) Real and random series for different sets of covariates; (d) comparison of the covariate sets: the main specification controls for gender and province; Simola et al. (2025) also control for government status, as Gentzkow et al. (2019) do for the majority status of the party. With government status, the series is not identified in the periods when a single family held office (values between 0.53 and 0.72 in 1868–1902).

Figure A3 repeats this comparison for left–others partisanship. Government status produces no jumps like those of the religious series. With government status alone (panel b), the real series is lower than without covariates in 41 of 58 periods; with government status, gender and province (panel c), it is lower than in the main specification in 36 of 58. Before 1960, the reductions are larger in the eleven periods when the left almost coincides with the opposition, including 1896–1900, 1927–1934 and 1949–1954: with government status alone, the real series

falls by 0.0013 on average in these periods and by 0.0006 in the other periods. In the eleven periods, average net partisanship is 0.0019 without covariates and 0.0004 with government status alone (0.0012 in the main specification and 0.0006 in panel c), and the 1932–1934 value largely disappears (0.0011 in panel b, against 0.0053 without covariates and 0.0039 in the main specification). The highest value of the main specification, 0.0052 in 2024–2025, also falls, to 0.0028 in panel (c). Without covariates, the real series is higher than in the main specification in all 30 periods before 1960, and its highest net value is that of 1932–1934 rather than 2024–2025. As with religion, government status absorbs much of partisanship when the cleavage aligns with government versus opposition (Section 5.4).

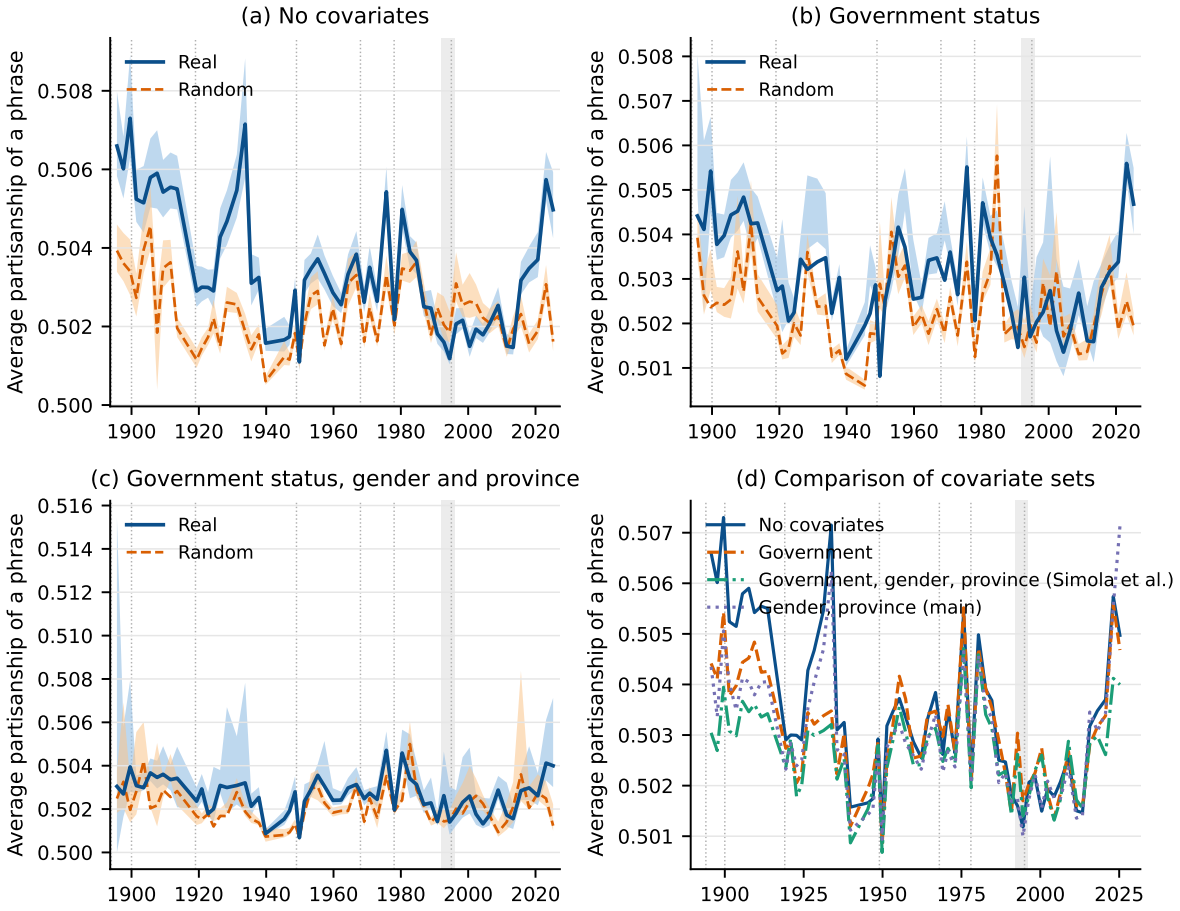



**Figure A3:** Left–others partisanship: impact of covariates

*Notes*: As Figure A2.

Figure A4 excludes the populist radical right: Rex from 1936, Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang from 1978, Front National from 1991 and Parti Populaire from 2010. This follows Simola et al. (2023)'s exclusion of Finland's Rural Party. Real series change little: before 1985, religious and left–others estimates move by less than 0.0001, and afterwards by at most 0.0005. They change even before 1936, when no radical-right member sits, because phrase penalties and covariate effects are estimated jointly across periods. The three highest left–others values remain those of 2024–2025, 1932–1934 and 2021–2024.

Net estimates change more because each specification draws its own random benchmark. In 1969–1971, the religious maximum of the main series, net partisanship falls from 0.0020 to 0.0007

while the real estimate is almost unchanged (0.5037 and 0.5038). Without the radical right, the highest religious value is that of 1932–1934 (0.0022). The radical right does not determine the real series, but the ranking of single periods by net partisanship depends on the random draw.

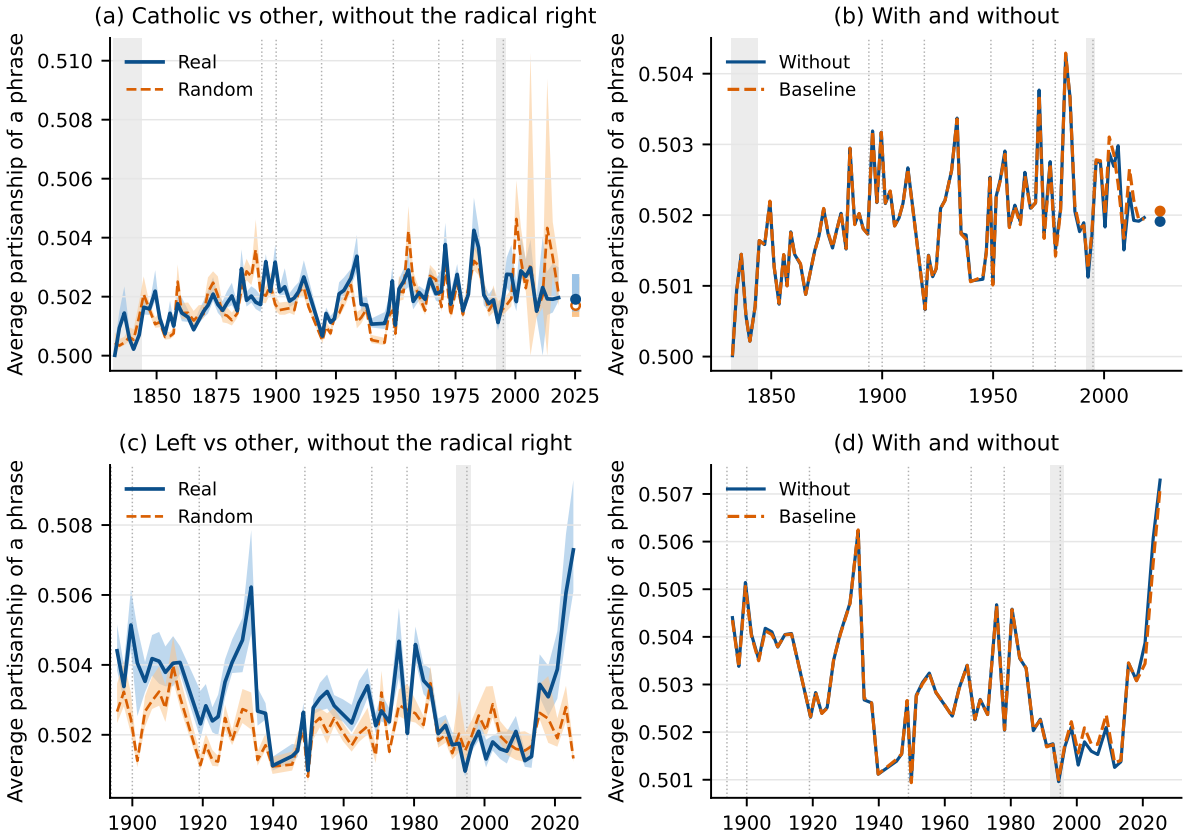



**Figure A4:** Partisanship without the populist radical right

*Notes*: Members of Rex, the Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang, the Front National and the Parti Populaire excluded.

Figure A5 calculates partisanship from observed phrase-choice probabilities without penalization. This is the plug-in estimator used by Gentzkow et al. (2019, Figure 1) to demonstrate finite-sample bias. In the periods with adequate coverage, real estimates range from 0.56 to 0.75, far above penalized estimates. However, random benchmarks follow them closely and account for more than nine tenths of their distance from 0.5 on average. Levels also track speech volume: the correlation between real estimates and log phrases per speaker is $-0.94$ for the religious grouping and $-0.90$ for the left–others grouping. Peaks occur in short or poorly covered periods, including 1831–1833, 1949–1950 and 1991–1995. The unpenalized empirical estimator therefore mainly captures finite-sample bias, motivating our use of penalization (Section 4).

Figure A6 shows the information available for each religious-series period. Panel (a) counts French and Dutch vocabulary phrases used at least once. Panel (b) counts phrases whose party coefficient $\hat{\varphi}_{jt}$ remains non-zero after penalization. The first count averages about 69,000 per period in 1894–1970 and 51,000 in the federal era, about a quarter fewer. The second falls more, from about 300 per period under plural voting to about 130 in the federal era. It follows speech volume (correlation 0.90 with the number of phrases spoken) and drops in short or poorly covered periods such as 1944–1946, 1949–1950, 1991–1995 and 2024–2025. Since partisanship

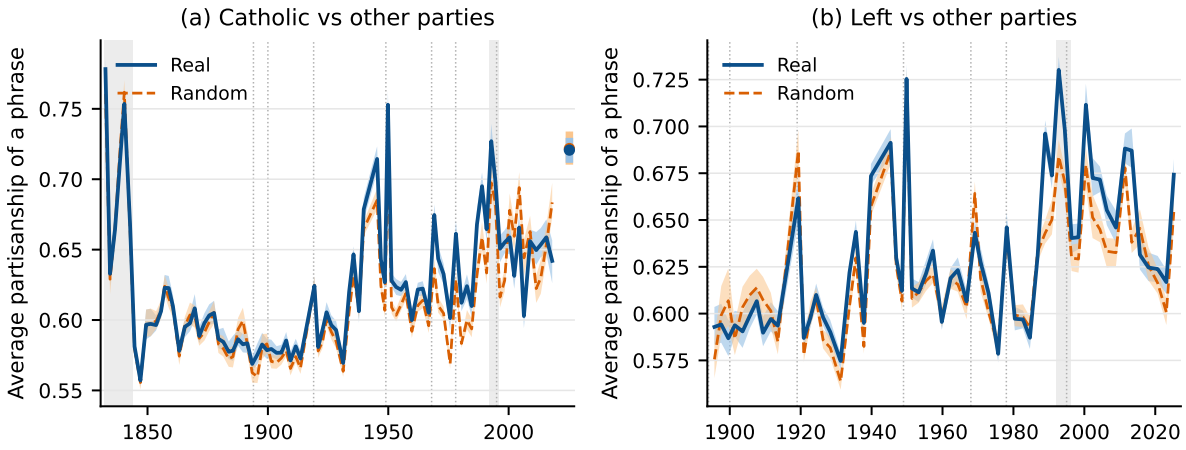



**Figure A5:** Partisanship computed from empirical phrase choice probabilities

*Notes*: Choice probabilities $\hat{q}_{jt} = c_{jt} / \sum_k c_{kt}$ by group, without penalization (the plug-in estimator of Gentzkow et al., 2019).

depends on non-zero coefficients, lower recent estimates may partly reflect less speech rather than smaller differences in speech (Section 5.12).

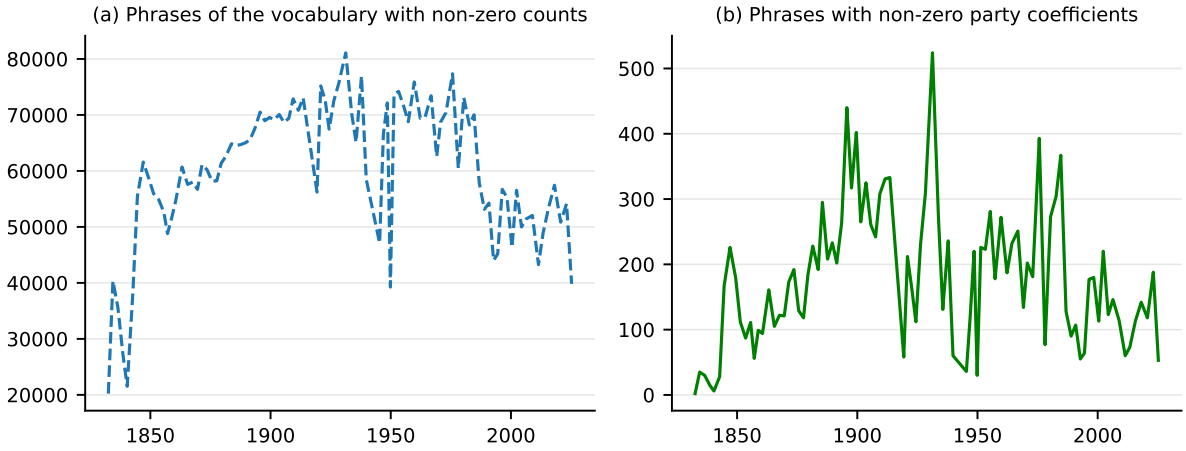



**Figure A6:** Phrase usage and partisanship

*Notes*: (a) Phrases of the vocabulary with non-zero counts; (b) phrases with non-zero party coefficients $\hat{\varphi}_{jt}$, religious split, main specification.

Figure A7 re-estimates the series without covariates, increasing or decreasing the penalty $\psi$ tenfold, as in Gentzkow et al. (2019)'s robustness checks. The reference estimates are panel (a) of Figures A2 and A3, with $\psi = 10^{-5}$. At $\psi = 10^{-4}$, every real estimate moves towards 0.5. The median reduction is about a fifth of its distance from 0.5 for the religious series and a sixth for the left–others series. Random estimates fall by about the same amount, leaving average net partisanship almost unchanged: 0.0003 for the religious series and 0.0012 for the left–others series, as with $\psi = 10^{-5}$. At $\psi = 10^{-6}$, real estimates are almost identical to those at $\psi = 10^{-5}$, with correlation above 0.999. At every value of $\psi$, the highest religious value falls under plural voting, in 1894–1896 or 1898–1900, and the highest left–others value is that of 1932–1934. The timing of the highest values without covariates is therefore robust to the penalty.

Figure A8 separates the French and Dutch components of the main series, which are weighted

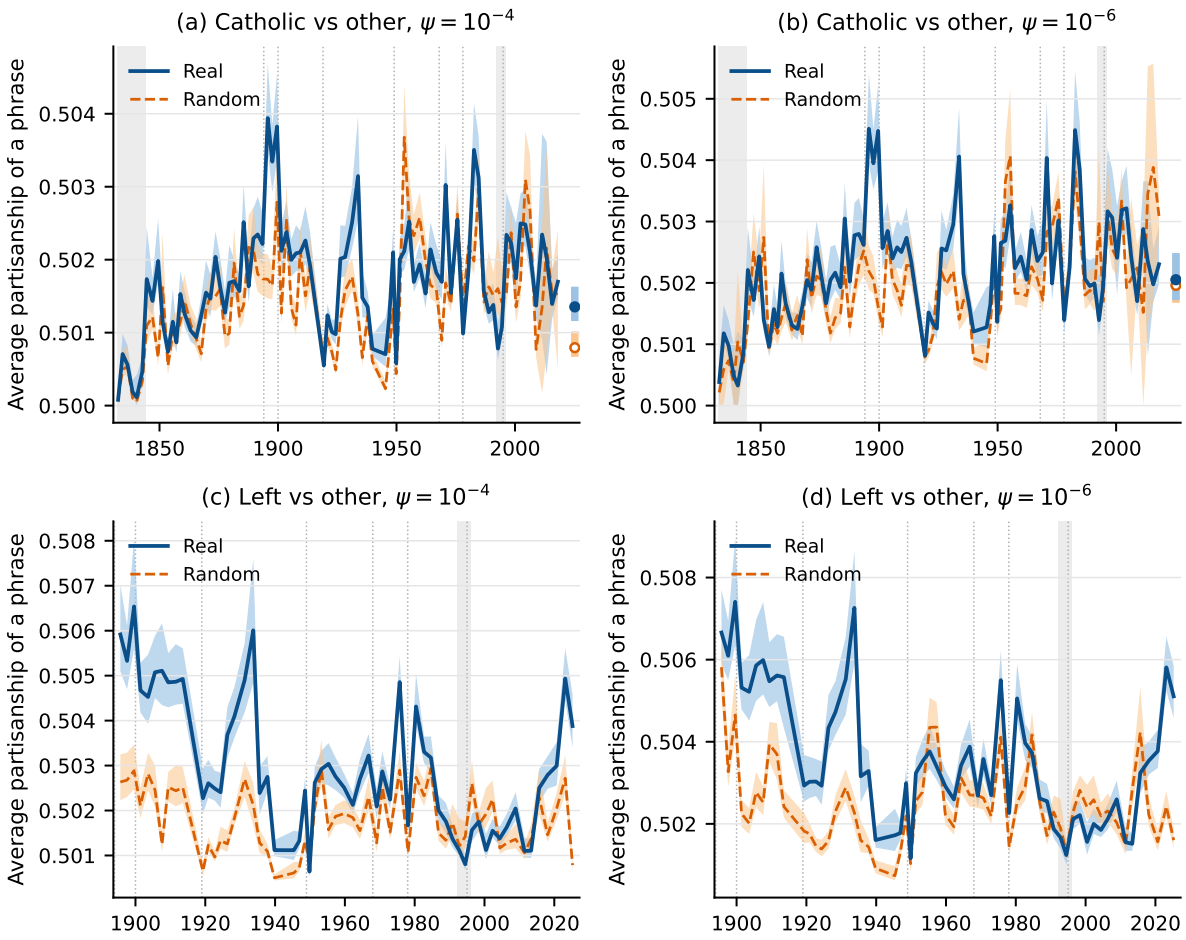



**Figure A7:** The impact of $\psi$

*Notes*: Series without covariates, with $\psi = 10^{-4}$ and $\psi = 10^{-6}$ (the main specifications use $\psi = 10^{-5}$).

by their phrase shares. Dutch enters in 1900 but carries little weight before 1919. It accounts for less than a fifth of interwar phrases and for 17–26 per cent in 1950–1958. The Dutch religious series is highest in 1954–1956 (0.0029), during the second school war; this is the only period of 1950–1958 in which either Dutch series exceeds its benchmark. The Dutch left–others series is highest in 2024–2025 (0.0105). French religious estimates in 1950–1958 (0.0000–0.0004) are below the plural-voting maximum (0.0017 in 1898–1900) and the 1969–1971 value (0.0028), the highest of the French series, when 19 Christian democrats spoke French. The French left–others series peaks in 1932–1934 (0.0041). French speech contributes 96 per cent of the religious maximum of 1969–1971, and Dutch speech 91 per cent of the left–others maximum of 2024–2025. Levels cannot be compared across languages because the Dutch vocabulary is about a quarter the size of the French vocabulary (Section 4).

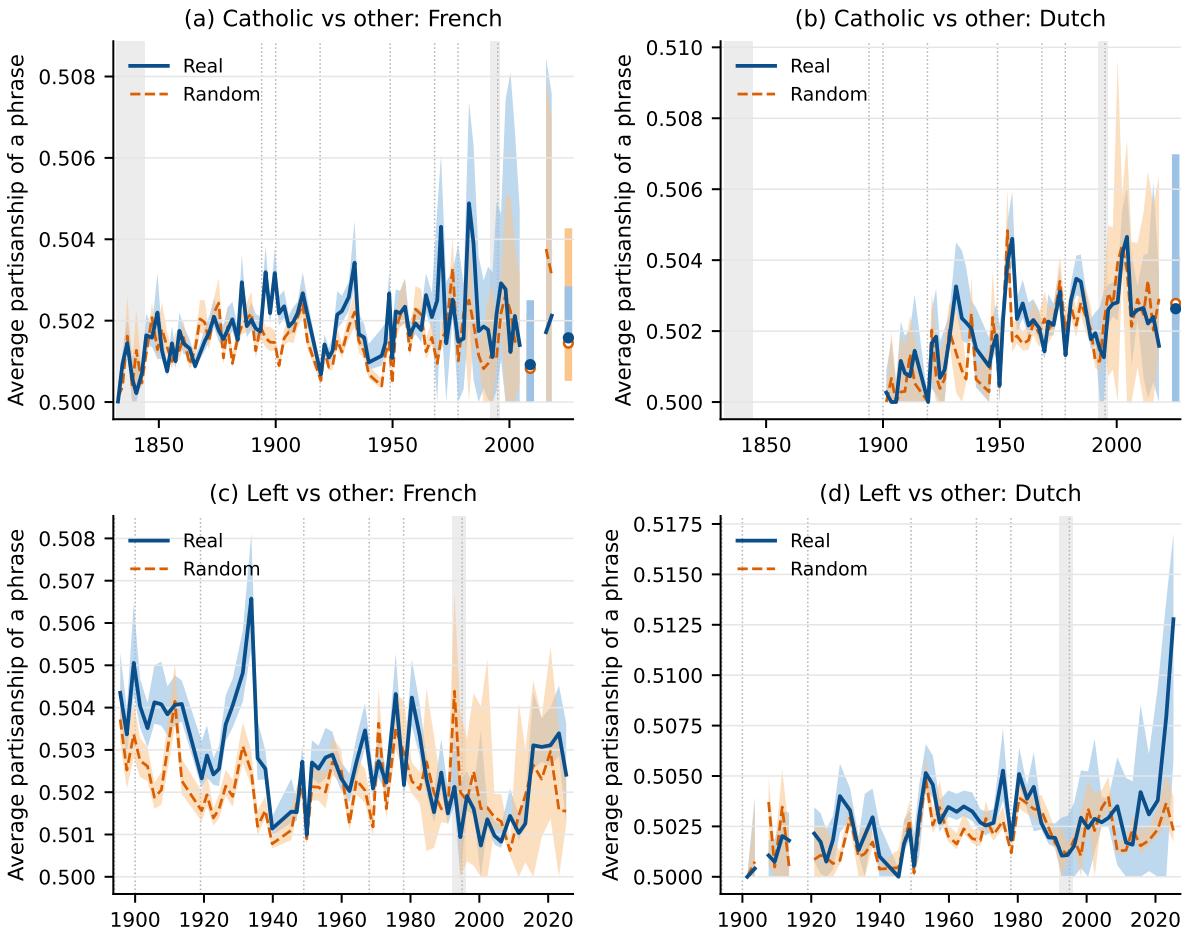



**Figure A8:** Partisanship by language

*Notes*: The French and Dutch components of Figures 1 and 2. Levels are not comparable across languages: the Dutch vocabulary is about a quarter of the French one.

Figure A9 reports the unpenalized leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019) for the three main groupings, without covariates. Its random benchmark averages close to 0.5, but estimates are noisy. Some fall below 0.5, and intervals are more than ten times wider than penalized intervals. Religious estimates are positive in every period of 1843–1893 but exceed their benchmark in only three. They exceed it in all ten periods of 1894–1914 and are highest in 1894–1896; they exceed it in no period of 1950–1961 and are lowest, and negative, in 1974–1978.

Left–others estimates are highest before 1914, when they exceed their benchmark in all ten periods, and lower after 1945. Government–opposition estimates exceed their benchmark in most periods under plural voting and equal male suffrage and in the federal era (9 of 10, 7 of 9 and 11 of 14 periods).

The leave-out series rank recent periods higher than the penalized series do. In 2024–2025, a short period, left–others leave-out partisanship (0.023) exceeds every value after 1914 but remains below most values of 1894–1914, and government–opposition leave-out partisanship (0.035) is the highest of its series. Averaged over the federal era, the latter (0.016) is as high as under plural voting and equal male suffrage (0.015 and 0.016), whereas the penalized government–opposition series averages half as much in the federal era as under equal male suffrage. The religious leave-out series exceeds its benchmark in 2024–2025, unlike the penalized series, which never does so in the federal era (Section 5.12).

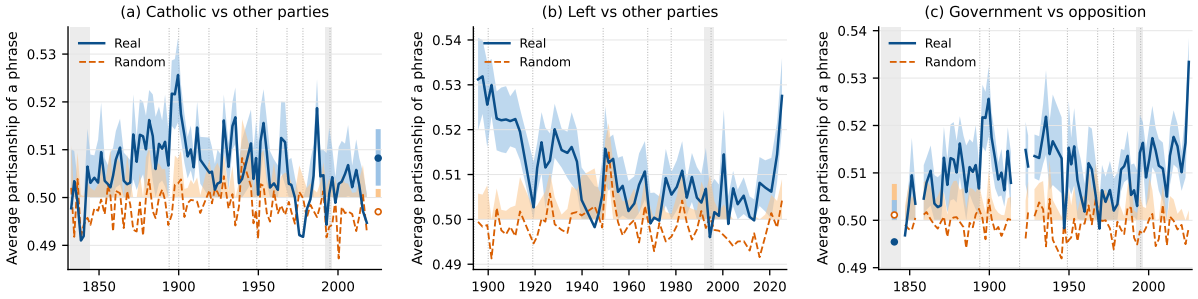



**Figure A9:** Leave-out estimator

*Notes*: Leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019), as used by Graziani and Vanschoonbeek (2026); no covariates.

Figure A10 compares the main real series with estimates excluding speeches delivered by members as ministers, which account for about a sixth of phrases. It omits random benchmarks and confidence intervals. Before 1968, religious estimates are higher without ministerial speeches in 52 of 58 periods, but after the Christian-democratic split in only 11 of 23. None of the five periods after 1968 in which the main religious series exceeds its random benchmark does so without ministerial speeches. In 1969–1971, net partisanship falls from 0.0020 to 0.0005. Conversely, 1950–1952 and 1952–1954, when the Christian democrats governed alone, exceed the benchmark only without ministerial speeches (0.0012 and 0.0011). The left–others series is higher without ministerial speeches in 41 of 58 periods and exceeds its benchmark in 33 periods rather than 27. Its highest value is then that of 1932–1934 (0.0041), and the value of 2024–2025 falls from 0.0052 to 0.0028 but still exceeds its benchmark. The religious values above the benchmark after 1968 therefore depend on speeches delivered by ministers, while the left–others series keeps its high values of 1932–1934 and 2024–2025.

Figure A11 compares constant gender and province effects with effects that vary by institutional period: six periods for the religious series and five for the left–others series, which begins in 1894. The real series are close, with correlations of 0.98 and 0.94 over the periods with adequate coverage. They differ most in the federal era for the left–others grouping: with varying effects, its real series is 0.0028 lower in 2024–2025 and 0.0013 lower in 2021–2024. Average net religious partisanship is 0.00028 with constant effects and 0.00024 with varying effects; average net left–others partisanship is 0.00083 and 0.00091. The figure shows the real series only.

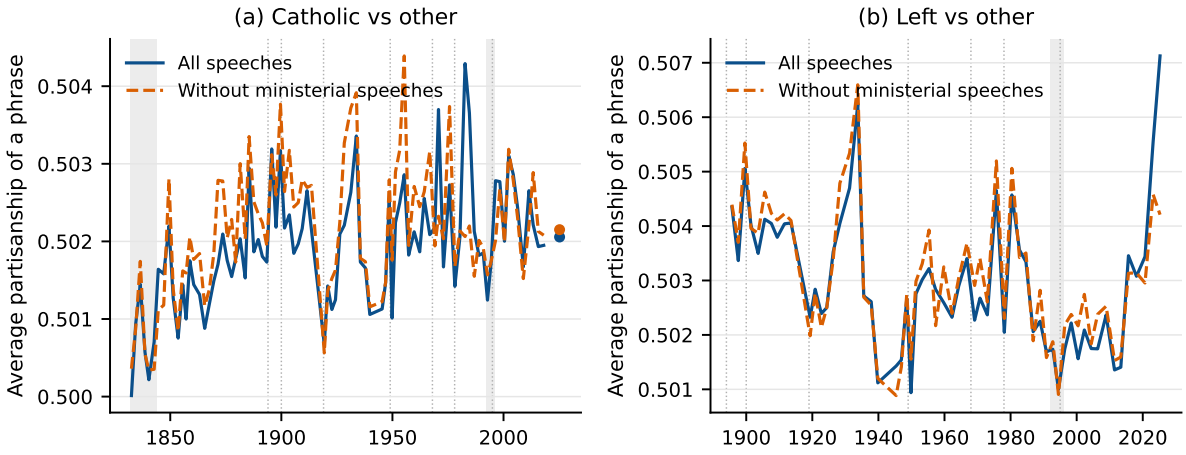



**Figure A10:** Speeches delivered in a ministerial capacity left out

Individual net estimates vary more, because each specification draws its own random benchmark. With varying effects, religious partisanship in 1969–1971, the highest value of the main series, falls from 0.0020 to 0.0009 and no longer exceeds its benchmark, mainly because the random estimate rises. For the same reason, 1894–1896 falls from 0.0016 to 0.0001. The highest religious value is then 0.0019, in 1932–1934, where the random estimate falls. Left–others partisanship in 2024–2025 falls from 0.0052 to 0.0029, because its real series is lower, and still exceeds its benchmark; the highest left–others value is then 0.0045, in 1932–1934.

With varying effects, the religious series exceeds its benchmark in 20 rather than 23 of 81 periods, and the left–others series in 30 rather than 27 of 58. Institutional-period averages keep the ranking of Table 4: religious partisanship is highest under plural voting and lowest in the federal era, and left–others partisanship is highest under equal male suffrage and lowest in the post-war unitary state.

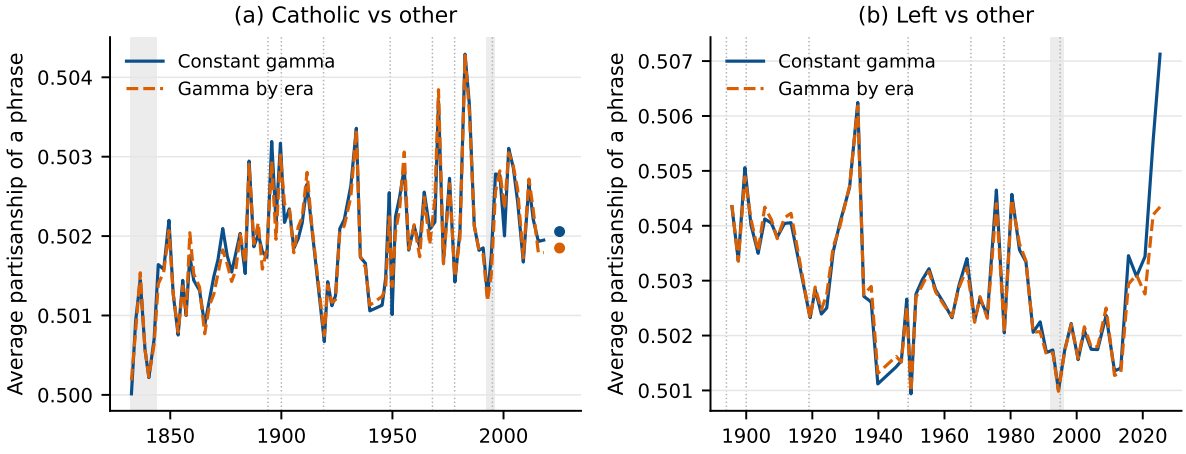



**Figure A11:** Covariate effects that vary by institutional period

Figure A12 compares Flemish and Walloon members within national parties before each party's split, using French speech without covariates. Each region needs 15 speakers. This creates Catholic-series gaps before 1884, when few Walloon Catholics speak. The Liberal series covers only the years to 1864 and 1904–1914, and the Socialist series begins in 1919. Catholics speak

similarly across regions: net partisanship averages 0.0004 and exceeds its random benchmark in 4 of 42 periods, all before 1914. Socialists differ more, averaging 0.0022, and exceed their benchmark in 5 of 23 periods: four between the wars and 1952–1954. Their intervals are wide, however, with only 15 to 25 Flemish Socialists speaking French. Liberal differences average 0.0017 and exceed the benchmark only in 1850–1852 and 1857–1859. Regional differences within national parties therefore appear mainly among Socialists between the wars and among Liberals in the 1850s, and rarely among Catholics (Section 5.6).

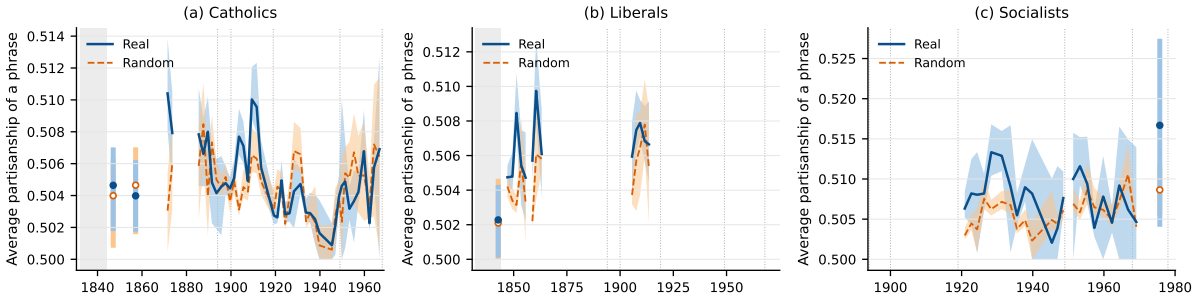



**Figure A12:** Flemish vs Walloon members within each party family, before its split

*Notes*: French speech; no covariates.

Figure A13 tracks French phrase partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ (Gentzkow et al., 2019), multiplied by 1,000. Eligible phrases were among a decade's three most partisan. Each panel selects phrases first identified in its half-century and displays the five with the largest absolute value in any period. Cleavage-related phrases mark particular episodes: *instruction publique* for Catholics in 1878–1884 and *écoles communales* for Liberals in 1884–1886, during and after the first school war; *suffrage universel* and *classe ouvrière* for other parties from the 1890s; *consultation populaire* for other parties in 1949–1950; and *pays en voie de développement* for Christian democrats in 1969–1971 (Section 5.1.1). Fewer phrases reflect institutional roles than in earlier versions of the vocabulary, which kept procedural formulas and titles. The clearest is *pouvoirs spéciaux*, which identifies other parties in 1981–1983 and 1995–1997, under governments that included the Christian democrats. The largest values come from the first decades: *los renten* for Catholics in 1835–1837 (1.00), a period with low coverage of the sittings, and *chemin de fer* for Catholics in 1843–1845 (0.99). Since 1945, the largest is that of *union européenne* for the Catholic family in 2024–2025 (0.70).

Figure A14 repeats this exercise for left–others partisanship. The first panel is empty because the series begins in 1894. Before 1914, *banque nationale*, *suffrage universel* and *classe ouvrière* identify the left, at about 0.7 in 1898–1902 and 1912–1914. Later panels mix policy and role vocabulary. *pleins pouvoirs* identifies the Socialist opposition in 1932–1934 (0.41), and *sécurité sociale* the left in 1995–1997 (0.60), when the Socialists governed. *pouvoirs spéciaux* changes sides with government status: it identifies the left when the Socialists are in opposition, as in 1985–1987 (0.43), and other parties when they govern, as in 1995–1997 ($-0.63$).

In earlier versions of the vocabulary, two name sequences ranked first and third among the left's most partisan phrases in 1894–1896: *Cousin Coiseau* and *MM. Cousin*, the names of the Zeebrugge port contractors whose concession was debated in August 1895. The vocabulary now leaves out names of persons (Section 3). In the lists of Online Appendix C, the left's most

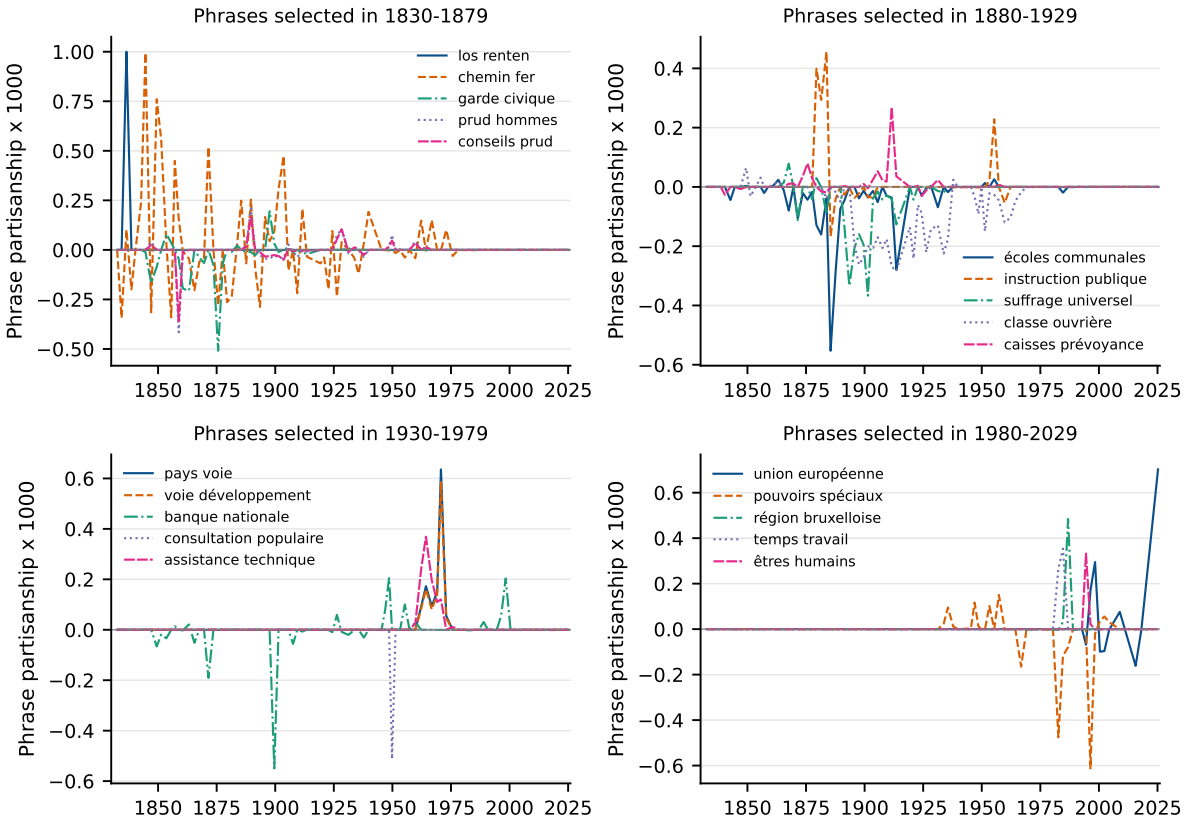



**Figure A13:** Religious partisanship $\zeta_{jt}$ of selected phrases

*Notes*: Phrase partisanship multiplied by 1000. The phrases are selected among the three most partisan of each decade (French speech); each panel shows, among those first selected in the decades of its half-century, the five with the largest absolute value in any period. Positive values: Catholic phrases.

partisan phrase in 1894–1896 is *classe ouvrière* (0.40), followed by *cahier des charges*, *chemin de fer*, *conseil communal* and *suffrage universel* (0.13–0.15). A left speaker is predicted to use *classe ouvrière* 219 times per 100,000 phrases, compared with 58 for other parties (Section 5.2).

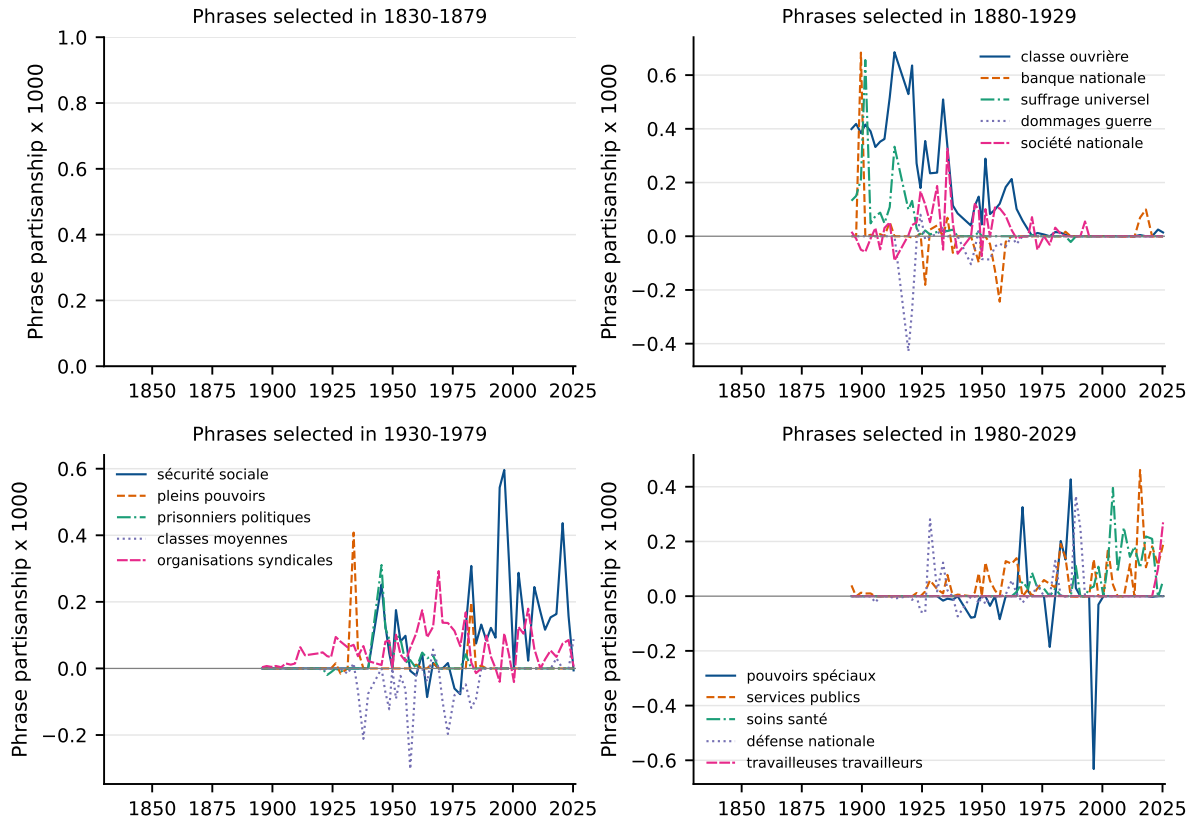



**Figure A14:** Left–others partisanship $\zeta_{jt}$ of selected phrases

*Notes*: As Figure A13; positive values: phrases of the left.

Figure A15 plots monarchy-related phrases as a share of all phrases alongside religious partisanship (top). The bottom panels show Catholic members' count and share of these phrases. The matches are spread over many phrases; the most frequent accounts for 6 per cent. They include institutions named after the Crown (*commissaire royal*, *bibliothèque royale*, *athénées royaux*), the monarchy itself (*famille royale*, *prérogative royale*, *question royale*) and fragments of royal-decree formulas (*royal pris*, *royal délibéré*), whose main phrase, *arrêté royal*, is no longer in the vocabulary (Section 3). Almost all are French. Their share peaks in 1949–1950, before the referendum on Leopold III's return. Catholics use 19 per cent of these phrases, below their shares of speakers (46 per cent) and speeches (28 per cent). Religious partisanship then exceeds its benchmark at a modest level (0.0006), and no period of 1950–1958 exceeds it (Sections 5.1.1 and 6).

Figure A16 plots language-policy phrases (top) and labour phrases (bottom) alongside the corresponding partisanship series. These compare Flemish and Walloon French speech before 1968, and the left with other parties. Language-policy phrases are most frequent in 1906–1908, 1921–1923 and 1929–1932, and around the state reforms of 1970 and 1988. Regional partisanship does not track them: the correlation is −0.01. Labour phrases reach 1.4–2.7 per cent in 1894–1914 after the Socialists enter and become less frequent after 1934. Left–others partisanship tracks them only loosely, with a correlation of 0.36.

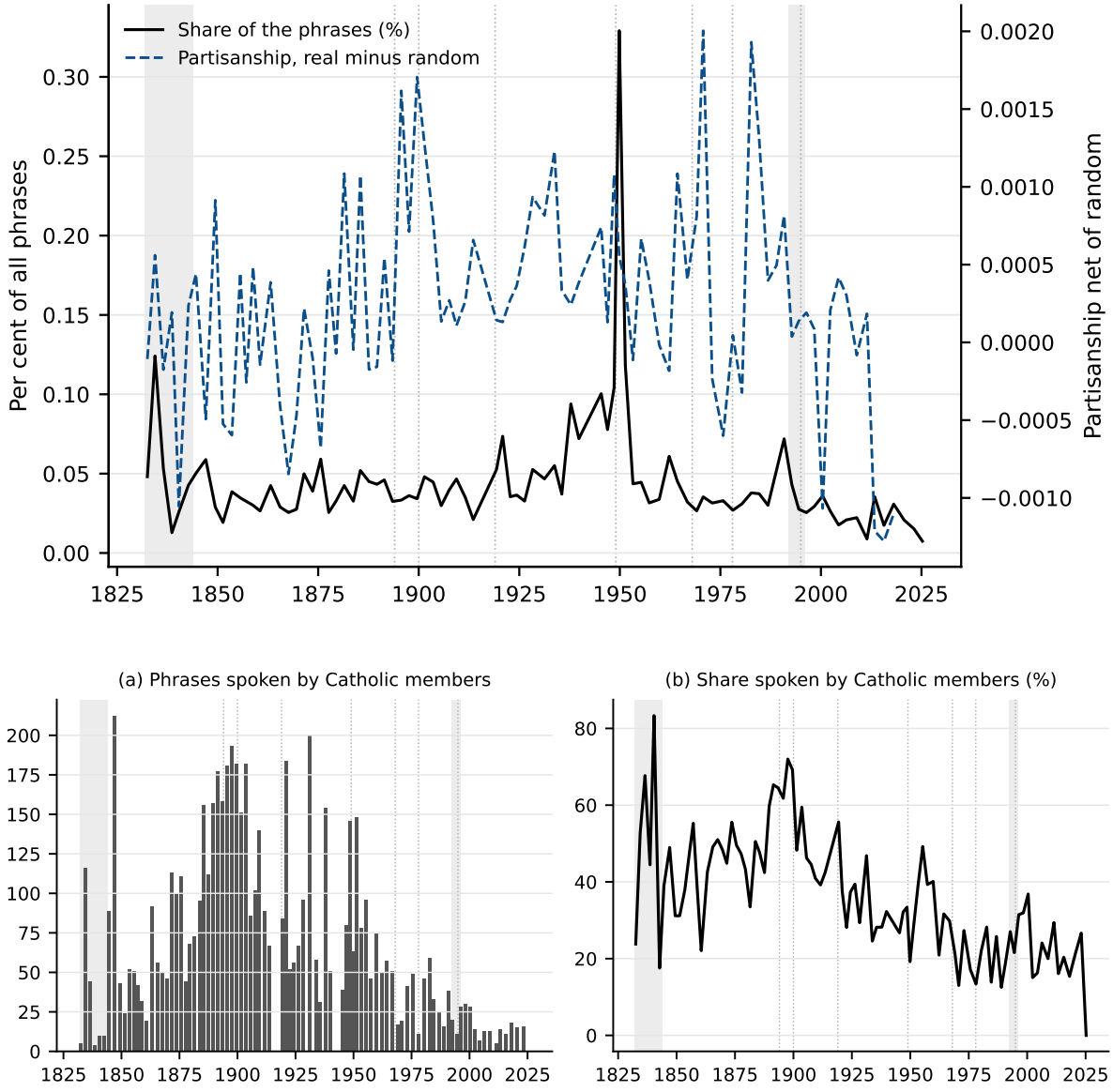



**Figure A15:** Phrases related to the Royal Question

The labour dictionary matches few Dutch phrases (2 per cent of matches, against 13 per cent of all phrases), so Dutch speech's growing share partly explains the later decline. In French alone, labour phrases still account for 0.7–1.3 per cent in 2016–2025. Left–others differences thus move loosely with labour attention; regional differences do not move with language-policy attention (Section 6).

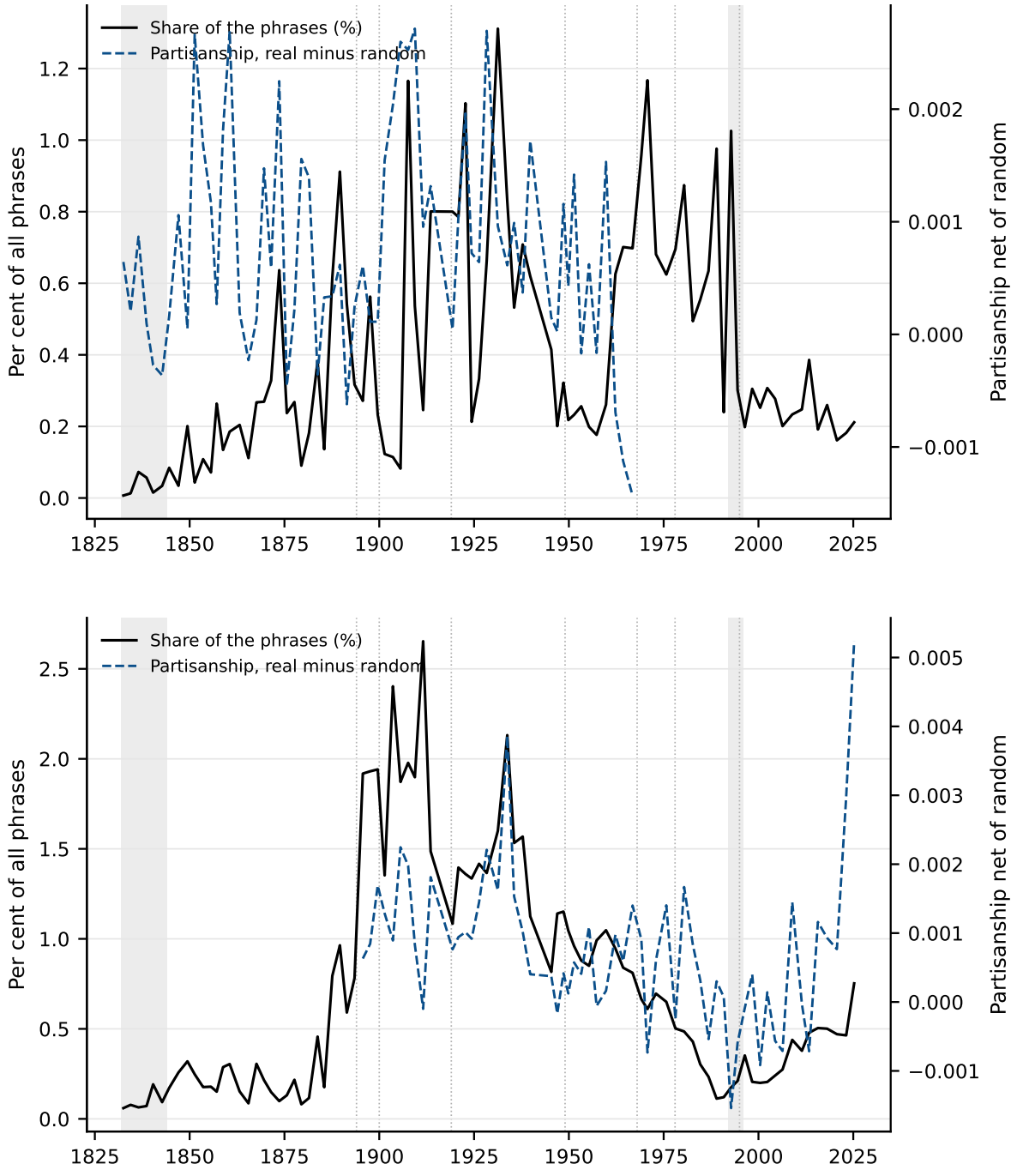



**Figure A16:** Phrases related to the language question (top) and to labour (bottom)

**Roll-call votes.** The dataset records the Chamber's roll-call votes, linked to members (Graziani, 2026). We keep yes and no votes. In 2,402 of the 31,615 roll calls, a member appears more

than once, because several votes are recorded under one number, most of them in 1981–1983, 1995–1997 and 2019–2021; we leave these roll calls out. The division between two groups in a roll call is the index of party unlikeness of Rice (1925), the absolute difference between the groups' shares of yes among their yes and no votes. A roll call enters a comparison if each group casts at least five yes or no votes. The division of a period is the mean over its roll calls; periods with fewer than 20 roll calls and periods with low coverage of the sittings are left out of the correlations and the figures. Speech is net partisanship of the same groups in the same period. For the comparison of all Flemish with all Walloon members (Section 5.7), each region must cast at least ten yes or no votes, and we subtract from each roll call's index its expected value when the region labels are assigned at random among the members voting, computed exactly from the hypergeometric distribution. Within families, the division of a roll call is the mean over the families with at least five yes or no votes in each region, weighted by their votes. Subjects come from the title of the bill, taken from the legislative files of the dataset or, failing these, from the title printed in the report, and classified by keywords in French and Dutch. Produced by `code/python/28_votes.py` and `code/python/29_regions.py`.

Figure A17 compares the three main speech series with the division in votes between the same groups, and Table A1 reports their correlations by institutional period. Religious-group voting differences (panel a) are greatest under plural voting (0.50–0.81 in 1894–1914) and in 1954–1956 (0.64). Left–others voting differences (panel b) move with Socialist government status. They range from 0.45 to 0.63 in 1894–1914, fall to about 0.1 in 1934–1939 and 1961–1965, when the Socialists govern, and peak under the centre-right governments of 1981–1987 (0.61–0.73). Across periods, their correlation with the share of Socialist members whose party is in government is −0.82, against −0.30 for speech (54 periods). Votes therefore move with government–opposition divisions more closely than speech does (Section 5.4). Government–opposition voting differences (panel c) range from 0.18 to 0.81 and move little with speech (0.05).

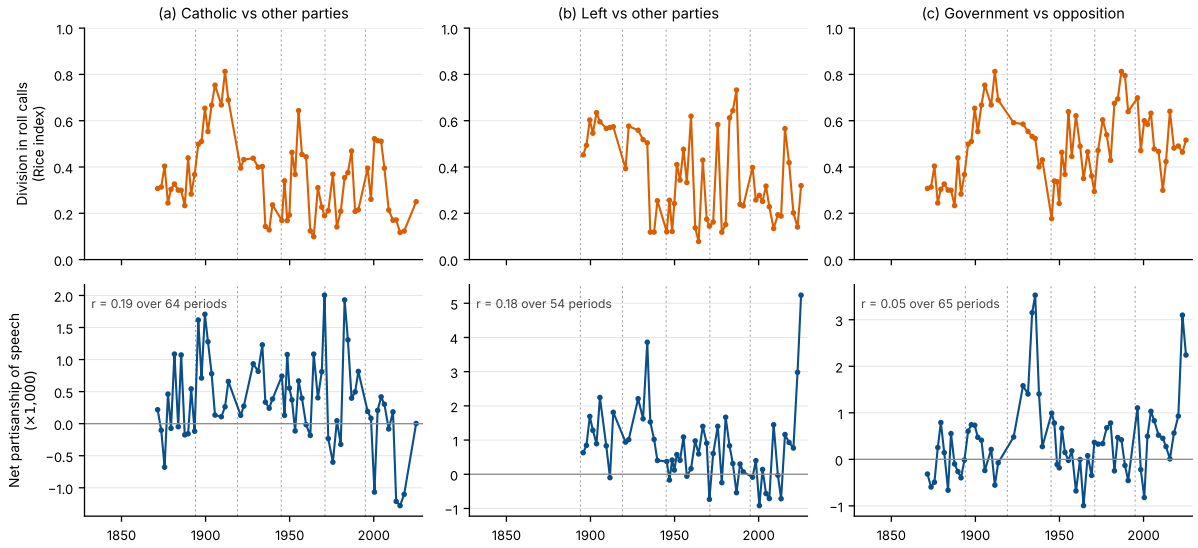



**Figure A17:** Partisanship in speech and division in roll-call votes

*Notes*: Top: division in roll calls (Rice, 1925), mean over the roll calls of the period in which each group casts at least five yes or no votes. Bottom: net partisanship of the same groups (Figures 1, 2 and 4), multiplied by 1,000; *r*: correlation over the periods shown. Periods with fewer than 20 roll calls and periods with low coverage of the sittings are left out; dotted lines: start of the institutional periods. Produced by `code/python/28_votes.py`.

**Table A1:** Correlation between division in roll calls and partisanship in speech, by institutional period

| | All | 1831–1893 | 1894–1918 | 1919–1944 | 1945–1970 | 1971–1994 | 1995–2025 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Catholic vs other parties | 0.19 (64) | −0.38 (12) | −0.63 (9) | 0.47 (8) | −0.34 (14) | 0.31 (9) | 0.45 (12) |
| Left vs other parties | 0.18 (54) | – | 0.35 (9) | 0.41 (8) | 0.18 (14) | −0.11 (9) | 0.02 (14) |
| Government vs opposition | 0.05 (65) | −0.24 (12) | −0.86 (9) | 0.15 (7) | −0.34 (14) | −0.46 (9) | −0.08 (14) |

*Notes*: Correlation across periods between the division in roll calls (Figure A17) and net partisanship in speech; number of periods in parentheses. –: no periods. Correlations describe how the two measures move together; with 7 to 14 periods per institutional period, they are imprecise.

Figure A18 compares pairs of parties of the same language since 1979 (Section 5.5). Each point is a pair in a period: the division of the two parties in roll calls against their net partisanship in speech. A pair is on the same side when both parties are in government, or both in opposition, for at least half the period. Pairs on the same side vote alike and are harder to tell apart in speech. Panels (b) and (c) follow two pairs over time. The division between N-VA, with its predecessor the Volksunie, and Vlaams Belang is 0.10 to 0.30 in the periods in which both are in opposition and rises to 0.55 in 2024–2025, when N-VA governs for most of the period. CD&V and N-VA, with their predecessors, vote alike when both govern (a division of at most 0.04) and less so otherwise. Over time, the two measures are correlated at 0.16 for the first pair (6 periods) and 0.47 for the second (14 periods).

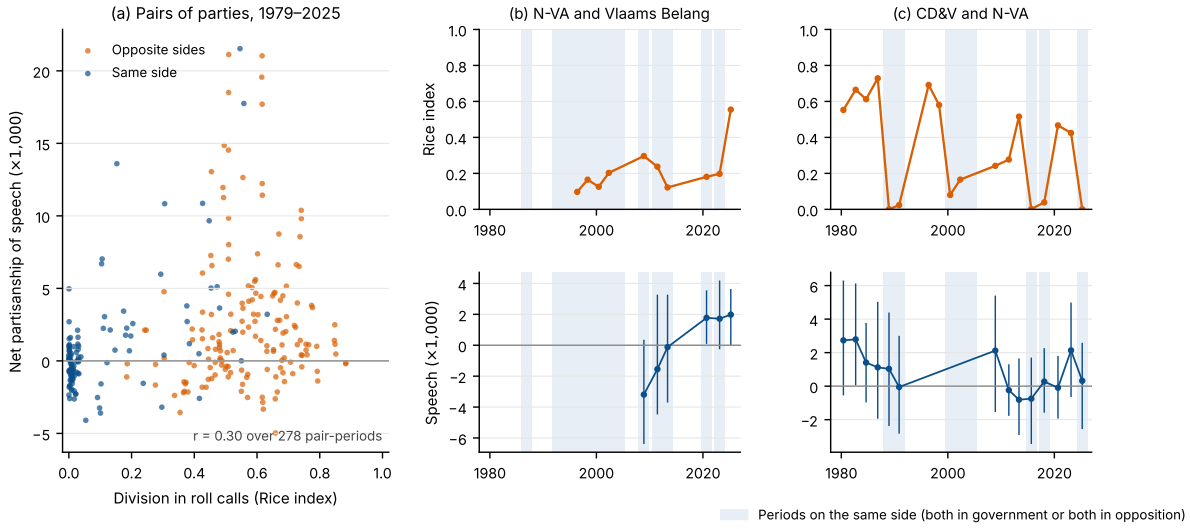



**Figure A18:** Pairs of parties since 1979: speech and roll-call votes

*Notes*: (a) Pairs of parties of the same language and period (Section 5.5): division in roll calls between the members of the two parties and net partisanship of the pair in speech, without covariates, multiplied by 1,000; same side: both parties in government, or both in opposition, for at least half the period; *r*: correlation over the pair-periods. (b) and (c) The division in roll calls (top) and net partisanship in speech with its 80 per cent interval (bottom) for two pairs; shaded: periods on the same side. The parties of the votes are the party units of Online Appendix B; N-VA includes the Volksunie. Produced by `code/python/28_votes.py`.

Figure A19 compares Flemish and Walloon members within the national parties before their splits. In each of the three parties, the members of the two regions seldom vote differently: the division, pooled over the three parties, averages 0.04 and is at most 0.19, in the early 1920s. It is correlated at 0.17 with Flemish–Walloon partisanship in French speech (49 periods). Figure A20 reports the division between Flemish and Walloon members by subject of the bill (Section 5.7).

Figure A21 reports the experiment from Section 4. In panel (a), simulated character errors in

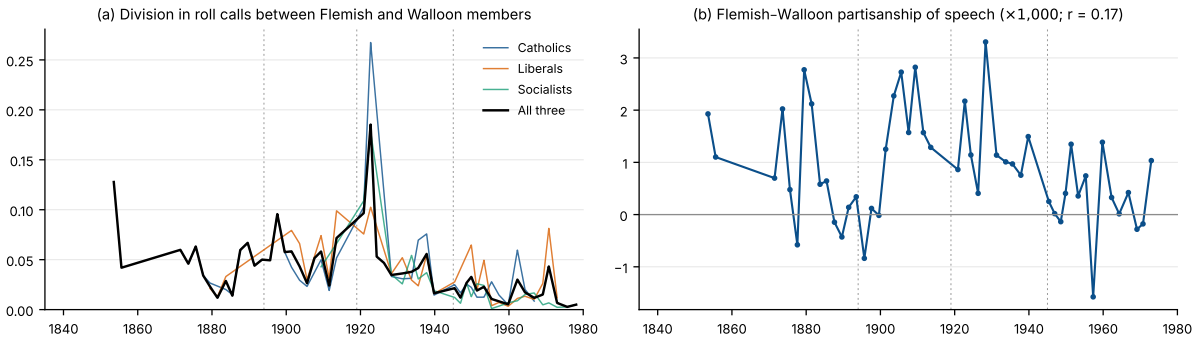



**Figure A19:** Flemish and Walloon members of the national parties: roll-call votes and speech

*Notes*: (a) Division in roll calls between the members of each national party elected in Flemish and in Walloon districts, before the party's split, and the three parties pooled (Brussels left out); not net of its random expectation. (b) Flemish–Walloon net partisanship in French speech (Figure 20 until 1967, then the families not yet split), multiplied by 1,000; *r*: correlation with the pooled division in roll calls. Produced by `code/python/28_votes.py`.




**Figure A20:** Flemish and Walloon members in roll-call votes, by subject of the bill

*Notes*: Net division in roll calls (Figure 8) by subject of the bill and institutional period: (a) all Flemish against all Walloon members; (b) members of the same party family. Subjects from keywords in French and Dutch in the title of the bill, the first matching class in the order shown; roll calls without a usable title are in *Other or unknown*. –: fewer than 10 roll calls. Periods with fewer than 20 roll calls and periods with low coverage of the sittings are left out. Produced by `code/python/29_regions.py`.

born-digital reports from 2019–2025 steadily reduce left–others partisanship without covariates. At 5 per cent error, its distance above 0.5 falls to 72 per cent of the clean-text distance. With covariates, attenuation is smaller and less regular, retaining 81 per cent at 5 per cent error. The religious series is undefined in most of these years.

Panel (b) shows the share of tokens outside a lexicon of words occurring at least twice in each of at least ten periods. For French, this share is 6–12 per cent before 1843 and 1.1–3.0 per cent from 1845 to 2019, close to or below the 2.9 per cent of the clean reports used in the experiment. Applied to the experiment, these rates suggest no attenuation from 1845. However, the lexicon also excludes new and rare words. These shares therefore do not yet measure historical OCR error rates (Section 5.10).

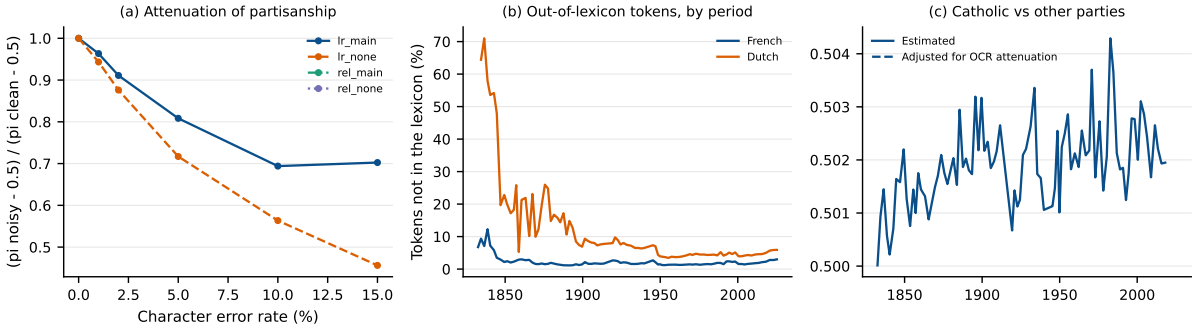



**Figure A21:** OCR noise and measured partisanship

*Notes*: (a) Attenuation of partisanship in the born-digital reports of 2019–2025 with simulated OCR errors; the religious series is not defined in these years. (b) Share of the tokens that are not in the reference lexicon (the words used at least twice in each of at least ten periods), by language. (c) Religious partisanship, real series; the series adjusted for the attenuation implied by panel (b) is not defined, because the religious series is not defined in the experiment.

Figure A22 applies Figure 24' decomposition to left–others partisanship. From 1894–1896 to 1912–1914, cumulative leave-out partisanship falls by 0.013, almost entirely through renewal; sitting-member changes sum to about zero. The First World War adds a further decline of 0.016, mainly among sitting members ($-0.013$). Afterwards, the within component varies more than renewal, with about one and a half times its standard deviation. The cumulative total stays negative from 1898–1900 to 2021–2024 and returns to about zero only in 2024–2025. Across the full sample, renewal subtracts 0.047 and sitting members add 0.048, as in the religious series; the change into 1999–2001 alone adds 0.042 to the within component. The components have opposite signs in three of five institutional periods (Table 9). The pattern in Section 5.8 is therefore weaker for left–others differences.

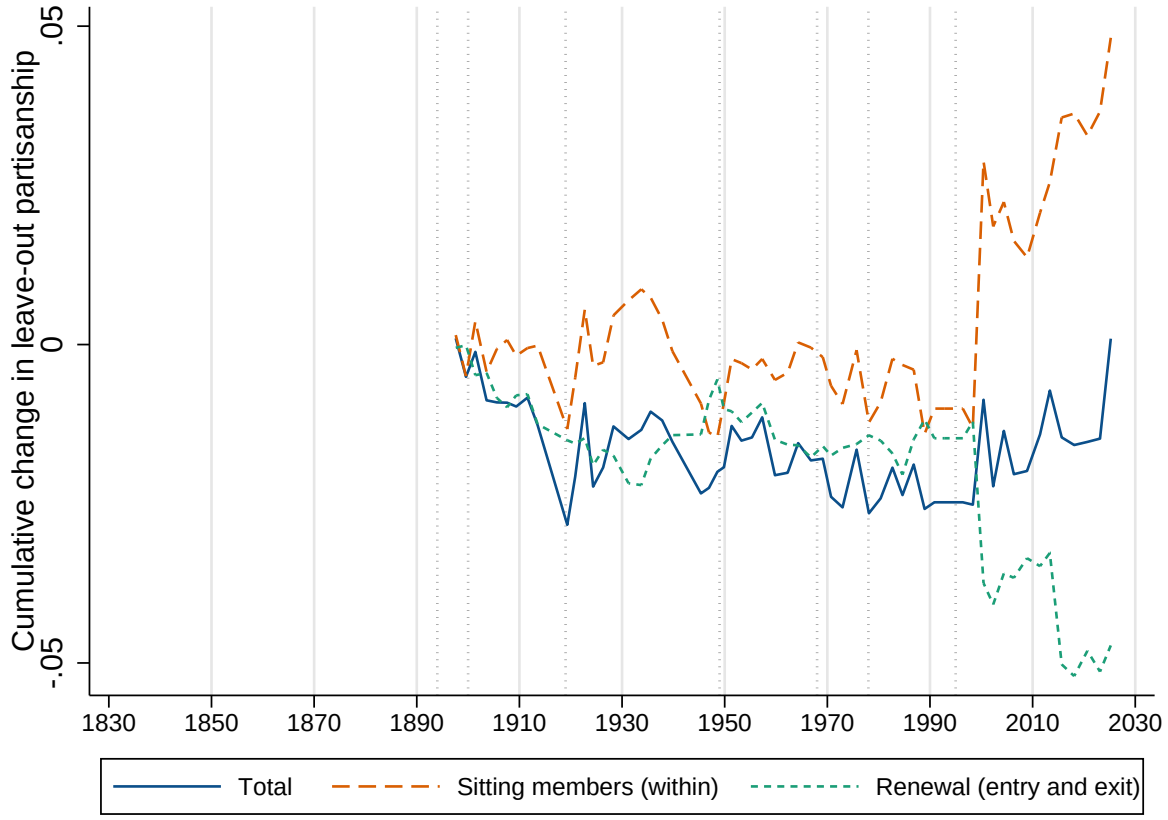



**Figure A22:** Left–others partisanship: renewal of the Chamber and adaptation of sitting members

*Notes*: As Figure 24.

## Online Appendix B: Data and preprocessing

**Sample selection.** We start from the dataset's 3,411,572 blocks and select speech blocks from plenary sittings. Plenary reports are identified by document code from 1999 and by the 1985–1999 classification in `committee_scan.csv` for earlier reports. We exclude the chair's turns, retain French or Dutch speeches linked to a member through exact, fuzzy or manual matching or to a minister, and require Chamber membership on the sitting date. Table B1 gives block counts at each step. We retain speeches by members serving as ministers; Online Appendix Figure A10 excludes those delivered in a ministerial capacity.

**Table B1:** Sample selection

| Step | Blocks |
|---|---|
| All blocks | 3,411,572 |
| Speech blocks | 2,370,355 |
| In plenary sittings | 2,262,560 |
| Not turns of the chair | 1,826,697 |
| In French or Dutch, linked to a member or minister | 1,798,626 |
| Delivered by members of the Chamber | 1,732,227 |

**Preprocessing.** We remove parenthetical text containing interruptions, applause and laughter, and rejoin words hyphenated at line breaks. In the PDF reports of 1 July 1999 to 14 July 2000, every accent is printed as a separate character after its letter (*pre´sident*); we join each accent to its letter. We spell out euro, dollar, per cent and paragraph signs, replace other non-alphanumeric characters with spaces, lowercase the text and split it into words. We remove each language's Snowball stopwords and single-character tokens, then apply the French and Dutch Snowball stemmers (Porter, 2001). For Dutch, we use the original algorithm, which retains the prefix *ge-*.

We form bigrams from consecutive stems. We remove those containing the surname of a member of the Chamber, including members who served as ministers, a party acronym, an address to the chair or colleagues, or a month. We retain surnames printed in lowercase at least half the time, treating them as common words. We also exclude listed procedural phrases and party names. Party adjectives such as *catholique* and *socialiste* remain because they can describe policy objects, as in *enseignement catholique*. The lists are in `code/python/textproc.py`.

**Phrases without content.** After the vocabulary is formed, we leave out phrases without content, with the rules of the project's website (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`): procedural formulas (*projet loi*, *section centrale*, *ter tafel*), courtesies and titles (*premier ministre*, *eerste minister*), names of parties and parliamentary groups (*groupe socialiste*), amounts, dates and other numbers (a law with its year and an age remain, as in *67 ans*), person names that the surname filter misses, such as those of ministers who never sat in the Chamber (*général cousebant*, *van houtte*), fragments of words, pairs of filler words (*eh bien*, *ten eerste*) and the names of ministries, which serve as titles (*ministre finances*, *binnenlandse zaken*). French keeps 77,324 of 84,812 phrases, with 85.8 per cent of the occurrences, and Dutch 18,045 of 22,240, with 71.7 per cent. The phrases left out are listed, with their frequencies, in `output/checks/vocab_dropped_fr.csv` and `vocab_dropped_nl.csv`

of the replication package. Phrases that name a subject, such as *classe ouvrière*, remain, and so do a few phrases without content that the rules miss, among them some text of the voting procedure (Section 5.12).

**Parties.** Rules in `code/python/parties.py` map party labels to families, language communities and party units. We manually check these mappings in `party_crosswalk.csv` and use the dataset's family label when available. A party unit is the national party before its family's split—Catholics in 1968, Liberals in 1972 and Socialists in 1978—and the language-community party afterwards. Where a family has several parties at the same time, each party is a separate unit. Members of the joint parliamentary group of the two Green parties belong to the community of their district or, in Brussels, of the language they speak. A unit is in government on a day if one of its members holds ministerial office; ministers without a party place no unit in government. Unionist governments include both Catholics and Liberals. Table B2 lists every party label of the register, with its family and community, the years in which it appears, its speakers and speeches, its side in every comparison and its years in government. Table B3 lists the parties in government between consecutive changes of composition.

**Table B2:** Party labels, families and groups in each comparison

| Party label | Community | Years | Leg. | Speakers | Speeches | Words (000s) | Side in the comparison: Rel. | L–O | L–R | R–O | Flemish–Walloon | Years in government | Multiparty family | Party of 2024 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Catholic and Christian democrat* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Katholiek[r] | national | 1831–1946 | 33 | 589 | 518,034 | 37,079 | A | B | – | B | A, B | 1831–1840, 1841–1847, 1855–1857, 1870–1878, 1884–1945 | Catholic | CD&V, Les Engagés |
| CVP-PSC | national | 1946–1968 | 7 | 191 | 75,713 | 7,161 | A | B | – | B | A, B | 1947–1954, 1958–1968 | Catholic | CD&V, Les Engagés |
| Daensist | Dutch | 1894–1898, 1900–1921 | 6 | 5 | 8,928 | 353 | A | B | – | B | A | 1894–1898, 1900–1921 | Catholic | CD&V |
| CVP-PSC[r] | Dutch | 1968–1971 | 2 | 52 | 3,436 | 618 | A | B | – | B | – | 1968–1971 | Catholic | CD&V |
| CVP | Dutch | 1971–2003 | 10 | 141 | 38,255 | 5,158 | A | B | – | B | – | 1971–1999 | Catholic | CD&V |
| CD&V[r] | Dutch | 2003–2025 | 7 | 62 | 12,688 | 1,609 | A | B | – | B | – | 2007–2025 | Catholic | CD&V |
| CD&V/N-VA[s] | Dutch | 2007–2024 | 4 | 2 | 294 | 46 | A | B | – | B | – | 2007–2021 | Catholic | CD&V |
| RSCL | French | 1954–1958 | 1 | 1 | 26 | 6 | A | B | – | B | – | never | Catholic | Les Engagés |
| CVP-PSC | French | 1968–1971 | 1 | 19 | 1,378 | 284 | A | B | – | B | – | 1968–1971 | Catholic | Les Engagés |
| PSC | French | 1971–2003 | 10 | 70 | 15,512 | 2,056 | A | B | – | B | – | 1971–1999 | Catholic | Les Engagés |
| cdH[r] | French | 2003–2024 | 6 | 29 | 7,246 | 1,106 | A | B | – | B | – | 2007–2014 | Catholic | Les Engagés |
| Les Engagés | French | 2024–2025 | 1 | 18 | 467 | 69 | A | B | – | B | – | 2025 | Catholic | Les Engagés |
| *Liberal* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Liberaal[r] | national | 1831–1946 | 33 | 488 | 350,431 | 28,123 | B | B | B | A | A, B | 1831–1846, 1847–1870, 1878–1884, 1918–1925, 1925–1939, 1939–1946 | Liberal | Open VLD, MR |
| LP | national | 1946–1965 | 6 | 50 | 24,567 | 2,372 | B | B | B | A | A, B | 1946, 1946–1947, 1949–1950, 1954–1958, 1958–1961 | Liberal | Open VLD, MR |
| PVV-PLP | national | 1965–1971 | 2 | 54 | 6,334 | 908 | B | B | B | A | A, B 1965–1968; ext. A, B 1968–1971 | 1966–1968 | Liberal | Open VLD, MR |
| PVV[r] | Dutch | 1971–1995 | 11 | 65 | 17,027 | 2,174 | B | B | B | A | ext. A 1971–1974 | 1973–1977, 1980, 1981–1988 | Liberal | Open VLD |
| VLD[r] | Dutch | 1995–2007 | 6 | 49 | 8,595 | 1,078 | B | B | B | A | – | 1999–2007 | Liberal | Open VLD |
| Open Vld[r] | Dutch | 2007–2025 | 6 | 44 | 7,526 | 1,069 | B | B | B | A | – | 2007–2025 | Liberal | Open VLD |
| PLP[r] | French | 1971–1977 | 3 | 17 | 1,340 | 205 | B | B | B | A | ext. B 1971–1974 | 1973–1977 | Liberal | MR |
| PLDP | French | 1974–1977 | 1 | 3 | 613 | 63 | B | B | B | A | – | 1974–1977 | Liberal | MR |
| PL | French | 1977–1981 | 2 | 2 | 516 | 71 | B | B | B | A | – | 1977, 1980 | Liberal | MR |

**Table B2:** Party labels, families and groups in each comparison (continued)

| Party label | Community | Years | Leg. | Speakers | Speeches | Words (000s) | Side in the comparison: Rel. | L–O | L–R | R–O | Flemish–Walloon | Years in government | Multiparty family | Party of 2024 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| PRLW[r] | French | 1977–1981 | 3 | 16 | 3,961 | 426 | B | B | B | A | – | 1977, 1980 | Liberal | MR |
| PRL[r] | French | 1981–2003 | 7 | 58 | 13,953 | 2,079 | B | B | B | A | – | 1981–1988, 1999–2003 | Liberal | MR |
| PRL-FDF-MCC[s] | French | 1995–2003 | 2 | 4 | 79 | 19 | B | B | B | A | – | 1999–2001 | Liberal | MR |
| MCC | French | 1999–2003 | 1 | 2 | 92 | 15 | B | B | B | A | – | 1999–2003 | Liberal | MR |
| MR | French | 2003–2025 | 6 | 70 | 9,519 | 1,497 | B | B | B | A | – | 2003–2025 | Liberal | MR |
| *Socialist* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Socialist[r] | national | 1894–1946 | 14 | 176 | 285,158 | 14,108 | B | A | A | B | A, B | 1918–1921, 1925–1927, 1935–1939, 1939–1946 | Socialist | Vooruit, PS |
| BSP-PSB[r] | national | 1946–1971 | 9 | 164 | 83,210 | 6,698 | B | A | A | B | A, B 1946–1968; ext. A, B 1968–1971 | 1946–1949, 1954–1958, 1961–1966, 1968–1971 | Socialist | Vooruit, PS |
| BSP | national | 1971–1978 | 3 | 49 | 7,922 | 808 | B | A | A | B | ext. A 1971–1978 | 1971–1974, 1977–1978 | Socialist | Vooruit, PS |
| BSP-Rode Leeuwen | national | 1971–1974 | 1 | 1 | 13 | 5 | B | A | A | B | – | 1971–1974 | Socialist | Vooruit, PS |
| PSB[r] | national | 1971–1978 | 5 | 48 | 8,548 | 1,238 | B | A | A | B | ext. B 1971–1978 | 1971–1974, 1977–1978 | Socialist | Vooruit, PS |
| BSP[r] | Dutch | 1978–1981 | 2 | 26 | 2,530 | 398 | B | A | A | B | – | 1979–1981 | Socialist | Vooruit |
| SP[r] | Dutch | 1981–2003 | 9 | 75 | 19,627 | 2,389 | B | A | A | B | – | 1981, 1988–2003 | Socialist | Vooruit |
| Spirit | Dutch | 2003–2007 | 1 | 7 | 457 | 60 | B | A | A | B | – | 2003–2007 | Socialist | Vooruit |
| sp.a[r] | Dutch | 2003–2024 | 6 | 45 | 8,103 | 965 | B | A | A | B | – | 2003–2007, 2011–2014, 2020–2024 | Socialist | Vooruit |
| sp.a-Spirit[s] | Dutch | 2003–2010 | 2 | 7 | 666 | 80 | B | A | A | B | – | 2003–2007 | Socialist | Vooruit |
| Vooruit | Dutch | 2024–2025 | 1 | 15 | 422 | 43 | B | A | A | B | – | 2024–2025 | Socialist | Vooruit |
| PS | French | 1978–2025 | 13 | 161 | 29,202 | 3,891 | B | A | A | B | – | 1979–1981, 1988–2014, 2020–2025 | Socialist | PS |
| *Communist and radical left* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Communist[r] | national | 1925–1946 | 6 | 14 | 12,530 | 920 | B | A | A | B | B | 1944, 1945–1946 | Communist | PVDA-PTB |
| KPB-PCB | national | 1946–1985 | 13 | 33 | 19,826 | 2,415 | B | A | A | B | A, B 1946–1968 | 1946, 1946–1947 | Communist | PVDA-PTB |
| UGS | national | 1965–1968 | 1 | 1 | 135 | 26 | B | A | A | B | – | never | Communist | PVDA-PTB |
| PTB-go! | national | 2014–2019 | 1 | 2 | 1,270 | 175 | B | A | A | B | – | never | Communist | PVDA-PTB |
| PVDA/PTB | national | 2019–2025 | 2 | 21 | 3,714 | 566 | B | A | A | B | – | never | Communist | PVDA-PTB |

**Table B2:** Party labels, families and groups in each comparison (continued)

| Party label | Community | Years | Leg. | Speakers | Speeches | Words (000s) | Side in the comparison: Rel. | L–O | L–R | R–O | Flemish–Walloon | Years in government | Multiparty family | Party of 2024 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Flemish nationalist, except N-VA* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Vlaams-nationalist | Dutch | 1919–1946 | 7 | 29 | 15,453 | 1,089 | B | B | – | B | A 1919–1940 | never | Flemish nationalist | N-VA |
| VNV | Dutch | 1939–1946 | 1 | 2 | 312 | 27 | B | B | – | B | A 1939–1940 | never | Flemish nationalist | N-VA |
| CVV | Dutch | 1954–1958 | 1 | 1 | 112 | 15 | B | B | – | B | A 1956–1958 | never | Flemish nationalist | N-VA |
| Volksunie | Dutch | 1958–1999 | 13 | 58 | 26,445 | 3,730 | B | B | – | B | A 1961–1968 | 1977–1979, 1988–1991 | Flemish nationalist | N-VA |
| VU-ID | Dutch | 1999–2003 | 1 | 7 | 1,783 | 252 | B | B | – | B | – | never | Flemish nationalist | N-VA |
| *Flemish nationalist: N-VA* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| N-VA | Dutch | 2003–2025 | 6 | 76 | 11,686 | 1,734 | B | B | B | A | – | 2014–2018, 2025 | Flemish nationalist | N-VA |
| *Populist radical right* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Rexist | national | 1936–1946 | 2 | 22 | 2,700 | 189 | B | B | B | A | A, B | never | Radical right | Vlaams Belang |
| Vlaams Blok | Dutch | 1978–2007 | 8 | 33 | 7,861 | 1,113 | B | B | B | A | – | never | Radical right | Vlaams Belang |
| Vlaams Belang$^{r}$ | Dutch | 2007–2025 | 6 | 48 | 6,863 | 1,180 | B | B | B | A | – | never | Radical right | Vlaams Belang |
| Front National | French | 1991–2010 | 5 | 5 | 454 | 67 | B | B | B | A | – | never | Radical right | – |
| Parti Populaire | French | 2010–2019 | 2 | 2 | 571 | 74 | B | B | B | A | – | never | Radical right | – |
| *Francophone regionalist* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| FDF | French | 1965–1987, 1995–2003, 2010–2019 | 12 | 24 | 9,301 | 1,560 | B | B | – | B | – | 1977–1980 | Francophone regionalist | DéFI |
| Front Wallon | French | 1965–1968 | 1 | 1 | 226 | 34 | B | B | – | B | B | never | Francophone regionalist | DéFI |
| PWT | French | 1965–1968 | 1 | 1 | 319 | 34 | B | B | – | B | B | never | Francophone regionalist | DéFI |
| RW | French | 1968–1985 | 6 | 20 | 5,102 | 640 | B | B | – | B | – | 1974–1977 | Francophone regionalist | DéFI |
| FDF/PPW | French | 1988–1995 | 2 | 5 | 863 | 196 | B | B | – | B | – | never | Francophone regionalist | DéFI |

**Table B2:** Party labels, families and groups in each comparison (continued)

| Party label | Community | Years | Leg. | Speakers | Speeches | Words (000s) | Side in the comparison: Rel. | L–O | L–R | R–O | Flemish–Walloon | Years in government | Multiparty family | Party of 2024 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| DéFI | French | 2019–2025 | 2 | 2 | 1,012 | 222 | B | B | – | B | – | never | Francophone regionalist | DéFI |
| *Green* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Agalev | Dutch | 1981–2003 | 6 | 24 | 4,788 | 758 | B | B | –[a] | B | – | 1999–2003 | Green | Groen |
| Groen! | Dutch | 2007–2014 | 2 | 6 | 1,526 | 260 | B | B | –[a] | B | – | never | Green | Groen |
| Groen | Dutch | 2014–2025 | 3 | 15 | 2,869 | 406 | B | B | –[a] | B | – | 2020–2025 | Green | Groen |
| Ecolo | French | 1981–2025 | 12 | 49 | 8,721 | 1,423 | B | B | –[a] | B | – | 1999–2003, 2020–2025 | Green | Ecolo |
| Ecolo-Agalev[s] | Dutch, French | 1991–2003 | 3 | 8 | 966 | 166 | B | B | –[a] | B | – | 1999–2003 | Green | Groen, Ecolo |
| Ecolo-Groen[s] | Dutch, French | 2007–2025 | 5 | 13 | 1,358 | 221 | B | B | –[a] | B | – | 2020–2025 | Green | Groen, Ecolo |
| *Other parties and independents* | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Middenstanders | national | 1919–1921 | 1 | 1 | 19 | 2 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |
| Oud-strijders | national | 1919–1925, 1939–1946 | 3 | 3 | 1,027 | 81 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |
| Renaissance nationale | national | 1919–1921 | 1 | 1 | 47 | 2 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |
| Onafhankelijk | national | 1929–1932, 2019–2025 | 3 | 2 | 484 | 56 | B | B | – | B | A 1929–1932 | never | – | – |
| Onafhankelijke | national | 1932–1939, 1988–1991 | 3 | 2 | 211 | 33 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |
| Technocraat | national | 1939–1946 | 1 | 1 | 122 | 11 | B | B | – | B | A | never | – | – |
| UDB | national | 1946–1949 | 1 | 1 | 38 | 2 | B | B | – | B | B | 1946 | – | – |
| PSI | national | 1961–1965 | 1 | 1 | 85 | 8 | B | B | – | B | B | never | – | – |
| RN | national | 1961–1965 | 1 | 1 | 96 | 31 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |
| UDRT-RAD | national | 1978–1987 | 3 | 3 | 660 | 110 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |
| ROSSEM | Dutch | 1991–1995 | 1 | 3 | 165 | 19 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |
| LDD | Dutch | 2007–2014 | 2 | 6 | 949 | 126 | B | B | – | B | – | never | – | – |

*Notes*: One row per party label as it appears in the register of members (78 rows), by family. Community: *national* before the family's split; *Dutch* and *French*, parties of one language community, after the split or from their foundation. Years: first and last year in which a member with the label sits in the Chamber; Leg.: legislatures. Speakers, speeches and words

come from the 14,487 speaker-periods of the analysis; the 84 without a family are not in the table, which counts 1,725,057 speeches and 146.3 million words. A family groups parties over time for comparison; it does not imply organizational continuity. A and B: the two sides of each comparison; –: left out of the comparison. Rel.: Catholic family against all other parties; L–O: Socialist and Communist families against all other parties; L–R: the left against the Liberal family, the populist radical right and N-VA ([a]: in a variant, the Greens join the left); R–O: the right against all other parties; Flemish–Walloon: members elected in Flemish (A) and in Walloon (B) districts, before the split, and in the extended series (ext.) the families not yet split. Government and opposition are defined by government status, not by family (Table B3). Multiparty family: the family in the multiparty index (Section 5.5). Party of 2024: the party elected in 2024 to which the label leads, as a grouping. Members whose party is unknown (341 of 16,793 member-periods) are left out of every comparison. [r] Residual uses, counted in the row: speakers who carry the label in a legislature in which most speakers of its lineage carry another name (legislature, speakers): Katholiek: 1946–1949 (1); CVP-PSC (Dutch): 1971–1974 (1); CD&V: 1999–2003 (1); cdH: 2024–2025 (1); Liberaal: 1946–1949 (2); PVV: 1999–2003 (1), 2003–2007 (1), 2007–2010 (1); VLD: 1991–1995 (2), 2007–2010 (2), 2010–2014 (1); Open Vld: 2003–2007 (1); PLP: 1977–1978 (1); PRLW: 1981–1985 (1); PRL: 2003–2007 (2); Socialist: 1946–1949 (5); BSP-PSB: 1971–1974 (1); PSB (national): 1978–1981 (2), 1981–1985 (1), speakers of the French community; BSP (Dutch): 1981–1985 (3); SP: 2003–2007 (2), 2019–2024 (1), 2024–2025 (1); sp.a: 1999–2003 (1); Communist: 1946–1949 (1); Vlaams Belang: 2003–2007 (1). [s] Label printed in the speeches, for members listed without a party in the register in that year: CD&V/N-VA, Ecolo-Agalev, Ecolo-Groen, PRL-FDF-MCC, sp.a-Spirit. Printed variants of a register label are counted with it: FDF-PPW with FDF/PPW; FN with Front National; PVDA-PTB with PVDA/PTB; VB with Vlaams Belang; VL.BLOK with Vlaams Blok; VLAAMS BLOK with Vlaams Blok. Produced by `code/python/27_paper_extras.py`.

**Table B3:** Parties in government, 1831–2025

| First sitting | Last sitting | Sittings | Parties in government | Periods |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14.09.1831 | 06.04.1840 | 474 | Catholic, Liberal | 1831–1833 to 1839–1841 |
| 24.04.1840 | 17.03.1841 | 20 | Liberal | 1839–1841 |
| 16.11.1841 | 25.03.1846 | 412 | Catholic, Liberal | 1841–1843 to 1845–1848 |
| 20.04.1846 | 10.05.1847 | 192 | Catholic | 1845–1848 |
| 10.11.1847 | 28.03.1855 | 1002 | Liberal | 1845–1848 to 1854–1856 |
| 24.04.1855 | 28.05.1857 | 264 | Catholic, Liberal | 1854–1856 to 1856–1857 |
| 15.12.1857 | 13.05.1870 | 1383 | Liberal | 1857–1859 to 1868–1870 |
| 09.08.1870 | 24.05.1878 | 828 | Catholic | 1870–1872 to 1876–1878 |
| 24.07.1878 | 17.05.1884 | 604 | Liberal | 1878–1880 to 1882–1884 |
| 22.07.1884 | 04.08.1914 | 3427 | Catholic | 1882–1884 to 1912–1914 |
| 28.11.1918 | 21.10.1921 | 287 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist | 1918–1919 to 1919–1921 |
| 06.12.1921 | 12.05.1925 | 354 | Catholic, Liberal | 1921–1923 to 1925–1927 |
| 19.05.1925 | 22.05.1925 | 3 | Catholic | 1925–1927 |
| 23.06.1925 | 15.11.1927 | 215 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist | 1925–1927 to 1927–1929 |
| 29.11.1927 | 14.03.1935 | 638 | Catholic, Liberal | 1927–1929 to 1934–1936 |
| 29.03.1935 | 22.02.1939 | 288 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist | 1934–1936 to 1936–1939 |
| 23.02.1939 | 13.04.1939 | 4 | Catholic, Socialist | 1936–1939 to 1939–1940 |
| 18.04.1939 | 18.04.1939 | 1 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist | 1939–1940 |
| 21.04.1939 | 30.06.1939 | 27 | Catholic, Liberal | 1939–1940 |
| 05.09.1939 | 20.09.1944 | 56 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist | 1939–1940 to 1944–1946 |
| 03.10.1944 | 14.11.1944 | 4 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist, Communist | 1944–1946 |
| 21.11.1944 | 07.02.1945 | 8 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist | 1944–1946 |
| 14.02.1945 | 26.07.1945 | 26 | Catholic, Liberal, Socialist, Communist | 1944–1946 |
| 07.08.1945 | 08.03.1946 | 45 | Liberal, Socialist, Communist, UDB | 1944–1946 to 1946–1947 |
| 19.03.1946 | 26.03.1946 | 3 | Socialist | 1946–1947 |
| 03.04.1946 | 11.03.1947 | 97 | Liberal, Socialist, Communist | 1946–1947 |
| 25.03.1947 | 26.07.1949 | 204 | Catholic, Socialist | 1946–1947 to 1949–1950 |
| 16.08.1949 | 09.03.1950 | 42 | Catholic, Liberal | 1949–1950 |
| 20.06.1950 | 12.03.1954 | 356 | Catholic | 1950–1952 to 1952–1954 |
| 27.04.1954 | 18.06.1958 | 314 | Liberal, Socialist | 1954–1956 to 1958–1961 |
| 01.07.1958 | 11.10.1958 | 9 | Catholic | 1958–1961 |
| 18.11.1958 | 18.04.1961 | 195 | Catholic, Liberal | 1958–1961 to 1961–1963 |
| 27.04.1961 | 08.02.1966 | 302 | Catholic, Socialist | 1961–1963 to 1965–1968 |
| 23.03.1966 | 28.02.1968 | 155 | Catholic, Liberal | 1965–1968 |
| 23.04.1968 | 23.04.1968 | 1 | CVP, PSC, Liberal | 1968–1969 |
| 25.06.1968 | 07.12.1972 | 325 | CVP, PSC, Socialist | 1968–1969 to 1971–1974 |
| 30.01.1973 | 17.01.1974 | 79 | CVP, PSC, Liberal, Socialist | 1971–1974 |
| 28.03.1974 | 28.03.1974 | 1 | CVP, PSC, PVV, PLP, Socialist | 1974–1977 |
| 30.04.1974 | 06.06.1974 | 14 | CVP, PSC, PVV, PLP | 1974–1977 |
| 12.06.1974 | 05.05.1977 | 235 | CVP, PSC, PVV, PLP/PRLW, RW | 1974–1977 to 1977–1978 |
| 07.06.1977 | 14.11.1978 | 93 | CVP, PSC, Socialist, Volksunie, FDF | 1977–1978 |
| 11.01.1979 | 03.04.1979 | 2 | CVP, PSC, BSP, PS, Volksunie, FDF | 1979–1981 |
| 05.04.1979 | 16.01.1980 | 48 | CVP, PSC, BSP/SP, PS, FDF | 1979–1981 |
| 17.01.1980 | 03.04.1980 | 23 | CVP, PSC, SP, PS | 1979–1981 |
| 20.05.1980 | 14.10.1980 | 32 | CVP, PSC, PVV, PRL, SP, PS | 1979–1981 |
| 24.10.1980 | 15.12.1981 | 69 | CVP, PSC, SP, PS | 1979–1981 to 1981–1983 |
| 18.12.1981 | 21.04.1988 | 365 | CVP, PSC, PVV, PRL | 1981–1983 to 1988–1989 |
| 10.05.1988 | 13.07.1991 | 170 | CVP, PSC, SP, PS, Volksunie | 1988–1989 to 1989–1991 |
| 02.10.1991 | 01.07.1999 | 413 | CVP, PSC, SP, PS | 1989–1991 to 1999–2001 |

**Table B3:** Parties in government, 1831–2025 (continued)

| First sitting | Last sitting | Sittings | Parties in government | Periods |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14.07.1999 | 08.04.2003 | 234 | VLD, PRL/MR, SP/sp.a, PS, Agalev, Ecolo | 1999–2001 to 2001–2003 |
| 05.06.2003 | 26.06.2003 | 2 | VLD, MR, sp.a, PS, Agalev | 2003–2005 |
| 14.07.2003 | 20.12.2007 | 182 | VLD/Open Vld, MR, sp.a, PS | 2003–2005 to 2007–2010 |
| 21.12.2007 | 21.12.2007 | 1 | CD&V, cdH, Open Vld, MR, sp.a, PS | 2007–2010 |
| 23.12.2007 | 01.12.2011 | 155 | CD&V, cdH, Open Vld, MR, PS | 2007–2010 to 2010–2012 |
| 07.12.2011 | 07.10.2014 | 126 | CD&V, cdH, Open Vld, MR, sp.a, PS | 2010–2012 to 2014–2016 |
| 14.10.2014 | 06.12.2018 | 202 | CD&V, Open Vld, MR, N-VA | 2014–2016 to 2016–2019 |
| 12.12.2018 | 24.09.2020 | 67 | CD&V, Open Vld, MR | 2016–2019 to 2019–2021 |
| 01.10.2020 | 30.01.2025 | 197 | CD&V, Open Vld, MR, sp.a/Vooruit, PS, Groen, Ecolo | 2019–2021 to 2024–2025 |
| 04.02.2025 | 18.12.2025 | 44 | CD&V, Les Engagés, MR, Vooruit, N-VA | 2024–2025 |

*Notes*: Spells of unchanged composition of the parties in government, by sitting day: a party is in government on a day if one of its members holds ministerial office. Before their family's split (Catholics 1968, Liberals 1972, Socialists 1978), parties are named by family; afterwards, by the name of each community's party, with both names when a party was renamed during the spell. Sittings: days with plenary sittings in the spell; periods: the periods of Section 3 that the spell covers. Produced by `code/python/27_paper_extras.py` from `output/data/government_units.csv`.

**Districts.** We map electoral districts to provinces and the three regions in `code/python/districts.py`, treating Brussels, Flemish Brabant and Walloon Brabant separately. The arrondissement of Brussels before 1995 and the constituency of Brussels-Halle-Vilvoorde are coded as Brussels.

**Groups of phrases.** School, Royal Question, language-policy and labour phrases are vocabulary phrases whose stems match the patterns in `code/python/08_dictionary.py`. Matches are listed in `output/phrases/`.

**Language of the speeches.** Each block starts from the dataset's language label. Before counting phrases, we cut each block at a line that introduces a translation (*Traduction :*, *Vertaling :*) and remove the roll-call formulas (*Début du vote*, *Résultat du vote*, *Uitslag van de stemming*, *Tout le monde a-t-il voté*). We relabel a block when it contains at least two function words of the other language and more than twice as many as of its labeled language, or at least one and none of its labeled language. Within a block, sentences that are clearly in the other language by the same rule are counted as speech in that language when they contain at least five words in all (`code/python/textproc.py`). Function words are, for example, *het*, *een*, *ik* and *mijnheer* for Dutch, and *le*, *que*, *dans* and *monsieur* for French. The lists leave out words that the two languages share, such as *de*, *en*, *je* and *pas*.

We check the remaining text in the other language by counting phrases containing its function words (`code/python/19_language_check.py`). The lists of this check also leave out words that occur in proper names, such as *van*, and the check misses other-language phrases without a function word. After the corrections, flagged phrases account for at most 0.25 per cent of French phrases in every period and, from 1919, for at most 0.21 per cent of Dutch phrases. Before 1919, Dutch counts are small: flagged phrases are one of the 38 Dutch phrases of 1892–1894 and at

most 0.12 per cent from 1894. The French vocabulary contains 16 flagged phrases and the Dutch vocabulary 8.

Three sources accounted for most text in the other language before the corrections. First, the record includes translated formulas. From the interwar years to the 1950s, these concern submission of reports and bills (*De heer X legt ter tafel het verslag over het wetsontwerp*; *sur le bureau de la Chambre le rapport*). From the 1990s, they also close interpellations (*het incident is gesloten*, *l'incident est clos*). Second, some speeches use both languages. Third, some speeches have the wrong language label.

The effect was largest when such text concentrated in one group. In an earlier estimation without the corrections, phrases with a Dutch function word accounted for 1.6–1.7 per cent of Catholics' French phrases in 1950–1954, compared with 0.2–0.4 per cent for Liberals and Socialists, and the shares reversed in 1954–1958. After 2010, many Flemish nationalist and Vlaams Belang speeches labeled French were Dutch, and French passages accounted for 41–50 per cent of Communist members' Dutch phrases in 1969–1981. After the corrections, flagged phrases account for at most 0.03 per cent of the French phrases of Catholics, Liberals, Socialists and Communists in 1950–1958, and for at most 0.1 per cent of Communist members' Dutch phrases in 1969–1981.

**Leave-out estimates without text in the other language.** The same script recomputes the three leave-out series without the phrases that contain a function word from the other language (`output/series/lo_without_other_language.csv`). In an earlier estimation without the corrections, these phrases accounted for 20 to 26 per cent of religious, left–others and government–opposition partisanship in 1949–1958 and raised several government–opposition estimates after 1995. With the corrections, they account for at most 3 per cent of net leave-out partisanship in 1949–1958 and change no estimate after 1995 by more than 0.0003. The largest changes are in 1965–1968 and 1974–1977, up to 0.0026.

**The language rule.** After the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families split, their members enter only their community's language estimation. From 1968, the rule also covers the parties associated with one community: Flemish nationalists, Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang, Francophone regionalists and the two Green parties (`code/python/designs.py`). Members of national parties, PVDA-PTB among them, enter both languages, as do all members before 1968. Flemish National League members, for example, did speak French in the 1930s.

Without the rule, the problem is larger in pairwise comparisons: a party represented in one language by a few mislabeled interventions can produce a component where the groups share almost no phrases. The pairs of the multiparty index (Section 5.5) are estimated with the rule: from 1968, pairs involving Flemish nationalists or the radical right have only a Dutch component, and pairs involving Francophone regionalists only a French one.

**Procedural text.** In 1993–1995 and 1997–2007, many speech blocks end with roll-call formulas: *Début du vote*, *Fin du vote*, *Résultat du vote*, and the Dutch equivalents *Begin van de stemming*, *Einde van de stemming*, *Uitslag van de stemming*. They concentrate among members speaking just before votes; in an earlier estimation, they reached 1,100–1,400 per 100,000 French phrases

of Christian-democratic members in 1999–2005. We remove them before counting phrases. Other text of the voting procedure is not removed: the vote tallies printed in both languages (*oui nee*, *abstentions totaal*) and the formula that applies the result of a previous vote (*uitslag vorige*, *stemming gelden*) are among the most partisan phrases of some lists, mostly Dutch lists of 1988–2010 (Online Appendix C).

**Tables and companion modules.** `code/python/20_main_tables.py` produces Tables 1 and 2 from the estimated series. `code/python/27_paper_extras.py` produces Tables B2, B3 and 3, Figures 3 and 7, and the macros in `tables/extras_macros.tex`. It reads `output/data`, the left–right and right–others series in `output/series` (including their leave-out series) and the party comparisons in `output/dyads`. The emotions module's run of 12 October 2026 supplies the data for Figures 13, 14 and 15, and Section 7 (`code/emotions`; Online Appendix E). `code/python/21_emotions_link.py` reads these outputs and draws the figures. It writes decade correlations to `output/series/emotions_corr.csv` and text macros to `tables/emotions_macros.tex`.

`code/python/22_economy.py` supplies Figure 10 and the growth results in Section 5.9. It reads the Maddison Project Database (`external/mpd2023_web.xlsx`), writes correlations and slopes to `output/series/economy_corr.csv`, and writes text macros to `tables/economy_macros.tex`.

The topic module (`code/topics`) labels every speech; its labels are in `topics/step5/topics.csv`. `code/python/23_topic_areas.py` estimates the series of Section 6 by topic and policy area, for periods and legislatures, with the random-label series, and writes them to `output/series/topic_partisanship.csv`. `code/python/26_topic_figures.py` draws Figure 12, writes Table 6, and writes text macros to `tables/topic_macros.tex`.

**Token files.** Token files for all 91 periods supply the very-long-speech counts from 1850 in Figure 19, panel b (`code/python/14_stata_inputs.py`), and the out-of-lexicon rates in Figure A21, panel b (`code/python/10_ocr_noise.py`).

## Online Appendix C: Most partisan phrases

The tables list each group's five most partisan phrases by $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker in each group, following Gentzkow et al. (2019). Religious, left–others and government–opposition comparisons cover, for French and for Dutch, every period in which that language's estimate is defined, with one table per decade. The Flemish–Walloon comparison uses French speech; Table C94 selects one period every ten years, and Tables C95–C108 list every period. Phrases are stemmed bigrams displayed in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out phrases without content (Online Appendix B), so the lists contain few formulas for submitting bills and reports, titles, or names of parties and persons. Some remain, such as *honneur proposer*, *général chazal* and *liberale groep*, as do some pairs of common words, such as *non seulement*. A list contains only phrases that favour its group, so some lists, mostly Dutch lists before 1914, contain fewer than five phrases, and a few are empty. Where a group lacks strongly partisan phrases, its list contains phrases with nearly equal predicted counts, as for both groups in 1831–1833 and in several Dutch lists before 1914. Some phrases are text in the other language or text of the voting procedure (Online Appendix B). Counts in this appendix cover all printed lists, including periods with low coverage of the sittings.

Tables C1–C20 (French) and C21–C33 (Dutch) show the religious comparison. Most phrases name subjects of legislation and debate. Education phrases appear from 1841–1843 to 1985–1987. They appear on both sides during the first school war (1878–1886). In 1950–1958, they are mostly Catholic phrases, both when the Catholics governed alone (1950–1954) and when they were in opposition during the second school war (1954–1958). *classe ouvrière* identifies other parties in 19 of 21 periods of 1894–1940. Catholic lists include family allowances (*allocations familiales*) in five periods from 1929 to 1958, the Congo in 1908–1912 and 1958–1963 (*comité spécial*, *union minière*, *force publique*), development aid in every period of 1961–1971 (*assistance technique*, *coopération développement*), the German-speaking community in most periods of 1971–1991 (*langue allemande*, *communauté germanophone*) and end-of-life care in 2001–2003 (*soins palliatifs*, *fin vie*). Other parties' lists include the Royal Question in 1949–1950 (*consultation populaire*, *question royale*) and the School Pact in 1958–1961 (*pacte scolaire*).

In Dutch, Catholic lists include large families (*kroostrijke gezinnen*) in every period from 1923–1925 to 1947–1949 except 1939–1940, technical education (*technisch onderwijs*) in every period from 1932–1934 to 1956–1958 except 1949–1950, and unborn life in 1989–1991 (*ongeboren leven*). Other parties' lists include veterans (*oud strijders*) in most periods between the wars, the Franco-Belgian military agreement (*fransch belgisch*, *militair akkoord*) in every period of 1925–1936, the Flemish people (*vlaamsche volk*) in every period of 1929–1940 and national education (*nationale opvoeding*) in six of the seven periods of 1961–1977. Record artefacts include headings of the printed reports in French lists of 1977–1993 (*annales parlementaires*, *belgique kamer*) and text of the voting procedure in Dutch lists. Three of the five Catholic phrases of 2001–2003 come from vote tallies printed in both languages (*oui nee*, *abstentions totaal*), and four of those of 2003–2005 from the formula that applies the result of a previous vote (*uitslag vorige*, *stemming gelden*).

The left–others lists appear in Tables C34–C47 and C48–C60. *classe ouvrière* identifies the French-speaking left in every period from 1894 to 1940. Before 1914 it appears alongside universal suffrage, the eight-hour day and labour courts (*prud hommes*); in 1932–1934, alongside

*pleins pouvoirs*. Social security and trade unions follow. In the federal era, the left's lists also include the index jump (*saut index*), pension age (*67 ans*) and tax havens (*paradis fiscaux*). Special powers (*pleins pouvoirs*, *pouvoirs spéciaux*) appear in the left's lists in 1932–1934, 1965–1968 and 1981–1987, mostly under governments without the Socialists, and in the other parties' lists in 1944–1947, 1956–1958, 1977–1978 and 1995–1997, when the Socialists governed. The other parties' lists include the middle classes (*classes moyennes*) in ten periods from 1934 to 1985 and the Congo in 1950–1954 and 1958–1961.

In Dutch, the left uses *werkende klas* in every period from 1919 to 1934 and in 14 of the 19 periods from 1902 to 1950; it returns in 2021–2025. In 2019–2025, the left's lists include *sterke overheid* in every period, *gewone mensen* in 2021–2024 and *werkende mensen* in 2024–2025, and the other parties' lists include guaranteed service (*gegarandeerde dienstverlening*) in every period from 2014–2016. Between the wars, the other parties' lists include veterans (*oud strijders*) in seven of ten periods. Record artefacts include Dutch text in French lists (*ik citeer* in 1969–1971 and *handelingen plenaire*, which heads the other parties' list of 1989–1991), headings of the reports in 1991–1995 (*représentants belgique*, *kamer volksvertegenwoordigers*), the French formula that closes interpellations in a Dutch list of 2014–2016 (*clos incident*) and the French pairing formula of votes in Dutch lists of 2005–2010 (*pairé avec*).

The government–opposition lists appear in Tables C61–C80 and C81–C93. Under governments formed by a single family, before 1914 and in 1950–1954, the French lists share most of their phrases with the religious lists, with the sides exchanged under Liberal governments. Special powers (*pleins pouvoirs*, *pouvoirs spéciaux*) are opposition phrases in 10 of the 11 French periods in which they appear. Several current issues identify the opposition: *suffrage universel* in 9 of the 10 periods in which it appears before 1914, *classe ouvrière* in every listed period from 1894–1896 to 1936–1939, the Royal Question in 1949–1950, *loi unique* in 1958–1963, and taxes in every period from 2007 to 2021 (*intérêts notionnels*, *fraude fiscale*, *tax shift*, *paradis fiscaux*). Governing members speak of the government agreement (*accord gouvernement*) in 2010–2016 and 2024–2025. Double forms such as *travailleurs travailleuses* and *celles ceux* are government phrases in 2021–2024 and opposition phrases in 2024–2025.

In Dutch, phrases of the Flemish movement (*vlaamsche volk*, *vlaamsche soldaten*) appear in the opposition's list in every listed period from 1921 to 1940, as does the Franco-Belgian military agreement in 1927–1936. From the 1960s, phrases on the Flemish community and its institutions (*vlaamse gemeenschap*, *vlaams parlement*, *halle vilvoorde*) are mostly opposition phrases, while governing members more often speak of Europe in 1981–2010 (*europese gemeenschap*, *europese unie*) and of the social partners (*sociale partners*) in most periods from 2001. Record artefacts include the vote tallies printed in both languages in the French opposition list of 2021–2024 (*oui nee*, *abstentions totaal*).

Table C94 suggests that regional economic interests often distinguish Flemish and Walloon members within the same families. Flemish lists include sugar and Ostend's port in 1839–1841; linen in 1848–1850; Ghent and West Flanders in 1888–1890; devastated regions in 1918–1919; the Congo in 1958–1961; and national product and public debt in 1965–1968. Walloon lists include the Société Générale in 1839–1841; the Charleroi canal and Meuse in 1859–1861; working hours and labour courts in 1908–1910; the national coal council in 1949–1950; and the Walloon

motorway in 1965–1968.

Language policy is absent from the periods of Table C94 apart from *pays flamand* in 1888–1890 and cultural councils in 1939–1940. In the full lists, it also appears on the Flemish side through *langue flamande* in 1856–1857 and 1861–1864, *pays flamand* in 1892–1894 and 1906–1908, Ghent's Flemish university in 1921–1923 and 1925–1927, and *problème linguistique* in 1961–1963, and on the Walloon side through *problème wallon* in 1944–1946.

**Table C1:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1830s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1831–1833* | | | | | |
| flandre orientale | 105 | 80 | pommes terre | 71 | 88 |
| province luxembourg | 4 | 4 | cour cassation | 405 | 405 |
| los renten | 5 | 5 | cour appel | 263 | 263 |
| grand duché | 6 | 6 | ville gand | 51 | 51 |
| maîtres forges | 11 | 11 | savoir si | 141 | 141 |
| *1833–1835* | | | | | |
| conseil communal | 266 | 139 | chemin fer | 139 | 276 |
| commissaire police | 124 | 34 | route fer | 62 | 103 |
| loi communale | 188 | 127 | cour comptes | 81 | 118 |
| pouvoir législatif | 107 | 52 | opinion projet | 6 | 28 |
| collège bourgmestre | 69 | 27 | péages canaux | 10 | 21 |
| *1835–1837* | | | | | |
| los renten | 461 | 65 | caisse épargne | 15 | 54 |
| ministres cultes | 100 | 25 | non activité | 23 | 59 |
| société générale | 88 | 42 | mines houille | 7 | 26 |
| chemin fer | 138 | 97 | plus voisin | 6 | 25 |
| substitut procureur | 56 | 15 | corps judiciaires | 18 | 35 |
| *1837–1839* | | | | | |
| sous officiers | 73 | 16 | chemin fer | 380 | 459 |
| état major | 66 | 14 | vote secret | 20 | 82 |
| sous armes | 51 | 13 | fils laine | 6 | 21 |
| réduction proposée | 40 | 11 | usages locaux | 13 | 24 |
| non activité | 33 | 7 | travaux publics | 226 | 226 |
| *1839–1841* | | | | | |
| société générale | 256 | 135 | sucre exotique | 105 | 185 |
| adjudication publique | 45 | 41 | tribunal commerce | 51 | 104 |
| chemin fer | 513 | 513 | chemins vicinaux | 49 | 73 |
| travaux publics | 266 | 266 | caisses prévoyance | 9 | 20 |
| plus grande | 145 | 144 | | | |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C2:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1840s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1841–1843* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 609 | 514 | écoles normales | 190 | 308 |
| sucre indigène | 139 | 50 | cours normaux | 25 | 80 |
| sucre exotique | 112 | 44 | écoles primaires | 78 | 121 |
| ministres cultes | 53 | 24 | loi communale | 74 | 104 |
| canalisation campine | 45 | 17 | conseil communal | 134 | 162 |
| *1843–1845* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 1089 | 694 | droits différentiels | 141 | 193 |
| bulletin officiel | 54 | 7 | pavillon national | 35 | 74 |
| cahier charges | 82 | 46 | cour comptes | 43 | 81 |
| juge paix | 103 | 69 | pavillon étranger | 26 | 60 |
| st trond | 56 | 26 | droit sortie | 19 | 50 |
| *1845–1848* | | | | | |
| sucre indigène | 111 | 35 | chemin fer | 419 | 545 |
| sucre exotique | 86 | 29 | travaux publics | 308 | 425 |
| cour comptes | 152 | 110 | garde civique | 37 | 104 |
| dette flottante | 53 | 24 | conseil communal | 56 | 97 |
| tribunal commerce | 33 | 8 | ponts chaussées | 22 | 59 |
| *1848–1850* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 611 | 307 | garde civique | 49 | 84 |
| enseignement religieux | 131 | 49 | société générale | 23 | 57 |
| enseignement moyen | 159 | 86 | banque nationale | 18 | 45 |
| conseil mines | 89 | 28 | lettre voiture | 8 | 35 |
| canal charleroy | 93 | 42 | code pénal | 18 | 43 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C3:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1850s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1850–1852* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 828 | 606 | flandre occidentale | 23 | 70 |
| trésor public | 118 | 55 | code civil | 41 | 80 |
| droits différentiels | 99 | 43 | peine mort | 8 | 31 |
| travaux publics | 370 | 324 | code pénal | 19 | 41 |
| dépôts mendicité | 62 | 27 | cour comptes | 59 | 81 |
| *1852–1854* | | | | | |
| commissaire arrondissement | 78 | 24 | flandre occidentale | 41 | 97 |
| garde civique | 301 | 269 | demande concession | 30 | 48 |
| prohibition sortie | 50 | 19 | banque nationale | 13 | 27 |
| flandre orientale | 69 | 43 | écoles moyennes | 7 | 20 |
| chemins vicinaux | 63 | 39 | pommes terre | 32 | 44 |
| *1854–1856* | | | | | |
| libre sortie | 71 | 29 | chemin fer | 844 | 979 |
| prohibition sortie | 79 | 38 | travaux publics | 336 | 450 |
| fer fort | 45 | 7 | département travaux | 45 | 87 |
| honneur proposer | 77 | 41 | dendre waes | 40 | 82 |
| luttre denderleeuw | 94 | 58 | code pénal | 39 | 73 |
| *1856–1857* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 416 | 237 | examen écrit | 39 | 138 |
| civil élémentaire | 63 | 19 | personnification civile | 40 | 84 |
| travaux publics | 213 | 170 | administrateurs spéciaux | 149 | 176 |
| prohibition sortie | 74 | 31 | opinion libérale | 15 | 32 |
| universités etat | 119 | 79 | examen oral | 27 | 42 |
| *1857–1859* | | | | | |
| ministres cultes | 234 | 134 | prud hommes | 135 | 302 |
| critique censure | 115 | 29 | conseils prud | 80 | 224 |
| chemin fer | 394 | 331 | contrainte corps | 25 | 106 |
| administrateurs spéciaux | 63 | 17 | ville anvers | 59 | 103 |
| propose renvoi | 91 | 49 | enseignement obligatoire | 12 | 45 |
| *1859–1861* | | | | | |
| vol domestique | 130 | 24 | garde civique | 10 | 88 |
| passe port | 99 | 20 | bruxelles louvain | 43 | 85 |
| fonds communal | 147 | 83 | sucre betterave | 18 | 48 |
| cours légal | 85 | 44 | cour appel | 42 | 72 |
| communes octroi | 119 | 78 | cours certificat | 10 | 39 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C4:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1860s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1861–1864* | | | | | |
| ministres cultes | 83 | 35 | garde civique | 22 | 105 |
| loi 1842 | 73 | 34 | servitudes militaires | 27 | 102 |
| personnes civiles | 56 | 23 | citadelle nord | 21 | 67 |
| réforme communale | 37 | 7 | travaux publics | 245 | 273 |
| instruction primaire | 83 | 56 | ville anvers | 59 | 86 |
| *1864–1866* | | | | | |
| station intérieure | 55 | 9 | chemin fer | 441 | 522 |
| responsabilité ministérielle | 39 | 13 | écoles normales | 5 | 28 |
| loi communale | 65 | 39 | jonction directe | 4 | 26 |
| armée permanente | 56 | 30 | banque nationale | 17 | 38 |
| général chazal | 47 | 22 | centrale examiné | 10 | 28 |
| *1866–1868* | | | | | |
| conseil communal | 161 | 94 | écoles adultes | 77 | 150 |
| communal enghien | 56 | 9 | loi 1842 | 98 | 168 |
| suffrage universel | 145 | 113 | enseignement primaire | 49 | 93 |
| peine mort | 148 | 125 | cour assises | 38 | 77 |
| corps électoral | 86 | 63 | code pénal | 89 | 125 |
| *1868–1870* | | | | | |
| listes électorales | 100 | 41 | sociétés coopératives | 4 | 76 |
| conseil communal | 109 | 75 | assemblée générale | 42 | 97 |
| service militaire | 90 | 56 | sociétés anonymes | 85 | 137 |
| visites domiciliaires | 50 | 19 | écoles normales | 11 | 57 |
| police judiciaire | 35 | 9 | travail enfants | 3 | 32 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C5:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1870s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1870–1872* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 807 | 599 | écoles moyennes | 101 | 189 |
| bassins houillers | 245 | 159 | banque nationale | 71 | 148 |
| compagnie bassins | 101 | 28 | enseignement primaire | 85 | 131 |
| arrondissement charleroi | 37 | 7 | suffrage universel | 32 | 77 |
| conseil communal | 121 | 96 | écoles communales | 22 | 64 |
| *1872–1874* | | | | | |
| juge instruction | 80 | 28 | écoles moyennes | 52 | 187 |
| partie civile | 70 | 28 | servitudes militaires | 48 | 151 |
| détention préventive | 62 | 29 | ville anvers | 88 | 129 |
| compagnie bassins | 41 | 8 | flandre occidentale | 39 | 78 |
| code instruction | 55 | 24 | sociétés coopératives | 17 | 54 |
| *1874–1876* | | | | | |
| juge paix | 128 | 51 | garde civique | 77 | 280 |
| peine mort | 49 | 5 | chambre commerce | 177 | 305 |
| code pénal | 50 | 14 | chemin fer | 476 | 587 |
| caisses prévoyance | 40 | 9 | travaux publics | 306 | 359 |
| loi ventôse | 54 | 25 | commerce ostende | 2 | 31 |
| *1876–1878* | | | | | |
| cours eau | 188 | 137 | écoles moyennes | 35 | 124 |
| bassins houillers | 66 | 22 | port ostende | 9 | 58 |
| code civil | 83 | 48 | écoles normales | 22 | 67 |
| lit cours | 29 | 5 | chevaux mixtes | 27 | 70 |
| question propriété | 29 | 7 | ville gand | 14 | 46 |
| *1878–1880* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 279 | 119 | chemin fer | 349 | 455 |
| corps électoral | 117 | 42 | écoles communales | 81 | 133 |
| valeur locative | 76 | 18 | marques fabrique | 19 | 50 |
| enseignement libre | 80 | 28 | département travaux | 35 | 64 |
| contribution personnelle | 60 | 18 | voies navigables | 26 | 52 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C6:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1880s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1880–1882* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 210 | 92 | chemin fer | 304 | 397 |
| cardinal nina | 83 | 9 | écoles communales | 54 | 118 |
| conseil communal | 196 | 124 | droit pêche | 21 | 74 |
| ministres cultes | 117 | 52 | cours eau | 68 | 94 |
| corps électoral | 99 | 52 | travaux publics | 251 | 277 |
| *1882–1884* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 285 | 102 | suffrage universel | 38 | 74 |
| général major | 61 | 13 | droit électoral | 35 | 68 |
| conseil communal | 116 | 73 | carte géologique | 14 | 37 |
| major gratry | 52 | 12 | eaux vie | 17 | 37 |
| députation permanente | 157 | 126 | écoles moyennes | 57 | 77 |
| *1884–1886* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 312 | 212 | écoles communales | 168 | 389 |
| droit auteur | 129 | 37 | pères famille | 96 | 191 |
| cuve matière | 58 | 3 | écoles adoptées | 107 | 181 |
| écoles moyennes | 60 | 32 | instruction publique | 93 | 160 |
| oeuvres littéraires | 31 | 5 | conseil communal | 150 | 206 |
| *1886–1888* | | | | | |
| concordat préventif | 68 | 9 | écoles communales | 79 | 194 |
| procureur général | 71 | 28 | conseil communal | 115 | 166 |
| tabac indigène | 36 | 4 | écoles adoptées | 47 | 89 |
| juge instruction | 53 | 23 | pères famille | 42 | 83 |
| partie civile | 45 | 21 | général major | 12 | 49 |
| *1888–1890* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 400 | 299 | sûreté publique | 21 | 105 |
| prud hommes | 245 | 161 | agents provocateurs | 4 | 51 |
| conseils prud | 172 | 106 | ville gand | 17 | 63 |
| pays flamand | 90 | 46 | écoles spéciales | 63 | 103 |
| programme candidature | 23 | 3 | conseil communal | 44 | 82 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C7:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1890s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1890–1892* | | | | | |
| fonds communes | 117 | 44 | lieutenant général | 29 | 105 |
| dépôts mendicité | 42 | 13 | traitement attente | 71 | 145 |
| service hospitalier | 32 | 5 | conseil communal | 58 | 124 |
| conseil supérieur | 47 | 20 | suffrage universel | 72 | 128 |
| loi 1876 | 52 | 26 | service personnel | 48 | 98 |
| *1892–1894* | | | | | |
| représentation proportionnelle | 199 | 117 | suffrage universel | 176 | 310 |
| juge paix | 63 | 23 | chemin fer | 267 | 383 |
| minimum salaire | 37 | 7 | droit électoral | 67 | 129 |
| traverses métalliques | 35 | 6 | députation permanente | 56 | 107 |
| deux langues | 32 | 5 | loi électorale | 77 | 117 |
| *1894–1896* | | | | | |
| droit licence | 90 | 15 | conseil communal | 65 | 178 |
| chemin fer | 405 | 339 | suffrage universel | 43 | 126 |
| droit accise | 77 | 35 | classe ouvrière | 67 | 145 |
| id id | 42 | 2 | députation permanente | 52 | 99 |
| tabac indigène | 49 | 12 | loi scolaire | 11 | 52 |
| *1896–1898* | | | | | |
| garde civique | 251 | 173 | classe ouvrière | 44 | 149 |
| unions professionnelles | 278 | 221 | suffrage universel | 28 | 92 |
| pourrait être | 106 | 81 | représentation proportionnelle | 43 | 77 |
| faire commerce | 41 | 17 | vote plural | 9 | 32 |
| sociétés secours | 70 | 48 | service personnel | 54 | 74 |
| *1898–1900* | | | | | |
| juge paix | 106 | 43 | banque nationale | 137 | 358 |
| chemin fer | 308 | 270 | classe ouvrière | 37 | 132 |
| fer vicinaux | 58 | 25 | tramways bruxellois | 32 | 118 |
| cour militaire | 41 | 9 | suffrage universel | 52 | 130 |
| conseil guerre | 89 | 61 | conseil communal | 48 | 96 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C8:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1900–1902* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 405 | 282 | suffrage universel | 225 | 372 |
| jeux hasard | 118 | 29 | classe ouvrière | 40 | 120 |
| cercles privés | 83 | 27 | représentation proportionnelle | 65 | 129 |
| maisons jeux | 79 | 24 | conseil communal | 90 | 144 |
| gare centrale | 65 | 23 | vote plural | 50 | 95 |
| *1902–1904* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 519 | 329 | classe ouvrière | 49 | 132 |
| chef entreprise | 64 | 19 | lieutenant général | 31 | 96 |
| faute lourde | 75 | 35 | conseil communal | 66 | 120 |
| assurance obligatoire | 100 | 68 | heures travail | 16 | 38 |
| droit proportionnel | 35 | 5 | conseils prud | 16 | 37 |
| *1904–1906* | | | | | |
| repos dominical | 94 | 55 | lieutenant général | 91 | 173 |
| ligne défense | 42 | 11 | classe ouvrière | 42 | 110 |
| société belge | 44 | 15 | navire école | 26 | 69 |
| droit patente | 42 | 15 | chemin fer | 299 | 340 |
| code civil | 87 | 61 | heures travail | 37 | 65 |
| *1906–1908* | | | | | |
| langue flamande | 107 | 52 | classe ouvrière | 28 | 110 |
| pays flamand | 72 | 45 | lieutenant général | 19 | 95 |
| flamande pays | 45 | 22 | conseil communal | 59 | 98 |
| domaine national | 37 | 15 | heures travail | 50 | 85 |
| enseignement flamand | 42 | 21 | fer postes | 39 | 68 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| comité spécial | 113 | 29 | chemin fer | 333 | 420 |
| loi 1902 | 84 | 23 | classe ouvrière | 35 | 105 |
| temps service | 93 | 50 | fer postes | 34 | 93 |
| effectif paix | 70 | 36 | écoles normales | 40 | 94 |
| union minière | 48 | 18 | postes télégraphes | 37 | 90 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C9:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1910–1912* | | | | | |
| caisses prévoyance | 148 | 40 | classe ouvrière | 48 | 156 |
| chemin fer | 464 | 381 | lieutenant général | 19 | 109 |
| comité spécial | 47 | 8 | conseil communal | 60 | 127 |
| caisse retraite | 68 | 32 | députation permanente | 65 | 103 |
| gouverneur général | 52 | 21 | chef cabinet | 23 | 60 |
| *1912–1914* | | | | | |
| assemblée générale | 45 | 17 | classe ouvrière | 46 | 159 |
| sous officiers | 37 | 14 | écoles communales | 87 | 200 |
| habitations bon | 40 | 18 | écoles adoptées | 99 | 157 |
| société nationale | 75 | 56 | suffrage universel | 75 | 125 |
| examiné projet | 27 | 8 | loi scolaire | 38 | 84 |
| *1918–1919* | | | | | |
| dommages guerre | 204 | 142 | classe ouvrière | 61 | 115 |
| oeuvre nationale | 43 | 8 | comité national | 50 | 93 |
| tribunaux dommages | 95 | 62 | avant guerre | 143 | 174 |
| écoles normales | 76 | 45 | chemin fer | 149 | 177 |
| orphelins guerre | 39 | 12 | pendant guerre | 159 | 179 |
| *1919–1921* | | | | | |
| administration centrale | 46 | 16 | classe ouvrière | 93 | 190 |
| victimes civiles | 35 | 10 | temps service | 19 | 68 |
| deux langues | 46 | 23 | avant guerre | 155 | 202 |
| partie flamande | 29 | 9 | huit heures | 37 | 83 |
| traité versailles | 43 | 24 | pendant guerre | 118 | 148 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C10:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1921–1923* | | | | | |
| gardes champêtres | 157 | 54 | chemin fer | 260 | 339 |
| pays flamand | 70 | 31 | écoles normales | 34 | 84 |
| extrême gauche | 83 | 49 | écoles moyennes | 19 | 46 |
| police rurale | 45 | 13 | classe ouvrière | 83 | 108 |
| locataire principal | 32 | 11 | avant guerre | 136 | 158 |
| *1923–1925* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 266 | 228 | dommages guerre | 43 | 98 |
| sous officiers | 44 | 7 | service sauvetage | 7 | 52 |
| examiné projet | 46 | 20 | classe ouvrière | 35 | 70 |
| prix maxima | 48 | 23 | droits spécifiques | 13 | 49 |
| tarif minimum | 37 | 13 | ad valorem | 6 | 38 |
| *1925–1927* | | | | | |
| neuf ans | 85 | 35 | chemin fer | 275 | 369 |
| code civil | 63 | 16 | classe ouvrière | 47 | 135 |
| familles nombreuses | 61 | 31 | avant guerre | 84 | 149 |
| partie immeuble | 35 | 5 | huit heures | 35 | 91 |
| prud hommes | 66 | 36 | coût vie | 18 | 48 |
| *1927–1929* | | | | | |
| prud hommes | 78 | 36 | défense nationale | 106 | 189 |
| conseil supérieur | 73 | 31 | classe ouvrière | 49 | 106 |
| conseils prud | 74 | 32 | avant guerre | 85 | 128 |
| ville anvers | 48 | 9 | personnel enseignant | 24 | 66 |
| prison école | 64 | 29 | service militaire | 18 | 46 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| pensions vieillesse | 95 | 56 | société nationale | 114 | 166 |
| allocations familiales | 73 | 41 | classe ouvrière | 75 | 127 |
| main oeuvre | 82 | 52 | sciences arts | 61 | 102 |
| produits agricoles | 41 | 14 | écoles moyennes | 19 | 56 |
| responsabilité limitée | 31 | 5 | écoles communales | 19 | 47 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C11:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1932–1934* | | | | | |
| allocations familiales | 141 | 65 | pleins pouvoirs | 40 | 154 |
| pensions vieillesse | 141 | 90 | classe ouvrière | 130 | 220 |
| caisse nationale | 73 | 29 | défense nationale | 68 | 144 |
| législation sociale | 58 | 20 | télégraphes téléphones | 32 | 78 |
| majoration gratuite | 42 | 6 | commerce intérieur | 25 | 67 |
| *1934–1936* | | | | | |
| gouverneur général | 53 | 2 | arrêtés lois | 56 | 130 |
| prix revient | 86 | 37 | classe ouvrière | 54 | 125 |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 117 | 79 | défense nationale | 99 | 165 |
| prix vente | 45 | 9 | société nationale | 149 | 205 |
| nombre députés | 53 | 20 | chemin fer | 182 | 230 |
| *1936–1939* | | | | | |
| taxe crise | 81 | 27 | non intervention | 20 | 42 |
| taxe professionnelle | 49 | 20 | nationalistes flamands | 14 | 35 |
| loi cadre | 36 | 11 | gouvernement espagnol | 4 | 24 |
| section législation | 34 | 10 | pommes terre | 26 | 44 |
| conseil mines | 25 | 3 | éducation physique | 14 | 29 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 157 | 80 | personnel enseignant | 26 | 69 |
| pommes terre | 85 | 18 | nationalistes flamands | 12 | 46 |
| assurance chômage | 53 | 18 | politique indépendance | 11 | 37 |
| allocations familiales | 91 | 58 | sous officiers | 25 | 48 |
| caisses chômage | 42 | 9 | politique étrangère | 12 | 25 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C12:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1944–1946* | | | | | |
| dommages guerre | 139 | 72 | prisonniers politiques | 103 | 196 |
| impôt exceptionnel | 72 | 7 | secours civil | 11 | 60 |
| impôt capital | 90 | 37 | personnel enseignant | 10 | 34 |
| emprunt forcé | 61 | 10 | nations unies | 36 | 55 |
| application impôt | 56 | 9 | sécurité sociale | 50 | 68 |
| *1946–1947* | | | | | |
| allocations familiales | 159 | 50 | assistance publique | 22 | 88 |
| sous officiers | 70 | 10 | prisonniers politiques | 80 | 131 |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 54 | 7 | personnel enseignant | 15 | 56 |
| banque nationale | 74 | 42 | collaboration économique | 23 | 42 |
| balance comptes | 38 | 7 | réparation intégrale | 29 | 46 |
| *1947–1949* | | | | | |
| juge paix | 117 | 34 | prisonniers politiques | 37 | 84 |
| banque nationale | 141 | 58 | organisations syndicales | 11 | 54 |
| neuf ans | 84 | 8 | classe ouvrière | 27 | 64 |
| arrêté loi | 100 | 28 | coût vie | 29 | 63 |
| conseil administration | 85 | 37 | mobilisation civile | 5 | 39 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| assurés libres | 73 | 17 | consultation populaire | 201 | 406 |
| travailleurs indépendants | 66 | 15 | question royale | 105 | 148 |
| conseil entreprise | 65 | 20 | stations épuration | 9 | 31 |
| pouvoirs représentants | 53 | 9 | sociétés habitations | 14 | 31 |
| central provincial | 45 | 8 | eaux usées | 27 | 43 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C13:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1950–1952* | | | | | |
| reviseurs entreprises | 46 | 14 | personnel enseignant | 24 | 96 |
| experts comptables | 42 | 10 | quatre mois | 29 | 93 |
| fonds communes | 56 | 25 | classe ouvrière | 26 | 86 |
| enseignement public | 62 | 32 | coût vie | 43 | 94 |
| plan décennal | 47 | 19 | etats unis | 64 | 114 |
| *1952–1954* | | | | | |
| enseignement public | 99 | 44 | plan schuman | 21 | 138 |
| enseignement technique | 104 | 55 | assurés libres | 20 | 61 |
| experts comptables | 50 | 5 | victimes civiles | 34 | 71 |
| enseignement moyen | 123 | 81 | office séquestres | 1 | 35 |
| droit civil | 59 | 18 | etats unis | 65 | 96 |
| *1954–1956* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 184 | 92 | etats unis | 42 | 117 |
| enseignement moyen | 185 | 98 | travailleurs indépendants | 38 | 90 |
| enseignement public | 103 | 36 | haute autorité | 19 | 66 |
| enseignement technique | 125 | 69 | personnel enseignant | 25 | 64 |
| fonds routes | 69 | 13 | société nationale | 119 | 157 |
| *1956–1958* | | | | | |
| enseignement libre | 90 | 30 | conseil national | 58 | 148 |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 69 | 8 | oeuvre nationale | 20 | 53 |
| allocations familiales | 126 | 74 | national charbonnages | 29 | 62 |
| moyen libre | 31 | 4 | conseil administration | 25 | 57 |
| quatre ans | 62 | 37 | secteur privé | 42 | 71 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| politique scientifique | 53 | 3 | classe ouvrière | 26 | 74 |
| budget ordinaire | 59 | 26 | loi unique | 62 | 109 |
| gouverneur général | 61 | 31 | haute autorité | 27 | 72 |
| force publique | 62 | 31 | personnel enseignant | 9 | 54 |
| économique régional | 39 | 10 | pacte scolaire | 33 | 78 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C14:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1961–1963* | | | | | |
| assistance technique | 118 | 21 | education nationale | 57 | 102 |
| chemin fer | 178 | 119 | classe ouvrière | 12 | 53 |
| général gaulle | 49 | 7 | maladie invalidité | 24 | 53 |
| pays voie | 55 | 18 | assistance publique | 65 | 93 |
| affaires africaines | 44 | 9 | classes moyennes | 49 | 75 |
| *1963–1965* | | | | | |
| assistance technique | 177 | 28 | corps médical | 87 | 149 |
| pays voie | 77 | 8 | maladie invalidité | 119 | 177 |
| voie développement | 72 | 8 | victimes guerre | 17 | 65 |
| outre mer | 51 | 8 | etats unis | 59 | 106 |
| sous traitants | 51 | 12 | hausse prix | 15 | 45 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| assistance technique | 91 | 12 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 68 | 134 |
| cour comptes | 96 | 25 | maladie invalidité | 55 | 100 |
| chemin fer | 126 | 65 | assurance maladie | 73 | 102 |
| coopération développement | 47 | 7 | corps médical | 19 | 43 |
| pays voie | 50 | 12 | gaz naturel | 8 | 30 |
| *1968–1969* | | | | | |
| coopération développement | 85 | 15 | personnes âgées | 22 | 75 |
| registre national | 67 | 3 | organisations syndicales | 36 | 75 |
| pays voie | 71 | 11 | conseil économique | 117 | 148 |
| education nationale | 131 | 72 | assistance publique | 28 | 54 |
| nations unies | 71 | 13 | travailleurs indépendants | 13 | 31 |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| pays voie | 282 | 26 | police judiciaire | 13 | 94 |
| voie développement | 262 | 27 | gaz naturel | 11 | 54 |
| coopération développement | 136 | 15 | santé publique | 72 | 112 |
| parlement européen | 127 | 40 | travailleurs indépendants | 16 | 50 |
| gouvernement belge | 121 | 40 | personnes âgées | 12 | 45 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C15:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1971–1974* | | | | | |
| classes moyennes | 179 | 72 | expansion économique | 52 | 97 |
| santé publique | 165 | 89 | organisations syndicales | 48 | 77 |
| société nationale | 90 | 35 | conseil économique | 41 | 65 |
| langue allemande | 61 | 20 | fraude fiscale | 8 | 28 |
| exposé général | 65 | 24 | télégraphes téléphones | 12 | 27 |
| *1974–1977* | | | | | |
| arrondissement mons | 79 | 5 | aide sociale | 23 | 102 |
| économique sociale | 136 | 76 | travailleurs indépendants | 15 | 79 |
| langue allemande | 82 | 23 | centres publics | 11 | 44 |
| catégories sociales | 57 | 9 | publics aide | 13 | 43 |
| sous régions | 54 | 12 | autant plus | 77 | 101 |
| *1977–1978* | | | | | |
| finances publiques | 198 | 75 | travailleurs indépendants | 25 | 67 |
| langue allemande | 135 | 22 | plan secteur | 13 | 49 |
| maîtrise finances | 83 | 3 | fonds communes | 20 | 43 |
| politique industrielle | 129 | 58 | sociétés développement | 11 | 17 |
| education nationale | 138 | 71 | parlementaires parlementaire | 190 | 192 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| gouvernement belge | 128 | 46 | organisations syndicales | 26 | 56 |
| communauté germanophone | 97 | 23 | travailleurs indépendants | 15 | 44 |
| coopération développement | 84 | 29 | région bruxelles | 32 | 56 |
| parlement européen | 68 | 17 | communauté flamande | 26 | 46 |
| education nationale | 113 | 72 | communautés régions | 41 | 61 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C16:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1981–1983* | | | | | |
| troisième circuit | 160 | 15 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 409 | 600 |
| temps travail | 135 | 29 | cockerill sambre | 8 | 76 |
| circuit travail | 109 | 12 | fraude fiscale | 12 | 77 |
| conseil communal | 116 | 36 | pleins pouvoirs | 13 | 50 |
| crédits provisoires | 114 | 40 | utilisation rationnelle | 10 | 46 |
| *1983–1985* | | | | | |
| temps travail | 180 | 37 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 80 | 128 |
| politique scientifique | 126 | 19 | union soviétique | 11 | 44 |
| police communale | 93 | 17 | enseignement etat | 23 | 54 |
| langue allemande | 62 | 4 | education nationale | 128 | 158 |
| fonction publique | 136 | 80 | arriéré judiciaire | 5 | 31 |
| *1985–1987* | | | | | |
| région bruxelloise | 375 | 182 | education nationale | 64 | 155 |
| secteur textile | 152 | 8 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 259 | 290 |
| cockerill sambre | 94 | 16 | enseignement rénové | 17 | 47 |
| secteurs nationaux | 105 | 38 | fraude fiscale | 16 | 46 |
| service militaire | 108 | 49 | travailleurs indépendants | 13 | 33 |
| *1988–1989* | | | | | |
| communauté germanophone | 142 | 15 | culturelles nationales | 20 | 57 |
| société canal | 102 | 8 | scientifiques culturelles | 21 | 56 |
| accord coopération | 109 | 32 | publics institutions | 26 | 58 |
| mouscron comines | 82 | 21 | services publics | 84 | 98 |
| autorité nationale | 70 | 13 | annales parlementaires | 219 | 221 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| juge instruction | 162 | 72 | culturelles nationales | 16 | 69 |
| services police | 161 | 80 | scientifiques culturelles | 17 | 69 |
| précompte mobilier | 103 | 36 | loi financement | 26 | 72 |
| agents change | 69 | 7 | publics institutions | 24 | 65 |
| communauté germanophone | 64 | 12 | etat major | 10 | 33 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C17:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1991–1993* | | | | | |
| travaux intérêt | 63 | 4 | réforme etat | 103 | 169 |
| commissariat royal | 57 | 8 | gecontroleerd oui | 8 | 41 |
| acquisition nationalité | 44 | 9 | région bruxelles | 51 | 84 |
| nom groupe | 48 | 12 | conseil communauté | 131 | 141 |
| établissements pénitentiaires | 45 | 10 | belgique kamer | 684 | 687 |
| *1993–1995* | | | | | |
| êtres humains | 194 | 60 | sécurité sociale | 252 | 325 |
| traite êtres | 167 | 47 | entreprises publiques | 52 | 100 |
| juge instruction | 117 | 16 | dépenses électorales | 48 | 92 |
| remise dette | 87 | 9 | campagne information | 20 | 51 |
| procureur général | 107 | 29 | union européenne | 143 | 170 |
| *1995–1997* | | | | | |
| union monétaire | 163 | 49 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 62 | 308 |
| union européenne | 140 | 72 | sécurité sociale | 535 | 621 |
| dette publique | 112 | 50 | matière sécurité | 25 | 55 |
| contributions directes | 68 | 7 | services police | 44 | 66 |
| etats membres | 109 | 48 | police judiciaire | 25 | 43 |
| *1997–1999* | | | | | |
| union européenne | 196 | 77 | juge instruction | 119 | 170 |
| banque nationale | 96 | 14 | procureur général | 40 | 84 |
| banque centrale | 98 | 17 | nouveau belgique | 3 | 45 |
| extrême droite | 107 | 38 | organisations criminelles | 7 | 45 |
| administration fiscale | 90 | 22 | vie privée | 42 | 70 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| coopération développement | 151 | 43 | services police | 32 | 92 |
| arc ciel | 76 | 31 | criminalité organisée | 14 | 55 |
| principe précaution | 77 | 35 | union européenne | 129 | 169 |
| nations unies | 66 | 29 | réduction temps | 18 | 55 |
| soumis sanction | 53 | 17 | police locale | 36 | 71 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C18:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2001–2003* | | | | | |
| soins palliatifs | 146 | 33 | police locale | 37 | 91 |
| réforme polices | 136 | 68 | criminalité organisée | 13 | 57 |
| arc ciel | 107 | 44 | police fédérale | 29 | 70 |
| fin vie | 65 | 14 | union européenne | 113 | 152 |
| protection jeunesse | 66 | 17 | accords bilatéraux | 9 | 48 |
| *2003–2005* | | | | | |
| titres services | 126 | 20 | peine travail | 5 | 33 |
| entités fédérées | 123 | 52 | tax shelter | 2 | 30 |
| communautés régions | 92 | 30 | police fédérale | 15 | 38 |
| nouvelle fois | 89 | 28 | arriéré judiciaire | 21 | 44 |
| insécurité juridique | 67 | 10 | coopération développement | 41 | 50 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| partenaires sociaux | 243 | 117 | intérêts notionnels | 32 | 73 |
| demandeurs emploi | 111 | 29 | fraude fiscale | 69 | 102 |
| plan relance | 113 | 57 | demandeurs asile | 20 | 52 |
| titres services | 107 | 54 | aide financière | 12 | 34 |
| coopération développement | 109 | 56 | médecins généralistes | 53 | 69 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C19:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2014–2016* | | | | | |
| aide juridique | 121 | 8 | sécurité sociale | 102 | 175 |
| contre terrorisme | 175 | 84 | saut index | 165 | 232 |
| cour assises | 102 | 19 | doel doel | 22 | 89 |
| partenaires sociaux | 236 | 171 | union européenne | 199 | 264 |
| très clairement | 145 | 85 | enveloppe bien | 7 | 60 |
| *2016–2019* | | | | | |
| juge instruction | 125 | 45 | sécurité sociale | 153 | 201 |
| secret professionnel | 84 | 29 | saut index | 10 | 53 |
| aide juridique | 68 | 16 | hommes femmes | 21 | 49 |
| toute série | 125 | 74 | droits femmes | 21 | 45 |
| arabie saoudite | 88 | 44 | droits humains | 17 | 41 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C20:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| union européenne | 459 | 178 | flexi jobs | 40 | 115 |
| coopération développement | 127 | 33 | malades longue | 17 | 86 |
| norme croissance | 119 | 48 | travailleurs travailleuses | 14 | 73 |
| consommation drogues | 47 | 6 | travailleuses travailleurs | 11 | 62 |
| spf justice | 39 | 4 | tableaux budgétaires | 10 | 56 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C21:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1900–1902* | | | | | |
| vlaamsche volk | 633 | 315 | algemeen stemrecht | 565 | 566 |
| | | | enkele woorden | 383 | 384 |
| | | | vlaamsche land | 213 | 214 |
| | | | onderlingen bijstand | 279 | 280 |
| | | | werkende klas | 384 | 385 |
| *1902–1904* | | | | | |
| 10 jaar | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommige vragen | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommigen wel | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommige zaken | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommigen zeggen | 1 | 1 | | | |
| *1904–1906* | | | | | |
| | | | 10 jaar | 23 | 23 |
| | | | sommige vragen | 2 | 2 |
| | | | sommigen wel | 1 | 1 |
| | | | sommige zaken | 1 | 1 |
| | | | sommigen zeggen | 1 | 1 |
| *1906–1908* | | | | | |
| mager vee | 443 | 438 | nationale bank | 161 | 644 |
| jaar dienst | 451 | 447 | bedienden werklieden | 141 | 404 |
| vlaamsche volk | 410 | 406 | private nijverheid | 30 | 108 |
| west vlaanderen | 353 | 350 | | | |
| vlaamsche taal | 360 | 357 | | | |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| kleine bedienden | 298 | 91 | ambtenaar burgerlijke | 34 | 196 |
| spoorwegen posterijen | 550 | 549 | burgerlijke stand | 69 | 230 |
| vlaamsche volk | 315 | 315 | land waas | 33 | 65 |
| posterijen telegrafen | 384 | 383 | werkende klas | 440 | 440 |
| vlaamsche taal | 329 | 329 | 67 jaar | 57 | 57 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C22:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1910–1912* | | | | | |
| onderlingen bijstand | 488 | 486 | private nijverheid | 21 | 347 |
| kleine bedienden | 355 | 354 | | | |
| werkende klas | 342 | 341 | | | |
| vlaamsche land | 360 | 359 | | | |
| twintig jaar | 358 | 357 | | | |
| *1912–1914* | | | | | |
| algemeen stemrecht | 870 | 297 | lagere scholen | 125 | 342 |
| vlaamsche soldaten | 136 | 136 | tweede taal | 74 | 266 |
| officieele scholen | 326 | 326 | lager onderwijs | 121 | 303 |
| twintig jaar | 259 | 258 | vlaamsche volk | 281 | 360 |
| jaar dienst | 267 | 267 | werkende klas | 329 | 329 |
| *1918–1919* | | | | | |
| | | | 10 jaar | 3 | 3 |
| | | | sommige vragen | 3 | 3 |
| | | | sommigen wel | 3 | 3 |
| | | | sommige zaken | 2 | 2 |
| | | | sommigen zeggen | 2 | 2 |
| *1919–1921* | | | | | |
| landelijke politie | 361 | 15 | werkende klas | 201 | 533 |
| syndicale vrijheid | 154 | 32 | oud strijders | 472 | 608 |
| land waes | 88 | 27 | politieke gevangenen | 65 | 133 |
| lager onderwijs | 91 | 39 | nationale maatschappij | 134 | 164 |
| onze nationale | 95 | 71 | vlaamsche volk | 219 | 220 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C23:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1921–1923* | | | | | |
| middelbaar onderwijs | 469 | 194 | oud strijders | 109 | 288 |
| lager onderwijs | 368 | 202 | werkende klas | 67 | 208 |
| vierde graad | 166 | 40 | vlaamsche waalsche | 83 | 203 |
| landelijke politie | 229 | 114 | nationaal werk | 48 | 149 |
| militair statuut | 122 | 59 | vlaamsche soldaten | 58 | 153 |
| *1923–1925* | | | | | |
| vierde graad | 187 | 34 | vóór oorlog | 344 | 346 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 154 | 14 | nationale maatschappij | 312 | 313 |
| fransche taal | 204 | 87 | oud strijders | 283 | 284 |
| | | | kosteloos pensioen | 265 | 267 |
| | | | 65 jaar | 268 | 269 |
| *1925–1927* | | | | | |
| onze soldaten | 175 | 45 | oud strijders | 143 | 279 |
| militaire overheid | 152 | 48 | nationale bank | 107 | 189 |
| tusschen beide | 124 | 51 | fransch belgisch | 50 | 105 |
| land waes | 113 | 42 | belgische regering | 108 | 130 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 102 | 34 | militair akkoord | 15 | 35 |
| *1927–1929* | | | | | |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 338 | 104 | oud strijders | 209 | 426 |
| openbare werken | 440 | 229 | fransch belgisch | 38 | 165 |
| speciaal fonds | 94 | 15 | militair akkoord | 20 | 110 |
| één oplossing | 135 | 61 | veertien maanden | 35 | 104 |
| onderwijzend personeel | 123 | 68 | werkende klas | 66 | 128 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 256 | 71 | vlaamsche volk | 131 | 297 |
| ambachten neringen | 136 | 12 | fransch belgisch | 12 | 143 |
| openbare werken | 451 | 340 | belgische regering | 66 | 188 |
| kamers ambachten | 103 | 14 | militair akkoord | 4 | 119 |
| kadastraal inkomen | 127 | 40 | belgische staat | 56 | 153 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C24:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1932–1934* | | | | | |
| nationale maatschappij | 460 | 169 | vlaamsche volk | 133 | 236 |
| maatschappij buurtspoorwegen | 301 | 17 | oud strijders | 93 | 143 |
| wet 1930 | 212 | 14 | militair akkoord | 10 | 57 |
| technisch onderwijs | 202 | 22 | fransch belgisch | 26 | 52 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 243 | 106 | openbare werken | 334 | 338 |
| *1934–1936* | | | | | |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 260 | 69 | vlaamsche volk | 84 | 341 |
| brusselsche agglomeratie | 192 | 52 | oud strijders | 57 | 238 |
| kadastraal inkomen | 213 | 77 | belgische staat | 55 | 128 |
| landen tuinbouw | 106 | 13 | fransch belgisch | 103 | 168 |
| technisch onderwijs | 106 | 29 | militair akkoord | 62 | 119 |
| *1936–1939* | | | | | |
| nationale bank | 340 | 112 | officieel onderwijs | 77 | 144 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 198 | 31 | vlaamsche volk | 180 | 244 |
| gewijzigd wet | 106 | 22 | jaar dienst | 67 | 115 |
| wet 1930 | 112 | 33 | belgische staat | 55 | 102 |
| technisch onderwijs | 129 | 55 | laatste woord | 49 | 83 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| technisch onderwijs | 511 | 125 | vlaamsche volk | 66 | 138 |
| nationale maatschappij | 523 | 256 | vlaamsche soldaten | 31 | 100 |
| onze nationale | 157 | 80 | nationaal werk | 76 | 133 |
| ambachten neringen | 112 | 47 | vierde graad | 15 | 51 |
| bevoorrading land | 83 | 22 | openbaar onderwijs | 308 | 311 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C25:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1944–1946* | | | | | |
| dienst pensioenen | 373 | 91 | gedurende oorlog | 234 | 236 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 223 | 33 | arbeid sociale | 161 | 163 |
| belasting kapitaal | 237 | 81 | tijdens bezetting | 203 | 205 |
| technisch onderwijs | 151 | 105 | tijdens oorlog | 259 | 261 |
| | | | moeten betalen | 140 | 141 |
| *1946–1947* | | | | | |
| technisch onderwijs | 339 | 106 | politieke gevangenen | 92 | 281 |
| maatschappelijke zekerheid | 248 | 122 | dienst pensioenen | 50 | 186 |
| ambachten neringen | 140 | 28 | economische unie | 110 | 229 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 89 | 17 | economische problemen | 30 | 77 |
| sociale voorzorg | 239 | 171 | werkende klas | 56 | 81 |
| *1947–1949* | | | | | |
| nationale maatschappij | 370 | 228 | grote steden | 38 | 119 |
| technisch onderwijs | 223 | 87 | centraal bestuur | 46 | 117 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 155 | 37 | fonds gemeenten | 41 | 98 |
| nationale bank | 164 | 64 | werkende klas | 29 | 83 |
| volksgezondheid gezin | 171 | 82 | sint niklaas | 53 | 107 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| rechterlijke orde | 199 | 63 | algemene paritaire | 36 | 139 |
| burgerlijke partij | 167 | 57 | sociale voorzorg | 168 | 168 |
| | | | arbeid sociale | 170 | 170 |
| | | | vrij verzekerden | 183 | 183 |
| | | | staan vóór | 144 | 144 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C26:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1950–1952* | | | | | |
| maatschappelijke zekerheid | 297 | 138 | twintig maanden | 52 | 199 |
| belgisch congo | 176 | 54 | openbare werken | 179 | 288 |
| technisch onderwijs | 194 | 76 | gehuwde vrouw | 40 | 111 |
| landen tuinbouw | 141 | 39 | sociale zekerheid | 93 | 156 |
| lager onderwijs | 118 | 44 | sociale voorzorg | 232 | 292 |
| *1952–1954* | | | | | |
| technisch onderwijs | 366 | 74 | heilige stoel | 52 | 310 |
| hoge autoriteit | 193 | 61 | achttien maanden | 36 | 246 |
| belgisch congo | 260 | 132 | twintig maanden | 75 | 277 |
| zelfstandige arbeiders | 326 | 210 | militaire diensttijd | 9 | 79 |
| gemeenschappelijke markt | 114 | 35 | officieel onderwijs | 72 | 141 |
| *1954–1956* | | | | | |
| technisch onderwijs | 282 | 18 | vier jaar | 124 | 288 |
| openbaar onderwijs | 324 | 159 | vorige regering | 150 | 267 |
| vrij verzekerden | 218 | 77 | jonge mannen | 12 | 78 |
| sociale voorzorg | 323 | 188 | openbare werken | 198 | 257 |
| dienst pensioenen | 148 | 16 | rijksmiddelbare school | 32 | 86 |
| *1956–1958* | | | | | |
| sociale voorzorg | 277 | 140 | jonge mannen | 9 | 171 |
| technisch onderwijs | 170 | 44 | openbare werken | 253 | 315 |
| arbeid sociale | 257 | 158 | nationaal inkomen | 55 | 108 |
| belgisch congo | 224 | 130 | twintig maanden | 21 | 70 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 97 | 29 | commissaris generaal | 22 | 71 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 302 | 216 | nationale bank | 14 | 151 |
| ronde tafelconferentie | 116 | 51 | vorige regering | 58 | 153 |
| volksgezondheid gezin | 111 | 47 | openbare schuld | 28 | 100 |
| regionale economie | 80 | 17 | nationaal inkomen | 56 | 127 |
| nationaal werk | 108 | 46 | belgisch congo | 138 | 201 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C27:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1961–1963* | | | | | |
| dienst pensioenen | 220 | 50 | fiscale hervorming | 215 | 357 |
| verenigde staten | 154 | 52 | arrondissement leper | 9 | 138 |
| kadastraal inkomen | 235 | 147 | economische expansie | 134 | 207 |
| openbare schuld | 105 | 33 | nationale opvoeding | 188 | 254 |
| haven antwerpen | 126 | 57 | vitaal belang | 11 | 64 |
| *1963–1965* | | | | | |
| europese school | 148 | 33 | nationale opvoeding | 155 | 287 |
| nationale maatschappij | 141 | 74 | tweede taal | 74 | 170 |
| openbare werken | 272 | 218 | nationale kas | 17 | 109 |
| technisch onderwijs | 79 | 31 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 34 | 109 |
| maatschappelijke zekerheid | 70 | 31 | twee gemeenschappen | 19 | 84 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 338 | 170 | nationale opvoeding | 202 | 345 |
| wetenschappelijk onderzoek | 135 | 63 | vrije universiteiten | 17 | 113 |
| departement openbare | 71 | 21 | generaal toerisme | 6 | 52 |
| verzekering geven | 73 | 29 | huidige regering | 68 | 112 |
| maatschappelijke zekerheid | 73 | 39 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 26 | 68 |
| *1968–1969* | | | | | |
| openbare onderstand | 198 | 76 | economische expansie | 89 | 133 |
| gewaarborgd inkomen | 166 | 44 | vrije universiteiten | 31 | 75 |
| openbare werken | 363 | 245 | regionale economische | 56 | 92 |
| collectieve arbeidsovereenkomsten | 83 | 6 | onze landbouwers | 21 | 57 |
| sociale voorzorg | 211 | 149 | socialistische mutualiteiten | 31 | 60 |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| hoger onderwijs | 226 | 71 | nationale opvoeding | 139 | 204 |
| nationale maatschappij | 223 | 93 | lager onderwijs | 47 | 102 |
| openbare werken | 375 | 281 | economische hogeschool | 13 | 62 |
| ruimtelijke ordening | 139 | 74 | universitaire expansie | 21 | 70 |
| gewaarborgd inkomen | 81 | 17 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 29 | 70 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C28:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1971–1974* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 430 | 326 | sociale voorzorg | 75 | 183 |
| landen tuinbouw | 89 | 15 | vorige regering | 102 | 157 |
| buitengewoon onderwijs | 102 | 35 | traditionele partijen | 17 | 60 |
| departement openbare | 106 | 44 | nationale opvoeding | 115 | 156 |
| middelgrote ondernemingen | 97 | 40 | belgische staat | 27 | 65 |
| *1974–1977* | | | | | |
| sociale voorzorg | 180 | 91 | nationale opvoeding | 140 | 263 |
| hoger onderwijs | 167 | 87 | openbaar ambt | 91 | 143 |
| sociale zekerheid | 125 | 66 | vlaamse aangelegenheden | 42 | 88 |
| minder validen | 128 | 72 | openbare werken | 259 | 303 |
| maatschappelijke zekerheid | 61 | 19 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 14 | 56 |
| *1977–1978* | | | | | |
| halle vilvoorde | 143 | 64 | openbaar vervoer | 47 | 151 |
| vlaamse gemeenschap | 151 | 82 | nationale investeringsmaatschappij | 28 | 107 |
| sociale voorzorg | 109 | 55 | vorige regering | 81 | 155 |
| maatschappelijke zekerheid | 60 | 10 | openbare holding | 7 | 69 |
| hoofdstedelijk gebied | 59 | 27 | toegevoegd eerste | 6 | 52 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| hoofdstedelijk gebied | 173 | 23 | openbaar vervoer | 59 | 106 |
| beide gemeenschappen | 85 | 20 | studiemeester opvoeder | 3 | 50 |
| sociale zekerheid | 425 | 362 | wijze waarop | 77 | 120 |
| europees parlement | 83 | 34 | centrale regering | 7 | 41 |
| franstalige gemeenschap | 71 | 25 | vorige regering | 57 | 91 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C29:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1981–1983* | | | | | |
| cockerill sambre | 314 | 150 | centrale regering | 23 | 87 |
| europese commissie | 177 | 40 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 75 | 135 |
| europese gemeenschap | 216 | 95 | fiscale druk | 11 | 69 |
| vrije beroepen | 117 | 40 | openbaar vervoer | 84 | 137 |
| hoog comité | 75 | 10 | openbare ziekenhuizen | 26 | 76 |
| *1983–1985* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 217 | 113 | fiscale druk | 27 | 91 |
| nationale sectoren | 204 | 114 | centrale regering | 9 | 57 |
| cockerill sambre | 160 | 89 | verenigde staten | 206 | 249 |
| vijf nationale | 80 | 13 | sociale zekerheid | 256 | 299 |
| stand gebracht | 85 | 34 | fiscale fraude | 8 | 49 |
| *1985–1987* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 295 | 137 | wetenschappelijk onderzoek | 65 | 168 |
| sociale zekerheid | 306 | 197 | politieke vluchtelingen | 45 | 129 |
| sociale gesprekspartners | 90 | 10 | centrale regering | 8 | 69 |
| politieke samenwerking | 84 | 4 | openbare financiën | 88 | 142 |
| nationale overheid | 86 | 28 | voorlopige kredieten | 67 | 118 |
| *1988–1989* | | | | | |
| roerende voorheffing | 200 | 79 | openbare financiën | 87 | 171 |
| nationale bank | 241 | 132 | wetenschappelijke culturele | 18 | 94 |
| europees parlement | 118 | 49 | neen geantwoord | 61 | 132 |
| nationaal vlak | 100 | 44 | nationale wetenschappelijke | 17 | 86 |
| economische monetaire | 151 | 99 | diensten nationale | 25 | 94 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 390 | 210 | diensten nationale | 30 | 98 |
| europees parlement | 185 | 62 | nationale wetenschappelijke | 31 | 98 |
| menselijk leven | 80 | 9 | midden oosten | 66 | 132 |
| ongeboren leven | 97 | 27 | wetenschappelijke culturele | 31 | 97 |
| politieke unie | 108 | 39 | culturele instellingen | 31 | 96 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C30:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1991–1993* | | | | | |
| bijzondere wet | 430 | 150 | sociale zekerheid | 615 | 665 |
| hoofdstedelijk gewest | 113 | 26 | halle vilvoorde | 60 | 108 |
| gemeenschappen gewesten | 175 | 98 | stemming gelden | 1 | 33 |
| monetaire unie | 101 | 26 | uitslag vorige | 4 | 36 |
| fiscale druk | 114 | 58 | franstalige brusselaars | 9 | 36 |
| *1993–1995* | | | | | |
| globaal plan | 406 | 282 | sociale zekerheid | 794 | 988 |
| georganiseerde criminaliteit | 74 | 8 | sociaal pact | 114 | 198 |
| algemene uitgavenbegroting | 64 | 11 | objectieve aansprakelijkheid | 58 | 134 |
| wou stemmen | 88 | 43 | sociale programmawet | 46 | 108 |
| ontwerp verklaring | 35 | 4 | stemming gelden | 12 | 68 |
| *1995–1997* | | | | | |
| procureur generaal | 436 | 275 | sociale zekerheid | 888 | 1196 |
| monetaire unie | 145 | 54 | sociale partners | 203 | 249 |
| onbemande camera | 144 | 54 | medisch dossier | 21 | 63 |
| college procureurs | 125 | 48 | politieke cultuur | 39 | 76 |
| strafrechtelijk beleid | 94 | 27 | vlaams parlement | 32 | 69 |
| *1997–1999* | | | | | |
| voorwaardelijke invrijheidstelling | 189 | 54 | sociale zekerheid | 103 | 208 |
| procureur konings | 190 | 105 | vlaams parlement | 87 | 192 |
| procureur generaal | 289 | 220 | politieke partijen | 122 | 203 |
| lokale politie | 99 | 33 | medisch dossier | 7 | 58 |
| college procureurs | 121 | 59 | fiscale discriminatie | 19 | 61 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| federale politie | 235 | 89 | halle vilvoorde | 30 | 156 |
| sociale partners | 200 | 102 | europese unie | 117 | 188 |
| actieve welvaartsstaat | 186 | 100 | gerechtelijk arrondissement | 32 | 92 |
| georganiseerde criminaliteit | 80 | 9 | voorlopige hechtenis | 13 | 62 |
| belgische nationaliteit | 174 | 106 | stemming gelden | 4 | 48 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C31:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2001–2003* | | | | | |
| veiligheid staat | 247 | 100 | europese unie | 102 | 224 |
| ontwerp verklaring | 138 | 18 | toegevoegde rechters | 19 | 98 |
| oui nee | 148 | 39 | lambermont akkoord | 57 | 132 |
| abstentions totaal | 141 | 41 | verenigde staten | 79 | 141 |
| total bijgevolg | 128 | 38 | georganiseerde misdaad | 10 | 69 |
| *2003–2005* | | | | | |
| stemming gelden | 142 | 1 | europese unie | 149 | 340 |
| uitslag vorige | 141 | 1 | halle vilvoorde | 114 | 222 |
| federale overheid | 221 | 85 | sociale partners | 81 | 181 |
| vorige stemming | 143 | 10 | europees parlement | 56 | 148 |
| gelden stemming | 136 | 4 | net zoals | 66 | 134 |
| *2005–2007* | | | | | |
| pairé avec | 78 | 8 | europese unie | 89 | 325 |
| inspectie financiën | 77 | 16 | sociale partners | 108 | 212 |
| volgende week | 188 | 130 | europese grondwet | 26 | 91 |
| onze vraag | 75 | 29 | europees parlement | 26 | 80 |
| nieuwe belastingen | 80 | 36 | europese commissie | 117 | 169 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| sociale partners | 376 | 249 | nationale bank | 79 | 196 |
| nmbs groep | 106 | 8 | halle vilvoorde | 65 | 167 |
| financiële crisis | 189 | 105 | notionele intrestaftrek | 20 | 98 |
| bnp paribas | 87 | 27 | vlaams parlement | 49 | 112 |
| voorlopige hechtenis | 75 | 25 | fiscale fraude | 143 | 190 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C32:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2010–2012* | | | | | |
| sociale partners | 336 | 108 | minnelijke schikking | 49 | 200 |
| nmbs groep | 184 | 53 | notionele intrestaftrek | 10 | 102 |
| nationale bank | 285 | 191 | fiscale fraude | 92 | 135 |
| bilaterale akkoorden | 99 | 21 | halle vilvoorde | 41 | 74 |
| begeleide minderjarigen | 85 | 20 | lopende zaken | 462 | 468 |
| *2012–2014* | | | | | |
| sociale partners | 497 | 203 | halle vilvoorde | 44 | 164 |
| voorliggend ontwerp | 290 | 96 | europese unie | 354 | 463 |
| europese commissie | 346 | 211 | gemiste kans | 59 | 118 |
| erg belangrijk | 105 | 25 | vlaamse partijen | 40 | 95 |
| ambtenaar burgerlijke | 103 | 25 | civiele lijst | 20 | 74 |
| *2014–2016* | | | | | |
| nationale bank | 312 | 115 | gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 26 | 95 |
| sociale partners | 519 | 336 | europese unie | 225 | 294 |
| volgend jaar | 253 | 125 | verenigde staten | 69 | 134 |
| sociale bescherming | 188 | 75 | erkende vluchtelingen | 30 | 85 |
| beschikbaar inkomen | 115 | 12 | bijzonder ernstig | 11 | 29 |
| *2016–2019* | | | | | |
| sociale zekerheid | 389 | 272 | gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 14 | 57 |
| europese commissie | 330 | 219 | openbare orde | 21 | 60 |
| nationale bank | 291 | 183 | regering michel | 18 | 54 |
| beschikbaar inkomen | 102 | 12 | vlaams parlement | 40 | 73 |
| minnelijke schikking | 209 | 134 | jaar gewerkt | 18 | 47 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C33:** Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

| Catholic | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| fiscale hervorming | 392 | 83 | sociale zekerheid | 378 | 385 |
| nationale loterij | 216 | 61 | voorlopige twaalfden | 227 | 232 |
| zodat we | 244 | 110 | langdurig zieken | 254 | 258 |
| sociaal tarief | 174 | 43 | twee jaar | 197 | 201 |
| binnen europa | 130 | 21 | vorige regering | 191 | 195 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C34:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1890s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1894–1896* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 219 | 58 | droit licence | 6 | 87 |
| cahier charges | 93 | 33 | droits entrée | 49 | 101 |
| chemin fer | 424 | 368 | distillateurs agricoles | 7 | 57 |
| conseil communal | 149 | 94 | droit accise | 28 | 73 |
| suffrage universel | 112 | 58 | tabac indigène | 10 | 46 |
| *1896–1898* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 207 | 39 | garde civique | 145 | 261 |
| suffrage universel | 94 | 34 | fabricants sucre | 7 | 40 |
| sociétés coopératives | 78 | 42 | tribunal liége | 1 | 28 |
| grand central | 119 | 83 | pourrait être | 80 | 103 |
| syndicats professionnels | 38 | 9 | observations présentées | 20 | 43 |
| *1898–1900* | | | | | |
| banque nationale | 414 | 139 | juge paix | 27 | 113 |
| classe ouvrière | 186 | 31 | conseil guerre | 42 | 96 |
| suffrage universel | 143 | 57 | députation permanente | 39 | 88 |
| caisse épargne | 155 | 71 | cour militaire | 5 | 50 |
| tramways bruxellois | 111 | 36 | cour appel | 15 | 51 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C35:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1900–1902* | | | | | |
| suffrage universel | 502 | 239 | chemin fer | 244 | 366 |
| classe ouvrière | 202 | 34 | jeux hasard | 10 | 88 |
| industrie travail | 101 | 44 | cercles privés | 14 | 69 |
| général major | 129 | 83 | gare centrale | 7 | 55 |
| comités patronage | 36 | 9 | distilleries agricoles | 10 | 57 |
| *1902–1904* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 203 | 46 | chemin fer | 349 | 449 |
| heures travail | 62 | 13 | conseil communal | 57 | 109 |
| prix viande | 79 | 35 | faute lourde | 27 | 68 |
| industrie travail | 109 | 74 | chef entreprise | 21 | 50 |
| augmentation prix | 49 | 16 | ville bruxelles | 12 | 42 |
| *1904–1906* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 176 | 42 | code civil | 34 | 88 |
| lieutenant général | 211 | 110 | repos dominical | 36 | 88 |
| heures travail | 113 | 30 | grande coupure | 44 | 96 |
| industrie travail | 185 | 106 | navire école | 8 | 52 |
| etat indépendant | 93 | 36 | conseil communal | 56 | 91 |
| *1906–1908* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 176 | 35 | langue flamande | 23 | 97 |
| industrie travail | 216 | 101 | seconde ligne | 4 | 37 |
| huit heures | 172 | 66 | pays flamand | 35 | 65 |
| heures travail | 130 | 47 | enseignement moyen | 16 | 45 |
| chemin fer | 533 | 455 | ligne défense | 7 | 35 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 180 | 34 | comité spécial | 6 | 85 |
| chemin fer | 477 | 342 | union minière | 4 | 45 |
| prud hommes | 299 | 168 | loi 1902 | 26 | 61 |
| conseils prud | 200 | 121 | budget extraordinaire | 33 | 63 |
| huit heures | 120 | 46 | effectif paix | 31 | 60 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C36:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1910–1912* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 258 | 50 | caisses prévoyance | 50 | 107 |
| industrie travail | 163 | 101 | juge paix | 32 | 77 |
| lieutenant général | 112 | 53 | cour comptes | 8 | 48 |
| heures travail | 74 | 25 | députation permanente | 57 | 93 |
| suffrage universel | 64 | 20 | loi 1900 | 22 | 54 |
| *1912–1914* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 314 | 38 | bons trésor | 9 | 69 |
| suffrage universel | 204 | 70 | écoles communales | 110 | 159 |
| industrie travail | 105 | 56 | société nationale | 37 | 74 |
| quelque chose | 102 | 54 | enseignement public | 17 | 52 |
| heures travail | 53 | 14 | budget extraordinaire | 16 | 50 |
| *1918–1919* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 258 | 46 | dommages guerre | 43 | 214 |
| comité national | 133 | 55 | tribunaux dommages | 13 | 99 |
| huit heures | 50 | 10 | écoles normales | 22 | 73 |
| suffrage universel | 90 | 50 | juge unique | 40 | 77 |
| suffrage femmes | 69 | 37 | langue flamande | 10 | 44 |
| *1919–1921* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 325 | 69 | dommages guerre | 56 | 166 |
| passage eau | 55 | 1 | tribunaux dommages | 23 | 61 |
| suffrage universel | 81 | 28 | commissaires etat | 15 | 52 |
| avant guerre | 216 | 167 | chemin fer | 191 | 228 |
| huit heures | 97 | 51 | régions dévastées | 60 | 85 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C37:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1921–1923* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 169 | 60 | chemin fer | 286 | 336 |
| industrie travail | 113 | 56 | gardes champêtres | 69 | 113 |
| sciences arts | 147 | 95 | extrême gauche | 41 | 73 |
| quatrième degré | 54 | 13 | grand duché | 21 | 53 |
| administration communale | 117 | 76 | pays flamand | 25 | 56 |
| *1923–1925* | | | | | |
| service sauvetage | 98 | 8 | chemin fer | 184 | 291 |
| classe ouvrière | 103 | 31 | union douanière | 13 | 50 |
| société nationale | 113 | 46 | pro deo | 11 | 39 |
| industrie travail | 152 | 97 | prix maxima | 16 | 43 |
| sciences arts | 80 | 40 | examiné projet | 15 | 40 |
| *1925–1927* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 183 | 40 | banque nationale | 52 | 125 |
| chemin fer | 392 | 287 | dette flottante | 19 | 75 |
| huit heures | 112 | 37 | général kestens | 19 | 70 |
| avant guerre | 161 | 93 | neuf ans | 29 | 77 |
| société nationale | 103 | 55 | etats unis | 53 | 97 |
| *1927–1929* | | | | | |
| défense nationale | 211 | 98 | prison école | 17 | 69 |
| classe ouvrière | 137 | 42 | juge paix | 10 | 56 |
| personnel enseignant | 75 | 22 | grands lacs | 5 | 47 |
| huit heures | 71 | 26 | condamnation conditionnelle | 10 | 49 |
| industrie travail | 144 | 101 | ville anvers | 10 | 40 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| industrie travail | 180 | 77 | sociétés privées | 6 | 33 |
| classe ouvrière | 164 | 69 | langue flamande | 14 | 42 |
| société nationale | 191 | 116 | libre échange | 24 | 52 |
| huit heures | 63 | 21 | responsabilité limitée | 2 | 27 |
| assurances sociales | 61 | 24 | deux langues | 20 | 43 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C38:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1932–1934* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 308 | 102 | caisse nationale | 11 | 76 |
| pleins pouvoirs | 204 | 39 | juge paix | 27 | 85 |
| liste arrondissement | 76 | 14 | allocations familiales | 63 | 119 |
| allocations chômage | 97 | 37 | tenir compte | 103 | 159 |
| défense nationale | 142 | 93 | agents change | 13 | 60 |
| *1934–1936* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 176 | 42 | prix revient | 31 | 77 |
| société nationale | 260 | 129 | gouverneur général | 5 | 35 |
| arrêtés lois | 156 | 57 | classes moyennes | 32 | 59 |
| chemin fer | 265 | 175 | prix vente | 8 | 33 |
| nationale chemins | 125 | 58 | revenu cadastral | 10 | 34 |
| *1936–1939* | | | | | |
| travaux publics | 145 | 75 | classes moyennes | 57 | 142 |
| classe ouvrière | 129 | 83 | grands magasins | 16 | 68 |
| non intervention | 58 | 15 | prix revient | 38 | 66 |
| administration communale | 72 | 29 | juge paix | 9 | 35 |
| caisses chômage | 52 | 22 | banque nationale | 108 | 133 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| personnel enseignant | 102 | 23 | santé publique | 80 | 116 |
| instruction publique | 156 | 105 | budget extraordinaire | 21 | 51 |
| classe ouvrière | 81 | 47 | classes moyennes | 33 | 63 |
| union soviétique | 29 | 2 | défense nationale | 239 | 269 |
| masses laborieuses | 25 | 1 | fournitures bureau | 3 | 32 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C39:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1944–1946* | | | | | |
| prisonniers politiques | 236 | 112 | impôt exceptionnel | 5 | 48 |
| sécurité sociale | 116 | 15 | dommages guerre | 65 | 107 |
| secours civil | 94 | 9 | prix revient | 22 | 62 |
| ouvriers mineurs | 54 | 7 | pouvoirs extraordinaires | 26 | 59 |
| pensions vieillesse | 60 | 19 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 66 | 98 |
| *1946–1947* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 103 | 50 | allocations familiales | 57 | 111 |
| prisonniers politiques | 140 | 91 | juge paix | 38 | 89 |
| société nationale | 85 | 37 | sous officiers | 13 | 46 |
| classe ouvrière | 103 | 57 | prix revient | 78 | 109 |
| personnel enseignant | 64 | 20 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 7 | 37 |
| *1947–1949* | | | | | |
| plan marshall | 174 | 100 | classes moyennes | 88 | 137 |
| classe ouvrière | 85 | 26 | neuf ans | 6 | 53 |
| mobilisation civile | 57 | 5 | commerce extérieur | 45 | 90 |
| allocations compensatoires | 72 | 28 | juge paix | 36 | 78 |
| société nationale | 131 | 92 | banque nationale | 62 | 102 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| membres conseil | 149 | 70 | eaux usées | 10 | 66 |
| consultation populaire | 400 | 323 | dommages guerre | 29 | 63 |
| libre belgique | 62 | 16 | société nationale | 53 | 83 |
| question royale | 162 | 122 | collège électoral | 18 | 47 |
| vrai oui | 46 | 11 | organisations ouvrières | 15 | 44 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C40:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1950–1952* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 133 | 17 | classes moyennes | 46 | 83 |
| personnel enseignant | 115 | 38 | dommages guerre | 42 | 77 |
| sécurité sociale | 138 | 68 | enseignement moyen | 41 | 69 |
| chemin fer | 105 | 55 | congo belge | 18 | 44 |
| services publics | 81 | 31 | loi 1947 | 7 | 30 |
| *1952–1954* | | | | | |
| plan schuman | 142 | 73 | dommages guerre | 22 | 56 |
| victimes civiles | 89 | 32 | après ordres | 2 | 30 |
| assurés libres | 74 | 21 | experts comptables | 4 | 30 |
| personnel enseignant | 84 | 32 | commerce extérieur | 19 | 44 |
| santé publique | 83 | 44 | congo belge | 24 | 49 |
| *1954–1956* | | | | | |
| personnel enseignant | 92 | 19 | banque nationale | 27 | 77 |
| travailleurs indépendants | 106 | 47 | fonds routes | 11 | 55 |
| enseignement libre | 211 | 154 | taxe transmission | 18 | 56 |
| enseignement officiel | 114 | 58 | instruction publique | 108 | 142 |
| santé publique | 129 | 77 | enseignement public | 38 | 72 |
| *1956–1958* | | | | | |
| oeuvre nationale | 77 | 10 | classes moyennes | 69 | 190 |
| conseil administration | 87 | 22 | banque nationale | 22 | 120 |
| santé publique | 104 | 50 | dette publique | 11 | 65 |
| classe ouvrière | 78 | 29 | haute conjoncture | 21 | 69 |
| société nationale | 124 | 82 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 10 | 44 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 94 | 20 | congo belge | 70 | 172 |
| loi unique | 120 | 58 | table ronde | 99 | 141 |
| pacte scolaire | 89 | 33 | politique scientifique | 3 | 40 |
| services publics | 103 | 52 | ruanda urundi | 73 | 107 |
| personnel enseignant | 60 | 12 | marché commun | 71 | 100 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C41:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1961–1963* | | | | | |
| classe ouvrière | 89 | 4 | assistance technique | 26 | 67 |
| organisations syndicales | 97 | 27 | marché commun | 107 | 141 |
| services publics | 106 | 58 | pays voie | 11 | 42 |
| santé publique | 124 | 81 | besoins vitaux | 12 | 42 |
| loi unique | 108 | 75 | voie développement | 10 | 40 |
| *1963–1965* | | | | | |
| corps médical | 168 | 91 | assistance technique | 35 | 114 |
| services publics | 142 | 86 | pays voie | 8 | 48 |
| etats unis | 117 | 64 | voie développement | 8 | 46 |
| maladie invalidité | 184 | 132 | outre mer | 5 | 41 |
| assurance maladie | 190 | 142 | sécurité sociale | 50 | 85 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 194 | 63 | cour comptes | 10 | 75 |
| assurance maladie | 147 | 54 | assistance technique | 6 | 54 |
| maladie invalidité | 135 | 52 | économique wallon | 15 | 53 |
| corps médical | 69 | 14 | lois linguistiques | 18 | 48 |
| ouvriers mineurs | 60 | 8 | autoroute wallonie | 21 | 51 |
| *1968–1969* | | | | | |
| organisations syndicales | 132 | 15 | conseil économique | 102 | 190 |
| maladies professionnelles | 95 | 38 | code judiciaire | 6 | 53 |
| ouvriers mineurs | 64 | 18 | économique wallon | 30 | 71 |
| marché commun | 129 | 89 | région flamande | 17 | 57 |
| union soviétique | 38 | 6 | minimum vital | 11 | 48 |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| santé publique | 153 | 75 | conseil culturel | 34 | 106 |
| distribution eau | 70 | 9 | police judiciaire | 42 | 99 |
| organisations syndicales | 114 | 59 | ik citeer | 9 | 62 |
| etats unis | 119 | 75 | conseil économique | 41 | 89 |
| marché commun | 105 | 67 | six communes | 19 | 66 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C42:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1971–1974* | | | | | |
| travailleurs frontaliers | 68 | 14 | classes moyennes | 36 | 115 |
| organisations syndicales | 109 | 54 | santé publique | 57 | 131 |
| marche famenne | 35 | 2 | conseil culturel | 52 | 103 |
| fonds communes | 54 | 23 | moyennes entreprises | 14 | 48 |
| régie postes | 49 | 20 | aménagement territoire | 32 | 64 |
| *1974–1977* | | | | | |
| aide sociale | 166 | 16 | économique sociale | 67 | 109 |
| centres publics | 77 | 5 | langue allemande | 16 | 57 |
| publics aide | 71 | 6 | communes facilités | 3 | 43 |
| conseil communal | 127 | 68 | région bruxelles | 5 | 42 |
| assistance publique | 71 | 17 | classes moyennes | 67 | 100 |
| *1977–1978* | | | | | |
| santé publique | 85 | 39 | finances publiques | 30 | 126 |
| conseil administration | 69 | 38 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 67 | 142 |
| famille libérale | 48 | 17 | pacte egmont | 14 | 62 |
| groupes financiers | 35 | 6 | conseil régional | 21 | 64 |
| etats unis | 87 | 59 | moyennes entreprises | 83 | 120 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| loi programme | 184 | 103 | région bruxelles | 15 | 66 |
| organisations syndicales | 96 | 28 | communauté germanophone | 5 | 56 |
| etats unis | 94 | 37 | finances publiques | 37 | 86 |
| défense nationale | 126 | 74 | région wallonne | 106 | 149 |
| sécurité sociale | 194 | 144 | matières personnalisables | 14 | 50 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C43:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1981–1983* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 244 | 120 | troisième circuit | 14 | 67 |
| cockerill sambre | 116 | 8 | classes moyennes | 26 | 74 |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 619 | 539 | temps travail | 29 | 70 |
| pleins pouvoirs | 91 | 11 | circuit travail | 11 | 49 |
| services publics | 137 | 61 | conseil communal | 31 | 67 |
| *1983–1985* | | | | | |
| services publics | 131 | 75 | temps travail | 28 | 103 |
| région wallonne | 103 | 47 | classes moyennes | 25 | 62 |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 151 | 97 | année scolaire | 22 | 51 |
| secteurs nationaux | 94 | 44 | langue allemande | 2 | 29 |
| poser question | 151 | 109 | travaux publics | 48 | 72 |
| *1985–1987* | | | | | |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 373 | 202 | droits succession | 134 | 230 |
| publicité commerciale | 88 | 16 | communauté européenne | 27 | 64 |
| sécurité sociale | 196 | 143 | finances publiques | 75 | 112 |
| education nationale | 166 | 115 | secteur textile | 8 | 44 |
| politique scientifique | 63 | 24 | juge instruction | 12 | 44 |
| *1988–1989* | | | | | |
| défense nationale | 217 | 70 | pacte scolaire | 22 | 131 |
| cour comptes | 113 | 8 | etat central | 117 | 177 |
| biologie clinique | 75 | 17 | région flamande | 21 | 71 |
| loi programme | 110 | 51 | cour arbitrage | 52 | 88 |
| budget général | 61 | 5 | conseil communal | 77 | 112 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| défense nationale | 191 | 92 | handelingen plenaire | 250 | 352 |
| etat major | 90 | 10 | loi financement | 27 | 76 |
| office contrôle | 88 | 31 | communauté européenne | 73 | 110 |
| santé publique | 84 | 33 | cour arbitrage | 14 | 46 |
| sécurité sociale | 154 | 105 | précompte professionnel | 13 | 35 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C44:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1991–1993* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 122 | 15 | communauté germanophone | 33 | 172 |
| partis politiques | 131 | 32 | plan convergence | 24 | 102 |
| conseil régional | 164 | 104 | loyauté fédérale | 25 | 87 |
| biologie clinique | 63 | 8 | congé politique | 18 | 64 |
| conseil administration | 68 | 15 | francophones périphérie | 14 | 59 |
| *1993–1995* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 487 | 270 | temps travail | 46 | 76 |
| congé politique | 127 | 22 | organisations syndicales | 3 | 19 |
| voulais voter | 109 | 34 | santé publique | 56 | 64 |
| organismes assureurs | 83 | 9 | représentants belgique | 635 | 639 |
| clauses sociales | 102 | 53 | annales handelingen | 588 | 592 |
| *1995–1997* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 786 | 548 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 91 | 344 |
| services publics | 88 | 33 | fiscale parafiscale | 29 | 90 |
| maladies chroniques | 51 | 8 | pression fiscale | 48 | 107 |
| organisations syndicales | 53 | 11 | union monétaire | 33 | 80 |
| sociales fiscales | 58 | 16 | huit ans | 22 | 54 |
| *1997–1999* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 199 | 70 | cour comptes | 24 | 129 |
| santé publique | 104 | 46 | juge instruction | 124 | 177 |
| etats membres | 86 | 42 | nouveau belgique | 2 | 49 |
| soins santé | 108 | 65 | supérieur contrôle | 17 | 57 |
| socialiste votera | 32 | 3 | purement simplement | 77 | 110 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| conséquence proposition | 57 | 4 | organisations syndicales | 33 | 49 |
| proposition modification | 54 | 8 | poser question | 98 | 114 |
| parole déclaration | 75 | 33 | non seulement | 169 | 170 |
| temps travail | 95 | 55 | union européenne | 160 | 161 |
| défense européenne | 43 | 10 | celle ci | 154 | 155 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C45:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2001–2003* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 183 | 68 | cour arbitrage | 25 | 81 |
| santé publique | 199 | 90 | arc ciel | 27 | 69 |
| services publics | 174 | 104 | accords bilatéraux | 8 | 50 |
| zones police | 151 | 87 | poser question | 80 | 100 |
| organisations syndicales | 83 | 33 | cour comptes | 21 | 38 |
| *2003–2005* | | | | | |
| soins santé | 370 | 212 | consultation populaire | 29 | 73 |
| service universel | 103 | 19 | gouvernement fédéral | 37 | 73 |
| sécurité sociale | 218 | 155 | vote automatisé | 6 | 31 |
| établissements pénitentiaires | 66 | 10 | poser question | 101 | 119 |
| organisations syndicales | 53 | 11 | pécule vacances | 13 | 27 |
| *2005–2007* | | | | | |
| organisations syndicales | 84 | 13 | dossier confidentiel | 32 | 90 |
| service universel | 74 | 33 | sécurité routière | 33 | 72 |
| santé publique | 92 | 52 | cour comptes | 19 | 49 |
| soins santé | 126 | 91 | adopter enfant | 5 | 26 |
| établissements pénitentiaires | 40 | 6 | gouvernement fédéral | 51 | 67 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| santé publique | 182 | 77 | titres services | 29 | 75 |
| soins santé | 183 | 82 | coopération développement | 48 | 76 |
| sécurité sociale | 193 | 95 | jeux hasard | 27 | 51 |
| crise financière | 159 | 84 | droits enfant | 20 | 40 |
| paradis fiscaux | 82 | 24 | état fédéral | 31 | 49 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C46:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2010–2012* | | | | | |
| groupe sncb | 154 | 53 | gouvernement affaires | 29 | 67 |
| santé publique | 131 | 55 | assistance avocat | 10 | 31 |
| sécurité sociale | 138 | 70 | union européenne | 284 | 287 |
| observatoire prix | 71 | 6 | celle ci | 143 | 144 |
| soins santé | 122 | 64 | doivent être | 135 | 136 |
| *2012–2014* | | | | | |
| partenaires sociaux | 200 | 125 | arrondissement judiciaire | 40 | 82 |
| pouvoir achat | 143 | 69 | supérieur justice | 9 | 34 |
| soins santé | 138 | 65 | juge paix | 16 | 36 |
| gouvernement fédéral | 126 | 53 | allocations chômage | 37 | 53 |
| états membres | 109 | 55 | chefs corps | 20 | 35 |
| *2014–2016* | | | | | |
| services publics | 244 | 58 | partenaires sociaux | 149 | 203 |
| saut index | 339 | 155 | contre terrorisme | 78 | 111 |
| tax shift | 201 | 125 | gouvernement fédéral | 52 | 83 |
| plus riches | 79 | 9 | arabie saoudite | 24 | 55 |
| sécurité sociale | 203 | 141 | génocide arménien | 17 | 47 |
| *2016–2019* | | | | | |
| saut index | 111 | 13 | extrêmement important | 28 | 67 |
| soins santé | 195 | 108 | pacte énergétique | 18 | 56 |
| sécurité sociale | 238 | 172 | santé publique | 43 | 80 |
| 67 ans | 71 | 7 | entités fédérées | 80 | 118 |
| tax shift | 148 | 86 | prendre compte | 14 | 48 |
| *2019–2021* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 236 | 61 | droit passerelle | 62 | 181 |
| paradis fiscaux | 105 | 19 | entités fédérées | 61 | 117 |
| soins santé | 237 | 152 | niveaux pouvoir | 35 | 76 |
| services publics | 136 | 63 | état islamique | 4 | 44 |
| conditions travail | 123 | 56 | gouvernement fédéral | 40 | 77 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C47:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2021–2024* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 145 | 81 | ose espérer | 9 | 47 |
| conditions travail | 104 | 44 | cour constitutionnelle | 53 | 91 |
| gaz électricité | 76 | 19 | partis majorité | 21 | 58 |
| cessez feu | 72 | 18 | droits patient | 13 | 48 |
| services publics | 95 | 50 | raison laquelle | 127 | 155 |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| travailleuses travailleurs | 119 | 10 | énergies fossiles | 8 | 58 |
| 67 ans | 106 | 6 | transition énergétique | 6 | 32 |
| travailleurs travailleuses | 125 | 28 | aidants proches | 12 | 34 |
| pouvoir achat | 205 | 123 | santé publique | 36 | 56 |
| services publics | 161 | 85 | travailleurs sociaux | 29 | 49 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C48:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1900–1902* | | | | | |
| 10 jaar | 2 | 2 | | | |
| sommige vragen | 2 | 2 | | | |
| sommigen wel | 2 | 2 | | | |
| sommige zaken | 2 | 2 | | | |
| sommigen zeggen | 2 | 2 | | | |
| *1902–1904* | | | | | |
| werkende klas | 231 | 26 | mager vee | 1347 | 1349 |
| | | | vlaamsche taal | 673 | 674 |
| | | | vlaamsche land | 479 | 480 |
| | | | ten gevolge | 416 | 417 |
| | | | één grote | 290 | 291 |
| *1906–1908* | | | | | |
| werkende klas | 555 | 126 | nationale bank | 188 | 516 |
| mager vee | 437 | 437 | jaar dienst | 448 | 449 |
| christen democratie | 67 | 67 | kleine bedienden | 273 | 274 |
| uitsluitend fransch | 168 | 168 | werklieden bedienden | 177 | 178 |
| katholieke regeering | 153 | 153 | dertig jaar | 185 | 185 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| werkende klas | 524 | 265 | kleine bedienden | 76 | 266 |
| grote mogendheden | 138 | 22 | spoorwegen posterijen | 553 | 554 |
| officieele scholen | 127 | 63 | jaar dienst | 333 | 334 |
| jaar 1962 | 1 | 1 | vlaamsche taal | 331 | 332 |
| | | | vlaamsche volk | 313 | 314 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C49:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1910–1912* | | | | | |
| private nijverheid | 657 | 22 | onderlingen bijstand | 483 | 489 |
| kleine bedienden | 745 | 281 | algemeen stemrecht | 324 | 329 |
| | | | werkende klas | 334 | 338 |
| | | | twintig jaar | 352 | 356 |
| | | | vlaamsche land | 356 | 360 |
| *1912–1914* | | | | | |
| uren dagen | 561 | 157 | vrije scholen | 277 | 320 |
| ten honderd | 441 | 69 | algemeen stemrecht | 708 | 716 |
| 14 jaar | 493 | 176 | officieele scholen | 321 | 325 |
| landen tuinbouw | 103 | 19 | vlaamsche volk | 303 | 306 |
| lager onderwijs | 202 | 165 | één grote | 280 | 283 |
| *1919–1921* | | | | | |
| werkende klas | 614 | 84 | oud strijders | 206 | 698 |
| voort brengen | 97 | 26 | landelijke politie | 69 | 210 |
| nationale maatschappij | 193 | 127 | syndicale vrijheid | 50 | 117 |
| kleine eigenaars | 65 | 19 | gewestelijke indeeling | 64 | 104 |
| arbeidende klas | 102 | 90 | verwoeste streken | 204 | 204 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C50:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1921–1923* | | | | | |
| werkende klas | 226 | 23 | middelbaar onderwijs | 172 | 436 |
| nationaal werk | 167 | 58 | gewestelijke indeeling | 64 | 192 |
| zoo lang | 153 | 61 | vierde graad | 30 | 157 |
| pensioen ontvangen | 108 | 26 | lager onderwijs | 229 | 326 |
| oud strijders | 243 | 172 | vlaamsche land | 105 | 173 |
| *1923–1925* | | | | | |
| werkende klas | 263 | 48 | vierde graad | 34 | 144 |
| werk kinderwelzijn | 187 | 60 | oud strijders | 229 | 325 |
| arbeidende klas | 72 | 59 | 65 jaar | 269 | 269 |
| kanaal terneuzen | 35 | 35 | grote markt | 178 | 179 |
| sluis terneuzen | 1 | 1 | volgende bepaling | 132 | 133 |
| *1925–1927* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 808 | 374 | oud strijders | 108 | 308 |
| drie jaar | 601 | 274 | zeer zeker | 41 | 75 |
| negen jaar | 397 | 111 | vóór oorlog | 292 | 296 |
| landbouw openbare | 240 | 132 | zes maanden | 263 | 267 |
| werkende klas | 90 | 19 | twee jaar | 237 | 239 |
| *1927–1929* | | | | | |
| gewestelijke indeeling | 316 | 52 | oud strijders | 183 | 531 |
| zes maanden | 560 | 313 | fransch belgisch | 37 | 204 |
| werkende klas | 160 | 5 | militair akkoord | 9 | 142 |
| maanden dienst | 199 | 46 | nationale maatschappij | 395 | 514 |
| departement landsverdediging | 166 | 19 | openbare werken | 229 | 337 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| nijverheid arbeid | 471 | 256 | oud strijders | 134 | 356 |
| openbare werken | 510 | 329 | vlaamsche land | 90 | 239 |
| werkende klas | 118 | 13 | vlaamsche volk | 153 | 269 |
| officieele scholen | 137 | 42 | fransch belgisch | 16 | 130 |
| dien zin | 167 | 81 | katholieke vlaamsche | 22 | 100 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C51:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1932–1934* | | | | | |
| openbaren onderstand | 293 | 32 | wet 1930 | 27 | 104 |
| sint truiden | 190 | 64 | oud strijders | 80 | 139 |
| openbare werken | 427 | 306 | nationale maatschappij | 283 | 285 |
| vrije scholen | 127 | 24 | ten gevolge | 208 | 209 |
| werkende klas | 124 | 51 | sociale voorzorg | 184 | 185 |
| *1934–1936* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 677 | 416 | oud strijders | 41 | 162 |
| west vlaanderen | 328 | 142 | fransch belgisch | 43 | 157 |
| provincie west | 168 | 35 | kroostrijke gezinnen | 92 | 189 |
| officieele scholen | 125 | 38 | militair akkoord | 20 | 106 |
| toestand landbouw | 112 | 27 | landen tuinbouw | 24 | 71 |
| *1936–1939* | | | | | |
| officieel onderwijs | 307 | 62 | nationale bank | 56 | 258 |
| jaar dienst | 186 | 69 | vlaamsche land | 142 | 260 |
| vrije scholen | 145 | 35 | verkeerswezen posterijen | 46 | 141 |
| officieele scholen | 126 | 30 | buitenlandsche politiek | 52 | 140 |
| terugwerkende kracht | 86 | 21 | kroostrijke gezinnen | 30 | 114 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| vierde graad | 148 | 9 | landen tuinbouw | 24 | 74 |
| werkende klas | 93 | 3 | nationale maatschappij | 366 | 368 |
| culturele autonomie | 101 | 32 | openbaar onderwijs | 306 | 308 |
| openbaren onderstand | 151 | 88 | technisch onderwijs | 295 | 297 |
| openbare werken | 320 | 257 | bespreking begroting | 232 | 233 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C52:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1944–1946* | | | | | |
| universitair hoger | 1 | 1 | | | |
| 10 jaar | 0 | 0 | | | |
| sommige sprekers | 19 | 19 | | | |
| sommige streken | 56 | 56 | | | |
| sommige vragen | 11 | 11 | | | |
| *1946–1947* | | | | | |
| economische unie | 271 | 92 | technisch onderwijs | 144 | 297 |
| politieke gevangenen | 272 | 112 | maatschappelijke zekerheid | 120 | 239 |
| werkende klas | 100 | 14 | onderwijzend personeel | 41 | 148 |
| economische problemen | 103 | 19 | ambachten neringen | 35 | 130 |
| internationale organisatie | 96 | 16 | sociale voorzorg | 182 | 224 |
| *1947–1949* | | | | | |
| fonds gemeenten | 123 | 28 | technisch onderwijs | 98 | 208 |
| steden gemeenten | 102 | 21 | nationale bank | 66 | 162 |
| centraal bestuur | 123 | 43 | volksgezondheid gezin | 76 | 166 |
| grote steden | 116 | 41 | nationale maatschappij | 256 | 343 |
| werkende klas | 77 | 6 | kroostrijke gezinnen | 57 | 132 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| algemene paritaire | 153 | 34 | rechterlijke orde | 51 | 183 |
| werkende klas | 73 | 29 | burgerlijke partij | 61 | 139 |
| gemengde militaire | 53 | 23 | rode kruis | 60 | 80 |
| arrondissement kortrijk | 71 | 71 | stad antwerpen | 57 | 57 |
| west vlaanderen | 66 | 66 | eenheid land | 158 | 158 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C53:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1950–1952* | | | | | |
| twintig maanden | 217 | 49 | maatschappelijke zekerheid | 152 | 278 |
| openbare werken | 315 | 169 | landen tuinbouw | 40 | 135 |
| officieel onderwijs | 192 | 91 | gebrekkigen verminkten | 41 | 127 |
| gehuwde vrouw | 121 | 38 | technisch onderwijs | 94 | 174 |
| burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers | 79 | 18 | belgisch congo | 73 | 151 |
| *1952–1954* | | | | | |
| heilige stoel | 330 | 48 | zelfstandige arbeiders | 114 | 397 |
| achttien maanden | 274 | 30 | technisch onderwijs | 95 | 330 |
| twintig maanden | 307 | 70 | hoge autoriteit | 56 | 195 |
| officieel onderwijs | 168 | 61 | belgisch congo | 153 | 240 |
| buitengewone begroting | 140 | 56 | gemeenschap kolen | 15 | 90 |
| *1954–1956* | | | | | |
| vier jaar | 310 | 131 | technisch onderwijs | 30 | 256 |
| rijksmiddelbare school | 130 | 27 | vrij onderwijs | 74 | 196 |
| vorige regering | 253 | 159 | lager onderwijs | 41 | 152 |
| openbare werken | 284 | 195 | vrij verzekerden | 95 | 199 |
| sint niklaas | 139 | 50 | openbaar onderwijs | 197 | 299 |
| *1956–1958* | | | | | |
| jonge mannen | 201 | 12 | sociale voorzorg | 168 | 256 |
| buitenlandse handel | 144 | 68 | technisch onderwijs | 69 | 151 |
| twintig maanden | 92 | 18 | zelfstandige arbeiders | 20 | 100 |
| nationaal inkomen | 123 | 54 | arbeid sociale | 178 | 244 |
| medisch schooltoezicht | 64 | 10 | openbare schuld | 29 | 95 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| nationale bank | 196 | 15 | vlaamse land | 65 | 222 |
| vorige regering | 170 | 63 | regionale economische | 24 | 87 |
| belgisch congo | 231 | 138 | ten overstaan | 166 | 223 |
| openbare schuld | 114 | 32 | rode kruis | 8 | 50 |
| belgische spoorwegen | 124 | 59 | economische politiek | 105 | 146 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C54:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1961–1963* | | | | | |
| arrondissement leper | 171 | 5 | fiscale hervorming | 193 | 316 |
| vitaal belang | 127 | 8 | kleine middelgrote | 20 | 133 |
| zaken energie | 127 | 31 | kadastraal inkomen | 110 | 215 |
| nationaal inkomen | 157 | 69 | vlaamse waalse | 34 | 128 |
| burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers | 89 | 9 | vlaamse land | 56 | 144 |
| *1963–1965* | | | | | |
| economische expansie | 221 | 98 | europese school | 9 | 113 |
| sociale partners | 152 | 31 | tweede taal | 60 | 148 |
| oud strijders | 128 | 11 | vlaamse land | 98 | 176 |
| orde geneesheren | 119 | 35 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 16 | 87 |
| burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers | 94 | 15 | middelbaar onderwijs | 68 | 132 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| onze landbouwers | 99 | 23 | openbare werken | 152 | 268 |
| bijzondere machten | 92 | 25 | universitaire expansie | 33 | 104 |
| lid staten | 101 | 37 | nationale partijen | 30 | 100 |
| vrije verzekering | 69 | 6 | wetenschappelijk onderzoek | 45 | 110 |
| nieuwe belastingen | 106 | 44 | jaar 1967 | 16 | 67 |
| *1968–1969* | | | | | |
| openbare besturen | 149 | 57 | technische ingenieurs | 33 | 175 |
| collectieve overeenkomsten | 96 | 12 | nationale opvoeding | 163 | 276 |
| onze landbouwers | 107 | 26 | openbare werken | 214 | 318 |
| sluiting ondernemingen | 89 | 18 | gewaarborgd inkomen | 29 | 110 |
| openbaar ambt | 105 | 45 | sociale voorzorg | 119 | 190 |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| verdovende middelen | 142 | 11 | hoger onderwijs | 30 | 166 |
| verenigde staten | 163 | 61 | secundair onderwijs | 42 | 133 |
| gerechtelijke politie | 96 | 15 | buitengewoon onderwijs | 15 | 71 |
| buitenlandse handel | 123 | 52 | universitair onderwijs | 22 | 66 |
| openbaar ambt | 130 | 65 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 20 | 61 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C55:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1971–1974* | | | | | |
| minder validen | 329 | 140 | openbare werken | 292 | 389 |
| arrondissement aalst | 144 | 29 | openbare onderstand | 51 | 107 |
| sociale voorzorg | 220 | 116 | academisch ziekenhuis | 4 | 61 |
| gewaarborgd inkomen | 170 | 98 | kleine middelgrote | 56 | 110 |
| grote steden | 88 | 33 | middelgrote ondernemingen | 28 | 74 |
| *1974–1977* | | | | | |
| openbare sector | 166 | 62 | hoger onderwijs | 50 | 138 |
| openbare werken | 360 | 262 | kleine middelgrote | 32 | 118 |
| openbare holding | 102 | 13 | sociale voorzorg | 61 | 138 |
| privé sector | 155 | 80 | middelgrote ondernemingen | 17 | 93 |
| hoog comité | 81 | 26 | lager onderwijs | 32 | 89 |
| *1977–1978* | | | | | |
| buitengewoon onderwijs | 110 | 6 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 20 | 141 |
| openbare werken | 311 | 210 | buitenlandse handel | 60 | 136 |
| nationale opvoeding | 199 | 125 | halle vilvoorde | 57 | 106 |
| rekening gehouden | 162 | 110 | hoog comité | 8 | 48 |
| secundair onderwijs | 76 | 29 | belgische dienst | 13 | 53 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| openbare sector | 196 | 46 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 48 | 273 |
| privé sector | 133 | 60 | gemeenschappen gewesten | 70 | 160 |
| el salvador | 77 | 10 | hoofdstedelijk gebied | 15 | 86 |
| rekening houdend | 173 | 113 | vlaanderen wallonië | 36 | 95 |
| bestuur postchecks | 78 | 20 | sociale zekerheid | 344 | 394 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C56:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1981–1983* | | | | | |
| bijzondere machten | 487 | 358 | cockerill sambre | 109 | 236 |
| sociale zekerheid | 358 | 238 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 49 | 142 |
| privé sector | 141 | 51 | openbare werken | 67 | 149 |
| openbare sector | 128 | 53 | gemeenschappen gewesten | 43 | 121 |
| gesubsidieerd onderwijs | 85 | 33 | openbaar vervoer | 82 | 143 |
| *1983–1985* | | | | | |
| deeltijdse arbeid | 103 | 42 | nationale sectoren | 76 | 173 |
| fiscale fraude | 74 | 18 | cockerill sambre | 55 | 141 |
| openbare diensten | 102 | 46 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 34 | 106 |
| inrichtende machten | 72 | 22 | openbare werken | 57 | 126 |
| sociale promotie | 92 | 42 | gemeenschappen gewesten | 34 | 87 |
| *1985–1987* | | | | | |
| openbaar ambt | 213 | 47 | europese gemeenschap | 122 | 209 |
| fiscale uitgaven | 158 | 36 | gemeenschappen gewesten | 36 | 111 |
| openbare diensten | 103 | 29 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 52 | 123 |
| vijf jaar | 167 | 103 | nationale regering | 108 | 152 |
| buitengewoon onderwijs | 45 | 2 | financieren saldo | 71 | 109 |
| *1988–1989* | | | | | |
| vaste leden | 112 | 3 | neen geantwoord | 16 | 126 |
| oudere werklozen | 126 | 37 | nationale bank | 88 | 169 |
| wetenschappelijk onderzoek | 158 | 71 | roerende voorheffing | 60 | 116 |
| nucleaire sector | 81 | 15 | wetenschappelijke culturele | 29 | 84 |
| sociale partners | 95 | 33 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 58 | 98 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| gewaarborgd inkomen | 180 | 47 | derde fase | 61 | 177 |
| 18 jaar | 126 | 23 | wetenschappelijke culturele | 35 | 90 |
| mannen vrouwen | 133 | 49 | openbare diensten | 60 | 112 |
| inkomen bejaarden | 100 | 24 | ongeboren leven | 6 | 54 |
| politie inlichtingendiensten | 80 | 20 | roerende voorheffing | 69 | 114 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C57:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1991–1993* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 299 | 110 | sint michielsakkoord | 172 | 413 |
| rijbewijs punten | 121 | 29 | halle vilvoorde | 67 | 94 |
| 18 jaar | 99 | 20 | kamer volksvertegenwoordigers | 1486 | 1491 |
| sociaal verzekerden | 57 | 20 | volksvertegenwoordigers belgië | 1429 | 1434 |
| belgië parlementaire | 45 | 10 | représentants belgique | 1420 | 1425 |
| *1993–1995* | | | | | |
| verenigde staten | 196 | 94 | sociale zekerheid | 714 | 984 |
| problemen rijzen | 77 | 16 | nationale bank | 56 | 156 |
| intergouvernementele conferentie | 70 | 15 | politieke partijen | 105 | 143 |
| buitenlands beleid | 97 | 43 | hoog comité | 25 | 57 |
| radioactief afval | 50 | 11 | comité toezicht | 28 | 34 |
| *1995–1997* | | | | | |
| sociale zekerheid | 1311 | 1088 | nationale bank | 27 | 68 |
| sociaal overleg | 252 | 71 | politieke benoemingen | 19 | 53 |
| medisch dossier | 145 | 37 | fiscale druk | 45 | 69 |
| modernisering sociale | 171 | 76 | vlaams parlement | 41 | 64 |
| deeltijdse arbeid | 143 | 76 | parlementaire onderzoekscommissie | 37 | 58 |
| *1997–1999* | | | | | |
| medisch dossier | 193 | 14 | hoog comité | 18 | 143 |
| politieke partijen | 314 | 153 | comité toezicht | 14 | 115 |
| chronische zieken | 134 | 20 | vlaams parlement | 101 | 184 |
| mannen vrouwen | 124 | 30 | belgische nationaliteit | 20 | 91 |
| europese unie | 220 | 144 | nationale bank | 32 | 81 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| actieve welvaartsstaat | 369 | 96 | belgische nationaliteit | 36 | 142 |
| sociaal overleg | 245 | 48 | halle vilvoorde | 34 | 132 |
| chronische zieken | 167 | 24 | snel belg | 11 | 25 |
| sociale partners | 253 | 126 | belg wet | 13 | 27 |
| sociale gesprekspartners | 118 | 10 | sociale zekerheid | 228 | 231 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C58:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2001–2003* | | | | | |
| binnen kader | 130 | 19 | vlaams parlement | 76 | 241 |
| sociale partners | 171 | 68 | veiligheid staat | 32 | 165 |
| bepaald ogenblik | 164 | 63 | halle vilvoorde | 46 | 135 |
| denk goed | 86 | 22 | snel belg | 10 | 87 |
| vrije beroepen | 103 | 40 | belg wet | 11 | 85 |
| *2003–2005* | | | | | |
| sociale partners | 321 | 105 | snel belg | 14 | 155 |
| wet major | 82 | 4 | belg wet | 16 | 154 |
| denk goed | 89 | 31 | fiscale amnestie | 18 | 155 |
| denk inderdaad | 74 | 22 | halle vilvoorde | 95 | 205 |
| economische inspectie | 53 | 3 | stemming bijgevolg | 12 | 53 |
| *2005–2007* | | | | | |
| sociale zekerheid | 332 | 138 | snel belg | 7 | 84 |
| sociale partners | 305 | 134 | belg wet | 8 | 84 |
| huiselijk geweld | 112 | 22 | belgische nationaliteit | 24 | 90 |
| collectieve schuldenregeling | 97 | 30 | nationale bank | 36 | 90 |
| zwarte lijst | 68 | 6 | wet houdende | 24 | 68 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| sociale partners | 528 | 209 | parlementaire onderzoekscommissie | 61 | 154 |
| sociale zekerheid | 456 | 224 | nationale bank | 112 | 188 |
| sociaal overleg | 173 | 50 | halle vilvoorde | 89 | 164 |
| pairé avec | 99 | 8 | vlaams parlement | 47 | 112 |
| oudere werknemers | 88 | 6 | snel belgwet | 12 | 61 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C59:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2010–2012* | | | | | |
| nucleaire centrales | 109 | 23 | fiscale fraude | 79 | 135 |
| hoofdelijke aansprakelijkheid | 107 | 23 | halle vilvoorde | 38 | 74 |
| interprofessioneel akkoord | 132 | 57 | sociale partners | 139 | 155 |
| nederland duitsland | 98 | 23 | lopende zaken | 463 | 468 |
| sociaal overleg | 156 | 87 | vorig jaar | 233 | 236 |
| *2012–2014* | | | | | |
| magistrale bereidingen | 151 | 10 | halle vilvoorde | 74 | 147 |
| fiscale paradijzen | 96 | 14 | gemiste kans | 67 | 114 |
| tijden crisis | 97 | 17 | sociale partners | 220 | 253 |
| heel europa | 70 | 17 | roerende voorheffing | 44 | 69 |
| europese commissie | 280 | 228 | federale overheid | 253 | 255 |
| *2014–2016* | | | | | |
| tax shift | 561 | 187 | gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 43 | 532 |
| vorige regering | 513 | 217 | zware beroepen | 68 | 178 |
| grote vermogens | 184 | 25 | europese unie | 237 | 294 |
| fiscale fraude | 214 | 97 | clos incident | 173 | 222 |
| sociaal overleg | 375 | 267 | intrafamiliaal geweld | 14 | 58 |
| *2016–2019* | | | | | |
| tweede pijler | 144 | 21 | europese unie | 145 | 296 |
| 45 jaar | 182 | 66 | saudi arabië | 106 | 198 |
| alle duidelijkheid | 207 | 95 | sociale zekerheid | 245 | 309 |
| minnelijke schikking | 230 | 127 | gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 5 | 59 |
| europese commissie | 321 | 224 | riziv nummers | 15 | 58 |
| *2019–2021* | | | | | |
| sterke overheid | 157 | 1 | gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 0 | 432 |
| sociale bescherming | 131 | 16 | europese unie | 289 | 380 |
| intrafamiliaal geweld | 158 | 88 | nieuwe belastingen | 27 | 76 |
| sociale zekerheid | 321 | 258 | ter stemming | 56 | 103 |
| internationaal recht | 85 | 26 | regering michel | 22 | 58 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C60:** Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

| Left | | | Other parties | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2021–2024* | | | | | |
| sociale bescherming | 218 | 39 | gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 0 | 792 |
| sterke overheid | 172 | 1 | nationale loterij | 14 | 124 |
| gewone mensen | 143 | 7 | nationale bank | 51 | 120 |
| werkende klas | 126 | 8 | state the | 27 | 87 |
| flexi jobs | 146 | 40 | europese commissie | 219 | 278 |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| sterke overheid | 282 | 2 | gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 0 | 1581 |
| werkende mensen | 311 | 56 | flexi jobs | 55 | 174 |
| sociale zekerheid | 563 | 314 | werkloosheidsuitkeringen tijd | 29 | 116 |
| werkende klas | 217 | 3 | nationale bank | 76 | 140 |
| sociaal akkoord | 200 | 26 | zweedse regering | 9 | 71 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C61:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1830s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1839–1841* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 515 | 512 | société générale | 112 | 382 |
| travaux publics | 266 | 265 | fil main | 9 | 63 |
| sucre exotique | 134 | 133 | avantages commerce | 6 | 59 |
| plus grande | 145 | 144 | fil mécanique | 14 | 59 |
| bons trésor | 126 | 125 | liste civile | 17 | 57 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C62:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1840s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1845–1848* | | | | | |
| cour comptes | 149 | 50 | travaux publics | 356 | 401 |
| chemin fer | 487 | 446 | juge paix | 40 | 80 |
| garde civique | 76 | 46 | industrie linière | 41 | 80 |
| sucre indigène | 75 | 47 | école vétérinaire | 9 | 32 |
| sucre exotique | 59 | 36 | province liège | 25 | 48 |
| *1848–1850* | | | | | |
| société générale | 58 | 17 | chemin fer | 308 | 611 |
| garde civique | 83 | 49 | enseignement religieux | 49 | 131 |
| banque nationale | 45 | 18 | enseignement moyen | 86 | 161 |
| lettre voiture | 35 | 8 | conseil mines | 27 | 89 |
| code pénal | 43 | 18 | canal charleroy | 40 | 99 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C63:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1850s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1850–1852* | | | | | |
| flandre occidentale | 72 | 22 | chemin fer | 608 | 827 |
| code civil | 81 | 39 | trésor public | 56 | 115 |
| ville wavre | 33 | 6 | droits différentiels | 43 | 99 |
| peine mort | 32 | 8 | travaux publics | 322 | 372 |
| cour comptes | 82 | 58 | dépôts mendicité | 27 | 61 |
| *1852–1854* | | | | | |
| flandre occidentale | 99 | 40 | commissaire arrondissement | 24 | 78 |
| demande concession | 48 | 30 | garde civique | 265 | 304 |
| banque nationale | 27 | 13 | flandre orientale | 43 | 69 |
| écoles moyennes | 20 | 6 | chemins vicinaux | 39 | 63 |
| expropriation forcée | 14 | 2 | prohibition sortie | 21 | 43 |
| *1857–1859* | | | | | |
| prud hommes | 299 | 141 | critique censure | 29 | 115 |
| conseils prud | 221 | 87 | ministres cultes | 140 | 216 |
| contrainte corps | 107 | 23 | chemin fer | 331 | 393 |
| ville anvers | 100 | 66 | administrateurs spéciaux | 15 | 69 |
| enseignement obligatoire | 45 | 12 | propose renvoi | 49 | 91 |
| *1859–1861* | | | | | |
| garde civique | 87 | 9 | vol domestique | 24 | 129 |
| bruxelles louvain | 85 | 43 | passe port | 20 | 99 |
| sucre betterave | 49 | 17 | fonds communal | 82 | 149 |
| cours certificat | 41 | 9 | cours légal | 43 | 87 |
| direct bruxelles | 54 | 24 | communes octroi | 78 | 119 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C64:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1860s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1861–1864* | | | | | |
| garde civique | 104 | 21 | loi 1842 | 34 | 73 |
| servitudes militaires | 101 | 27 | ministres cultes | 39 | 76 |
| citadelle nord | 67 | 21 | personnes civiles | 24 | 54 |
| travaux publics | 271 | 246 | réforme communale | 7 | 35 |
| ville anvers | 83 | 62 | instruction primaire | 56 | 84 |
| *1864–1866* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 523 | 441 | station intérieure | 9 | 55 |
| jonction directe | 26 | 4 | loi électorale | 38 | 66 |
| banque nationale | 38 | 17 | responsabilité ministérielle | 13 | 40 |
| écoles normales | 26 | 7 | armée permanente | 30 | 56 |
| centrale examiné | 28 | 10 | loi communale | 40 | 65 |
| *1866–1868* | | | | | |
| écoles adultes | 150 | 77 | conseil communal | 94 | 161 |
| loi 1842 | 168 | 98 | communal enghien | 9 | 58 |
| cour assises | 78 | 38 | suffrage universel | 114 | 144 |
| enseignement primaire | 91 | 52 | peine mort | 124 | 150 |
| code pénal | 125 | 89 | corps électoral | 63 | 86 |
| *1868–1870* | | | | | |
| sociétés coopératives | 75 | 6 | listes électorales | 37 | 103 |
| assemblée générale | 97 | 42 | conseil communal | 75 | 109 |
| sociétés anonymes | 138 | 84 | service militaire | 56 | 90 |
| écoles normales | 54 | 13 | visites domiciliaires | 19 | 51 |
| travail enfants | 32 | 3 | police judiciaire | 7 | 37 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C65:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1870s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1870–1872* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 805 | 599 | écoles moyennes | 101 | 187 |
| bassins houillers | 245 | 159 | banque nationale | 71 | 152 |
| compagnie bassins | 102 | 28 | écoles communales | 22 | 65 |
| arrondissement charleroi | 36 | 7 | suffrage universel | 33 | 76 |
| conseil communal | 121 | 95 | enseignement moyen | 48 | 90 |
| *1872–1874* | | | | | |
| juge instruction | 80 | 28 | écoles moyennes | 52 | 185 |
| partie civile | 70 | 28 | servitudes militaires | 48 | 151 |
| détention préventive | 64 | 28 | flandre occidentale | 38 | 82 |
| compagnie bassins | 42 | 8 | cour comptes | 14 | 52 |
| code instruction | 54 | 25 | sociétés coopératives | 18 | 53 |
| *1874–1876* | | | | | |
| juge paix | 128 | 51 | garde civique | 77 | 277 |
| peine mort | 50 | 5 | chambre commerce | 175 | 309 |
| code pénal | 50 | 14 | chemin fer | 476 | 586 |
| loi ventôse | 54 | 25 | travaux publics | 308 | 357 |
| caisses prévoyance | 38 | 10 | aucune espèce | 27 | 57 |
| *1876–1878* | | | | | |
| cours eau | 192 | 130 | écoles moyennes | 35 | 123 |
| bassins houillers | 66 | 22 | port ostende | 9 | 58 |
| code civil | 84 | 46 | chevaux mixtes | 27 | 70 |
| lit cours | 30 | 5 | listes électorales | 33 | 74 |
| question propriété | 30 | 6 | écoles normales | 24 | 63 |
| *1878–1880* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 453 | 349 | instruction publique | 114 | 279 |
| écoles communales | 135 | 81 | corps électoral | 42 | 117 |
| marques fabrique | 50 | 19 | valeur locative | 19 | 76 |
| parti clérical | 31 | 3 | enseignement libre | 28 | 80 |
| voies navigables | 52 | 26 | contribution personnelle | 18 | 60 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C66:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1880s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1880–1882* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 397 | 305 | instruction publique | 88 | 212 |
| écoles communales | 119 | 53 | cardinal nina | 9 | 83 |
| droit pêche | 73 | 21 | conseil communal | 123 | 196 |
| cours eau | 96 | 66 | ministres cultes | 57 | 110 |
| enseignement moyen | 68 | 43 | corps électoral | 52 | 99 |
| *1882–1884* | | | | | |
| suffrage universel | 73 | 39 | instruction publique | 99 | 285 |
| droit électoral | 68 | 35 | général major | 13 | 61 |
| carte géologique | 37 | 15 | conseil communal | 73 | 116 |
| eaux vie | 37 | 16 | major gratry | 12 | 52 |
| droits pilotage | 24 | 4 | députation permanente | 125 | 157 |
| *1884–1886* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 312 | 212 | écoles communales | 167 | 393 |
| droit auteur | 130 | 36 | pères famille | 94 | 193 |
| cuve matière | 59 | 3 | instruction publique | 86 | 167 |
| écoles moyennes | 61 | 32 | écoles adoptées | 107 | 181 |
| vaine pâture | 46 | 19 | école mixte | 18 | 78 |
| *1886–1888* | | | | | |
| concordat préventif | 68 | 9 | écoles communales | 78 | 197 |
| procureur général | 71 | 28 | conseil communal | 115 | 166 |
| tabac indigène | 35 | 4 | pères famille | 40 | 86 |
| juge instruction | 53 | 23 | écoles adoptées | 47 | 89 |
| partie civile | 45 | 21 | écoles libres | 64 | 101 |
| *1888–1890* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 401 | 297 | sûreté publique | 20 | 108 |
| prud hommes | 245 | 162 | ville gand | 17 | 66 |
| conseils prud | 172 | 108 | agents provocateurs | 4 | 51 |
| pays flamand | 90 | 45 | écoles spéciales | 63 | 102 |
| fer vicinaux | 64 | 36 | conseil communal | 44 | 81 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C67:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1890s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1890–1892* | | | | | |
| fonds communes | 116 | 44 | lieutenant général | 29 | 105 |
| dépôts mendicité | 42 | 13 | traitement attente | 71 | 145 |
| conseil supérieur | 47 | 19 | conseil communal | 58 | 123 |
| service hospitalier | 32 | 5 | suffrage universel | 73 | 127 |
| loi 1876 | 53 | 26 | service personnel | 48 | 99 |
| *1892–1894* | | | | | |
| représentation proportionnelle | 199 | 118 | suffrage universel | 178 | 308 |
| juge paix | 63 | 23 | chemin fer | 269 | 381 |
| minimum salaire | 37 | 6 | droit électoral | 67 | 129 |
| traverses métalliques | 35 | 6 | députation permanente | 56 | 107 |
| deux langues | 33 | 4 | loi électorale | 76 | 118 |
| *1894–1896* | | | | | |
| droit licence | 90 | 15 | conseil communal | 65 | 177 |
| chemin fer | 406 | 340 | suffrage universel | 44 | 125 |
| droit accise | 77 | 35 | classe ouvrière | 67 | 146 |
| id id | 42 | 2 | députation permanente | 52 | 99 |
| tabac indigène | 49 | 12 | loi scolaire | 11 | 52 |
| *1896–1898* | | | | | |
| garde civique | 254 | 171 | classe ouvrière | 43 | 150 |
| unions professionnelles | 278 | 221 | suffrage universel | 28 | 90 |
| pourrait être | 106 | 81 | représentation proportionnelle | 44 | 74 |
| faire commerce | 41 | 17 | vote plural | 9 | 31 |
| sociétés secours | 70 | 48 | service personnel | 54 | 74 |
| *1898–1900* | | | | | |
| juge paix | 106 | 43 | banque nationale | 136 | 365 |
| fer vicinaux | 62 | 22 | classe ouvrière | 36 | 133 |
| chemin fer | 308 | 270 | tramways bruxellois | 32 | 118 |
| cour militaire | 41 | 9 | suffrage universel | 52 | 129 |
| conseil guerre | 90 | 60 | conseil communal | 48 | 96 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C68:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1900–1902* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 405 | 282 | suffrage universel | 227 | 370 |
| jeux hasard | 115 | 31 | classe ouvrière | 39 | 121 |
| maisons jeux | 81 | 23 | représentation proportionnelle | 67 | 127 |
| cercles privés | 80 | 29 | conseil communal | 91 | 144 |
| gare centrale | 65 | 23 | vote plural | 50 | 95 |
| *1902–1904* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 520 | 329 | classe ouvrière | 48 | 133 |
| chef entreprise | 63 | 19 | lieutenant général | 31 | 96 |
| faute lourde | 76 | 35 | conseil communal | 66 | 119 |
| droit proportionnel | 36 | 5 | instruction publique | 42 | 67 |
| assurance obligatoire | 98 | 70 | heures travail | 16 | 39 |
| *1904–1906* | | | | | |
| repos dominical | 94 | 54 | lieutenant général | 91 | 173 |
| ligne défense | 41 | 12 | classe ouvrière | 42 | 111 |
| société belge | 44 | 15 | navire école | 26 | 69 |
| code civil | 88 | 60 | chemin fer | 299 | 339 |
| ponts chaussées | 44 | 16 | heures travail | 37 | 65 |
| *1906–1908* | | | | | |
| langue flamande | 107 | 52 | classe ouvrière | 27 | 111 |
| pays flamand | 72 | 45 | lieutenant général | 19 | 95 |
| code civil | 47 | 25 | conseil communal | 59 | 98 |
| enseignement moyen | 47 | 25 | heures travail | 49 | 85 |
| flamande pays | 45 | 23 | fer postes | 39 | 68 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| comité spécial | 114 | 28 | chemin fer | 333 | 420 |
| loi 1902 | 85 | 23 | classe ouvrière | 34 | 106 |
| temps service | 94 | 50 | fer postes | 34 | 93 |
| effectif paix | 70 | 35 | postes télégraphes | 38 | 89 |
| union minière | 48 | 18 | écoles normales | 41 | 92 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C69:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1910–1912* | | | | | |
| caisses prévoyance | 146 | 41 | classe ouvrière | 47 | 157 |
| chemin fer | 463 | 381 | lieutenant général | 19 | 109 |
| comité spécial | 48 | 7 | conseil communal | 60 | 127 |
| caisse retraite | 68 | 32 | députation permanente | 65 | 103 |
| gouverneur général | 51 | 21 | chef cabinet | 23 | 60 |
| *1912–1914* | | | | | |
| assemblée générale | 45 | 17 | classe ouvrière | 45 | 161 |
| bon marché | 64 | 39 | écoles communales | 87 | 201 |
| sous officiers | 37 | 14 | écoles adoptées | 99 | 157 |
| société nationale | 78 | 55 | suffrage universel | 75 | 125 |
| habitations bon | 40 | 19 | loi scolaire | 38 | 84 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C70:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1921–1923* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 347 | 262 | classe ouvrière | 64 | 147 |
| gardes champêtres | 111 | 66 | sciences arts | 92 | 152 |
| extrême gauche | 76 | 38 | industrie travail | 59 | 104 |
| grand duché | 55 | 22 | quatrième degré | 14 | 49 |
| pays flamand | 51 | 29 | écoles libres | 35 | 66 |
| *1923–1925* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 292 | 170 | service sauvetage | 9 | 85 |
| union douanière | 52 | 14 | classe ouvrière | 33 | 91 |
| prix maxima | 43 | 16 | sciences arts | 34 | 90 |
| sous officiers | 31 | 6 | société nationale | 47 | 102 |
| point arrêt | 29 | 4 | industrie travail | 99 | 142 |
| *1927–1929* | | | | | |
| prud hommes | 81 | 19 | défense nationale | 104 | 214 |
| conseils prud | 74 | 18 | classe ouvrière | 47 | 128 |
| prison école | 67 | 18 | personnel enseignant | 20 | 83 |
| juge paix | 51 | 11 | service militaire | 16 | 57 |
| condamnation conditionnelle | 46 | 9 | six mois | 89 | 123 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| sociétés privées | 34 | 6 | industrie travail | 77 | 171 |
| libre échange | 51 | 23 | classe ouvrière | 71 | 149 |
| seconde langue | 70 | 45 | société nationale | 117 | 180 |
| deux langues | 46 | 21 | écoles communales | 18 | 57 |
| responsabilité limitée | 26 | 2 | sciences arts | 69 | 107 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C71:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1932–1934* | | | | | |
| caisse nationale | 77 | 11 | classe ouvrière | 101 | 275 |
| allocations familiales | 123 | 60 | pleins pouvoirs | 39 | 202 |
| tenir compte | 163 | 102 | liste arrondissement | 14 | 81 |
| juge paix | 87 | 30 | allocations chômage | 37 | 92 |
| agents change | 56 | 15 | défense nationale | 93 | 142 |
| *1934–1936* | | | | | |
| juge paix | 48 | 7 | classe ouvrière | 56 | 313 |
| nord midi | 47 | 13 | arrêtés lois | 66 | 305 |
| société nations | 43 | 23 | union nationale | 20 | 194 |
| croix feu | 27 | 8 | gouvernement union | 7 | 138 |
| gouverneur général | 25 | 5 | petite épargne | 55 | 170 |
| *1936–1939* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 84 | 43 | banque nationale | 89 | 254 |
| travaux publics | 104 | 76 | classes moyennes | 86 | 154 |
| santé publique | 104 | 76 | classe ouvrière | 85 | 136 |
| éducation physique | 31 | 8 | quarante heures | 23 | 74 |
| beaux arts | 23 | 6 | crédit industrie | 2 | 38 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 142 | 94 | charges sociales | 16 | 66 |
| santé publique | 107 | 61 | sous officiers | 32 | 69 |
| société nationale | 112 | 78 | masses laborieuses | 1 | 37 |
| beaux arts | 39 | 14 | heures travail | 19 | 54 |
| écoles moyennes | 39 | 16 | allocations familiales | 58 | 90 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C72:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1944–1946* | | | | | |
| prisonniers politiques | 190 | 95 | impôt exceptionnel | 6 | 91 |
| secours civil | 59 | 5 | emprunt forcé | 9 | 74 |
| sécurité sociale | 72 | 33 | impôt spécial | 22 | 86 |
| nations unies | 56 | 29 | amnistie fiscale | 19 | 77 |
| théâtre national | 46 | 26 | impôt capital | 40 | 93 |
| *1946–1947* | | | | | |
| assistance publique | 98 | 18 | allocations familiales | 47 | 146 |
| personnel enseignant | 62 | 13 | banque emission | 8 | 78 |
| main oeuvre | 135 | 93 | banque nationale | 27 | 96 |
| prisonniers politiques | 131 | 88 | sous officiers | 11 | 58 |
| santé publique | 101 | 64 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 6 | 46 |
| *1947–1949* | | | | | |
| société nationale | 135 | 56 | prisonniers politiques | 48 | 112 |
| chemin fer | 109 | 46 | allocations compensatoires | 30 | 86 |
| juge paix | 76 | 20 | coût vie | 37 | 88 |
| plan marshall | 145 | 103 | syndicats libéraux | 7 | 57 |
| arrêté loi | 58 | 30 | services publics | 36 | 73 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| eaux usées | 54 | 22 | question royale | 97 | 177 |
| cours eau | 52 | 26 | membres conseil | 84 | 136 |
| prince régent | 52 | 26 | libre belgique | 17 | 62 |
| pouvoirs représentants | 32 | 7 | vrai oui | 9 | 48 |
| après ordres | 29 | 4 | oui non | 51 | 71 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C73:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1950–1952* | | | | | |
| experts comptables | 42 | 9 | personnel enseignant | 25 | 96 |
| reviseurs entreprises | 46 | 14 | classe ouvrière | 25 | 87 |
| fonds communes | 56 | 25 | quatre mois | 33 | 91 |
| enseignement public | 62 | 32 | etats unis | 62 | 115 |
| neuf ans | 42 | 14 | coût vie | 43 | 95 |
| *1952–1954* | | | | | |
| enseignement public | 99 | 44 | plan schuman | 30 | 134 |
| enseignement technique | 102 | 56 | classes moyennes | 62 | 98 |
| experts comptables | 50 | 5 | office séquestres | 1 | 35 |
| enseignement moyen | 125 | 80 | etats unis | 63 | 96 |
| pouvoirs spéciaux | 56 | 13 | victimes civiles | 38 | 71 |
| *1954–1956* | | | | | |
| haute autorité | 73 | 20 | instruction publique | 100 | 159 |
| société nationale | 165 | 117 | enseignement public | 40 | 84 |
| gouvernement précédent | 123 | 79 | maladie invalidité | 40 | 82 |
| après ordres | 35 | 1 | enseignement moyen | 112 | 153 |
| grande bretagne | 50 | 20 | fonds routes | 15 | 56 |
| *1956–1958* | | | | | |
| conseil national | 160 | 60 | allocations familiales | 55 | 141 |
| marché commun | 164 | 114 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 5 | 62 |
| secteur privé | 80 | 37 | enseignement libre | 35 | 73 |
| national charbonnages | 69 | 27 | travail prévoyance | 47 | 85 |
| oeuvre nationale | 56 | 22 | ouvriers mineurs | 43 | 79 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| congo belge | 175 | 74 | loi unique | 61 | 124 |
| table ronde | 146 | 99 | classe ouvrière | 23 | 86 |
| politique scientifique | 40 | 3 | personnel enseignant | 11 | 61 |
| ruanda urundi | 104 | 76 | pacte scolaire | 35 | 84 |
| gouverneur général | 53 | 30 | instruction publique | 42 | 87 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C74:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1961–1963* | | | | | |
| assistance technique | 66 | 14 | réforme fiscale | 92 | 172 |
| nations unies | 73 | 22 | loi unique | 64 | 144 |
| chemin fer | 156 | 107 | assistance publique | 56 | 136 |
| allocations familiales | 90 | 53 | classe ouvrière | 23 | 72 |
| santé publique | 111 | 79 | taxe transmission | 15 | 62 |
| *1963–1965* | | | | | |
| assistance technique | 97 | 19 | indice prix | 12 | 73 |
| corps médical | 147 | 85 | prix détail | 25 | 84 |
| allocations familiales | 93 | 31 | hausse prix | 20 | 66 |
| organismes assureurs | 57 | 26 | dépenses militaires | 10 | 52 |
| sécurité sociale | 76 | 45 | frais production | 7 | 44 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| cour comptes | 78 | 11 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 60 | 176 |
| assistance technique | 62 | 5 | maladie invalidité | 57 | 117 |
| budget ordinaire | 49 | 17 | assurance maladie | 66 | 121 |
| coopération développement | 33 | 2 | corps médical | 15 | 58 |
| défense nationale | 106 | 78 | education nationale | 88 | 122 |
| *1968–1969* | | | | | |
| etats unis | 131 | 70 | personnes âgées | 40 | 92 |
| centres santé | 45 | 4 | conseil économique | 119 | 170 |
| question posée | 133 | 93 | revenu garanti | 22 | 58 |
| nations unies | 39 | 8 | ouvriers mineurs | 28 | 58 |
| gouvernement belge | 63 | 34 | économique wallon | 35 | 62 |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| pays voie | 132 | 15 | police judiciaire | 32 | 124 |
| voie développement | 130 | 13 | classes moyennes | 22 | 77 |
| parlement européen | 97 | 17 | conseil culturel | 56 | 95 |
| coopération développement | 65 | 10 | région flamande | 23 | 52 |
| secteur public | 72 | 27 | chemin fer | 25 | 53 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C75:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1971–1974* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 95 | 40 | conseil culturel | 64 | 99 |
| travailleurs indépendants | 87 | 34 | emplois nouveaux | 12 | 39 |
| société nationale | 64 | 23 | partis traditionnels | 3 | 23 |
| pension nationale | 35 | 2 | fraude fiscale | 16 | 35 |
| promotion sociale | 40 | 8 | bruxelles capitale | 11 | 30 |
| *1974–1977* | | | | | |
| classes moyennes | 137 | 60 | aide sociale | 25 | 117 |
| langue allemande | 64 | 15 | conseil communal | 69 | 121 |
| catégories sociales | 43 | 4 | education nationale | 52 | 104 |
| partenaires sociaux | 54 | 16 | centres publics | 7 | 55 |
| économique sociale | 110 | 74 | publics aide | 8 | 52 |
| *1977–1978* | | | | | |
| langue allemande | 68 | 9 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 49 | 192 |
| régie postes | 68 | 15 | classes moyennes | 55 | 165 |
| education nationale | 96 | 67 | moyennes entreprises | 72 | 145 |
| eau heure | 31 | 3 | petites moyennes | 88 | 156 |
| industrie aéronautique | 44 | 16 | secteur public | 66 | 105 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| etats unis | 92 | 38 | taux intérêt | 29 | 79 |
| gouvernement belge | 90 | 41 | communauté flamande | 15 | 59 |
| education nationale | 101 | 64 | région bruxelles | 24 | 63 |
| pacte scolaire | 53 | 16 | communautés régions | 35 | 72 |
| coopération développement | 59 | 24 | secteur public | 35 | 69 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C76:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1981–1983* | | | | | |
| classes moyennes | 96 | 32 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 417 | 657 |
| troisième circuit | 71 | 17 | cockerill sambre | 7 | 98 |
| education nationale | 210 | 159 | fraude fiscale | 23 | 92 |
| temps travail | 76 | 32 | pleins pouvoirs | 8 | 63 |
| circuit travail | 52 | 13 | sécurité sociale | 143 | 196 |
| *1983–1985* | | | | | |
| temps travail | 102 | 41 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 69 | 153 |
| politique scientifique | 61 | 20 | modération salariale | 48 | 89 |
| education nationale | 173 | 136 | région wallonne | 54 | 88 |
| chefs établissements | 56 | 21 | sécurité sociale | 98 | 131 |
| année scolaire | 55 | 24 | pouvoir achat | 20 | 53 |
| *1985–1987* | | | | | |
| secteur textile | 63 | 6 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 182 | 335 |
| juge instruction | 62 | 13 | libre belgique | 21 | 68 |
| candidats réfugiés | 49 | 14 | francophones majorité | 6 | 50 |
| police judiciaire | 43 | 10 | publicité commerciale | 27 | 66 |
| procureur général | 49 | 17 | education nationale | 115 | 150 |
| *1988–1989* | | | | | |
| cour comptes | 65 | 10 | pacte scolaire | 56 | 135 |
| communauté germanophone | 66 | 17 | conseil communal | 54 | 121 |
| charges intérêts | 52 | 13 | culturelles nationales | 13 | 74 |
| rigueur budgétaire | 40 | 4 | etat central | 126 | 184 |
| crédits provisoires | 45 | 10 | publics institutions | 19 | 74 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| juge instruction | 143 | 50 | loi financement | 25 | 90 |
| nations unies | 106 | 51 | culturelles nationales | 28 | 86 |
| procureur général | 91 | 39 | scientifiques culturelles | 31 | 82 |
| police judiciaire | 93 | 43 | publics institutions | 32 | 79 |
| etat major | 47 | 15 | institutions scientifiques | 33 | 75 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C77:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1991–1993* | | | | | |
| aide sociale | 76 | 34 | loyauté fédérale | 24 | 96 |
| travailleurs sociaux | 46 | 11 | réforme etat | 113 | 178 |
| chemin fer | 58 | 23 | francophones périphérie | 9 | 68 |
| comité avis | 47 | 11 | communauté germanophone | 103 | 162 |
| partis politiques | 69 | 38 | etat fédéral | 132 | 183 |
| *1993–1995* | | | | | |
| êtres humains | 127 | 61 | campagne information | 19 | 64 |
| traite êtres | 110 | 46 | allocations familiales | 40 | 75 |
| congé politique | 77 | 23 | dépenses électorales | 63 | 97 |
| juge instruction | 63 | 17 | électeurs inscrits | 17 | 46 |
| remise dette | 47 | 8 | campagne électorale | 19 | 48 |
| *1995–1997* | | | | | |
| sécurité sociale | 669 | 558 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 72 | 399 |
| dette publique | 105 | 30 | pression fiscale | 55 | 113 |
| etats membres | 91 | 34 | fiscale parafiscale | 41 | 93 |
| union européenne | 116 | 61 | peines incompressibles | 22 | 70 |
| monnaie unique | 86 | 38 | libération conditionnelle | 45 | 90 |
| *1997–1999* | | | | | |
| etats membres | 97 | 17 | cour comptes | 46 | 147 |
| sécurité sociale | 139 | 75 | nouveau belgique | 2 | 93 |
| consommation drogues | 42 | 3 | juge instruction | 118 | 194 |
| union européenne | 117 | 81 | purement simplement | 67 | 123 |
| extrême droite | 68 | 34 | comité supérieur | 18 | 69 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| police locale | 79 | 25 | coopération développement | 44 | 144 |
| services police | 88 | 41 | nations unies | 21 | 84 |
| criminalité organisée | 55 | 15 | principe précaution | 32 | 83 |
| organisations syndicales | 58 | 23 | purement simplement | 74 | 121 |
| temps travail | 70 | 49 | pénale internationale | 13 | 51 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C78:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2001–2003* | | | | | |
| police locale | 99 | 24 | cour arbitrage | 25 | 183 |
| criminalité organisée | 60 | 12 | soins palliatifs | 32 | 140 |
| accords bilatéraux | 51 | 9 | réforme polices | 68 | 131 |
| organisations syndicales | 55 | 14 | bruxelles hal | 7 | 51 |
| nations unies | 67 | 30 | arc ciel | 48 | 86 |
| *2003–2005* | | | | | |
| service universel | 71 | 20 | entités fédérées | 40 | 109 |
| santé publique | 130 | 82 | gouvernement fédéral | 40 | 95 |
| procureur général | 59 | 22 | titres services | 16 | 68 |
| peine travail | 39 | 8 | créances alimentaires | 54 | 93 |
| établissements pénitentiaires | 39 | 13 | communautés régions | 29 | 68 |
| *2005–2007* | | | | | |
| cour arbitrage | 144 | 92 | one shot | 7 | 55 |
| services police | 72 | 29 | cour comptes | 21 | 66 |
| juge instruction | 109 | 69 | demandeurs asile | 21 | 63 |
| organisations syndicales | 45 | 14 | nouvelle fois | 22 | 63 |
| loi 2003 | 35 | 10 | centres fermés | 32 | 72 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| santé publique | 129 | 47 | sécurité sociale | 107 | 146 |
| pouvoir achat | 155 | 80 | fonds vieillissement | 14 | 49 |
| partenaires sociaux | 151 | 110 | entités fédérées | 30 | 59 |
| plan relance | 76 | 45 | intérêts notionnels | 58 | 81 |
| maladies chroniques | 48 | 19 | organisation travaux | 5 | 28 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C79:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2010–2012* | | | | | |
| accord gouvernement | 105 | 58 | intérêts notionnels | 34 | 107 |
| abus sexuels | 74 | 31 | temps partiel | 8 | 57 |
| coopération développement | 61 | 18 | crédit temps | 8 | 42 |
| nations unies | 60 | 29 | autorité nationale | 3 | 31 |
| nom groupe | 44 | 25 | efficacité énergétique | 5 | 31 |
| *2012–2014* | | | | | |
| accord gouvernement | 121 | 43 | intérêts notionnels | 66 | 285 |
| santé publique | 82 | 36 | région bruxelloise | 32 | 109 |
| partenaires sociaux | 160 | 115 | fraude fiscale | 63 | 125 |
| coopération développement | 68 | 24 | ajustement budgétaire | 22 | 69 |
| compétitivité entreprises | 54 | 14 | système fiscal | 20 | 67 |
| *2014–2016* | | | | | |
| accord gouvernement | 230 | 118 | saut index | 94 | 256 |
| réforme pensions | 110 | 37 | sécurité sociale | 103 | 179 |
| âge légal | 77 | 38 | services publics | 67 | 143 |
| entités fédérées | 94 | 56 | fraude fiscale | 64 | 139 |
| 63 ans | 43 | 6 | tax shift | 94 | 167 |
| *2016–2019* | | | | | |
| pouvoir achat | 141 | 45 | sécurité sociale | 136 | 211 |
| extrêmement important | 120 | 30 | voitures société | 18 | 67 |
| entités fédérées | 151 | 89 | saut index | 16 | 55 |
| pension complémentaire | 72 | 12 | fraude fiscale | 55 | 94 |
| commission européenne | 154 | 102 | paradis fiscaux | 6 | 44 |
| *2019–2021* | | | | | |
| droit passerelle | 225 | 79 | comptes titres | 19 | 101 |
| union européenne | 223 | 149 | paradis fiscaux | 14 | 90 |
| travailleurs indépendants | 73 | 23 | sécurité sociale | 77 | 152 |
| transition énergétique | 53 | 5 | pouvoirs spéciaux | 33 | 98 |
| niveau européen | 95 | 53 | taxe comptes | 13 | 63 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C80:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2021–2024* | | | | | |
| travailleurs travailleuses | 70 | 11 | courtes peines | 9 | 56 |
| femmes hommes | 72 | 19 | police judiciaire | 46 | 88 |
| celles ceux | 64 | 22 | ose espérer | 11 | 52 |
| toutes tous | 49 | 12 | oui nee | 1 | 41 |
| nations unies | 63 | 27 | abstentions totaal | 1 | 41 |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| accord gouvernement | 359 | 260 | travailleurs travailleuses | 10 | 87 |
| union européenne | 291 | 193 | 67 ans | 5 | 74 |
| transition énergétique | 50 | 5 | tableaux budgétaires | 14 | 80 |
| travailleurs sociaux | 68 | 28 | travailleuses travailleurs | 14 | 80 |
| entités fédérées | 83 | 43 | celles ceux | 111 | 175 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C81:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1900–1902* | | | | | |
| vlaamsche volk | 1133 | 96 | algemeen stemrecht | 562 | 568 |
| | | | enkele woorden | 380 | 385 |
| | | | vlaamsche land | 210 | 213 |
| | | | onderlingen bijstand | 278 | 280 |
| | | | werkende klas | 370 | 373 |
| *1902–1904* | | | | | |
| 10 jaar | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommige vragen | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommigen wel | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommige zaken | 1 | 1 | | | |
| sommigen zeggen | 1 | 1 | | | |
| *1904–1906* | | | | | |
| alleen kwestie | 1 | 1 | | | |
| belgische nationale | 1 | 1 | | | |
| 10 jaar | 23 | 23 | | | |
| speciaal aandacht | 1 | 1 | | | |
| spaaren lijfrentekas | 1 | 1 | | | |
| *1906–1908* | | | | | |
| vlaamsche volk | 493 | 310 | nationale bank | 185 | 619 |
| mager vee | 442 | 439 | bedienden werklieden | 129 | 419 |
| jaar dienst | 451 | 449 | | | |
| west vlaanderen | 352 | 350 | | | |
| werkende klas | 352 | 350 | | | |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| kleine bedienden | 299 | 91 | burgerlijke stand | 42 | 255 |
| spoorwegen posterijen | 550 | 548 | ambtenaar burgerlijke | 50 | 182 |
| posterijen telegrafen | 384 | 383 | vlaamsche volk | 264 | 367 |
| vlaamsche taal | 329 | 328 | werkende klas | 423 | 423 |
| jaar dienst | 336 | 335 | 67 jaar | 57 | 57 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C82:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1910–1912* | | | | | |
| onderlingen bijstand | 488 | 486 | private nijverheid | 54 | 278 |
| kleine bedienden | 355 | 354 | | | |
| vlaamsche land | 359 | 358 | | | |
| werkende klas | 338 | 337 | | | |
| twintig jaar | 358 | 357 | | | |
| *1912–1914* | | | | | |
| algemeen stemrecht | 868 | 306 | lagere scholen | 61 | 517 |
| officieele scholen | 325 | 323 | vlaamsche volk | 220 | 480 |
| vrije scholen | 315 | 313 | lager onderwijs | 110 | 337 |
| één grote | 284 | 282 | ten honderd | 87 | 208 |
| jaar dienst | 268 | 266 | tweede taal | 96 | 217 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C83:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1921–1923* | | | | | |
| middelbaar onderwijs | 520 | 116 | oud strijders | 118 | 301 |
| lager onderwijs | 359 | 202 | vlaamsche soldaten | 54 | 166 |
| vierde graad | 160 | 40 | werkende klas | 82 | 192 |
| vlaamsche land | 172 | 127 | pensioen ontvangen | 24 | 101 |
| landen tuinbouw | 61 | 27 | pensioen toegekend | 23 | 87 |
| *1923–1925* | | | | | |
| vierde graad | 154 | 46 | vlaamsche volk | 99 | 177 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 103 | 32 | vóór oorlog | 345 | 346 |
| openbare werken | 294 | 240 | kosteloos pensioen | 266 | 266 |
| lagere scholen | 185 | 169 | nationale maatschappij | 310 | 311 |
| | | | 65 jaar | 269 | 269 |
| *1927–1929* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 476 | 195 | oud strijders | 184 | 459 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 274 | 114 | zes maanden | 323 | 474 |
| onderwijzend personeel | 154 | 50 | fransch belgisch | 39 | 176 |
| speciaal fonds | 86 | 13 | gewestelijke indeeling | 72 | 204 |
| één oplossing | 125 | 61 | vlaamsche volk | 76 | 177 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 233 | 72 | vlaamsche volk | 111 | 314 |
| ambachten neringen | 134 | 7 | fransch belgisch | 13 | 149 |
| kadastraal inkomen | 149 | 26 | militair akkoord | 2 | 126 |
| openbare werken | 446 | 335 | belgische staat | 49 | 162 |
| kamers ambachten | 95 | 16 | belgische regering | 87 | 180 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C84:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1932–1934* | | | | | |
| nationale maatschappij | 431 | 163 | vlaamsche volk | 94 | 281 |
| maatschappij buurtspoorwegen | 238 | 32 | besluit wet | 124 | 231 |
| technisch onderwijs | 174 | 26 | vlaamsche katholieken | 12 | 106 |
| wet 1930 | 165 | 19 | openbaren onderstand | 36 | 124 |
| sociale voorzorg | 262 | 130 | militair akkoord | 5 | 69 |
| *1934–1936* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 511 | 356 | vlaamsche volk | 75 | 471 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 204 | 96 | oud strijders | 59 | 333 |
| kadastraal inkomen | 171 | 94 | belgische staat | 36 | 208 |
| technisch onderwijs | 90 | 21 | fransch belgisch | 90 | 228 |
| onze nationale | 117 | 52 | vlaamsche land | 130 | 265 |
| *1936–1939* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 271 | 138 | vlaamsche volk | 163 | 326 |
| officieel onderwijs | 153 | 38 | vlaamsche land | 181 | 336 |
| sociale voorzorg | 187 | 96 | belgische staat | 49 | 160 |
| nationale maatschappij | 332 | 243 | buitenlandsche politiek | 88 | 179 |
| middelbare scholen | 106 | 38 | wij vlaamsche | 27 | 106 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| technisch onderwijs | 446 | 72 | vlaamsche volk | 51 | 184 |
| nationale maatschappij | 446 | 265 | vlaamsche soldaten | 26 | 135 |
| buitengewone begroting | 134 | 33 | vlaamsche land | 102 | 178 |
| openbare werken | 301 | 230 | uitsluitend fransch | 23 | 69 |
| onze nationale | 135 | 83 | wij vlaamsche | 19 | 59 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C85:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1944–1946* | | | | | |
| ambachten neringen | 184 | 34 | belasting kapitaal | 60 | 324 |
| arbeid sociale | 162 | 161 | dienst pensioenen | 130 | 365 |
| tijdens bezetting | 204 | 203 | onze jeugd | 107 | 107 |
| gedurende oorlog | 235 | 234 | voldoende reden | 1 | 1 |
| moeten betalen | 138 | 137 | rol overheid | 1 | 1 |
| *1946–1947* | | | | | |
| economische unie | 236 | 94 | technisch onderwijs | 107 | 345 |
| politieke gevangenen | 265 | 132 | dienst pensioenen | 44 | 197 |
| economische problemen | 83 | 28 | ambachten neringen | 13 | 159 |
| internationale organisatie | 69 | 22 | onderwijzend personeel | 74 | 141 |
| sint niklaas | 73 | 45 | landen tuinbouw | 43 | 103 |
| *1947–1949* | | | | | |
| nationale maatschappij | 327 | 186 | werkende klas | 23 | 256 |
| technisch onderwijs | 177 | 53 | verenigde staten | 130 | 324 |
| middelbaar onderwijs | 154 | 95 | sovjet unie | 11 | 184 |
| lager onderwijs | 87 | 37 | vlaamse volk | 24 | 137 |
| kroostrijke gezinnen | 106 | 74 | onze hoop | 8 | 107 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| vrij verzekerden | 183 | 183 | algemene paritaire | 29 | 156 |
| eenheid land | 158 | 158 | | | |
| arbeid sociale | 170 | 170 | | | |
| wetgevende macht | 155 | 154 | | | |
| sociale voorzorg | 169 | 168 | | | |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C86:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1950–1952* | | | | | |
| maatschappelijke zekerheid | 276 | 159 | twintig maanden | 55 | 195 |
| technisch onderwijs | 192 | 76 | openbare werken | 173 | 290 |
| landen tuinbouw | 136 | 40 | gehuwde vrouw | 40 | 111 |
| gebrekkigen verminkten | 135 | 40 | burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers | 13 | 78 |
| belgisch congo | 162 | 67 | sociale voorzorg | 231 | 292 |
| *1952–1954* | | | | | |
| technisch onderwijs | 361 | 74 | heilige stoel | 48 | 317 |
| zelfstandige arbeiders | 334 | 201 | achttien maanden | 31 | 253 |
| hoge autoriteit | 190 | 68 | twintig maanden | 78 | 272 |
| belgisch congo | 248 | 143 | buitengewone begroting | 42 | 154 |
| gemeenschappelijke markt | 116 | 31 | militaire diensttijd | 10 | 77 |
| *1954–1956* | | | | | |
| vier jaar | 309 | 118 | technisch onderwijs | 19 | 277 |
| vorige regering | 259 | 156 | openbaar onderwijs | 172 | 317 |
| openbare werken | 268 | 192 | sociale voorzorg | 182 | 323 |
| jonge mannen | 82 | 12 | vrij onderwijs | 70 | 206 |
| rijksmiddelbare school | 94 | 29 | vrij verzekerden | 80 | 215 |
| *1956–1958* | | | | | |
| jonge mannen | 183 | 11 | sociale voorzorg | 136 | 276 |
| openbare werken | 315 | 252 | technisch onderwijs | 48 | 166 |
| gemeenschappelijke markt | 164 | 105 | arbeid sociale | 171 | 250 |
| twintig maanden | 71 | 22 | belgisch congo | 139 | 218 |
| verenigde staten | 140 | 95 | kroostrijke gezinnen | 35 | 91 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 291 | 207 | nationale bank | 17 | 174 |
| haven antwerpen | 77 | 36 | vorige regering | 64 | 166 |
| regionale economische | 79 | 38 | belgisch congo | 137 | 217 |
| liberale groep | 55 | 15 | hoger onderwijs | 42 | 120 |
| economische politiek | 147 | 110 | openbare schuld | 34 | 108 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C87:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1961–1963* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 198 | 86 | fiscale hervorming | 214 | 488 |
| dienst pensioenen | 145 | 46 | arbeiders bedienden | 115 | 250 |
| burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers | 42 | 3 | nationale opvoeding | 194 | 309 |
| haven antwerpen | 97 | 59 | kleine middelgrote | 79 | 174 |
| vitaal belang | 50 | 19 | vlaamse land | 94 | 189 |
| *1963–1965* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 286 | 130 | tweede taal | 64 | 264 |
| gewestelijke investeringsmaatschappijen | 55 | 6 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 21 | 201 |
| nationale maatschappij | 122 | 73 | nationale opvoeding | 175 | 337 |
| burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers | 48 | 3 | hoger onderwijs | 80 | 237 |
| technisch onderwijs | 67 | 22 | vlaamse land | 127 | 257 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 278 | 197 | vrije universiteiten | 36 | 127 |
| jaar 1966 | 106 | 36 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 19 | 94 |
| wetenschappelijk onderzoek | 121 | 59 | nationale opvoeding | 254 | 319 |
| jaar 1967 | 77 | 23 | universitaire expansie | 60 | 121 |
| gemengde loopbaan | 80 | 32 | generaal toerisme | 6 | 64 |
| *1968–1969* | | | | | |
| openbare onderstand | 163 | 69 | technische ingenieurs | 74 | 259 |
| gewaarborgd inkomen | 118 | 60 | nationale opvoeding | 206 | 333 |
| paritaire comités | 59 | 18 | hoger onderwijs | 78 | 165 |
| collectieve arbeidsovereenkomsten | 51 | 10 | parlementaire vraag | 59 | 143 |
| technische bijstand | 53 | 15 | culturele autonomie | 102 | 177 |
| *1969–1971* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 361 | 257 | nationale opvoeding | 135 | 242 |
| nationale maatschappij | 184 | 97 | lager onderwijs | 40 | 138 |
| hoger onderwijs | 171 | 95 | universitaire expansie | 13 | 109 |
| minder validen | 94 | 21 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 20 | 98 |
| verzekering geven | 70 | 21 | economische hogeschool | 11 | 85 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C88:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1971–1974* | | | | | |
| minder validen | 213 | 119 | traditionele partijen | 7 | 114 |
| buitengewoon onderwijs | 82 | 17 | academisch ziekenhuis | 13 | 115 |
| openbare schuld | 78 | 15 | bevoegdheid cultuurraden | 10 | 68 |
| verzekering geven | 87 | 26 | militaire technische | 7 | 63 |
| openbare werken | 384 | 336 | syndicale vrijheid | 4 | 59 |
| *1974–1977* | | | | | |
| hoger onderwijs | 181 | 54 | openbare werken | 233 | 336 |
| buitengewoon onderwijs | 107 | 35 | nationale opvoeding | 183 | 263 |
| sociale zekerheid | 120 | 54 | vlaamse aangelegenheden | 33 | 103 |
| lager onderwijs | 106 | 45 | langstlevende echtgenoot | 17 | 77 |
| sociale voorzorg | 143 | 96 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 11 | 66 |
| *1977–1978* | | | | | |
| openbare werken | 276 | 84 | nationale investeringsmaatschappij | 29 | 245 |
| nationale opvoeding | 168 | 67 | openbare holding | 15 | 174 |
| vlaamse gemeenschap | 134 | 36 | zuid afrika | 26 | 138 |
| openbaar vervoer | 127 | 65 | toegevoegd eerste | 15 | 121 |
| sociale voorzorg | 88 | 43 | vlaamse aangelegenheden | 41 | 127 |
| *1979–1981* | | | | | |
| hoofdstedelijk gebied | 122 | 27 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 151 | 292 |
| openbare sector | 105 | 46 | studiemeester opvoeder | 10 | 72 |
| privé sector | 99 | 49 | vlaanderen wallonië | 52 | 113 |
| sociale gesprekspartners | 68 | 23 | gemeenschappen gewesten | 115 | 170 |
| rekening houdend | 146 | 101 | centrale regering | 5 | 58 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C89:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1981–1983* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 189 | 90 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 62 | 153 |
| europese commissie | 133 | 43 | centrale regering | 22 | 98 |
| cockerill sambre | 242 | 165 | openbare ziekenhuizen | 29 | 80 |
| vrije beroepen | 104 | 34 | sociale zekerheid | 252 | 294 |
| sovjet unie | 98 | 32 | openbare werken | 100 | 137 |
| *1983–1985* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 206 | 101 | vlaamse gemeenschap | 48 | 109 |
| stand gebracht | 85 | 24 | centrale regering | 9 | 65 |
| nationale sectoren | 170 | 118 | onze mening | 14 | 56 |
| vijf nationale | 60 | 13 | fiscale amnestie | 8 | 49 |
| westeuropese unie | 47 | 6 | sociale zekerheid | 263 | 304 |
| *1985–1987* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 309 | 102 | politieke vluchtelingen | 48 | 140 |
| sociale zekerheid | 282 | 194 | centrale regering | 6 | 82 |
| tijdens komende | 96 | 13 | openbaar ambt | 66 | 124 |
| netto financieren | 136 | 55 | vier jaar | 118 | 168 |
| financieren saldo | 135 | 68 | vlaamse meerderheid | 2 | 47 |
| *1988–1989* | | | | | |
| gemeenschappen gewesten | 352 | 168 | wetenschappelijke culturele | 24 | 134 |
| netto financieren | 156 | 80 | diensten nationale | 28 | 132 |
| financieren saldo | 150 | 83 | openbare financiën | 100 | 197 |
| sociale zekerheid | 441 | 385 | culturele instellingen | 26 | 118 |
| wij wensen | 111 | 58 | nationale wetenschappelijke | 28 | 117 |
| *1989–1991* | | | | | |
| europese gemeenschap | 330 | 190 | derde fase | 114 | 211 |
| europees parlement | 159 | 30 | vergaderingen vrijdag | 64 | 149 |
| gemeenschappen gewesten | 137 | 65 | openbaar vervoer | 71 | 143 |
| politieke unie | 90 | 31 | wetenschappelijke culturele | 50 | 117 |
| netto financieren | 75 | 16 | diensten nationale | 50 | 117 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C90:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1991–1993* | | | | | |
| bijzondere wet | 292 | 179 | sint michielsakkoord | 281 | 438 |
| europese gemeenschap | 172 | 107 | halle vilvoorde | 49 | 119 |
| hoofdstedelijk gewest | 78 | 32 | vlaanderen wallonië | 48 | 110 |
| voorstel bijzondere | 44 | 14 | sociale zekerheid | 622 | 672 |
| vlaams parlement | 99 | 75 | vlaamse beweging | 34 | 75 |
| *1993–1995* | | | | | |
| globaal plan | 403 | 250 | sociale zekerheid | 737 | 1092 |
| wou stemmen | 102 | 22 | gelden stemming | 12 | 84 |
| onbemande camera | 66 | 7 | sociale programmawet | 56 | 120 |
| verdrag maastricht | 98 | 52 | sociaal pact | 141 | 202 |
| intergouvernementele conferentie | 47 | 9 | vlaamse regering | 25 | 84 |
| *1995–1997* | | | | | |
| procureur generaal | 376 | 272 | traditionele partijen | 9 | 83 |
| gerechtelijk onderzoek | 128 | 48 | vlaams parlement | 17 | 88 |
| gerechtelijke politie | 121 | 49 | sociale zekerheid | 1081 | 1149 |
| onbemande camera | 111 | 40 | politieke cultuur | 32 | 90 |
| sociaal overleg | 139 | 71 | politieke benoemingen | 15 | 69 |
| *1997–1999* | | | | | |
| procureur konings | 179 | 84 | vlaams parlement | 76 | 231 |
| voorwaardelijke invrijheidstelling | 136 | 50 | hoog comité | 67 | 155 |
| europese unie | 198 | 128 | sociale zekerheid | 133 | 219 |
| college procureurs | 105 | 50 | politieke verantwoordelijkheid | 41 | 109 |
| medisch dossier | 76 | 21 | comité toezicht | 60 | 121 |
| *1999–2001* | | | | | |
| europese unie | 229 | 129 | federale politie | 43 | 190 |
| actieve welvaartsstaat | 187 | 96 | halle vilvoorde | 31 | 163 |
| oudere werknemers | 71 | 23 | vlaams parlement | 72 | 142 |
| ten volle | 88 | 40 | politieke cultuur | 34 | 97 |
| chronische zieken | 70 | 23 | vlaamse partijen | 4 | 65 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C91:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2001–2003* | | | | | |
| europese unie | 267 | 134 | vlaams parlement | 60 | 300 |
| duurzame ontwikkeling | 138 | 59 | veiligheid staat | 50 | 202 |
| sociale partners | 118 | 58 | snel belg | 13 | 123 |
| verenigde staten | 152 | 102 | belg wet | 13 | 120 |
| binnen kader | 60 | 14 | lambermont akkoord | 38 | 136 |
| *2003–2005* | | | | | |
| europese unie | 354 | 206 | snel belg | 6 | 220 |
| federale politie | 154 | 27 | belg wet | 6 | 217 |
| sociale partners | 213 | 95 | halle vilvoorde | 108 | 233 |
| europees parlement | 181 | 71 | fiscale amnestie | 54 | 177 |
| oudere werknemers | 119 | 63 | vlaams parlement | 125 | 221 |
| *2005–2007* | | | | | |
| europese unie | 344 | 145 | snel belg | 11 | 123 |
| sociale partners | 228 | 126 | belg wet | 11 | 122 |
| europees parlement | 105 | 25 | nieuwe belastingen | 4 | 87 |
| sociale zekerheid | 219 | 145 | federaal agentschap | 15 | 84 |
| buitenlandse werknemers | 55 | 13 | pairé avec | 3 | 64 |
| *2007–2010* | | | | | |
| europese unie | 226 | 132 | halle vilvoorde | 58 | 186 |
| opel antwerpen | 126 | 39 | vlaams parlement | 46 | 125 |
| federale politie | 92 | 19 | hebt gedaan | 31 | 97 |
| voorlopige hechtenis | 67 | 20 | vlaamse partijen | 9 | 67 |
| nmbs groep | 55 | 11 | binnen regering | 48 | 103 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C92:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2010–2012* | | | | | |
| sociale partners | 200 | 123 | seksueel misbruik | 91 | 173 |
| financiële instellingen | 87 | 38 | notionele intrestaftrek | 36 | 115 |
| neemt minuut | 52 | 3 | halle vilvoorde | 30 | 89 |
| stilte acht | 52 | 3 | onze amendementen | 11 | 61 |
| financiële markten | 77 | 29 | vlaamse partijen | 19 | 67 |
| *2012–2014* | | | | | |
| europese commissie | 321 | 178 | halle vilvoorde | 52 | 216 |
| sociale partners | 311 | 206 | gemiste kans | 28 | 164 |
| sociaal overleg | 135 | 67 | vlaamse partijen | 18 | 137 |
| elektronisch toezicht | 146 | 83 | constitutieve autonomie | 10 | 74 |
| erg belangrijk | 67 | 19 | politieke benoemingen | 7 | 63 |
| *2014–2016* | | | | | |
| sociale partners | 434 | 295 | tax shift | 181 | 402 |
| economische groei | 176 | 67 | vorige regering | 238 | 352 |
| gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 107 | 5 | grote vermogens | 25 | 118 |
| onze economie | 117 | 49 | saoedi arabië | 31 | 122 |
| nationale bank | 179 | 119 | europese unie | 245 | 329 |
| *2016–2019* | | | | | |
| sociale zekerheid | 354 | 198 | saudi arabië | 131 | 252 |
| gegarandeerde dienstverlening | 68 | 4 | zware beroepen | 97 | 170 |
| riziv nummers | 69 | 6 | gemiste kans | 27 | 84 |
| flexi jobs | 69 | 30 | tweede pijler | 30 | 86 |
| verenigd koninkrijk | 89 | 53 | fiscale rechtvaardigheid | 18 | 66 |
| *2019–2021* | | | | | |
| tijdelijke werkloosheid | 295 | 155 | europese unie | 285 | 417 |
| sociale partners | 205 | 100 | nieuwe belastingen | 8 | 103 |
| komende weken | 133 | 40 | sociale zekerheid | 218 | 304 |
| seksueel geweld | 101 | 29 | intrafamiliaal geweld | 65 | 132 |
| hernieuwbare energie | 104 | 43 | onze patiënten | 14 | 69 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C93:** Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

| Government | | | Opposition | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *2021–2024* | | | | | |
| sociaal tarief | 446 | 217 | europese commissie | 203 | 323 |
| hernieuwbare energie | 201 | 59 | nationale loterij | 59 | 144 |
| vorige regering | 186 | 79 | gemiste kans | 10 | 89 |
| stappen gezet | 115 | 34 | sociale zekerheid | 184 | 252 |
| onze samenleving | 151 | 76 | tijdens bespreking | 60 | 121 |
| *2024–2025* | | | | | |
| sterke overheid | 109 | 3 | flexi jobs | 52 | 182 |
| eerlijke bijdrage | 110 | 18 | nieuwe belastingen | 19 | 138 |
| werken we | 111 | 22 | moeten betalen | 103 | 190 |
| mensen werken | 188 | 101 | sterkste schouders | 154 | 218 |
| gaan werken | 148 | 61 | asiel migratie | 64 | 128 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 4; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C94:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: one period every ten years

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1839–1841* | | | | | |
| sucre indigène | 150 | 49 | société générale | 156 | 248 |
| sucre exotique | 149 | 95 | tribunal commerce | 18 | 104 |
| fil mécanique | 49 | 7 | publicité concurrence | 78 | 141 |
| gouvernement hollandais | 69 | 44 | ville gand | 7 | 24 |
| port ostende | 23 | 4 | juge paix | 24 | 36 |
| *1848–1850* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 531 | 307 | conseil mines | 29 | 67 |
| enseignement moyen | 143 | 77 | juge paix | 11 | 36 |
| industrie linière | 71 | 23 | société générale | 38 | 62 |
| garde civique | 88 | 46 | code pénal | 21 | 45 |
| instruction primaire | 73 | 32 | cour comptes | 33 | 56 |
| *1859–1861* | | | | | |
| écoles normales | 125 | 4 | canal charleroi | 40 | 262 |
| conseil communal | 124 | 52 | canalisation meuse | 7 | 103 |
| élève universitaire | 112 | 58 | travaux publics | 280 | 360 |
| examen écrit | 60 | 9 | code pénal | 101 | 168 |
| flandre occidentale | 57 | 11 | communes octroi | 68 | 128 |
| *1868–1870* | | | | | |
| députation permanente | 224 | 110 | sociétés anonymes | 66 | 186 |
| listes électorales | 109 | 41 | assemblée générale | 27 | 136 |
| lieutenant général | 96 | 30 | sociétés commandite | 35 | 101 |
| conseil communal | 124 | 76 | code pénal | 56 | 121 |
| flandre orientale | 55 | 10 | chemin fer | 289 | 348 |
| *1878–1880* | | | | | |
| députation permanente | 236 | 84 | chemin fer | 262 | 764 |
| conseil communal | 177 | 84 | travaux publics | 269 | 384 |
| instruction publique | 227 | 144 | voies navigables | 25 | 78 |
| valeur locative | 85 | 7 | canal charleroi | 8 | 57 |
| administration communale | 161 | 85 | ministres cultes | 59 | 107 |
| *1888–1890* | | | | | |
| prud hommes | 262 | 183 | tribunal commerce | 33 | 95 |
| pays flamand | 98 | 24 | commis greffiers | 6 | 56 |
| conseils prud | 183 | 117 | général major | 12 | 57 |
| ville gand | 65 | 9 | sûreté publique | 22 | 63 |
| flandre occidentale | 45 | 8 | caisses prévoyance | 15 | 52 |
| *1898–1900* | | | | | |
| représentation proportionnelle | 345 | 262 | banque nationale | 165 | 235 |
| banque etat | 73 | 30 | chemin fer | 266 | 315 |
| fer vicinaux | 61 | 25 | députation permanente | 68 | 93 |
| société nationale | 44 | 9 | contrat travail | 111 | 133 |
| banque émission | 54 | 24 | suffrage universel | 64 | 86 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| travaux publics | 117 | 52 | prud hommes | 129 | 251 |
| administration communale | 117 | 58 | conseils prud | 83 | 186 |
| effectif paix | 83 | 26 | neuf heures | 7 | 90 |
| temps service | 92 | 41 | écoles normales | 31 | 110 |
| collège échevinal | 66 | 16 | huit heures | 38 | 94 |
| *1918–1919* | | | | | |
| régions dévastées | 87 | 19 | traité paix | 26 | 95 |
| flandre occidentale | 66 | 9 | juge paix | 23 | 66 |
| administration communale | 123 | 78 | chemin fer | 139 | 176 |
| députation permanente | 56 | 18 | prix revient | 11 | 46 |
| commissaire royal | 28 | 4 | tribunaux dommages | 63 | 95 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| enseignement moyen | 88 | 25 | chemin fer | 152 | 241 |
| sciences arts | 108 | 58 | société nationale | 128 | 174 |
| écoles libres | 72 | 26 | impôt foncier | 20 | 54 |
| application loi | 106 | 62 | défense nationale | 81 | 107 |
| allocations familiales | 89 | 46 | droits douane | 19 | 43 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| crédit anversois | 155 | 18 | sous officiers | 11 | 45 |
| conseil culturel | 115 | 9 | prix revient | 38 | 67 |
| santé publique | 104 | 42 | bénéfices exceptionnels | 15 | 43 |
| supérieur contrôle | 63 | 2 | charges sociales | 16 | 36 |
| pleins pouvoirs | 69 | 10 | pommes terre | 24 | 44 |

**Table C94:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| société nationale | 143 | 39 | travailleurs indépendants | 6 | 53 |
| bureaux dépouillement | 76 | 16 | prisonniers guerre | 40 | 80 |
| code électoral | 75 | 26 | conseil national | 31 | 71 |
| nationale habitations | 62 | 18 | national charbonnages | 11 | 50 |
| logements bon | 55 | 12 | prix revient | 47 | 85 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| table ronde | 209 | 59 | allocations familiales | 45 | 120 |
| gouverneur général | 116 | 19 | conseil national | 32 | 103 |
| congo belge | 142 | 55 | haute autorité | 31 | 81 |
| ruanda urundi | 128 | 47 | national charbonnages | 20 | 62 |
| force publique | 97 | 21 | travailleurs indépendants | 26 | 66 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| etats unis | 207 | 108 | autoroute wallonie | 12 | 73 |
| dette publique | 115 | 19 | plan restructuration | 0 | 17 |
| national brut | 121 | 30 | santé publique | 66 | 82 |
| travailleurs indépendants | 125 | 35 | province luxembourg | 15 | 30 |
| produit national | 123 | 40 | ouvriers mineurs | 41 | 51 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C95:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1830s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1831–1833* | | | | | |
| flandre orientale | 121 | 34 | conseil guerre | 49 | 125 |
| flandre occidentale | 75 | 12 | gouvernement provisoire | 97 | 155 |
| ville gand | 68 | 10 | excès pouvoir | 13 | 69 |
| près cour | 80 | 32 | pommes terre | 80 | 117 |
| tribunal commerce | 38 | 18 | cour cassation | 386 | 386 |
| *1833–1835* | | | | | |
| prix céréales | 45 | 4 | sociétés anonymes | 24 | 70 |
| bas prix | 40 | 17 | ministres cultes | 30 | 68 |
| session ordinaire | 27 | 6 | cour comptes | 69 | 101 |
| loi électorale | 34 | 14 | opinion projet | 7 | 37 |
| députation conseil | 33 | 14 | élection directe | 29 | 55 |
| *1835–1837* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 228 | 72 | los renten | 114 | 286 |
| société générale | 103 | 45 | bois communaux | 9 | 72 |
| chambre représentans | 68 | 29 | cour bruxelles | 26 | 70 |
| contribution foncière | 75 | 38 | loi 1810 | 33 | 72 |
| caissier général | 36 | 4 | mis circulation | 13 | 47 |
| *1837–1839* | | | | | |
| sous officiers | 77 | 14 | chemin fer | 280 | 489 |
| flandre orientale | 66 | 22 | droit timbre | 26 | 68 |
| traité paix | 56 | 20 | grand duché | 16 | 32 |
| port ostende | 40 | 5 | plus grande | 226 | 226 |
| non activité | 42 | 8 | travaux publics | 226 | 226 |
| *1839–1841* | | | | | |
| sucre indigène | 150 | 49 | société générale | 156 | 248 |
| sucre exotique | 149 | 95 | tribunal commerce | 18 | 104 |
| fil mécanique | 49 | 7 | publicité concurrence | 78 | 141 |
| gouvernement hollandais | 69 | 44 | ville gand | 7 | 24 |
| port ostende | 23 | 4 | juge paix | 24 | 36 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C96:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1840s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1841–1843* | | | | | |
| travaux publics | 247 | 190 | instruction primaire | 45 | 109 |
| canalisation campine | 65 | 14 | deux navires | 6 | 44 |
| canal zelzaete | 51 | 10 | an xii | 13 | 43 |
| sucre indigène | 120 | 85 | ancienne majorité | 4 | 32 |
| industrie linière | 57 | 27 | morale religion | 17 | 40 |
| *1843–1845* | | | | | |
| cour appel | 123 | 52 | chemin fer | 694 | 1093 |
| domicile secours | 59 | 13 | cahier charges | 37 | 90 |
| flandre occidentale | 58 | 13 | trésor public | 40 | 84 |
| ville gand | 50 | 6 | entre sambre | 25 | 57 |
| avocat général | 52 | 9 | canal latéral | 21 | 50 |
| *1845–1848* | | | | | |
| cour comptes | 164 | 82 | chemin fer | 404 | 683 |
| juge paix | 60 | 24 | travaux publics | 330 | 449 |
| bons trésor | 70 | 35 | ponts chaussées | 22 | 63 |
| flandre occidentale | 52 | 18 | santo thomas | 7 | 37 |
| dépôts mendicité | 51 | 20 | trésor public | 37 | 63 |
| *1848–1850* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 531 | 307 | conseil mines | 29 | 67 |
| enseignement moyen | 143 | 77 | juge paix | 11 | 36 |
| industrie linière | 71 | 23 | société générale | 38 | 62 |
| garde civique | 88 | 46 | code pénal | 21 | 45 |
| instruction primaire | 73 | 32 | cour comptes | 33 | 56 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C97:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1850s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1850–1852* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 917 | 558 | lettres gage | 66 | 172 |
| travaux publics | 411 | 322 | crédit foncier | 71 | 172 |
| flandre occidentale | 70 | 16 | code civil | 28 | 90 |
| ville gand | 54 | 1 | administration forestière | 3 | 50 |
| trésor public | 101 | 60 | hypothèque judiciaire | 11 | 55 |
| *1852–1854* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 991 | 738 | conseil communal | 74 | 162 |
| travaux publics | 543 | 419 | droit commun | 16 | 54 |
| flandre occidentale | 107 | 22 | conseils milice | 5 | 40 |
| flandre orientale | 97 | 15 | administration forestière | 2 | 35 |
| cours eau | 122 | 43 | province namur | 12 | 43 |
| *1854–1856* | | | | | |
| canal schipdonck | 55 | 16 | chemin fer | 877 | 1124 |
| flandre orientale | 56 | 19 | minerai fer | 19 | 131 |
| cours eau | 44 | 11 | luttre denderleeuw | 45 | 111 |
| contich lierre | 46 | 15 | code pénal | 35 | 97 |
| ville anvers | 38 | 7 | fer fort | 3 | 64 |
| *1856–1857* | | | | | |
| examen écrit | 113 | 48 | chemin fer | 321 | 458 |
| balance romaine | 53 | 11 | travaux publics | 204 | 247 |
| écoles moyennes | 57 | 20 | province namur | 9 | 47 |
| élève universitaire | 112 | 76 | civil élémentaire | 29 | 63 |
| langue flamande | 50 | 16 | libre entrée | 54 | 82 |
| *1857–1859* | | | | | |
| prud hommes | 267 | 185 | ministres cultes | 102 | 310 |
| conseils prud | 193 | 136 | code pénal | 84 | 286 |
| chemin fer | 376 | 327 | critique censure | 21 | 122 |
| flandre occidentale | 59 | 14 | canal charleroi | 27 | 94 |
| chambre commerce | 81 | 38 | ville anvers | 95 | 133 |
| *1859–1861* | | | | | |
| écoles normales | 125 | 4 | canal charleroi | 40 | 262 |
| conseil communal | 124 | 52 | canalisation meuse | 7 | 103 |
| élève universitaire | 112 | 58 | travaux publics | 280 | 360 |
| examen écrit | 60 | 9 | code pénal | 101 | 168 |
| flandre occidentale | 57 | 11 | communes octroi | 68 | 128 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C98:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1860s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1861–1864* | | | | | |
| servitudes militaires | 92 | 30 | canal charleroi | 20 | 84 |
| chemin fer | 423 | 376 | juge paix | 67 | 121 |
| peinture murale | 57 | 10 | réforme communale | 2 | 49 |
| flandre occidentale | 47 | 11 | travaux publics | 247 | 288 |
| langue flamande | 42 | 7 | bourses études | 32 | 63 |
| *1864–1866* | | | | | |
| général chazal | 55 | 14 | travaux publics | 310 | 414 |
| flandre orientale | 45 | 6 | code pénal | 41 | 94 |
| flandre occidentale | 43 | 5 | dépenses électorales | 12 | 47 |
| armée permanente | 61 | 24 | bourses études | 32 | 64 |
| lieutenant général | 43 | 15 | banque nationale | 17 | 48 |
| *1866–1868* | | | | | |
| suffrage universel | 165 | 77 | code pénal | 62 | 164 |
| conseil communal | 167 | 93 | chemin fer | 210 | 294 |
| lieutenant général | 65 | 19 | province namur | 10 | 59 |
| écoles gardiennes | 40 | 11 | peine mort | 117 | 159 |
| tribunal commerce | 96 | 69 | ministres cultes | 28 | 63 |
| *1868–1870* | | | | | |
| députation permanente | 224 | 110 | sociétés anonymes | 66 | 186 |
| listes électorales | 109 | 41 | assemblée générale | 27 | 136 |
| lieutenant général | 96 | 30 | sociétés commandite | 35 | 101 |
| conseil communal | 124 | 76 | code pénal | 56 | 121 |
| flandre orientale | 55 | 10 | chemin fer | 289 | 348 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C99:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1870s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1870–1872* | | | | | |
| écoles normales | 213 | 99 | chemin fer | 480 | 947 |
| conseil communal | 170 | 78 | bassins houillers | 166 | 288 |
| écoles primaires | 119 | 43 | compagnie bassins | 14 | 117 |
| ville gand | 64 | 5 | travaux publics | 366 | 431 |
| écoles communales | 78 | 24 | société générale | 30 | 84 |
| *1872–1874* | | | | | |
| ville gand | 99 | 9 | chemin fer | 416 | 905 |
| ville anvers | 144 | 63 | travaux publics | 389 | 448 |
| garde civique | 111 | 55 | fer athus | 0 | 43 |
| juge instruction | 86 | 31 | grand luxembourg | 7 | 47 |
| flandre occidentale | 70 | 19 | commissaire arrondissement | 30 | 69 |
| *1874–1876* | | | | | |
| domicile secours | 152 | 40 | chemin fer | 433 | 677 |
| juge paix | 111 | 52 | garde civique | 97 | 213 |
| fonds communes | 71 | 14 | travaux publics | 310 | 385 |
| commerce ostende | 44 | 1 | pommes terre | 34 | 93 |
| flandre occidentale | 49 | 7 | exercice profession | 21 | 54 |
| *1876–1878* | | | | | |
| port ostende | 76 | 1 | chemin fer | 319 | 456 |
| cours eau | 211 | 162 | ministres cultes | 67 | 112 |
| députation permanente | 193 | 161 | travaux publics | 258 | 297 |
| flandre occidentale | 51 | 21 | chevaux mixtes | 30 | 66 |
| ville gand | 36 | 11 | fer athus | 0 | 33 |
| *1878–1880* | | | | | |
| députation permanente | 236 | 84 | chemin fer | 262 | 764 |
| conseil communal | 177 | 84 | travaux publics | 269 | 384 |
| instruction publique | 227 | 144 | voies navigables | 25 | 78 |
| valeur locative | 85 | 7 | canal charleroi | 8 | 57 |
| administration communale | 161 | 85 | ministres cultes | 59 | 107 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C100:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1880s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1880–1882* | | | | | |
| commissaire spécial | 310 | 38 | chemin fer | 269 | 529 |
| députation permanente | 431 | 172 | travaux publics | 238 | 330 |
| administration communale | 242 | 101 | province namur | 21 | 65 |
| conseil communal | 199 | 119 | écoles communales | 67 | 97 |
| bureaux bienfaisance | 124 | 47 | première communion | 13 | 40 |
| *1882–1884* | | | | | |
| instruction publique | 229 | 106 | chemin fer | 362 | 566 |
| administration communale | 183 | 106 | ministres cultes | 37 | 74 |
| députation permanente | 185 | 111 | droit commun | 65 | 101 |
| conseil communal | 118 | 66 | travaux publics | 176 | 212 |
| carte géologique | 52 | 3 | concordat préventif | 11 | 47 |
| *1884–1886* | | | | | |
| écoles communales | 295 | 200 | commissaire arrondissement | 70 | 147 |
| ville gand | 73 | 9 | chemin fer | 236 | 310 |
| cuve matière | 48 | 3 | instruction publique | 107 | 156 |
| écoles normales | 107 | 66 | province namur | 12 | 54 |
| écoles adoptées | 153 | 119 | droit auteur | 47 | 89 |
| *1886–1888* | | | | | |
| service personnel | 167 | 68 | chemin fer | 480 | 562 |
| procureur général | 80 | 23 | ville bruxelles | 21 | 65 |
| port ostende | 56 | 1 | fer vicinaux | 60 | 99 |
| juge instruction | 69 | 21 | champs expérience | 5 | 43 |
| conseil communal | 135 | 95 | général major | 9 | 46 |
| *1888–1890* | | | | | |
| prud hommes | 262 | 183 | tribunal commerce | 33 | 95 |
| pays flamand | 98 | 24 | commis greffiers | 6 | 56 |
| conseils prud | 183 | 117 | général major | 12 | 57 |
| ville gand | 65 | 9 | sûreté publique | 22 | 63 |
| flandre occidentale | 45 | 8 | caisses prévoyance | 15 | 52 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C101:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1890s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1890–1892* | | | | | |
| fonds communes | 170 | 30 | chemin fer | 621 | 757 |
| flandre occidentale | 73 | 15 | lieutenant général | 21 | 86 |
| loi 1876 | 64 | 19 | conseil communal | 58 | 110 |
| domicile secours | 112 | 68 | cahier charges | 26 | 68 |
| dépôts mendicité | 58 | 14 | écoles normales | 22 | 63 |
| *1892–1894* | | | | | |
| représentation proportionnelle | 236 | 107 | chemin fer | 268 | 397 |
| deux langues | 39 | 4 | corps électoral | 155 | 224 |
| pays flamand | 40 | 7 | loi électorale | 67 | 121 |
| enseignement moyen | 81 | 50 | triple vote | 18 | 58 |
| général brassine | 59 | 31 | suffrage universel | 172 | 211 |
| *1894–1896* | | | | | |
| écoles adoptées | 70 | 17 | chemin fer | 319 | 399 |
| id id | 36 | 1 | conseil communal | 80 | 140 |
| administration communale | 97 | 71 | etat congo | 8 | 60 |
| sociétés coopératives | 34 | 9 | distilleries agricoles | 53 | 91 |
| flandre occidentale | 33 | 10 | loi communale | 12 | 43 |
| *1896–1898* | | | | | |
| unions professionnelles | 345 | 157 | grand central | 47 | 102 |
| garde civique | 282 | 171 | caisses prévoyance | 14 | 47 |
| ateliers chômage | 64 | 21 | chemin fer | 232 | 263 |
| administration communale | 81 | 51 | petite propriété | 33 | 61 |
| faire commerce | 42 | 15 | douaniers wallons | 3 | 25 |
| *1898–1900* | | | | | |
| représentation proportionnelle | 345 | 262 | banque nationale | 165 | 235 |
| banque etat | 73 | 30 | chemin fer | 266 | 315 |
| fer vicinaux | 61 | 25 | députation permanente | 68 | 93 |
| société nationale | 44 | 9 | contrat travail | 111 | 133 |
| banque émission | 54 | 24 | suffrage universel | 64 | 86 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C102:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1900–1902* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 357 | 272 | jeux hasard | 41 | 151 |
| ville anvers | 53 | 10 | maisons jeux | 30 | 96 |
| flandre occidentale | 47 | 6 | industrie travail | 40 | 85 |
| cahier charges | 47 | 12 | code pénal | 23 | 55 |
| compagnie générale | 36 | 1 | général major | 63 | 93 |
| *1902–1904* | | | | | |
| gare nord | 44 | 5 | caisses prévoyance | 7 | 127 |
| flandre occidentale | 48 | 10 | accidents travail | 79 | 150 |
| caisse épargne | 101 | 64 | faute lourde | 35 | 92 |
| ville bruxelles | 41 | 7 | ouvriers mineurs | 6 | 52 |
| bruxelles anvers | 42 | 9 | industrie travail | 69 | 115 |
| *1904–1906* | | | | | |
| grande coupure | 165 | 19 | caisses prévoyance | 3 | 100 |
| ville anvers | 83 | 12 | industrie travail | 108 | 164 |
| lieutenant général | 143 | 86 | ouvriers mineurs | 7 | 54 |
| installations maritimes | 55 | 14 | repos dominical | 47 | 94 |
| société belge | 51 | 14 | administration mines | 4 | 47 |
| *1906–1908* | | | | | |
| lieutenant général | 109 | 34 | conseil mines | 15 | 74 |
| pays flamand | 90 | 29 | ouvriers mineurs | 14 | 68 |
| seconde ligne | 61 | 7 | bon secours | 5 | 54 |
| ligne défense | 57 | 9 | effet utile | 11 | 56 |
| flandre occidentale | 58 | 13 | huit heures | 77 | 120 |
| *1908–1910* | | | | | |
| travaux publics | 117 | 52 | prud hommes | 129 | 251 |
| administration communale | 117 | 58 | conseils prud | 83 | 186 |
| effectif paix | 83 | 26 | neuf heures | 7 | 90 |
| temps service | 92 | 41 | écoles normales | 31 | 110 |
| collège échevinal | 66 | 16 | huit heures | 38 | 94 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C103:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1910–1912* | | | | | |
| cour comptes | 67 | 11 | caisses prévoyance | 45 | 165 |
| syndicats chrétiens | 59 | 11 | ouvriers mineurs | 32 | 92 |
| unions professionnelles | 62 | 15 | 60 ans | 14 | 65 |
| lock out | 43 | 5 | 55 ans | 17 | 67 |
| écoles communales | 64 | 28 | industrie travail | 111 | 158 |
| *1912–1914* | | | | | |
| écoles communales | 203 | 107 | chemin fer | 229 | 307 |
| conseil régional | 72 | 20 | industrie travail | 54 | 94 |
| écoles adoptées | 169 | 118 | huit heures | 9 | 40 |
| écoles libres | 95 | 47 | caisses prévoyance | 12 | 38 |
| loi scolaire | 70 | 32 | garde civique | 8 | 30 |
| *1918–1919* | | | | | |
| régions dévastées | 87 | 19 | traité paix | 26 | 95 |
| flandre occidentale | 66 | 9 | juge paix | 23 | 66 |
| administration communale | 123 | 78 | chemin fer | 139 | 176 |
| députation permanente | 56 | 18 | prix revient | 11 | 46 |
| commissaire royal | 28 | 4 | tribunaux dommages | 63 | 95 |
| *1919–1921* | | | | | |
| travaux publics | 114 | 46 | huit heures | 56 | 98 |
| cour comptes | 80 | 27 | temps service | 27 | 67 |
| régions dévastées | 100 | 49 | défense nationale | 84 | 121 |
| dommages guerre | 153 | 104 | comité national | 11 | 38 |
| commissaires etat | 59 | 21 | prix revient | 21 | 48 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C104:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1921–1923* | | | | | |
| université gand | 183 | 60 | défense nationale | 138 | 207 |
| écoles normales | 129 | 50 | gardes champêtres | 76 | 128 |
| huit heures | 141 | 67 | grand duché | 35 | 78 |
| sciences arts | 155 | 85 | union économique | 7 | 35 |
| université flamande | 126 | 56 | six mois | 41 | 70 |
| *1923–1925* | | | | | |
| coopératives locataires | 68 | 4 | ouvriers mineurs | 31 | 80 |
| service sauvetage | 53 | 1 | défense nationale | 71 | 111 |
| prix maxima | 63 | 18 | chemin fer | 216 | 254 |
| écoles moyennes | 57 | 19 | société nations | 17 | 51 |
| droits spécifiques | 58 | 20 | fonds communes | 12 | 45 |
| *1925–1927* | | | | | |
| chemin fer | 386 | 302 | neuf ans | 27 | 98 |
| sciences arts | 106 | 46 | eupen malmédy | 12 | 66 |
| société nationale | 107 | 52 | conseil communal | 40 | 80 |
| université gand | 48 | 5 | bail ferme | 26 | 66 |
| partie mobile | 48 | 13 | société nations | 39 | 79 |
| *1927–1929* | | | | | |
| sciences arts | 201 | 69 | prison école | 6 | 99 |
| société nationale | 210 | 105 | défense nationale | 134 | 210 |
| écoles libres | 112 | 27 | neuf ans | 36 | 96 |
| comité sélection | 99 | 14 | bail neuf | 16 | 53 |
| chemin fer | 279 | 211 | eupen malmédy | 9 | 45 |
| *1929–1932* | | | | | |
| enseignement moyen | 88 | 25 | chemin fer | 152 | 241 |
| sciences arts | 108 | 58 | société nationale | 128 | 174 |
| écoles libres | 72 | 26 | impôt foncier | 20 | 54 |
| application loi | 106 | 62 | défense nationale | 81 | 107 |
| allocations familiales | 89 | 46 | droits douane | 19 | 43 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C105:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1932–1934* | | | | | |
| allocations familiales | 188 | 62 | juge paix | 16 | 95 |
| caisse nationale | 106 | 25 | agents change | 5 | 56 |
| conventions collectives | 78 | 5 | défense nationale | 93 | 140 |
| liste arrondissement | 88 | 16 | chemin fer | 116 | 152 |
| fonds communes | 87 | 17 | taxe crise | 26 | 56 |
| *1934–1936* | | | | | |
| gouverneur général | 78 | 7 | défense nationale | 86 | 161 |
| ouvriers frontaliers | 63 | 12 | arrêté loi | 42 | 110 |
| droit sortie | 58 | 10 | arrêtés lois | 37 | 98 |
| voies hydrauliques | 46 | 2 | société nations | 18 | 73 |
| général voies | 39 | 1 | grand duché | 11 | 57 |
| *1936–1939* | | | | | |
| banque nationale | 234 | 63 | allocations familiales | 28 | 71 |
| congo belge | 63 | 3 | congés payés | 42 | 78 |
| ruanda urundi | 59 | 2 | quarante heures | 8 | 42 |
| lieutenant général | 131 | 78 | prix revient | 32 | 63 |
| grands magasins | 70 | 36 | état major | 15 | 43 |
| *1939–1940* | | | | | |
| crédit anversois | 155 | 18 | sous officiers | 11 | 45 |
| conseil culturel | 115 | 9 | prix revient | 38 | 67 |
| santé publique | 104 | 42 | bénéfices exceptionnels | 15 | 43 |
| supérieur contrôle | 63 | 2 | charges sociales | 16 | 36 |
| pleins pouvoirs | 69 | 10 | pommes terre | 24 | 44 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C106:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1944–1946* | | | | | |
| sous occupation | 139 | 49 | prisonniers politiques | 38 | 127 |
| arrêté loi | 90 | 35 | prix revient | 17 | 66 |
| création conseil | 48 | 3 | pommes terre | 34 | 69 |
| services incendie | 44 | 13 | conseils professionnels | 17 | 51 |
| pouvoirs extraordinaires | 51 | 26 | problème wallon | 5 | 33 |
| *1946–1947* | | | | | |
| auditeur général | 76 | 12 | juge paix | 37 | 106 |
| prisonniers politiques | 169 | 109 | travaux publics | 57 | 118 |
| banque emission | 95 | 40 | sous officiers | 5 | 52 |
| collaboration économique | 80 | 26 | réparation intégrale | 29 | 64 |
| augmentation salaire | 52 | 12 | travaux communaux | 14 | 42 |
| *1947–1949* | | | | | |
| banque emission | 88 | 14 | juge paix | 18 | 108 |
| syndicats libéraux | 66 | 4 | prisonniers politiques | 10 | 85 |
| banque nationale | 136 | 79 | travaux publics | 64 | 123 |
| organisations syndicales | 101 | 46 | arrêté loi | 30 | 65 |
| industrie textile | 71 | 19 | conseils professionnels | 7 | 35 |
| *1949–1950* | | | | | |
| société nationale | 143 | 39 | travailleurs indépendants | 6 | 53 |
| bureaux dépouillement | 76 | 16 | prisonniers guerre | 40 | 80 |
| code électoral | 75 | 26 | conseil national | 31 | 71 |
| nationale habitations | 62 | 18 | national charbonnages | 11 | 50 |
| logements bon | 55 | 12 | prix revient | 47 | 85 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C107:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1950–1952* | | | | | |
| etats unis | 153 | 43 | allocations familiales | 47 | 83 |
| coût vie | 139 | 67 | prisonniers politiques | 25 | 59 |
| bénéfices exceptionnels | 99 | 49 | enseignement moyen | 13 | 45 |
| vingt quatre | 113 | 64 | prisonniers guerre | 14 | 43 |
| européenne paiements | 55 | 10 | conseil administration | 28 | 52 |
| *1952–1954* | | | | | |
| plan schuman | 207 | 35 | allocations familiales | 27 | 110 |
| haute autorité | 69 | 15 | travailleurs indépendants | 36 | 118 |
| etats unis | 108 | 54 | victimes civiles | 16 | 93 |
| dette publique | 68 | 15 | prisonniers politiques | 17 | 67 |
| procureur général | 68 | 19 | civiles guerre | 19 | 52 |
| *1954–1956* | | | | | |
| tirer parti | 109 | 6 | enseignement technique | 36 | 130 |
| banque nationale | 114 | 39 | enseignement moyen | 53 | 142 |
| bancs socialistes | 89 | 32 | travailleurs indépendants | 24 | 89 |
| gouvernement précédent | 150 | 93 | enseignement public | 27 | 80 |
| impôt complémentaire | 59 | 10 | enseignement libre | 180 | 231 |
| *1956–1958* | | | | | |
| banque nationale | 217 | 55 | conseil national | 32 | 155 |
| dette publique | 155 | 26 | national charbonnages | 10 | 104 |
| allocations familiales | 221 | 121 | ouvriers mineurs | 39 | 121 |
| combats boxe | 73 | 12 | industrie charbonnière | 21 | 83 |
| court terme | 65 | 10 | santé publique | 51 | 90 |
| *1958–1961* | | | | | |
| table ronde | 209 | 59 | allocations familiales | 45 | 120 |
| gouverneur général | 116 | 19 | conseil national | 32 | 103 |
| congo belge | 142 | 55 | haute autorité | 31 | 81 |
| ruanda urundi | 128 | 47 | national charbonnages | 20 | 62 |
| force publique | 97 | 21 | travailleurs indépendants | 26 | 66 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

**Table C108:** Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

| Flemish districts | | | Walloon districts | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ | Phrase | $\hat{q}^A$ | $\hat{q}^B$ |
| *1961–1963* | | | | | |
| flandre wallonie | 115 | 11 | assistance publique | 33 | 84 |
| problème linguistique | 74 | 8 | allocations familiales | 56 | 104 |
| région mouscron | 49 | 2 | autoroute wallonie | 1 | 30 |
| assistance technique | 89 | 45 | santé publique | 111 | 135 |
| grande bretagne | 66 | 27 | pacte scolaire | 20 | 43 |
| *1963–1965* | | | | | |
| politique énergétique | 55 | 9 | santé publique | 84 | 158 |
| pays tiers | 57 | 12 | pacte scolaire | 12 | 72 |
| prix détail | 62 | 18 | allocations familiales | 44 | 97 |
| plein emploi | 51 | 9 | autoroute wallonie | 8 | 53 |
| chambre syndicale | 52 | 17 | travailleurs indépendants | 68 | 108 |
| *1965–1968* | | | | | |
| etats unis | 207 | 108 | autoroute wallonie | 12 | 73 |
| dette publique | 115 | 19 | plan restructuration | 0 | 17 |
| national brut | 121 | 30 | santé publique | 66 | 82 |
| travailleurs indépendants | 125 | 35 | province luxembourg | 15 | 30 |
| produit national | 123 | 40 | ouvriers mineurs | 41 | 51 |

*Notes*: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 20; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form. The vocabulary leaves out procedural phrases, forms of address and titles, names of parties and parliamentary groups, amounts, dates, names of persons, fragments of words and pairs of filler words (`code/python/04b_filter_vocabulary.py`).

## Online Appendix D: Descriptive figures and tables

This appendix describes Chamber composition and the speech volume behind the estimates. A period's members are all those listed for its legislature, whether or not they speak. This includes replacements and, before 1919, members entering or leaving through partial elections during the legislature. Speeches follow the sample in Section 3, except that the tables and Figures D1, D2 and D5 leave out 75 speaker-periods (4,910 speeches) whose speakers are missing from the list of members. Here, government status means the member's party held office on at least half the period's sitting days. Unlike the main estimates, it is not based on the timing of that member's speeches.

Table D1 selects one period every twenty years plus the final period. It reports each family's shares of members and speeches, and speeches per member. Catholics and Liberals share the Chamber until 1894. Socialists account for 19 per cent of members in 1898–1900. Flemish nationalists and Communists enter between the wars. In 2019–2021, no family has more than a quarter of members; in 2024–2025, the largest, the Flemish nationalist family, which in this table includes the Vlaams Belang, has 26 per cent.

Opposition families usually deliver more speeches per member than governing families. Socialists deliver 406 versus Catholics' 169 in 1898–1900; Communists deliver 652 in 1958–1961; and Christian democrats deliver 81 versus Socialists' 20 in 1999–2001. In the last two rows, 7–8 per cent of members lack a family label because the register lacks their party. Nearly all who speak nevertheless have a party in the speaker data used for estimation.

**Table D1:** Share of members and speeches by party family

| Period | Party family | Share of members | Share of speeches | Speeches per member |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1839–1841 | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.50 | 0.49 | 4.7 |
| | Liberal | 0.49 | 0.51 | 5.0 |
| | Unknown | 0.02 | 0.00 | 0.0 |
| 1859–1861 | Liberal | 0.64 | 0.63 | 60.8 |
| | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.35 | 0.37 | 64.2 |
| | Unknown | 0.01 | 0.00 | 1.5 |
| 1878–1880 | Liberal | 0.56 | 0.52 | 74.2 |
| | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.43 | 0.48 | 87.9 |
| | Unknown | 0.01 | 0.00 | 12.0 |
| 1898–1900 | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.72 | 0.56 | 169.0 |
| | Socialist | 0.19 | 0.36 | 406.4 |
| | Liberal | 0.08 | 0.08 | 201.5 |
| | Unknown | 0.01 | 0.00 | 85.0 |
| 1918–1919 | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.52 | 0.39 | 45.9 |
| | Liberal | 0.25 | 0.31 | 75.6 |
| | Socialist | 0.21 | 0.30 | 86.9 |
| | Unknown | 0.03 | 0.00 | 0.0 |
| 1939–1940 | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.34 | 0.30 | 42.9 |
| | Socialist | 0.33 | 0.30 | 45.0 |
| | Liberal | 0.16 | 0.16 | 49.3 |
| | Flemish nationalist | 0.08 | 0.11 | 67.8 |
| | Communist / radical left | 0.04 | 0.09 | 107.6 |
| | Unknown | 0.03 | 0.01 | 9.1 |
| | Other | 0.03 | 0.03 | 61.2 |
| 1958–1961 | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.48 | 0.33 | 96.9 |

**Table D1:** Share of members and speeches by party family (continued)

| Period | Party family | Share of members | Share of speeches | Speeches per member |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Socialist | 0.39 | 0.54 | 192.8 |
| | Liberal | 0.11 | 0.08 | 105.6 |
| | Communist / radical left | 0.01 | 0.04 | 651.5 |
| | Unknown | 0.01 | 0.00 | 0.0 |
| | Flemish nationalist | 0.00 | 0.01 | 204.0 |
| 1979–1981 | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.38 | 0.26 | 67.7 |
| | Socialist | 0.27 | 0.19 | 68.0 |
| | Liberal | 0.17 | 0.19 | 116.3 |
| | Francophone regionalist | 0.08 | 0.12 | 159.9 |
| | Flemish nationalist | 0.07 | 0.16 | 227.9 |
| | Communist / radical left | 0.02 | 0.07 | 411.5 |
| | Unknown | 0.01 | 0.00 | 6.0 |
| | Other | 0.00 | 0.00 | 63.0 |
| 1999–2001 | Liberal | 0.27 | 0.21 | 31.6 |
| | Socialist | 0.24 | 0.12 | 19.7 |
| | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.19 | 0.37 | 80.6 |
| | Green | 0.13 | 0.08 | 24.7 |
| | Flemish nationalist | 0.13 | 0.20 | 65.3 |
| | Unknown | 0.03 | 0.01 | 15.0 |
| | Francophone regionalist | 0.01 | 0.00 | 9.0 |
| | Other | 0.01 | 0.00 | 18.0 |
| 2019–2021 | Flemish nationalist | 0.25 | 0.27 | 64.0 |
| | Socialist | 0.19 | 0.15 | 44.8 |
| | Liberal | 0.18 | 0.16 | 55.2 |
| | Green | 0.14 | 0.08 | 34.6 |
| | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.10 | 0.13 | 78.0 |
| | Communist / radical left | 0.07 | 0.11 | 95.8 |
| | Unknown | 0.07 | 0.05 | 45.6 |
| | Francophone regionalist | 0.01 | 0.03 | 175.5 |
| | Other | 0.01 | 0.02 | 176.0 |
| 2024–2025 | Flemish nationalist | 0.26 | 0.25 | 40.1 |
| | Socialist | 0.18 | 0.17 | 38.5 |
| | Catholic / Christian democrat | 0.16 | 0.11 | 28.3 |
| | Liberal | 0.16 | 0.17 | 44.7 |
| | Communist / radical left | 0.08 | 0.11 | 53.8 |
| | Unknown | 0.08 | 0.04 | 16.9 |
| | Green | 0.06 | 0.11 | 76.9 |
| | Other | 0.01 | 0.01 | 57.0 |
| | Francophone regionalist | 0.01 | 0.03 | 206.0 |

*Notes*: One period every twenty years and the last period.

Table D2 reports, every ten years, the member, speaker and speech shares for Catholics, the left, women and governing parties. Since most members speak, speaker shares differ from member shares by at most 0.05. Speech shares differ more. Excluding low-coverage years, governing parties deliver a smaller speech share than member share in 53 of 55 periods since 1894 with at least ten opposition members, compared with 10 of 21 earlier periods. In 1949–1950, governing Catholics hold 0.50 of membership but deliver 0.27 of speeches, while the left accounts for 0.37 and 0.57. Women's member share stays below a tenth until 1995 and exceeds two fifths from 2019 (Section 5.5). Their speech share is below their seat share in 40 of 42 adequately covered periods since 1929.

Table D3 reports member and speech shares for Flemish, Walloon and Brussels districts. Flemish districts elect 0.45–0.52 of members until 2010 and 0.55–0.57 from 2019. Walloon districts

**Table D2:** Summary statistics: Catholics, left parties, women and government parties

| | Catholics | | | Left parties | | | Women | | | Government | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Period | MPs | Speakers | Speeches | MPs | Speakers | Speeches | MPs | Speakers | Speeches | MPs | Speakers | Speeches |
| 1839–1841 | 0.50 | 0.47 | 0.49 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.49 | 0.53 | 0.51 |
| 1848–1850 | 0.28 | 0.24 | 0.28 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.70 | 0.75 | 0.72 |
| 1859–1861 | 0.35 | 0.38 | 0.37 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.64 | 0.61 | 0.63 |
| 1868–1870 | 0.41 | 0.40 | 0.40 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.59 | 0.60 | 0.60 |
| 1878–1880 | 0.43 | 0.45 | 0.48 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.56 | 0.55 | 0.52 |
| 1888–1890 | 0.70 | 0.69 | 0.53 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.70 | 0.69 | 0.53 |
| 1898–1900 | 0.72 | 0.71 | 0.56 | 0.19 | 0.20 | 0.36 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.72 | 0.71 | 0.56 |
| 1908–1910 | 0.53 | 0.52 | 0.42 | 0.20 | 0.21 | 0.33 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.53 | 0.52 | 0.42 |
| 1918–1919 | 0.52 | 0.54 | 0.39 | 0.21 | 0.23 | 0.30 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.97 | 1.00 | 1.00 |
| 1929–1932 | 0.41 | 0.39 | 0.37 | 0.37 | 0.39 | 0.43 | 0.01 | 0.01 | 0.00 | 0.56 | 0.55 | 0.49 |
| 1939–1940 | 0.34 | 0.36 | 0.30 | 0.37 | 0.35 | 0.40 | 0.01 | 0.01 | 0.02 | 0.83 | 0.84 | 0.76 |
| 1949–1950 | 0.50 | 0.46 | 0.27 | 0.37 | 0.39 | 0.57 | 0.03 | 0.02 | 0.01 | 0.63 | 0.61 | 0.43 |
| 1958–1961 | 0.48 | 0.50 | 0.33 | 0.40 | 0.39 | 0.58 | 0.05 | 0.04 | 0.01 | 0.59 | 0.60 | 0.42 |
| 1969–1971 | 0.32 | 0.34 | 0.26 | 0.31 | 0.29 | 0.28 | 0.04 | 0.03 | 0.01 | 0.55 | 0.56 | 0.44 |
| 1979–1981 | 0.38 | 0.38 | 0.26 | 0.29 | 0.29 | 0.26 | 0.07 | 0.07 | 0.03 | 0.65 | 0.64 | 0.44 |
| 1989–1991 | 0.28 | 0.28 | 0.25 | 0.35 | 0.32 | 0.15 | 0.08 | 0.10 | 0.08 | 0.71 | 0.69 | 0.48 |
| 1999–2001 | 0.19 | 0.20 | 0.37 | 0.24 | 0.23 | 0.12 | 0.21 | 0.22 | 0.17 | 0.64 | 0.62 | 0.41 |
| 2007–2010 | 0.22 | 0.23 | 0.20 | 0.20 | 0.22 | 0.23 | 0.36 | 0.36 | 0.28 | 0.58 | 0.61 | 0.46 |
| 2019–2021 | 0.10 | 0.11 | 0.13 | 0.26 | 0.24 | 0.25 | 0.43 | 0.43 | 0.39 | 0.58 | 0.57 | 0.46 |
| 2024–2025 | 0.16 | 0.17 | 0.11 | 0.27 | 0.27 | 0.28 | 0.41 | 0.40 | 0.36 | 0.51 | 0.53 | 0.40 |

*Notes*: Share of the members, of the speakers (members with at least one speech) and of the speeches that belong to each category; one period every ten years and the last period.

elect 0.38–0.43 until 1940 and about a third from 1969. Brussels accounts for 0.10–0.17 from 1848.

Speech shares differ from seat shares. In every displayed period from 1908 to 1981, Brussels members' speech share is larger than their seat share, and Flemish members' is smaller except in 1958–1961; Brussels delivers 0.28 of speeches against 0.14 of seats in 1929–1932. In the displayed rows from 1989, Flemish members' speech share exceeds their seat share. Brussels members deliver 0.18–0.29 of speeches in the 1908–1991 rows and are excluded from Section 5.6's regional comparison. The low-coverage 1839–1841 row uses 598 speeches, and 4 per cent of members lack a region.

**Table D3:** Summary statistics: regions

| | Flanders | | Wallonia | | Brussels | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Period | MPs | Speeches | MPs | Speeches | MPs | Speeches |
| 1839–1841 | 0.50 | 0.30 | 0.40 | 0.55 | 0.06 | 0.14 |
| 1848–1850 | 0.50 | 0.49 | 0.40 | 0.44 | 0.10 | 0.07 |
| 1859–1861 | 0.45 | 0.50 | 0.42 | 0.37 | 0.13 | 0.14 |
| 1868–1870 | 0.47 | 0.37 | 0.43 | 0.52 | 0.10 | 0.10 |
| 1878–1880 | 0.45 | 0.53 | 0.43 | 0.36 | 0.12 | 0.11 |
| 1888–1890 | 0.47 | 0.48 | 0.39 | 0.43 | 0.14 | 0.08 |
| 1898–1900 | 0.46 | 0.42 | 0.42 | 0.51 | 0.12 | 0.06 |
| 1908–1910 | 0.48 | 0.37 | 0.38 | 0.41 | 0.14 | 0.21 |
| 1918–1919 | 0.45 | 0.32 | 0.42 | 0.45 | 0.14 | 0.23 |
| 1929–1932 | 0.47 | 0.37 | 0.39 | 0.36 | 0.14 | 0.28 |
| 1939–1940 | 0.45 | 0.36 | 0.40 | 0.43 | 0.15 | 0.21 |
| 1949–1950 | 0.49 | 0.38 | 0.36 | 0.35 | 0.15 | 0.26 |
| 1958–1961 | 0.50 | 0.50 | 0.36 | 0.32 | 0.15 | 0.18 |
| 1969–1971 | 0.50 | 0.43 | 0.34 | 0.29 | 0.15 | 0.29 |
| 1979–1981 | 0.50 | 0.48 | 0.33 | 0.27 | 0.17 | 0.26 |
| 1989–1991 | 0.51 | 0.54 | 0.32 | 0.25 | 0.17 | 0.21 |
| 1999–2001 | 0.52 | 0.63 | 0.34 | 0.26 | 0.14 | 0.12 |
| 2007–2010 | 0.51 | 0.52 | 0.34 | 0.26 | 0.15 | 0.21 |
| 2019–2021 | 0.55 | 0.59 | 0.34 | 0.27 | 0.11 | 0.14 |
| 2024–2025 | 0.57 | 0.58 | 0.32 | 0.30 | 0.11 | 0.12 |

*Notes*: Share of the members elected in, and of the speeches by members from, each region; one period every ten years and the last period.

Figure D1 shows the member shares of Catholic, Liberal and left (Socialist and Communist) families. Catholics and Liberals share the Chamber until 1894. Liberals reach 70 per cent in 1848–1852; Catholics hold 60–72 per cent in 1886–1900. Socialists enter with 17 per cent in 1894. In 1919–1968, Catholic and left shares are 31–51 and 34–45 per cent, while Liberals hold 9–22 per cent. After the party splits, the Catholic share falls most, reaching 10 per cent in 2019–2024. Liberals reach their highest post-1894 share, 27 per cent, in 1999–2007. Catholics, group $A$ in the religious comparison, thus form a majority under Catholic governments in 1884–1914 and a small federal-era minority. In 2019–2024, they are too few for the religious series to be defined (Section 5.1).

Figure D2 reports, among members with a known party, the share whose parties govern on at least half the period's sitting days. The governing share is 100 per cent in 1831–1839, 1841–1848 and 1854–1857. These periods have unionist or mixed cabinets, or successive cabinets of both parties in 1845–1848. The share is 85–100 per cent under the national-union governments of 1918–1921, 1925–1927, 1934–1936 and 1939–1940, and 77 per cent in 1936–1939. Most such periods are absent from Figure 4.

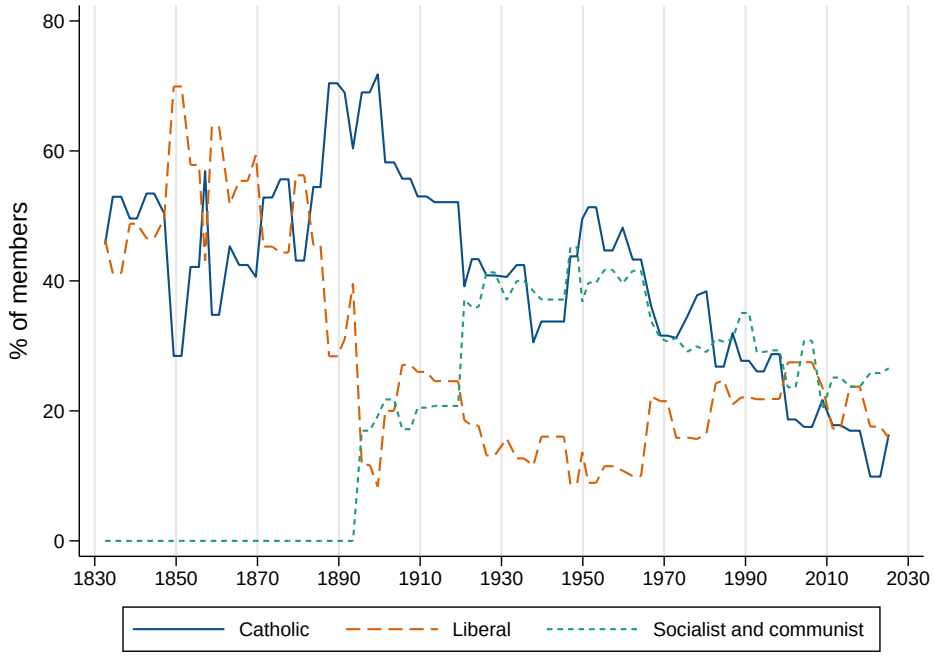



**Figure D1:** Members of the Catholic, Liberal and left families

Under single-party governments in 1847–1914, the governing family holds 53–72 per cent of members. The exception is 1882–1884 at 46 per cent, which includes members elected in 1884. After 1919, excluding national-union governments, the share ranges from 51–53 per cent in 1950–1958 and 1981–1987 to 82–85 per cent in 1961–1965 and 1977–1978. Federal-era shares are 56–66 per cent. The narrow majorities of 1950–1958 coincide with modest partisanship: net values are at most 0.0007 in the religious and government–opposition series, and only the latter exceeds its random benchmark, in 1950–1952. In an earlier estimation on all phrases, both series were high in these years (Section 5.12).

Figure D3 reports the decade share of plenary speech blocks linked to a member or minister, excluding the chair's turns. Linkage is 74 per cent in the 1830s, when sources are digitized years of the *Moniteur belge*, 93 per cent in the 1840s and 96 per cent in the 1850s. In every later decade it lies between 97.8 per cent (2000s) and 99.5 per cent (2010s). Overall, 98.5 per cent of 1,826,697 blocks are linked (Table B1). The lowest rates occur in the 1830s and 1840s, which include the low-coverage years excluded from averages. From the 1850s, at least 96 per cent of the blocks in the available reports are linked in every decade.

Figure D4 shows sample speech counts (a) and phrases per speaker (b). Speech counts are at most 3,500 per period before 1843, 33,000–57,000 in 1894–1914, and 69,371 in 1929–1932, a period lasting almost three years. From 1988, they range from 6,100 to 15,400. Panel (b) counts the phrases of the vocabulary before the phrases without content are left out. Phrases per speaker are highest in 1845–1848 (7,400) and 1894–1896 (6,600). They average about 4,700 in 1894–1918 and 2,300 in 1995–2025, while the mean number of days with plenary sittings falls from about 215 to about 105. With the vocabulary used for estimation, the two averages are about 4,100 and 1,800. The lowest values occur in the poorly covered years 1831–1843 and 1991–1995 and in short periods such as 1949–1950. Since penalization retains coefficients only when the data

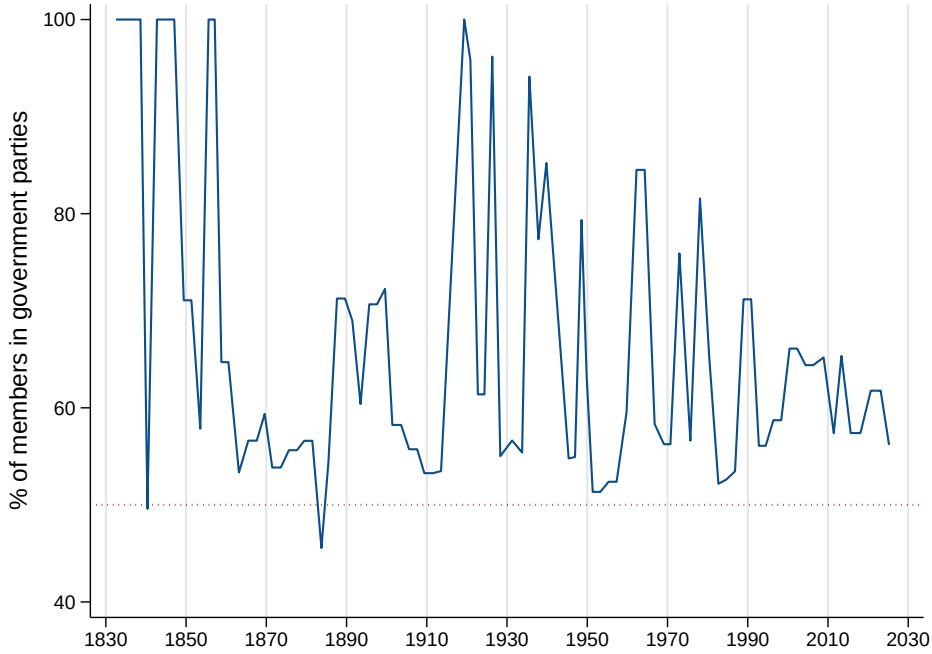



**Figure D2:** Members of the parties in government

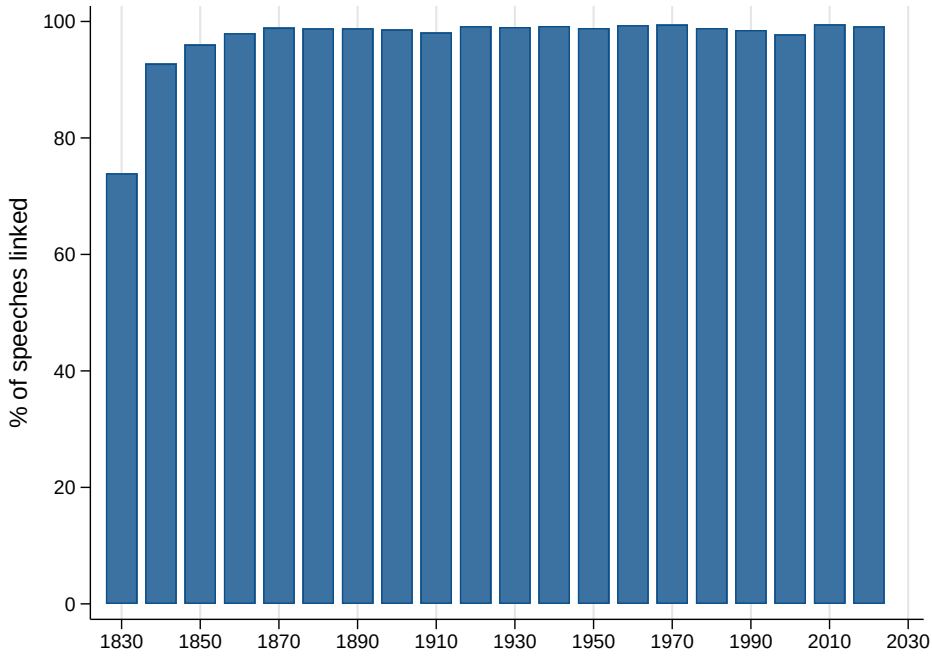



**Figure D3:** Speeches linked to a member or minister, by decade

*Notes*: See Graziani (2026) for the evaluation of the segmentation.

support them, declining speech volume complicates comparisons across eras (Section 5.12).

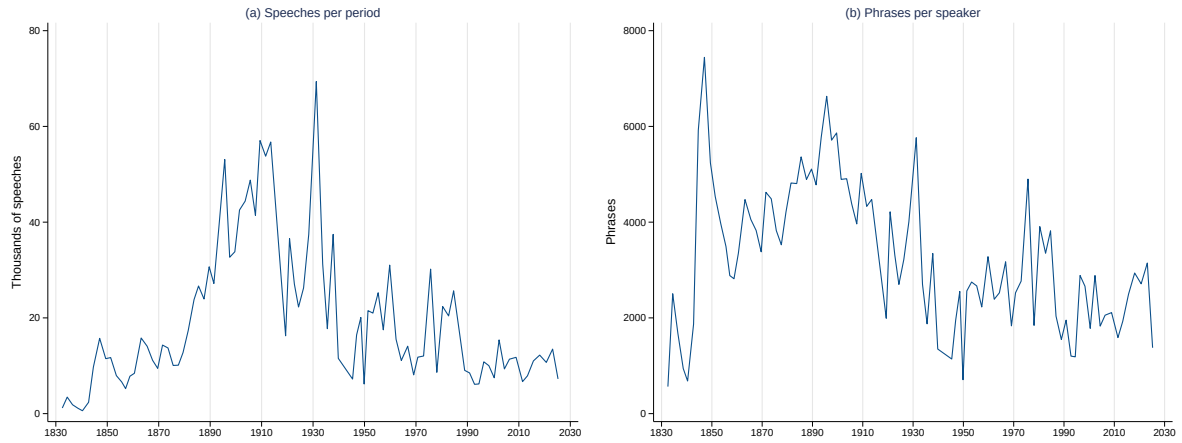



**Figure D4:** Amount of speech

*Notes*: (a) Speeches of the sample in each period. (b) Phrases of the vocabulary before the phrases without content are left out (`output/data/phrases_per_period.csv`), divided by the number of speakers.

Figure D5 shows the share of governing and opposition members who speak at least once per period. Both shares usually range from 80 to 100 per cent. Excluding low-coverage periods and periods with fewer than ten opposition members, opposition participation is higher in 37 of 55 periods since 1894 and 11 of 21 earlier periods, usually by a few points.

The lowest opposition shares, 59 per cent in 1884–1886 and 58 per cent in 1944–1946, include members who never speak. In 1884–1886, these are 34 Liberals who lose their seats in June 1884. In 1944–1946, they are all 18 Flemish nationalist members of the 1939 legislature, 24 Catholics and two Rexists. The opposition's higher speech share in Table D2 mainly reflects speaking more often. Since 1894, opposition speakers deliver a median of 1.7 times as many speeches as governing speakers, and more in 53 of 55 periods.

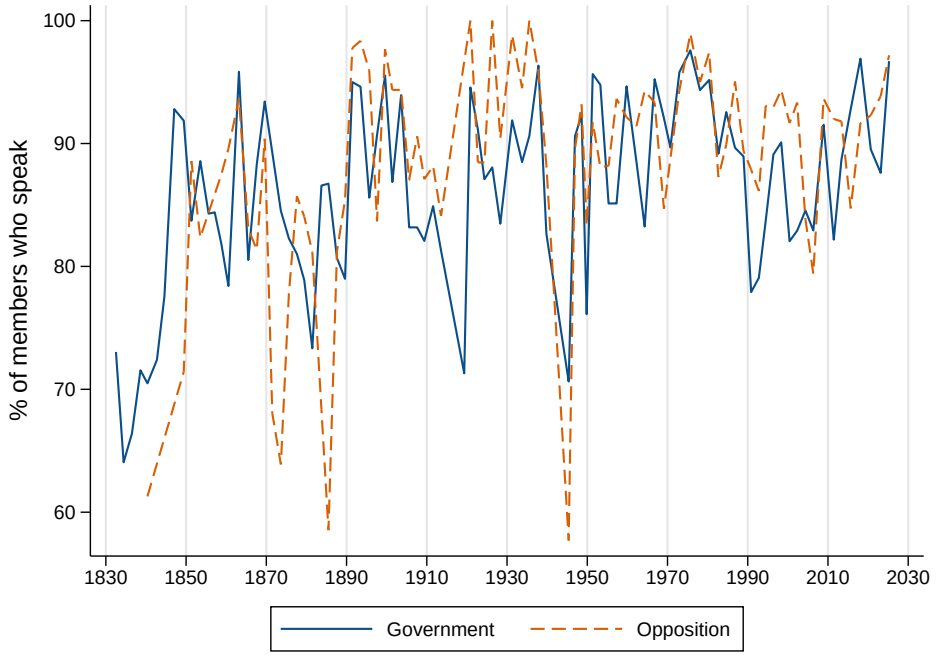



**Figure D5:** Share of government and opposition members who speak

## Online Appendix E: Reactions, references and emotions

Section 7's measures come from a companion module (`code/emotions`). Its first steps cover the full period without a language model. They detect stenographers' stage directions, the chair's interventions and references between members. Later steps classify emotions and tone using a language model and a classifier, as described below. The reported results come from the run of 12 October 2026, made with placeholder labels for those later steps, so Section 7 reports no emotion estimates. Reactions and references do not depend on these labels. Table E1 gives the detected counts.

**Table E1:** Reactions, calls to order and references found by the module

| | Number | Attributed to a member or minister (%) |
|---|---|---|
| *Stage directions (pieces of parentheses) in the speeches and procedural blocks* | | |
| Disorder | 139,378 | |
| Approval | 140,385 | |
| Laughter | 80,753 | |
| Stir | 1,230 | |
| Other (no measure) | 959,806 | |
| *Turns of the chair* | | |
| Calls to order | 1,223 | |
| Censures | 89 | |
| *References in the speeches* | | |
| By name | 1,219,393 | 78.2 |
| By office (ministers) | 654,670 | 68.8 |
| To the rapporteur | 29,045 | 46.6 |
| To the previous speaker | 8,861 | 85.7 |
| By constituency | 4,096 | 42.9 |
| Generic courtesy (no one designated) | 102,534 | |

*Notes*: Plenary sittings, September 1831–2025: 2,260,972 speeches before the split of merged interventions (see text), 26,092 collective interjections and 639,824 procedural blocks in 15,557 sittings. Stage directions: pieces of a parenthesis cut at its dashes and semicolons; a piece counts once in every category it records; the counts include the reactions attributed to the public galleries, which the measures leave out. References: in the 1,833,156 speeches other than the turns of the chair, after the split. Run of `code/emotions` of 12 October 2026 (steps 0–2).

**Sample.** The module uses the version of the dataset used for the partisanship analysis (Graziani, 2026). It selects speeches, collective interjections and procedural blocks from plenary sittings between September 1831 and the end of 2025. As in the partisanship analysis, it excludes committee and Central Commission reports identified in `committee_scan.csv` for 1985–1999, and later documents with committee codes. Chair turns are identified from printed roles (*président*, *voorzitter* and variants), dataset flags or links.

The resulting sample contains 1,833,156 non-chair speeches by members and ministers, a small share unlinked to a person. Unlike the partisanship selection (Table B1), it requires neither a link to a member or minister nor Chamber membership on the sitting date, and it splits the interventions that the reports from 1999 merge with the preceding block (below). After removing parenthetical text, the speeches contain 304 million words. We measure reactions and references in these speeches. Each legislature is split at the midpoint between its first and last sitting, producing 112 half-legislatures for Figures 13 and 15.

From 1999, some numbered interventions remain inside the preceding block of the dataset, often a chair turn, sometimes with a summary in the other language. The module splits these blocks at the printed labels of the interventions (`criv.py`). It cuts 4,058 blocks at 10,569 labels and recovers 7,294 interventions, 98 per cent of them linked to a member or minister. It removes 1,348 summaries in the other language, moves 1.46 million words out of chair turns and 0.23 million out of other members' blocks, and separates 1,141 chair turns from members' blocks. Levels after 1999 nevertheless remain not comparable with earlier ones (Section 7).

**Reactions of the Chamber.** Stenographers record reactions within speech parentheses, for example *(Interruptions.)*, *(Applaudissements à gauche. — Protestations à droite.)* and *(Gelach.)*. The module reads parentheses of at most 25 words in speeches and procedural blocks, splitting them at dashes and semicolons. It normalizes each piece to lowercase without accents or punctuation and matches patterns for one or more categories: disorder (interruptions, noise, murmurs, protests, exclamations, uproar, the chair's gavel and Dutch equivalents), approval (applause, *très bien*, *bravo*, assent), laughter, and stir (*mouvement*, *sensation*). Patterns match word beginnings to detect plurals and OCR-split forms such as *applau dissements*.

A single *(Non.)* or *(Neen.)* usually answers the chair's request for objections. Yes or no counts as approval or disorder only when repeated, as in *Non ! non !*, or attributed to a side of the House. Other pieces—petition or naturalization place names, document references, article numbers and footnotes—enter an unused residual category.

A reaction is assigned to the speech containing it. If printed in procedural text or a chair turn, it is assigned to the preceding non-chair speech in that sitting. We exclude reactions from public galleries. Disorder per 100,000 words is the count of disorder pieces assigned to a group's speeches divided by those speeches' word count. The hostile share is disorder divided by disorder plus approval. Decades follow sitting dates.

**The chair.** We detect calls to order in chair turns using patterns such as *je vous rappelle à l'ordre*, *à l'ordre !* and *ik roep u tot de orde*. Censures use *censure*, *inscription au procès-verbal* and *met vermelding in de notulen*. A turn containing both counts once in each category. We exclude agenda and business-order reminders: *je rappelle que … à l'ordre du jour*, *passer à l'ordre du jour*, *à l'ordre des travaux* and *tot de orde van de dag*. In a check of every detected call on an earlier version of the dataset, these exclusions removed 26 of 1,227 calls. We report calls and censures per 100 sittings. The module also records chair warnings, sitting suspensions and collective interjections, where shouts are attributed to several members. Section 7 does not use these.

**Government, party family and language community.** A speaker is on the governing side on the sitting date if they are a minister or belong to a party with a minister in office. Unlinked speeches have unknown status. We match parties by label, otherwise by family and party language, or by family alone when no language is specified, as before national-party splits. For Flemish nationalists, Francophone regionalists and the residual category, family and language are not enough: the party itself, or its predecessor, must hold office.

Some ministerial terms lack end dates, including 81 of 95 prime-minister terms. We end these the day before the next term in the same portfolio or the next prime minister's appointment.

Where neither follows, the minister is treated as currently in office. Independent and extra-parliamentary ministers count only in cabinets consisting entirely of such ministers. Most members therefore belong to the governing side under the Catholic–Liberal unionist cabinets of 1831–1847: 95 per cent of 1830s speeches with known status.

Party family comes from the member register or, if absent, from the party label. Language community follows party language for parties associated with one community: Flemish nationalists, Francophone regionalists, Greens and other community-specific parties throughout, and Catholics, Liberals and Socialists after their 1968, 1972 and 1978 splits. Otherwise it follows constituency region, assigning Flanders to Dutch and Wallonia to French. For Brussels members from 1919, we instead use the language of at least 70 per cent of their legislature's speeches, provided they deliver at least 20. Community is known for 94 per cent of member-legislatures. Almost every member speaks French before the 1890s, so early community labels describe constituency region rather than spoken language.

**References between members.** We detect references in non-chair speeches after removing parenthetical text. Six pattern types identify: names following titles (*M. Woeste*, *l'honorable M. de Theux*, *MM. Beernaert et Woeste*, *de heer Van Rompuy*, *Mijnheer Tindemans*, *collega De Wever*, *minister Vandenbroucke*); constituency-based references (*l'honorable membre de Gand*); ministerial offices (*M. le ministre des Finances*, *de eerste minister*); rapporteurs; previous speakers (*l'honorable préopinant*, *de vorige spreker*); and generic courtesy without a specific target (*l'honorable membre*). When matches overlap, we keep the most specific.

We match names against members of the legislature and ministers in office on the sitting date. First, we try exact surnames, including leading words of the printed name. Next, we try surnames without particles (*Theux* for *de Theux*), then leading words of longer surnames (*de Theux* for *de Theux de Meylandt*). Finally, names of at least six letters can match members' surnames by similarity to allow for OCR errors. We require a unique best match scoring at least 88 out of 100. Homonyms are resolved by first initial or, failing that, by who speaks in the same sitting. Otherwise they remain unresolved.

An office-based reference targets the minister holding that portfolio. If several qualify, we select the one speaking in the same debate. A minister mentioned without a portfolio is resolved only when a single minister speaks in that debate. Portfolios are unrecognized for 20 per cent of ministerial terms, leaving those ministers identifiable only by name. A rapporteur reference targets the most recent preceding speaker with that printed role in the same debate. A previous-speaker reference targets the last other member to speak in the debate. We exclude self-references.

Among name references, 72 per cent match surnames exactly. Another 6 per cent are resolved through particles, leading words, similarity, initials or sitting participation. One per cent remain ambiguous between homonyms, and 21 per cent match neither a legislature member nor a current minister. These include OCR errors, outsiders and members or ministers from other years. Section 7 uses resolved name references, following Peeters and Lefever (2026)'s name-only counts. A reference crosses families when both family labels are known and differ; the residual small-party category counts as a family. It crosses the language border when both communities

are known and differ.

**Random pairing.** Group sizes affect cross-group reference shares. When one family dominates membership, it receives many references even if speakers address opponents. Figure 15's benchmark randomly pairs each reference's speaker with a target from those referenced in the same half-legislature. The expected cross-group share is $1 - \sum_g s_g t_g$, where $s_g$ is group $g$'s share of references made and $t_g$ its share received. We calculate observed and expected shares by half-legislature. Decade averages include half-legislatures whose midpoint falls in that decade, weighted by reference counts.

**Validation.** Peeters and Lefever (2026, Appendix 1) report counts for 53 investiture, State of the Union and confidence debates in 1961–2023. They count member and minister speeches, excluding chair turns, and name references within and across language groups from Chamber reports. We manually identify each debate's sitting dates using agenda headings, chair announcements and cabinet dates, and list them in the module. For those dates, we select speeches outside headings for other business: questions, interpellations, bills, budgets, motions, petitions, naturalizations and personal statements. We then count name references between members with known language communities.

The module finds speeches for 49 of 53 debates. Investiture sittings from 1992, 1995 and 2003 are missing, and the 1994 debate is unidentified. For 1987 only the government declaration is available. Speech counts differ from those of Peeters and Lefever (2026) by more than 15 per cent in 12 debates: the module finds fewer in 1999, 2006 (only one of the debate days is in the dataset), 2009, 2014, 2018 and 2021–2023, and more in 1977, 1987, 1997 and 2008, when our days include both debates of the first Leterme government. Section 7 reports the comparison.

**Emotions and tone (in preparation).** We remove parenthetical text and divide members' speeches into passages of at most 120 words, producing 4.2 million passages. One language model labels both French and Dutch: OpenAI's `gpt-6-luna`, with low reasoning effort and answers constrained to the codebook's JSON schema. In sampled passages, it rates eight emotions from Widmann and Wich (2023): anger, fear, disgust, sadness, joy, enthusiasm, pride and hope. Ratings range from 0 (absent) to 2 (strong).

In sampled references, the model labels the speaker's stance towards the target as supportive, neutral or critical. It also detects uncivil attacks—insults, mockery, attacks on character or motives, and accusations of lying—and denial of the target's legitimacy as a political actor (Muddiman, 2017). Tone is classified as no attack, civil attack (critical without incivility) or uncivil attack.

The emotion sample contains 8,000 training passages and 2,400 test passages. A quarter of training passages are drawn from text with emotion cues, including exclamations, indignation, pride, hope or recorded disorder, to represent rare emotions. Test passages are allocated equally across institutional periods, languages and the 24 topics of Section 6, within the limits of each cell. The reference sample contains 5,000 training references, half crossing groups, and 2,000 test references, allocated equally across periods and topics. The training samples were drawn first, from an earlier version of the dataset; the test samples come from the version used here. The

74 test passages and 7 test references that also appear in the training samples stay in the gold standard but are left out of the classifiers' test metrics. The language model has labelled all four samples.

Two human coders independently label 300 test passages and 250 test references. We measure their agreement using Cohen's kappa and, for emotions, Krippendorff's alpha. We compare each with the language model using Cohen's kappa. For each task, a single multilingual XLM-R classifier (Conneau et al., 2020) is fine-tuned on language-model labels. Using one classifier for both languages avoids differences in calibration entering trends as Dutch speech grows from almost zero to about 60 per cent. Probabilities are recalibrated on validation labels and averaged by speech, weighting passages by word count. We correct group-period averages for classifier errors with the design-based supervised learning estimator of Egami et al. (2023). Its gold standard is the test sample drawn with known probabilities, using either language-model labels or the two coders' labels.